

CLAUDIAN

WITH AN ENGLISH TRANSLATION BY
MAURICE PLATNAUER

SOMETIME HONORARY SCHOLAR OF NEW COLLEGE, OXFORD
ASSISTANT MASTER AT WINCHESTER COLLEGE

IN TWO VOLUMES

I



CAMBRIDGE, MASSACHUSETTS
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CLAUDIAN

I

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INTRODUCTION

Claudius Claudianus may be called the last poet of classical Rome. He was born about the year 370 A.D. and died within a decade of the sack of the city by Alaric in 410. The thirty to forty odd years which comprised his life were some of the most momentous in the history of Rome. Valentinian and Valens were emperors respectively of the West and the East when he was born, and while the former was engaged in constant warfare with the northern tribes of Alamanni, Quadi and Sarmatians, whose advances the skill of his general, Theodosius, had managed to check, the latter was being reserved for unsuccessful battle with an enemy still more deadly.

It is about the year 370 that we begin to hear of the Huns. The first people to fall a victim to their eastward aggression were the Alans, next came the Ostrogoths, whose king, Hermanric, was driven to suicide; and by 375 the Visigoths were threatened with a similar fate. Hemmed in by the advancing flood of Huns and the stationary power of Rome this people, after a vain attempt to ally itself with the latter, was forced into arms against her. An indecisive battle with the generals of Valens (377) was followed by a crushing Roman defeat in the succeeding year (August 9, 378) at Adrianople, where^[viii] Valens himself, but recently returned from his Persian war, lost his life.

Gratian and his half-brother, Valentinian II., who had become Augusti upon the death of their father, Valentinian I., in 375, would have had little power of themselves to withstand the victorious Goths and Rome might well have fallen thirty years before she did, had it not been for the force of character and the military skill of that same Theodosius whose successes against the Alamanni have already been mentioned. Theodosius was summoned from his retirement in Spain and made Augustus (January 19, 379). During the next three years he succeeded, with the help of the Frankish generals, Bauto and Arbogast, in gradually driving the Goths northward, and so relieved the barbarian pressure on the Eastern Empire and its capital. In 381 Athanaric, the Gothic king, sued in person for peace at Constantinople and there did

homage to the emperor. In the following year the Visigoths became allies of Rome and, for a time at least, the danger was averted.

Meanwhile the West was faring not much better. Gratian, after an uneasy reign, was murdered in 383 by the British pretender, Magnus Maximus. From 383 to 387 Maximus was joint ruler of the West with Valentinian II., whom he had left in command of Italy rather from motives of policy than of clemency; but in the latter year he threw off the mask and, crossing the Alps, descended upon his colleague whose court was at Milan. Valentinian fled to Thessalonica and there threw himself on the mercy of Theodosius. Once more that general was to save the situation.

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Maximus was defeated by him at Aquileia and put to death, while Arbogast recovered Gaul by means of an almost bloodless campaign (388).

The next scene in the drama is the murder at Vienne on May 15, 392, of the feeble Valentinian at the instigation of Arbogast. Arbogast's triumph was, however, short-lived. Not daring himself, a Frank, to assume the purple he invested therewith his secretary, the Roman Eugenius, intending to govern the West with Eugenius as a mere figure-head. Once more, and now for the last time, Theodosius saved the cause of legitimacy by defeating Eugenius at the battle of the Frigidus^[1] in September 394. Eugenius was executed but Arbogast made good his escape, only to fall a few weeks later by his own hand.

Theodosius himself died on January 17, 395, leaving his two sons, Arcadius and Honorius, emperors of the East and West respectively. Arcadius was but a tool in the hands of his praetorian prefect, Rufinus, whose character is drawn with such venomous ferocity in Claudian's two poems. Almost equally powerful and scarcely less corrupt seems to have been that other victim of Claudian's splenetic verses, the eunuch chamberlain Eutropius, who became consul in the year 399. Both these men suffered a violent end: Eutropius, in spite of the pleadings of S. John Chrysostom, was put to death by Gainas, the commander of the Gothic troops in the East; Rufinus was torn to pieces in the presence of Arcadius himself by his Eastern troops.^[2] The instigator of^[x] this just murder was Claudian's hero, Stilicho the Vandal.

Stilicho, who had been one of Theodosius' generals, had been put in command of the troops sent to oppose Alaric, the Visigoth, when the latter had broken away from his allegiance to Rome and was spreading devastation throughout Thrace, Macedonia and Thessaly. He was successful in his campaign, but, upon his marching south into Greece, in order to rid that country also of its Gothic invaders, he was forbidden by Rufinus to advance any farther. There can be little doubt that the murder of Rufinus was Stilicho's answer.

In spite of a subsequent victory over Alaric near Elis in the year 397, Stilicho's success can have been but a partial one, for we find the Visigoth general occupying the post of Master of the Soldiery in Illyricum, the withholding of which office had been the main cause of his defection. Possibly, too, the revolt of Gildo in Africa had something to do with the unsatisfactory termination of the Visigothic war. It is interesting to observe the dependence of Italy on African corn, a dependence of which in the first century of the Christian era Vespasian, and right at the end of the second the pretender Pescennius Niger, threatened to make use. If we can credit the details of Claudian's poem on the war (No. xv.), Rome was very shortly reduced to a state of semi-starvation by Gildo's holding up of the corn fleet, and, but for Stilicho's prompt action in sending Gildo's own brother, Mascezel, to put down the rebellion, the situation might have become even more critical. The poet, it may be remarked, was in an awkward position with regard to the war for,^[xi] though the real credit of victory was clearly due to Mascezel (*cf.* xv. 380 *et sqq.*), he nevertheless wished to attribute it to his hero Stilicho, and, as Stilicho had Mascezel executed^[3] later in that same year (Gildo had been defeated at Tabraca July 31, 398), he prudently did not write, or perhaps suppressed, Book II.

Stilicho, who had married Serena, niece and adoptive daughter of Theodosius, still further secured his position by giving his daughter, Maria, in marriage to the young Emperor Honorius in the year 398. This "father-in-law and son-in-law of an emperor," as Claudian is never wearied of calling him, did the country of his adoption a signal service by the defeat at Pollentia on Easter Day (April 6), 402, of Alaric, who, for reasons of which we really know nothing, had again proved unfaithful to Rome and had invaded and laid waste Italy in the winter of 401-402.

The battle of Pollentia was the last important event in Claudian's lifetime. He seems to have died in 404, four years before the murder of Stilicho by the jealous Honorius and six before the sack of Rome by Alaric—a disaster which Stilicho^[4] alone, perhaps, might have averted.

So much for the historical background of the life of the poet. Of the details of his career we are not well informed. Something, indeed, we can gather from the pages of the poet himself, though it is not much, but besides this we have to guide us only Hesychius of Miletus' short^[xii] article in Suidas' lexicon, a brief mention in the Chronicle of 395, and (a curious survival) the inscription^[5] under the statue which, as he himself tells us,^[6] emperor and senate had made in his honour and set up in the Forum of Trajan. We are ignorant even of the date of his birth and can only conjecture that it was about the year 370. Of the place of his birth we are equally uninformed by contemporary and credible testimony, but there can be little doubt that he came from Egypt,^[7] probably from Alexandria itself. We have, for what it is worth, the word of^[xiii] Suidas and the lines of Sidonius Apollinaris,^[8] which clearly refer to Claudian and which give Canopus as the place of his birth. (Canopus is almost certainly to be taken as synonymous with Egypt.) But besides these two statements we have only to look at his interest in things Egyptian, *e.g.* his poems on the Nile, the Phoenix, etc., at such passages as his account of the rites at Memphis,^[9] at such phrases as "nostro cognite Nilo,"^[10] to see that the poet is an Egyptian himself. It is probable that, whether or not he spent all his early life in Egypt, Claudian did not visit Rome until 394. We know from his own statement^[11] that his first essays in literature were all of them written in Greek and that it was not until the year 395 that he started to write Latin. It is not unlikely, therefore, that his change of country and of literary language were more or less contemporaneous, and it is highly probable that he was in Rome before January 3, 395, on which day his friends the Anicii (Probinus and Olybrius) entered upon their consulship. Speaking, moreover, of Stilicho's consulship in 400 Claudian mentions a five years' *absence*.^[12] Not long after January 3, 395, Claudian seems to have betaken himself to the court at Milan, and it

is from there that he sends letters to Probinus and Olybrius.^[13] Here the poet seems to have stayed for five years, and here he seems to^[xiv] have won for himself a position of some importance. As we see from the inscription quoted above, he became *vir clarissimus, tribunus et notarius*, and, as he does not continue further along the road of honours (does not, for instance, become a *vir spectabilis*) we must suppose that he served in some capacity on Stilicho's private staff. No doubt he became a sort of poet laureate.

It is probable that the "De raptu" was written during the first two years of his sojourn at the court of Milan. The poem is dedicated, or addressed, to Florentinus,^[14] who was *praefectus urbi* from August 395 to the end of 397 when he fell into disgrace with Stilicho. It is to this circumstance that we are to attribute the unfinished state of Claudian's poem.

The Emperor Honorius became consul for the third time on January 3, 396, and on this occasion Claudian read his Panegyric in the emperor's presence.^[15]

Some five weeks before this event another of greater importance had occurred in the East. This was the murder of Rufinus, the praetorian prefect, amid the circumstances that have been related above. The date of the composition of Claudian's two poems "In Rufinum" is certainly to be placed within the years 395-397, and the mention of a "tenuem moram"^[16] makes it probable that Book II. was written considerably later than Book I.; the references, moreover, in the Preface to Book II. to a victory of Stilicho clearly point to that general's defeat of the Goths near Elis in 397.

To the year 398 belong the Panegyric on the^[xv] fourth consulship of Honorius and the poems celebrating the marriage of the emperor to Stilicho's daughter, Maria. We have already seen that the Gildo episode and Claudian's poem on that subject are to be attributed to this same year.

The consuls for the year 399 were both, in different ways, considered worthy of the poet's pen. Perhaps the most savage of all his poems was directed against Eutropius, the eunuch chamberlain, whose claim to the consulship the West never recognized,^[17] while a Panegyric on Flavius Manlius Theodorus made amends for an abusive epigram which the usually more politic Claudian had previously levelled at him.^[18]

At the end of 399, or possibly at the beginning of 400, Claudian returned to Rome^[19] where, probably in February,^[20] he recited his poem on the consulship of Stilicho; and we have no reason for supposing that the poet left the capital from this time on until his departure for his ill-starred journey four years later. In the year 402,^[21] as has already been mentioned, Stilicho defeated Alaric at Pollentia, and Claudian recited his poem on the Gothic war sometime during the summer of the same year. The scene of the recitation seems to have been the Bibliotheca Templi Apollinis.^[22] It was in this year, too, that the poet reached the summit of his greatness^[xvi] in the dedication of the statue which, as we have seen, was accorded to him by the wishes of the emperor and at the demand of the senate.

The last of Claudian's datable public poems is that on the sixth consulship of Honorius. It was composed probably towards the end of 403 and recited in Rome on (or after) the occasion of the emperor's triumphant entry into the city. The emperor had just returned after inflicting a defeat on the Goths at Verona in the summer of 403. It is reasonable to suppose that this triumphant entry (to which the poem refers in some detail, ll. 331-639) took place on the day on which the emperor assumed the consular office, viz. January 3, 404.

In the year 404 Claudian seems to have married some protégée of Serena's. Of the two poems addressed to her the "Laus Serenae" is clearly the earlier, and we may take the other, the "Epistola ad Serenam," to be the last poem Claudian ever wrote. It is a poem which seems to have been written on his honeymoon, during the course of which he died.^[23]

It is not easy to arrive at any just estimate of Claudian as a writer, partly because of an inevitable tendency to confuse relative with absolute standards, and partly (and it is saying much the same thing in other words) because it is so hard to separate Claudian the poet from Claudian the manipulator of the Latin language. If we compare his latinity with that of his contemporaries (with the possible exception of Rutilius) or with that of such a poet as Sidonius Apollinaris, who came not much more^[xvii] than half a century after him, it is hard to withhold our admiration from a writer who

could, at least as far as his language is concerned, challenge comparison with poets such as Valerius Flaccus, Silius Italicus, and Statius—poets who flourished about three centuries before him.^[24] I doubt whether, subject matter set aside, Claudian might not deceive the very elect into thinking him a contemporary of Statius, with whose *Silvae* his own shorter poems have much in common.

Even as a poet Claudian is not always despicable. His descriptions are often clever, *e.g.* the Aponus, and many passages in the “De raptu.”^[25] His treatment of somewhat commonplace and often threadbare themes is not seldom successful—for example, the poem on the Phoenix and a four-line description of the horses of the dawn in the Panegyric on Honorius’ fourth consulship^[26]—and he has a happy knack of phrase-making which often relieves a tedious page:

ille vel aerata Danaën in turre latentem
eliceret^[27]

he says of the pander Eutropius.

But perhaps Claudian’s forte is invective. The panegyrics (with the doubtful exception of that on^[xviii] Manlius, which is certainly brighter than the others) are uniformly dull, but the poems on Rufinus and Eutropius are, though doubtless in the worst of taste, at least in parts amusing.

Claudian’s faults are easy to find. He mistook memory for inspiration and so is often wordy and tedious, as for instance in his three poems on Stilicho’s consulship.^[28] Worse than this he is frequently obscure and involved—witness his seven poems on the drop of water contained within the rock crystal.^[29] The besetting sin, too, of almost all post-Virgilian Roman poets, I mean a “conceited” frigidity, is one into which he is particularly liable to fall. Examples are almost too numerous to cite but the following are typical: “nusquam totiensque sepultus”^[30] of the body of Rufinus, torn limb from limb by the infuriated soldiery; “caudamque in puppe retorquens Ad proram iacet usque leo”^[31] of one of the animals brought from Africa for the games at Stilicho’s triumph; “saevusque Damastor, Ad depellendos iaculum cum quaereret hostes, Germani rigidum misit pro rupe cadaver”^[32] of the giant Pallas turned to stone by the

Gorgon's head on Minerva's shield. Consider, too, the remarkable^[xix] statement that Stilicho, in swimming the Addua, showed greater bravery than Horatius Cocles because, while the latter swam away from Lars Porsenna, the former "dabat ... Geticis pectora bellis."^[33]

Two of the poems are interesting as touching upon Christianity (Carm. min. corp. xxxii. "De salvatore," and l. "In Iacobum"). The second of these two poems can scarcely be held to be serious, and although the first is unobjectionable it cannot be said to stamp its author as a sincere Christian. Orosius^[34] and S. Augustine^[35] both declare him to have been a heathen, but it is probable that, like his master Stilicho, Claudian rendered the new and orthodox religion at least lip-service.

It seems likely that after the death of Claudian (404) and that of his hero, Stilicho, the political poems (with the exception of the Panegyric on Probinus and Olybrius,^[36] which did not concern Stilicho) were collected and published separately. The "Carmina minora" may have been published about the same time. The subsequent conflation of these two portions came to be known as "Claudianus maior," the "De raptu" being "Claudianus minor."

The mss. of Claudian's poems fall into two main classes:

(1) Those which Birt refers to as the *Codices*^[xx] *maiores* and which contain the bulk of the poems but seldom the "De raptu."

(2) Those which Birt calls the *Codices minores* and which contain (generally exclusively) the "De raptu."

Class (1) may be again divided into (a) mss. proper; (b) excerpts. I give Birt's abbreviations.

(a) The most important are:

R = Cod. Veronensis 163. 9th century. Contains only the “Carmina minora.”

G = Cod. Sangallensis S n. 429. 9th century. Contains only the (Latin) “Gigantomachia.”

G (*sic*) = Cod. Reginensis 123. 11th century. Contains only “De Nilo.”

V = Cod. Vaticanus 2809. 12th century.

P = Cod. Parisinus lat. 18,552. 12th or 13th century. Contains all the “Carmina maiora” except (as usual) the “De raptu” and “Pan. Prob. et Olyb.” No “minora.”

C = Cod. Bruxellensis 5380-4. (?) 12th-13th century.

Π = Cod. Parisinus lat. 8082. 13th century. This is Heinsius’ “Regius.” The ms. once belonged to Petrarch and still bears his name.

B = Cod. Neapolitanus Borbonicus 1111 E 47. 13th century.

A = Cod. Ambrosianus S 66. 15th century. Contains all the “maiora” except the “De raptu” and “Pan. Prob. et Olyb.”

J = Cod. Cantabrigiensis coll. Trinitatis 0.3.22. 13th century.

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Besides these are many inferior mss. referred to collectively by Birt as ς .

(b) Consists of:

E = Excerpta Florentina. 15th century.

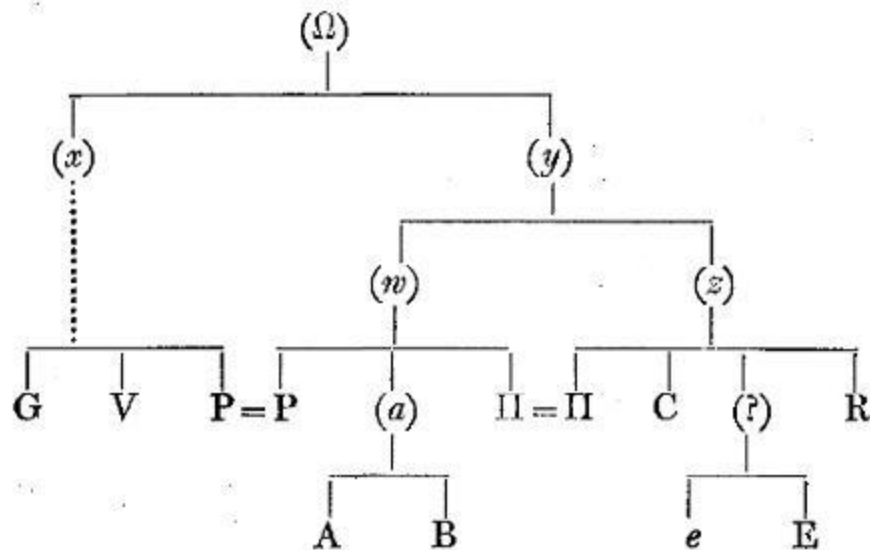
e = Excerpta Gyrالدina. 16th century.

Each of them resembles the other closely and both come from a common parent.

Under (b) may further be mentioned the Basel edition of Isengrin (1534), which preserves an independent tradition.

Birt postulates an archetype (Ω), dating between 6th and 9th centuries, and two main “streams,” x and y; y being again subdivided into w and z.

The following is the family “tree.” Letters enclosed in brackets refer to non-existent MSS.



Of class (2) may be mentioned:

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S = Cod. Parisinus lat. 15,005. 13th or 14th century.

C = Cod. Cantabrigiensis coll. corp. Christi 228. 13th century.

D = Cod. Musei Britannici 6042. 13th century.

W = Cod. Antverpiensis iii. 59. 12th or 13th century.

F = Cod. Florentinus bibl. St. Crucis. 12th century.

A, B = Codd. Oxonienses Bodleiani. (?) 13th century.

V = Cod. Antverpiensis N. 71. 14th century.

It is to be observed that in Birt's edition, and in any other that accepts his “sigla,” A B C and V stand for different MSS. according to whether they refer, or do not refer, to the “De raptu.”

Some MSS. contain scholia but none of these go back before the 12th or even the 13th century.

The chief editions of Claudian are as follows:

Ed. princeps:

Celsanus, Vicenza, 1482.

Ugolentus, Parma, 1500.

Parrhasius, Milan, 1500.

Camers, Vienna, 1510.

Aldine ed. (Asulanus), 1523.

Isengrin ed. (Michael Bentinus), Basel, 1534. [\[37\]](#)

Claverius, Paris, 1602.

Like Bentinus, Claverius used certain mss. (in his case those of the library of Cuiacius) unknown to us. [\[xxiii\]](#) [\[38\]](#)

Plantin ed. (Scaliger), 1603.

Elzevir ed. (Heinsius), Leyden, 1650.

Amsterdam, 1665.

Barth, Hanau, 1612.

Frankfort, 1650.

Delphin ed. (Pyrrho), Paris, 1677.

Burmann, Amsterdam, 1760.

König, Göttingen, 1808.

These last three have good explanatory notes.

The first critical edition is that of L. Jeep (Leipzig, 1876-79).

In 1892 Birt published what must be considered as the standard edition of Claudian—vol. x. in the *Monumenta Germaniae historica* series. Birt was the first to put the text of Claudian on a firm footing, and it is his edition that I have followed, appending critical notes only where I differ from him.

[\[39\]](#)

The latest edition of Claudian is that of Koch (Teubner, Leipzig, 1893). Koch was long associated with Birt in his researches into textual questions connected with Claudian, and his text is substantially the same as that of Birt.

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So far as I know, there is no English prose translation of Claudian already in the field, though various of his poems, notably the “De raptu,” have found many verse translators, and in 1817 his complete works were put into English verse by A. Hawkins. An Italian version was published by Domenico Grillo in Venice in 1716, a German one by Wedekind in Darmstadt in 1868, and there exist two French prose translations, one by MM. Delatour and Geruzet (éd. Nisard, Paris, 1850) and one by M. Héguin de Guerle (Garnier frères, Collection Panckoucke, Paris, 1865).

Of Claudiana may be mentioned Vogt, *De Claudiani carminum quae Stilichonem praedicant fide historica* (1863); Ney, *Vindictae Claudianae* (1865); T. Hodgkin’s *Claudian, the last of the Roman Poets* (1875); E. Arens’ *Quaestiones Claudianae* (1894); two studies by A. Parravicini, (1) *Studio di retorica sulle opere di Claudio Claudiano* (1905), and (2) *I Panegirici di Claudiano* (1909); J. H. E. Crees’ *Claudian as an Historical Authority* (Cambridge Historical Essays, No. 17, 1908); Professor Postgate’s article on the editions of Birt and Koch in the *Class. Rev.* (vol. ix. pp. 162 *et sqq.*), and the same scholar’s Emendations in the *Class. Quarterly* of 1910 (pp. 257 *et sqq.*). Reference may also be made to Professor Bury’s appendix to vol. iii. of his edition of Gibbon (1897, under “Claudian”) and to Harvard Studies in Classical Philology, vol. xxx. *The Encomiums of Claudius Claudianus*. Vollmer’s article in Pauly-Wissowa’s Lexicon is a mine of information, but for completeness Birt’s introduction (over 200 pp. long) stands alone.

The curious may find an interesting light thrown[xxv] on Claudian and his circle by Sudermann’s play, *Die Lobgesänge des Claudian* (Berlin, 1914).

All Claudian’s genuine works are translated in the present volumes with the exception of the two-line fragment “De Lanario” (Birt, c.m.c. lii

[lxxxviii.]). The appendix “vel spuria vel suspecta continens” has been rejected both by Birt and Koch, and I have in this followed their example. The eight Greek poems attributed to Claudian are at least of doubtful authenticity, though Birt certainly makes out a good case for the “Gigantomachia” (a fragment of 77 lines). The remainder consists of short epigrams, two on the well-worn theme of the water enclosed in the crystal and two Christian ones. These last are almost certainly not the work of Claudius Claudianus but of Claudianus Mamertus, presbyter of Vienne *circ.* 474 A.D. We know from Sidonius (*Ep.* iv. 3. 8) that this Claudian was a writer of sacred poetry both in Greek and Latin—indeed the famous “Pange lingua” is attributed to him.

A word should perhaps be said as to the numbering of the poems.

It is much to be regretted that Birt did not cut adrift from Gesner’s system, or at least that he only did so in the “Carmina minora.” The resultant discrepancy in his (and Koch’s) edition between the order of the poems and their numbering is undoubtedly a nuisance, but I have not felt justified, in so slight a work as the present one, in departing from the now traditional arrangement.

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I wish, in conclusion, to express my thanks to my colleagues, Mr. R. L. A. Du Pontet and Mr. E. H. Blakeney: to the first for valuable suggestions on several obscure points, and to the second for help in reading the proofs.

MAURICE PLATNAUER.

WINCHESTER, *September 1921.*

[1] *Cf.* vii. 99 *et sqq.*

[2] v. 348 *et sqq.* S. Jerome (*Ep.* lx.) refers to his death and tells how his head was carried on a pike to Constantinople.

[3] Or at least connived at his death; see Zosimus v. 11. 5.

[4] For an adverse (and probably unfair) view of Stilicho see Jerome, *Ep.* cxxiii. § 17.

[5] *C.I.L.* vi. 1710 (=Dessau 2949). Now in the Naples Museum.

[Cl.] Claudiani v.c. | [Cla]udio Claudiano v.c., tri[bu]no et notario, inter ceteras | [de]centes artes prae[g]loriosissimo | [po]etarum, licet ad memoriam sem[piternam] carmina ab eodem | scripta sufficiant, adtamen | testimonii gratia ob iudicii sui | [f]idem, dd. nn. Arcadius et Honorius | [fe-]licissimi et doctissimi | imperatores senatu petente | statuam in foro divi Traiani | erigi collocarique iusserunt.

Εἰν ἐνὶ Βιργιλίῳ νόον | καὶ Μοῦσαν Ὅμηρου |
Κλαυδιανὸν Ῥώμη καὶ | βασιλῆς ἔθεσαν.

v.c. = vir clarissimus, *i.e.* (roughly) The Rt. Hon. dd. nn. = domini nostri. The inscription may be translated:—To Claudius Claudianus v.c., son of Claudius Claudianus v.c., tribune and notary (*i.e.* Permanent Secretary), master of the ennobling arts but above all a poet and most famous of poets, though his own poems are enough to ensure his immortality, yet, in thankful memory of his discretion and loyalty, their serene and learned majesties, the Emperors Arcadius and Honorius have, at the instance of the senate, bidden this statue to be raised and set up in the Forum of the Emperor Trajan of blessed memory.

Rome and her kings—to one who has combined
A Homer’s music with a Vergil’s mind.

[6] xxv. 7.

[7] John Lydus (*De magistr.* i. 47) writes οὔτος ὁ Παφλαγών, but this, as Birt has shown, is merely an abusive appellation.

[8] *Sid. Ap. Carm.* ix. 274.

[9] viii. 570 *et sqq.*

[10] *Carm. min. corp.* xix. 3: *cf.* also *Carm. min. corp.* xxii. 20.

[11] *Carm. min. corp.* xli. 13.

[12] xxiii. 23.

[13] *Carm. min. corp.* xl. and xli.; see ref. to Via Flaminia in xl. 8.

[14] *Praef.* ii. 50.

[15] vi. 17.

[16] iv. 15.

[17] *Cf.* xxii. 291 *et sqq.*

[18] *Carm. min.* xxi.

[19] xxiii. 23.

[20] So Birt, *Praef.* p. xlii. note 1.

[21] It should perhaps be mentioned that this date is disputed: see Crees, *Claudian as an Historical Authority*, pp. 175 *et sqq.*

[22] xxv. 4 “Pythia ... domus.”

[23] This suggestion is Vollmer's: see his article on Claudian in Pauly-Wissowa, III. ii. p. 2655.

[24] Still more striking is the comparison of Claudian's latinity with that of his contemporary, the authoress of the frankly colloquial *Peregrinatio ad loca sancta* (see Grandgent, *Vulgar Latin*, p. 5: Wölfflin, "Über die Latinität der P. ad l. sancta," in *Archiv für lat. Lexikographie*, iv. 259).

[25] It is not impossible that this poem is a translation or at least an adaptation of a Greek (Alexandrine) original. So Förster, *Der Raub und die Rückkehr der Persephone*, Stuttgart, 1874.

[26] viii. 561-4 (dawns seem to suit him: *cf.* i. 1-6).

[27] xviii. 82, 83.

[28] Honourable exception should be made of xxi. 291 *et sqq.*—one of the best and most sincere things Claudian ever wrote.

[29] It is worth observing that not infrequently Claudian is making "tentamina," or writing alternative lines: *e.g.* Carm. min. corp. vii. 1 and 2, and almost certainly the four lines of id. vi. v. is quite likely "a trial" for some such passage as xv. 523.

[30] v. 453.

[31] xxiv. 357-8.

[32] Carm. min. corp. liii. 101-3.

[33] xxviii. 490.

[34] vii. 35 "Paganus pervicacissimus."

[35] *Civ. dei*, v. 26 "a Christi numine alienus."

[36] This poem does not seem to have been associated with the others till the 12th century.

[37] See section on MSS.

[38] Koch, *De codicibus Cuiacianis quibus in edendo Claudiano Claverius usus est*, Marburg, 1889.

[39] I should like if possible to anticipate criticism by frankly stating that the text of this edition makes no claims to being based on scientific principles. I have followed Birt not because I think him invariably right but because his is at present the standard text. Where I differ from him (and this is but in a few places) I do so not because I prefer the authority of another MS. or because I am convinced of the rightness of a conjecture, but because Birt's conservatism commits him (in my opinion) to untranslatable readings, in which cases my choice of a variant is arbitrary. Of the principle of *difficilior lectio* I pragmatically take no account.

CLAUDIAN

CLAUDII CLAUDIANI CARMINA

**PANEGYRICUS DICTUS
PROBINO ET OLYBRIO
CONSULIBUS**

I

Sol, qui flammigeris mundum
 complexus habenis
 volvis inexhausto redeuntia
 saecula motu,
 sparge diem meliore coma
 crinemque repexi
 blandius elato surgant temone
 iugales
 efflantes roseum frenis
 spumantibus ignem.
 iam nova germanis vestigia
 torqueat annus
 consulibus, laetique petant
 exordia menses.
 Scis genus Auchenium, nec
 te latuere potentes
 Anniadae; nam saepe soles
 ductoribus illis
 instaurare vias et cursibus
 addere nomen. 10
 his neque per dubium pendet
 Fortuna favorem
 nec novit mutare vices, sed
 fixus in omnes
 cognatos procedit honos.
 quemcumque require
 hac de stirpe virum: certum est
 de consule nasci.

**PANEGYRIC ON THE
CONSULS PROBINUS AND
OLYBRIUS**

I

Sun, that encirclest the world with
 reins of flame and rollest in ceaseless
 motion the revolving centuries,
 scatter thy light with kindlier beams
 and let thy coursers, their manes
 combed and they breathing forth a
 rosy flame from their foaming bits,
 climb the heavens more jocund in
 their loftier drawn chariot. Now let
 the year bend its new steps for the
 consul brothers and the glad months
 take their beginning.

Thou wottest of the Auchenian^[40]
 race nor are the powerful Anniadae
 unknown to thee, for thou oft hast
 started thy yearly journey with them
 as consuls and hast given their name
 to thy revolution. For them Fortune
 neither hangs on uncertain favour
 nor changes, but honours, firmly
 fixed, pass to all their kin. Select
 what man thou wilt from their
 family, 'tis certain he is a consul's
 son. Their ancestors are

^[40] Probinus and Olybrius, the consuls
 for 395 (they were brothers), both
 belonged to the Anician gens, of which
 Auchenius became an alternative
 gentile name, Anicius becoming, in

these cases, the *praenomen*. Many members of this family had been, and were to be, consuls: *e.g.* Anicius Auchenius Bassus in A.D. 408. The Annian gens was related by intermarriage to the Anician: *e.g.* Annius Bassus (cos. 331) who married the daughter of Annius Anicius Iulianus (cos. 322).

counted by the fasces (for each has held them), the same recurring honours crown them, and a like destiny awaits their children in unbroken succession. No noble, though he boast of the brazen statues of his ancestors, though Rome be thronged with senators, no noble, I say, dare boast himself their equal. Give the first place to the Auchenii and let who will contest the second. It is as when the moon queens it in the calm northern sky and her orb gleams with brightness equal to that of her brother whose light she reflects; for then the starry hosts give place, Arcturus' beam grows dim and tawny Leo loses his angry glint, far-spaced shine the Bear's stars in the Wain, wroth at their eclipse, Orion's shafts grow dark as he looks in feeble amaze at his strengthless arm.

Which shall I speak of first? Who has not heard of the deeds of Probinus of ancient lineage, who knows not the endless praise of Olybrius?

The far-flung fame of Probus^[41] and his sire lives yet and fills all ears with widespread discourse: the years to come shall not silence it nor time o'ercloud or put an end to it. His great name carries him beyond the seas, beyond Ocean's distant windings and Atlas' mountain

per fasces numerantur avi
semperque renata 15
nobilitate virent, et prolem fata
sequuntur
continuum simili servantia lege
tenorem.
nec quisquam procerum
temptat, licet aere
vetusto
floreat et claro cingatur Roma
senatu,
se iactare parem; sed, prima
sede relicta 20
Aucheniis, de iure licet certare
secundo:
haud secus ac tacitam Luna
regnante per Arcton
sidereae cedunt acies, cum
fratre retuso
aemulus adversis flagraverit
ignibus orbis;
tunc iubar Arcturi languet, tunc
fulva Leonis 25
ira perit, Plaustro iam rara
intermicat Arctos
indignata tegi, iam caligantibus
armis
debilis Orion dextram miratur
inertem.
Quem prius adgrediar?
veteris quis facta
Proбини
nesciat aut nimias laudes
ignoret Olybri? 30
Vivit adhuc completque vagis
sermonibus aures
gloria fusa Probi, quam non
ventura silabunt

caverns. If any live beneath the frozen sky by Maeotis' banks, or any, near neighbours of the torrid zone, drink Nile's stripling stream, they, too, have heard. Fortune yielded to his virtues, but never was he puffed up with success that engenders pride. Though his life was surrounded with luxury he knew how to preserve his uprightness uncorrupted. He did not hide his wealth in dark cellars nor condemn his riches to the nether gloom, but in showers more abundant than rain would ever enrich countless numbers of

[41] Probus was born about 332 and died about 390. He was (among many other things) proconsul of Africa and praefectus of Illyricum.

lustra nec ignota^[6] rapiet sub
 nube vetustas.
 ilium fama vehit trans aequora
 transque remotas
 Tethyos ambages Atlanteosque
 recessus. 35
 audiit et gelido si quem Maeotia
 pascit
 sub Iove vel calido si quis
 coniunctus in axe
 nascentem te, Nile, bibit.
 virtutibus ille
 Fortunam domuit numquamque
 levantibus alte
 intumuit rebus; sed mens
 circumflua luxu 40
 noverat intactum vitio servare
 rigorem.
 hic non divitias nigrantibus
 abdidit antris
 nec tenebris damnavit opes; sed
 largior imbre
 sueverat innumeras hominum
 ditare catervas.

men. The thick cloud of his
 generosity was ever big with gifts,
 full and overflowing with clients was
 his mansion, and thereinto there
 poured a stream of paupers to issue
 forth again rich men. His prodigal
 hand outdid Spain's rivers in
 scattering gifts of gold (scarce so
 much precious metal dazzles the
 gaze of the miner delving in the
 vexed bowels of the earth),
 exceeding all the gold dust carried
 down by Tagus' water trickling from
 unsmelted lodes, the glittering ore
 that enriches Hermus' banks, the
 golden sand that rich Pactolus in
 flood deposits over the plains of
 Lydia.

Could my words issue from a
 hundred mouths, could Phoebus'
 manifold inspiration breathe through
 a hundred breasts, even so I could
 not tell of Probus' deeds, of all the
 people his ordered governance ruled,
 of the many times he rose to the
 highest honours, when he held the
 reins of broad-acred Italy, the
 Illyrian coast, and Africa's lands. But
 his sons o'ershadowed their sire and
 they alone deserve to be called
 Probus' vanquishers. No such honour
 befell Probus in his youth: he was
 never consul with his brother. You
 ambition, ever o'ervaulting itself,
 pricks not; no anxious hopes afflict

quippe velut denso currentia
munera nimbo 45
cernere semper erat, populis
undare penates,
adsiduos intrare inopes, remeare
beatos.

praeceps illa manus fluvios
superabat Hiberos
aurea dona vomens (sic vix^[42]
tellure revulsa
sollicitis fodiens miratur
collibus aurum), 50
quantum stagna Tagi rudibus
stillantia venis
effluxere decus, quanto pretiosa
metalli

Hermi ripa micat, quantas per
Lydia culta
despumat rutilas dives Pactolus
harenas.

Non, mihi centenis pateant si
vocibus ora 55
multifidusque ruat centum per
pectora Phoebus,
acta Probi narrare queam, quot
in ordine gentes
rexerit, ad summi quotiens
fastigia iuris
venerit, Italiae late cum frena
teneret

Illyricosque sinus et quos arat
Africa campos. 60
sed nati vicere patrem solique
merentur

victores audire Probi. non
contigit illi
talis honor, prima cum parte

uirgineque pari

your minds or keep your hearts in
long suspense. You have begun
where most end: but few seniors
have attained to your earliest office.
You have finished your race e'er the
full flower of youth has crowned
your gentle cheeks or adolescence
clothed your faces with its pleasant
down. Do thou, my Muse, tell their
ignorant poet what god it was
granted such a boon to the twain.

When the warlike emperor had with
the thunderbolt of his might put his
enemy to flight and freed

[42] ^{VIRESCERE DEVI} MSS. si quis, *Birt* suggests sic vix;
~~ne consulcum fratre fuit. vos.~~
^{Postgate (C. I. Q. iv. n. 258) quae vix ...}
~~miretur ... Astur.~~
nulla fatigat

cura diu maiora petens, non

anxia mentem 65

spes agit et longo tendit

praecordia voto:

coepistis quo finis erat.

primordia vestra

vix pauci meruere senes,

metasque tenetis

ante genas dulces quam flos

iuvenilis inumbret

oraque ridenti lanugine vestiat

aetas. 70

tu, precor, ignarum doceas,

Parnasia, vatem,

quis deus ambobus tanti sit

muneris auctor.

Postquam fulmineis

impellens viribus

hostem

belliger Augustus trepidas

laxaverat Alpes,

the Alps from fear, Rome, anxious worthily to thank her Probus, hastened to beg the Emperor's favour for that hero's sons. Her slaves, Shock and horrid Fear, yoked her winged chariot; 'tis they who ever attend Rome with loud-voiced roar, setting wars afoot, whether she battle against the Parthians or vex Hydaspes' stream with her spear. The one fastens the wheels to the hubs, the other drives the horses beneath the iron yoke and makes them obey the stubborn bit. Rome herself in the guise of the virgin goddess Minerva soars aloft on the road by which she takes possession of the sky after triumphing over the realms of earth. She will not have her hair bound with a comb nor her neck made effeminate with a twisted necklace. Her right side is bare; her snowy shoulder exposed; her brooch fastens her flowing garments but loosely and boldly shows her breast: the belt that supports her sword throws a strip of scarlet across her fair skin. She looks as good as she is fair, chaste beauty armed with awe; her threatening helm of blood-red plumes casts a dark shadow and her shield challenges the sun in its fearful brilliance, that shield which Vulcan forged with all the subtlety of his skill. In it are depicted the children Romulus and Remus, and their

Roma Probo cupiens dignas
persolvere grates 75
sedula pro natis dominum
flexura rogando
ire parat. famuli currum iunxere
volantem
Impetus horribilisque Metus,
qui semper agentes
proelia cum fremitu Romam
comitantur anhelo,
sive petat Parthos seu cuspide
turbet Hydaspen. 80
hic ligat axe rotas; hic sub iuga
ferrea nectit
cornipedes rigidisque docet
servire lupatis.
ipsa, triumphatis qua possidet
aethera regnis,
adsilit innuptae ritus imitata
Minervae.
nam neque caesariem crinali
stringere cultu 85
colla nec ornatu patitur mollire
retorto;
dextrum nuda latus, niveos
exerta lacertos,
audacem reteggit mammam,
laxumque coercens
mordet gemma sinum; nodus,
qui sublevat ense,
album puniceo pectus
discriminat ostro. 90
miscetur decori virtus
pulcherque severo
armatur terrore pudor,
galeaeque minaci
flava cruentarum praetenditur
umbra iubarum

loving father Mars, Tiber's reverent
stream, and the wolf that was their
nurse; Tiber is embossed in electrum,
the children in pure gold, brazen is
the wolf, and Mars fashioned of
flashing steel.

And now Rome, loosing both her
steeds together, flies swifter than the
fleet east wind; the Zephyrs shrill
and the clouds, cleft with the track of
the wheels, glow in separate furrows.
What matchless speed! One pinion's
stroke and they reach their

umbra iubarum,
 et formidato clipeus Titana^[10]
 laccessit
 lumine quem tota variarat
 Mulciber arte. 95
 hic patrius Mavortis amor
 fetusque notantur
 Romulei; pius amnis inest et
 belua nutrix;
 electro Tiberis, pueri formantur
 in auro;
 fingunt aera lupam; Mavors
 adamante coruscat.
 Iam simul emissis rapido
 velocior Euro 100
 fertur equis; strident Zephyri
 cursuque rotarum
 saucia dividuis clarescunt
 nubila sulcis.
 nec traxere moras, sed lapsu
 protinus uno,

[11]

goal: it is there where in their
 furthestmost parts the Alps narrow
 their approaches into tortuous
 valleys and extend their adamantine
 bars of piled-up rocks. No other
 hand could unlock that gate, as, to
 their cost, those two tyrants^[43]
 found; to the Emperor only they
 offer a way. The smoke of towers
 o'erthrown and of ruined fortresses
 ascends to heaven. Slaughtered men
 are piled up on a heap and bring the
 lowest valley equal with the hills;
 corpses welter in their blood; the
 very shades are confounded with the
 inrush of the slain.

Close at hand the victor, Theodosius,
 happy that his warfare is
 accomplished, sits upon the green
 sward, his shoulders leaning against
 a tree. Triumphant earth crowned her
 lord and flowers sprang up from
 prouder banks. The sweat is still
 warm upon his body, his breath
 comes panting, but calm shines his
 countenance beneath his helmet.
 Such is Mars, when with deadly
 slaughter he has devastated the
 Geloni and thereafter rests, a dread
 figure, in the Getic plain, while
 Bellona, goddess of war, lightens
 him of his armour and unyokes his
 dust-stained coursers; an
 outstretched spear, a huge cornel
 trunk, arms his hand and flashes its

quem poscunt, tetigere locum:
 qua fine sub imo
 angustant aditum curvis
 anfractibus Alpes 105
 claustraque congestis scopulis
 durissima tendunt,
 non alia reseranda manu, sed
 pervia tantum
 Augusto geminisque fidem
 mentita tyrannis.
 semirutae turre avulsaque
 moenia fumant;
 crescunt in cumulum strages
 vallemque profundam
 aequavere iugis; stagnant
 immersa cruore 111
 corpora; turbantur permixto
 funere manes.
 Haud procul exhausto laetus
 certamine victor
 caespite gramineo consederat
 arbore fultus
 adclines umeros; domimim
 gavisa coronat 115
 terra suum, surguntque toris
 maioribus herbae.
 sudor adhuc per membra calet
 creberque recurrit
 halitus et placidi radiant in
 casside vultus:
 qualis letifera populatus caede
 Gelonos
 procubat horrendus Getico
 Gradivus in arvo; 120
 exuvias Bellona levat, Bellona
 tepentes
 pulvere solvit equos,
 immensaque corpus in

tremulous splendour over Hebrus' stream.

When Rome had ended her airy
 journey and now stood before her
 lord, thrice thundered the conscious
 rocks and the black wood shuddered
 in awe. First to speak was the hero:
 "Goddess and friend, mother of
 laws, thou whose empire is
 conterminous with heaven, thou that
 art called the consort of the
 Thunderer, say what hath caused thy
 coming: why leavest thou the towns
 of Italy and thy native clime? Say,
 queen of the world. Were it thy

[\[43\]](#) Maximus and Eugenius. See
 Introduction, p. ix.

immensaue cornus in
hastam^[12]

porrigitur tremulisque ferit
splendoribus Hebrum.

Ut stetit ante ducem
discussas Roma per
auras,
conscia ter sonuit rupes et
inhorrui atrum 125
maiestate nemus. prior hic: “o
numen amicum”
dux ait “et legum genetrix
longeque regendo
circumfusa polo consors ac
dicta Tonantis,
dic agedum, quae causa viae?
cur deseris arces
Ausonias caelumque tuum? dic,
maxima rerum! 130

[13]

wish I would not shrink from toiling
neath a Libyan sun nor from the cold
winds of a Russian midwinter. At thy
behest I will traverse all lands and
fearing no season of the year will
hazard Meroë in summer and the
Danube in winter.”

Then the Queen answered: “Full
well know I, far-famed ruler, that thy
victorious armies toil for Italy, and
that once again servitude and furious
rebels have given way before thee,
overthrown in one and the same
battle. Yet I pray thee add to our late
won liberty this further boon, if in
very truth thou still reverest me.
There are among my citizens two
young brothers of noble lineage, the
dearly loved sons of Probus, born on
a festal day and reared in my own
bosom. ’Twas I gave the little ones
their cradles when the goddess of
childbirth freed their mother’s womb
from its blessed burden and heaven
brought to light her glorious
offspring. To these I would not
prefer the noble Decii nor the brave
Metelli, no, nor the Scipios who
overcame the warlike Carthaginians
nor the Camilli, that family fraught
with ruin for the Gauls. The Muses
have endowed them with full
measure of their skill; their
eloquence knows no bounds. Theirs
not to wanton in sloth and banquets

non ego vel Libycos cessem
tolerare labores
Sarmaticosve pati medio sub
frigore Cauros,
si tu, Roma, velis; pro te
quascumque per oras
ibimus et nulla sub tempestate
timentes
solstitio Meroën, bruma
temptabimus Histrum.”

135

Tum regina refert: “non me
latet, inclite rector,
quod tua pro Latio victricia
castra laborant
nec quod servitium rursus
Furiaeque rebelles
edomitae paribus sub te
cecidere triumphis.
sed precor hoc donum cum
libertate recenti 140
adicias, si vera manet reverentia
nostri.
sunt mihi pubentes alto de
semine fratres,
pignora cara Probi, festa quos
luce creatos
ipsa meo fovi gremio. cunabula
parvis
ipsa dedi, cum matris onus
Lucina beatum 145
solveret et magnos proferrent
sidera partus.
his ego nec Decios pulchros
fortesve Metellos
praetulerim, non, qui Poenum
domuere ferocem,
Scipiadas Callique genus

spread; unbridled pleasure tempts
them not, nor can the lure of youth
undermine their characters. Gaining
from weighty cares an old man's
mind, their fiery youth is bridled by
a greybeard's wisdom. That fortune
to which their birth entitles them I
beg thee assure them and appoint for
them the path of the coming year.
'Tis no unreasonable request and
will be no unheard-of boon. Their
birth demands it should be so. Grant
it; so may Scythian Araxes be our
vassal

Scipiaas Camisqne genus
fatale Camillos.^[14]

Pieriis pollent studiis multoque
redundant 150
eloquio; nec desidiis dapibusve
paratis
indulgere iuvat nec tanta
licentia vitae
adripit aut mores aetas lasciva
relaxat:
sed gravibus curis animum
sortita senilem
ignea longaevo frenatur corde
iuventus. 155
illis, quam propriam ducunt ab
origine, sortem
oramus praebere velis annique
futurum
devoveas venientis iter. non
improba posco,
non insueta dabis: domus haec
de more requirit.
adnue: sic nobis Scythicus
famuletur Araxes, 160

[15]

and Rhine's either bank; so may the
Mede be o'erthrown and the towers
that Semiramis built yield to our
standards, while amazed Ganges
flows between Roman cities."

To this the king: "Goddess, thou
biddest me do what I would fain do
and askest a boon that I wish to
grant: thy entreaties were not needed
for this. Does forgetfulness so
wholly cloud my mind that I will not
remember Probus, beneath whose
leadership I have seen all Italy and
her war-weary peoples come again to
prosperity? Winter shall cause Nile's
rising, hinds shall make rivers their
element, dark-flowing Indus shall be
ice-bound, terror-stricken once again
by the banquet of Thyestes the sun
shall stay his course and fly for
refuge back into the east, all this ere
Probus can fade from my memory."

He spake, and now the speedy
messenger hies him to Rome.
Straightway the choirs chant and the
seven hills re-echo their tuneful
applause. Joy is in the heart of that
aged mother whose skilled fingers
now make ready gold-embroidered
vestment and garments agleam with
the thread which the Seres comb out
from their delicate plants, gathering
the leafy fleece of the wool-bearing
trees. These long threads she draws
out to an equal length with the

sic Rhēnus per utrumque latus,
 Medisque subactis
nostra Semiramiae timeant
 insignia turre;
sic fluat attonitus Romana per
 oppida Ganges.”
 Ductor ad haec: “optata iubēs
 ultrōque volentem,
diva, rogas; non haec precibus
 temptanda fuissent.
usque adeone meam condunt
 oblivia mentem, 166
ut pigeat meminisse Probi, quo
 vindice totam
vidimus Hesperiam fessasque
 resurgere gentes?
ante dabunt hiemes Nilum, per
 flumina dammae
errabunt glacieque niger
 damnabitur Indus, 170
ante Thyesteis iterum conterrita
 mensis
intercisa dies refugos vertetur in
 ortus,
quam Probus a nostro possit
 discedere sensu.”
 Dixerat et velox iam nuntius
 advolat urbem.
extemplo strepuere chori
 collesque canoris 175
plausibus impulsī septena voce
 resultant.
laetatur veneranda parens et
 pollice docto
iam parat auratas trabeas
 cinctusque micantes
stamine, quod molli tondent de
 stinita Sares

threads of gold and by intertwining
them makes one golden cord; as fair
Latona gave scarlet garments to her
divine offspring when they returned
to the now firm-fixèd shrine of Delos
their foster-island, Diana leaving the
forest glades and bleak Maenalus,
her unerring bow wearied with much
hunting, and Phoebus bearing the
sword still dripping with black
venom from the slaughtered Python.
Then their dear island laved the feet
of its acknowledged

supra series
frondea lanigeræ^[16] carpentes
vellera silvae, 180
et longum tenues tractus
producit in aurum
filaque concreto cogit squalere
metallo:
qualis purpureas praebebat
candida vestes
numinibus Latona suis, cum
sacra redirent
ad loca nutricis iam non errantia
Deli, 185
illa feros saltus et desolata
relinquens
Maenala lassato certis venatibus
arcu,
Phoebus adhuc nigris rorantia
tela venenis
extincto Pythone gerens; tunc
insula notos

[17]

deities, the Aegean smiled more gently on its nurslings, the Aegean whose soft ripples bore witness to its joy.

So Proba^[44] adorns her children with vestment rare, Proba, the world's glory, by whose increase the power of Rome, too, is increased. You would have thought her Modesty's self fallen from heaven or Juno, summoned by sacred incense, turning her eyes on the shrines of Argos. No page in ancient story tells of such a mother, no Latin Muse nor old Grecian tale. Worthy is she of Probus for a husband, for he surpassed all husbands as she all wives. 'Twas as though in rivalry either sex had done its uttermost and so brought about this marriage. Let Pelion vaunt no more that Nereid bride.^[45] Happy thou that art the mother of consuls twain, blessed thy womb whose offspring have given the year their name for its own.

So soon as their hands held the sceptres and the jewel-studded togas had enfolded their limbs the almighty Sire vouchsafes a sign with riven cloud and the shaken heavens, projecting a welcoming flash through the void, thundered with prosperous omen. Father Tiber, seated in that low valley, heard the

lambit amica pedes ridetque
Aegaeus alumnis 190
lenior et blando testatur gaudia
fluctu.

Sic Proba praecipuo natos
exornat amictu:
quae decorat mundum, cuius
Romana potestas
fetibus augetur. credas ex
aethere lapsam
stare Pudicitiam vel sacro ture
vocatam 195

Iunonem Inachiis oculos
advertere templis.
talem nulla refert antiquis
pagina libris
nec Latiae cecinere tubae nec
Graeca vetustas.
coniuge digna Probo; nam
tantum coetibus extat
femineis, quantum supereminet
ille maritos. 200
ceu sibi certantes, sexus quid
possit uterque,
hunc legere torum. taceat
Nereida nuptam
Pelion. o duplici fecundam
consule matrem
felicemque uterum, qui nomina
parturit annis!

Ut sceptrum gessere manu
membrisque rigentes
aptavere togas, signum dat
summus hiulca 200
nube Pater gratamque facem per
inane rotantes
prospera vibrati tonuerunt
omina nimbi

sound in his labyrinthine cave. He stays with ears pricked up wondering whence this sudden popular clamour comes. Straightway he leaves his couch of green leaves, his mossy bed, and entrusts his urn to his attendant nymphs. Grey eyes flecked with blue shine out from his shaggy countenance, recalling his father Oceanus; thick curled grasses cover his neck and lush sedge crowns his head.

[44] Anicia Faltonia Proba. She was still alive in 410 and according to Procopius (*Bell. Vand.* i. 2) opened the gates of Rome to Alaric.

[45] Thetis, daughter of Nereus, was married to Peleus on Mount Pelion in Thessaly.

Omnia immota.
 accepit sonitus^[18] curvis Tiberinus
 in antris
 ima valle sedens. adrectis
 auribus haesit, 210
 unde repentinus populi fragor.
 ilicet herbis
 pallentes thalamos et structa
 cubilia musco
 deserit ac Nymphis urnam
 commendat erilem.
 illi glauca nitent hirsuto lumina
 vultu
 caeruleis infecta notis, reddentia
 patrem 215
 Oceanum; crispo densantur
 gramine colla;
 vertice luxuriat toto crinalis
 harundo,

[19]

This the Zephyrs may not break nor
 the summer sun scorch to withering;
 it lives and burgeons around those
 brows immortal as itself. From his
 temples sprout horns like those of a
 bull; from these pour babbling
 streamlets; water drips upon his
 breast, showers pour down his hair-
 crowned forehead, flowing rivers
 from his parted beard. There clothes
 his massy shoulders a cloak woven
 by his wife Ilia, who threaded the
 crystalline loom beneath the flood.

There lies in Roman Tiber's stream
 an island where the central flood
 washes as 'twere two cities parted by
 the sundering waters: with equal
 threatening height the tower-clad
 banks rise in lofty buildings. Here
 stood Tiber and from this eminence
 beheld his prayer of a sudden
 fulfilled, saw the twin-souled
 brothers enter the Forum amid the
 press of thronging senators, the
 bared axes gleam afar and both sets
 of fasces brought forth from one
 threshold. He stood amazed at the
 sight and for a long time incredulous
 joy held his voice in check. Yet soon
 he thus began:

"Behold, Eurotas, river of Sparta,
 boastest thou that thy streams have
 ever nurtured such as these? Did that
 false swan^[47] beget a child to rival
 them, though 'tis true his sons could

quam neque fas Zephyris frangi
 nec sole perustam
 aestivo candore mori; sed
 vivida frondet
 aequaevum complexa caput.
 taurina levantur 220
 cornua temporibus raucos
 sudantia rivos;
 distillant per pectus aquae;
 frons hispida manat
 imbribus; in liquidos fontes se
 barba repectit.
 palla graves umeros velat, quam
 neverat uxor
 Ilia percurrens vitreas sub
 gurgite telas. 225
 Est in Romuleo procumbens
 insula Thybri
 qua medius geminas interfluit
 alveus urbes
 discretas subeunte freto,
 pariterque minantes
 ardua turrigeræ surgunt in
 culmina ripae.
 hic stetit et subitum prospexit
 ab aggere votum: 230
 unanimos^[46] fratres iuncto
 stipante senatu
 ire forum strictasque procul
 radiare secures
 atque uno biiugos tolli de limine
 fasces.
 obstupuit visu suspensaque
 gaudia vocem
 oppressam tenuere diu; mox
 incohat ore: 235
 “Respice, si tales iactas
 aliquos fluenta

fight with the heavy glove and save
 ships from cruel tempests? Behold
 new offspring outshining the stars to
 which Leda gave birth, men of my
 city for whose coming the Zodiac is
 now awatch, making ready his
 hollow tract of sky for a
 constellation that is to be.
 Henceforth let Olybrius rule the
 nightly sky, shedding his ruddy light
 where Pollux once shone, and where
 glinted Castor’s fires there let glitter
 Probinus’

[47] Jupiter, who courted Leda in the
 form of a swan, becoming by her the
 father of Helen, Clytemnestra, Castor
 and Pollux. These latter two were the
 patrons of the ring—hence “decernere
 caestu” (l. 238); and of sailors—hence
 “arcere procellas” (l. 239).

[46] *aiuisse illius,* unanimes;
Ekrota Spartane, tuis. quid
protulit aequum
falsus olor, valido quamvis
decernere caestu
noverit et ratibus saevas arcere
procellas?
en nova Ladaeis suboles
fulgentior astris, 240
ecce mei cives, quorum iam
Signifer optat
adventum stellisque parat
convexa futuris.
iam per noctivagos dominetur
Olybrius axes
pro Polluce rubens, pro Castore
flamma Probini.

flame. These shall direct men's sails and vouchsafe those breezes whereby the sailor shall guide his bark o'er the calm ocean. Let us now pour libation to the new gods and ease our hearts with copious draughts of nectar. Naiads, now spread your snowy bands, wreath every spring with violets. Let the woods bring forth honey and the drunken river roll, its waters changed to wine; let the watering streams that vein the fields give off the scent of balsam spice. Let one run and invite to the feast and banquet-board all the rivers of our land, even all that wander beneath the mountains of Italy and drink as their portion the Alpine snows, swift Vulturnus and Nar infected with ill-smelling sulphur, Ufens whose meanderings delay his course and Eridanus into whose waters Phaëthon fell headlong; Liris who laves Marica's golden oak groves and Galaesus who tempers the fields of Sparta's colony Tarentum. This day shall always be held in honour and observed by our rivers and its anniversary ever celebrated with rich feastings."

So spake he, and the Nymphs, obeying their sire's behest, made ready the rooms for the banquet, and the watery palace, ablaze with

ipsi vela regent, ipsis
 donantibus auras 245
navita tranquillo moderabitur
 aequore pinum.
nunc pateras libare deis, nunc
 solvere multo
nectare corda libet. niveos iam
 pandite coetus,
Naides, et totum violis
 praetexite fontem;
mella ferant silvae; iam profluat
 ebrius amnis 250
mutatis in vina vadis; iam
 sponte per agros
sudent inriguae spirantia
 balsama venae!
currat, qui sociae roget in
 convivia mensae
indigenas Fluvios, Italis
 quicumque suberrant
montibus Alpinasque bibunt de
 more pruinas: 255
Vulturnusque rapax et Nar
 vitiatus odoro
sulphure tardatusque suis
 erroribus Ufens
et Phaëthonteae perpessus
 damna ruinae
Eridanus flavaeque terens
 querceta Maricae
Liris et Oebaliae qui temperat
 arva Galaesus. 260
semper honoratus nostris
 celebrabitur undis
iste dies, semper dapibus
 recoletur opimis.”
Sic ait et Nymphae patris
 praecenta secutae

gleaming purple, shone with
jewelled tables.

O happy months to bear these
brothers' name! O year blessed to
own such a pair as overlords, begin
thou to turn the laborious wheel of
Phoebus' four-fold circle. First let
thy winter pursue its course, sans
numbing cold, not clothed in white
snow nor torn by rough blasts, but
warmed with the south wind's
breath: next, be thy spring calm from
the outset and let the limpid west
wind's gentler breeze flood thy
meads with yellow flowers.

praecepta secum
[22]
tectata parant epulis ostroque
induat infecta usque madentibus
umida gremia inferis, inluxit regia
omni nobilis lustro, tibi gloria

O besol signatum fraterno
contigit nomen tempusquam
o consanguineis felix auctoribus
germanos habuisse duces; te
incipere quadra loquere Phoebi
tellus; te requiescere laborem
prima tibi prope Flora
longaque frigore torpente
non canas vestigia fasti

aspera ventis, 270
sed tepido calefacta Noto; ver
inde serenum
protinus et liquidi clementior
aura Favoni
pratis te croceis pingat; te
messibus aestas

[23]

May summer crown thee with
harvest and autumn store thee with
luscious grapes. An honour that no
age has ever yet known, a privilege
never yet heard of in times gone by,
this has been thine and thine alone—
to have had brothers as thy consuls.
The whole world shall tell of thee,
the Hours shall inscribe thy name in
various flowers, and age-long annals
hand thy fame down through the
long centuries.

**IN RUFINUM LIBER
PRIMUS**

INCIPIT PRAEFATIO

(II.)

**THE FIRST BOOK AGAINST
RUFINUS**

PREFACE

(II.)

When Python had fallen, laid low by the arrow of Phoebus, his dying limbs outspread o'er Cirrha's heights—Python, whose coils covered whole mountains, whose maw swallowed rivers and whose bloody crest touched the stars—then Parnassus was free and the woods, their serpent fetters shaken off, began to grow tall with lofty trees. The mountain-ashes, long shaken by the dragon's sinuous coils, spread their leaves securely to the breeze, and Cephissus, who had so often foamed with his poisonous venom, now flowed a purer stream with limpid wave. The whole country echoed with the cry, "hail, Healer": every land sang Phoebus' praise. A fuller wind shakes the tripod, and the gods, hearing the Muses' sweet song from afar off, gather in the dread caverns of Themis.

A blessed band comes together to hear my song, now that a second Python has been slain by the weapons of that master of ours who

Phoebeo domitus Python cum
decidit arcu
membraque Cirrhaeo fudit
anhela iugo,
qui spiris tegetet montes,
hauriret hiatu
flumina, sanguineis tangeret
astra iubis:
iam liber Parnasus erat nexuque
solutus 5
coeperat erecta surgere
fronde nemus
concussaeque diu spatiosis
tractibus orni
securas ventis explicuere
comas
et qui vipereo spumavit saepe
veneno
Cephisos nitidis purior ibat
aquis. 10
omnis “io Paeon” regio sonat;
omnia Phoebum
rura canunt; tripodas plenior
aura rotat,
auditoque procul Musarum
carmine dulci
ad Themidis coeunt antra
severa dei.

Nunc alio domini telis
Pythone perempto 15
convenit ad nostram sacra
caterva lyram,
qui stabilem servans Augustis
fratribus orbem
iustitia pacem, viribus arma
regit.

made the rule of the brother
Emperors hold the world steady,
observing justice in peace and
showing vigour in war.

LIBER I

(III.)

BOOK I

(III.)

My mind has often wavered between two opinions: have the gods a care for the world or is there no ruler therein and do mortal things drift as dubious chance dictates? For when I investigated the laws and the ordinances of heaven and observed the sea's appointed limits, the year's fixed cycle and the alternation of light and darkness, then methought everything was ordained according to the direction of a God who had bidden the stars move by fixed laws, plants grow at different seasons, the changing moon fulfil her circle with borrowed light and the sun shine by his own, who spread the shore before the waves and balanced the world in the centre of the firmament. But when I saw the impenetrable mist which surrounds human affairs, the wicked happy and long prosperous and the good discomforted, then in turn my belief in God was weakened and failed, and even against mine own will I embraced the tenets of that other philosophy^[48] which teaches that atoms drift in purposeless motion and that new forms throughout the vast void are shaped by chance and not design—

Saepe mihi dubiam traxit
sententia mentem,
curarent superi terras an nullus
inesset
rector et incerto fluerent
mortalia casu.
nam cum dispositi quaesissem
foedera mundi
praescriptosque mari fines
annisque meatus 5
et lucis noctisque vices: tunc
omnia rebar
consilio firmata dei, qui lege
moveri
sidera, qui fruges diverso
tempore nasci,
qui variam Phoeben alieno
iusserit igni
compleri Solemque suo,
porrexerit undis 10
litora, tellurem medio libraverit
axe.
sed cum res hominum tanta
caligine volvi
adspicerem laetosque diu
florere nocentes
vexarique pios, rursus labefacta
cadebat
relligio causaeque viam non
sponte sequebar 15
alterius, vacuo quae currere
semina motu
adfirmat magnumque novas per
inane figuras
fortuna non arte regi, quae
numina sensu
ambiguo vel nulla putat vel
nescia nostri

that philosophy which believes in
God in an ambiguous sense, or holds
that there be no gods, or that they are
careless of our doings. At

[48] Epicureanism.

last Rufinus' fate has dispelled this uncertainty and freed the gods from this imputation. No longer can I complain that the unrighteous man reaches the highest pinnacle of success. He is raised aloft that he may be hurled down in more headlong ruin. Muses, unfold to your poet whence sprang this grievous pest.

Dire Allecto once kindled with jealous wrath on seeing widespread peace among the cities of men. Straightway she summons the hideous council of the nether-world sisters to her foul palace gates. Hell's numberless monsters are gathered together, Night's children of ill-omened birth. Discord, mother of war, imperious Hunger, Age, near neighbour to Death; Disease, whose life is a burden to himself; Envy that brooks not another's prosperity, woeful Sorrow with rent garments; Fear and foolhardy Rashness with sightless eyes; Luxury, destroyer of wealth, to whose side ever clings unhappy Want with humble tread, and the long company of sleepless Cares, hanging round the foul neck of their mother Avarice. The iron seats are filled with all this rout and the grim chamber is thronged with the monstrous crowd. Allecto stood in their midst and called for silence,

abstulit hunc tandem Rufini
 poena tumultum 20
absolvitque deos. iam non ad
 culmina rerum
iniustos crevisse queror;
 tolluntur in altum,
ut lapsu graviore ruant. vos
 pandite vati,
Pierides, quo tanta lues eruperit
 ortu.
 Invidiae quondam stimulis
 incanduit atrox 25
Allecto, placidas late cum
 cerneret urbes.
protinus infernas ad limina
 taetra sorores
concilium deforme vocat.
 glomerantur in unum
innumerae pestes Erebi,
 quascumque sinistro
Nox genuit fetu: nutrix
 Discordia belli, 30
imperiosa Fames, leto vicina
 Senectus
impatiensque sui Morbus
 Livorque secundis
anxius et scisso maerens
 velamine Luctus
et Timor et caeco praeceps
 Audacia vultu
et Luxus populator opum, quem
 semper adhaerens 35
infelix humili gressu comitatur
 Egestas,
foedaque Avaritiae complexae
 pectora matris
insomnes longo veniunt
 examine Curae

thrusting behind her back the snaky
hair that swept her face and letting it
play over her shoulders. Then with
mad utterance she unlocked the
anger deep hidden in her heart.

“Shall we allow the centuries to roll
on in this even tenour, and man to
live thus blessed? What novel
kindliness has corrupted our
characters? Where is our inbred
fury? Of what use the lash with none
to suffer beneath it? Why this
purposeless girdle of smoky torches?
Sluggards, ye,

complementur vario^[30] ferrata sedilia
 coetu
 torvaque collectis stipatur curia
 monstribus. 40
 Allecto stetit in mediis
 vulgusque tacere
 iussit et obstantes in tergum
 reppulit angues
 perque umeros errare dedit. tum
 corde sub imo
 inclusam rabidis patefecit
 vocibus iram:
 “Sicine tranquillo produci
 saecula cursu, 45
 sic fortunatas patiemur vivere
 gentes?
 quae nova corrumpit nostros
 clementia mores?
 quo rabies innata perit? quid
 inania prosunt
 verbera? quid facibus
 nequiquam cingimur
 atris?

whom Jove has excluded from heaven, Theodosius from earth. Lo! a golden age begins; lo! the old breed of men returns. Peace and Godliness, Love and Honour hold high their heads throughout the world and sing a proud song of triumph over our conquered folk. Justice herself (oh the pity of it!), down-gliding through the limpid air, exults over me and, now that crime has been cut down to the roots, frees law from the dark prison wherein she lay oppressed. Shall we, expelled from every land, lie this long age in shameful torpor? Ere it be too late recognize a Fury's duty: resume your wonted strength and decree a crime worthy of this august assembly. Fain would I shroud the stars in Stygian darkness, smirch the light of day with our breath, unbridle the ocean deeps, hurl rivers against their shattered banks, and break the bonds of the universe.”

So spake she with cruel roar and uproused every gaping serpent mouth as she shook her snaky locks and scattered their baneful poison. Of two minds was the band of her sisters. The greater number was for declaring war upon heaven, yet some respected still the ordinances of Dis and the uproar grew by reason of their dissension, even as the sea's

heu nimis ignavae, quas
Iuppiter arcet Olympo,
50
Theodosius terris. en aurea
nascitur aetas,
en proles antiqua redit.
Concordia, Virtus
eumque Fide Pietas alta cervice
vagantur
insignemque canunt nostra de
plebe triumphum.
pro dolor! ipsa mihi liquidas
delapsa per auras 55
Iustitia insultat vitiisque a stirpe
recisis
elicit oppressas tenebroso
carcere leges.
at nos indecores longo
torpebimus aevo
omnibus eiectae regnis!
agnoscite tandem
quid Furias deceat; consuetas
sumite vires 60
conventuque nefas tanto
decernite dignum.
iam cupio Stygiis invadere
nubibus astra,
iam flatu violare diem, laxare
profundo
frena mari, fluvios ruptis
inmittere ripis
et rerum vexare fidem.”

Sic

fata cruentum 65
mugiit et totos serpentum erexit
hiatus
noxiaque effudit concusso crine
venena

calm is not at once restored, but the
deep still thunders when, for all the
wind be dropped, the swelling tide
yet flows, and the last weary winds
of the departing storm play o’er the
tossing waves.

Thereupon cruel Megaera rose from
her funereal seat, mistress she of
madness’ howlings and impious ill
and wrath bathed in fury’s foam. No
blood her drink but that flowing
from kindred slaughter and
forbidden crime, shed by a father’s,
by a brother’s

venia.

anceps motus erat vulgi. pars
maxima bellum
indicit superis, pars Ditis iura
veretur,
dissensuque alitur rumor: ceu
murmurat alti 70
impacata quies pelagi, cum
flamine fracto
durat adhuc saevitque tumor
dubiumque per aestum
lassa recedentis fluitant vestigia
venti.

Improba mox surgit tristi de
sede Megaera,
quam penes insani fremitus
animique profanus 75
error et undantes spumis
furialibus irae:
non nisi quaesitum cognata
caede cruorem
inlicitumve bibit, patrius quem
fuderit ensis,

[33]

sword. 'Twas she made e'en
Hercules afraid and brought shame
upon that bow that had freed the
world of monsters; she aimed the
arrow in Athamas' [49] hand: she took
her pleasure in murder after murder,
a mad fury in Agamemnon's palace;
beneath her auspices wedlock mated
Oedipus with his mother and
Thyestes with his daughter. Thus
then she speaks with dread-sounding
words:

"To raise our standards against the
gods, my sisters, is neither right nor,
methinks, possible; but hurt the
world we may, if such our wish, and
bring an universal destruction upon
its inhabitants. I have a monster
more savage than the hydra brood,
swifter than the mother tigress,
fiercer than the south wind's blast,
more treacherous than Euripus'
yellow flood—Rufinus. I was the
first to gather him, a new-born babe,
to my bosom. Often did the child
nestle in mine embrace and seek my
breast, his arms thrown about my
neck in a flood of infant tears. My
snakes shaped his soft limbs licking
them with their three-forked tongues.
I taught him guile whereby he learnt
the arts of injury and deceit, how to
conceal the intended menace and
cover his treachery with a smile,
full-filled with savagery and hot with

quem dederint fratres; haec
 terrui Herculis ora
et defensores terrarum polluit
 arcus, 80
haec Athamanteae direxit
 spicula dextrae,
haec Agamemnonios inter
 bacchata penates
alternis lusit iugulis; hac
 auspice taedae
Oedipoden matri, natae iunxere
 Thyesten.
quae tunc horronis effatur
 taliter dictis: 85
 “Signa quidem, sociae, divos
 attollere contra
nec fas est nec posse reor; sed
 laedere mundum
si libet et populis commune
 intendere letum.
est mihi prodigium cunctis
 inmanius hydri,
tigride mobilis feta, violentius
 Austris 90
acribus, Euripi fulvis incertius
 undis
Rufinus, quem prima meo de
 matre cadentem
suscepi gremio. parvus reptavit
 in isto
saepo sinu teneroque per ardua
 colla volutus
ubera quaesivit fletu linguisque
 trisulcis 95
mollia lambentes finxerunt
 membra cerastae;
meque etiam tradente dolos
 artibus nocendi

lust of gain. Him nor the sands of
rich Tagus' flood by Tartessus' town
could satisfy nor the golden waters
of ruddy Pactolus; should he drink
all Hermus' stream he would parch
with the greedier thirst. How skilled
to deceive and wreck friendships
with hate! Had that old generation of
men produced such an one as he,
Theseus had fled Pirithous, Pylades
deserted Orestes in wrath, Pollux
hated Castor. I confess myself his
inferior: his quick genius has
outstripped

[49] Athamas, king of Orchomenus,
murdered his son Learchus in a fit of
madness.

edidicit: simulare^[34] fidem
 sensusque minaces
 protegere et blando fraudem
 praetexere risu,
 plenus saevitiae lucrique
 cupidine fervens. 100
 non Tartesiaceis ilium satiaret
 harenis
 tempestas pretiosa Tagi, non
 stagna rubentis
 aurea Pactoli; totumque
 exhausit Hermum,
 ardebit maiore siti. quam fallere
 mentes
 doctus et unanimos odiis
 turbare sodales! 105
 talem progenies hominum si
 prisca tulisset,
 Perithoum fugeret Theseus,
 offensus Orestem
 desereret Pylades, odisset
 Castora Pollux.
 ipsa quidem fateor vinci
 rapidoque magistram

[35]

his preceptress: in a word (that I waste not your time further) all the wickedness that is ours in common is his alone. Him will I introduce, if the plan commend itself to you, to the kingly palace of the emperor of the world. Be he wiser than Numa, be he Minos' self, needs must he yield and succumb to the treachery of my foster child."

A shout followed her words: all stretched forth their impious hands and applauded the awful plot. When Megaera had gathered together her dress with the black serpent that girdled her, and bound her hair with combs of steel, she approached the sounding stream of Phlegethon, and seizing a tall pine-tree from the scorched summit of the flaming bank kindled it in the pitchy flood, then plied her swift wings o'er sluggish Tartarus.

There is a place where Gaul stretches her furthestmost shore spread out before the waves of Ocean: 'tis there that Ulysses is said to have called up the silent ghosts with a libation of blood. There is heard the mournful weeping of the spirits of the dead as they flit by with faint sound of wings, and the inhabitants see the pale ghosts pass and the shades of the dead. 'Twas from here the goddess leapt forth, dimmed the

praevenit ingenio; nec plus
 sermone morabor: 110
solus habet scelerum quidquid
 possedimus omnes.
hunc ego, si vestrae res est
 accommoda turbae,
regalem ad summi producam
 principis aulam.
sit licet ipse Numa gravior, sit
 denique Minos,
cedet et insidiis nostri flectetur
 alumni.” 115
 Orantem sequitur clamor
 cunctaeque profanas
porrexere manus inventaque
 tristia laudant.
illa ubi caeruleo vestes conexuit
 angue
nodavitque adamante comas,
 Phlegethonta sonorum
poscit et ambusto flagrantis ab
 aggere ripae 120
ingentem piceo succendit
 gurgite pinum
pigraque veloces per Tartara
 concutit alas.
 Est locus extremum pandit
 qua Gallia litus
Oceani praetentus aquis, ubi
 fertur Ulixes
sanguine libato populum
 movisse silentem. 125
illic umbrarum tenui stridore
 volantum
flebilis auditur questus;
 simulacra coloni
pallida defunctasque vident
 migrare figuras

sun's fair beams and clave the sky
with horrid howlings. Britain felt the
deadly sound, the noise shook the
country of the Senones,^[50] Tethys
stayed her tide, and Rhine let fall his
urn and shrank his stream.
Thereupon, in the guise of an old
man, her serpent locks changed at
her desire to snowy hair, her dread
cheeks furrowed with many a
wrinkle and feigning weariness in
her gait she enters the walls of Elusa,
^[51] in search of the house she had
long known so well. Long

^[50] Their territory lay some sixty
miles S.E. of Paris. Its chief town was
Agedincum (mod. Sens).

^[51] Elusa (the modern Eauze in the
Department of Gers) was the birthplace
of Rufinus (*cf.* Zosim. iv. 51. 1).

ingratas linguas.
hinc dea prosiluit^[36] Phoebique
egressa serenos
infecit radios ululatuque aethera
rupit 130
terrifico: sentit ferale Britannia
murmur
et Senonum quatit arva fragor
revolutaque Tethys
substitit et Rhenus proiecta
torpuit urna.
tunc in canitiem mutatis sponte
colubris
longaevum mentita senem
rugisque seueras 135
persulcata genas et ficto
languida passu
invadit muros Elusae, notissima
dudum

[37]

she stood and gazed with jealous eyes, marvelling at a man worse than herself; then spake she thus: "Does ease content thee, Rufinus? Wastest thou in vain the flower of thy youth inglorious thus in thy father's fields? Thou knowest not what fate and the stars owe thee, what fortune makes ready. So thou wilt obey me thou shalt be lord of the whole world. Despise not an old man's feeble limbs: I have the gift of magic and the fire of prophecy is within me. I have learned the incantations wherewith Thessalian witches pull down the bright moon, I know the meaning of the wise Egyptians' runes, the art whereby the Chaldeans impose their will upon the subject gods, the various saps that flow within trees and the power of deadly herbs; all those that grow on Caucasus rich in poisonous plants, or, to man's bane, clothe the crags of Scythia; herbs such as cruel Medea gathered and curious Circe. Often in nocturnal rites have I sought to propitiate the dread ghosts and Hecate, and recalled the shades of buried men to live again by my magic: many, too, has my wizardry brought to destruction though the Fates had yet somewhat of their life's thread to spin. I have caused oaks to walk and the thunderbolt to stay his course, aye, and made rivers

tecta petens, oculisque diu
 liventibus haesit
peiolem mirata virum, tum talia
 fatur:

 “Otia te, Rufine, iuvant
 frustraue iuventae 140
consumis florem patriis
 inglorius arvis?
heu nescis quid fata tibi, quid
 sidera debent,
quid Fortuna parat: toto
 dominabere mundo,
si parere velis! artus ne sperne
 seniles!
namque mihi magicae vires
 aevique futuri 145
praescius ardor inest; novi quo
 Thessala cantu
eripiat lunare iubar, quid signa
 sagacis
Aegypti valeant, qua gens
 Chaldaea vocatis
imperet arte deis, nec me
 latuere fluentes
arboribus suci funestorumque
 potestas 150
herbarum, quidquid letali
 gramine pollens
Caucasus et Scythicae vernant
 in crimina^[52] rupes,
quas legit Medea ferox et
 callida Circe.
saepius horrendos manes
 sacrisque litavi
nocturnis Hecaten et condita
 funera traxi 155
carminibus victura meis,
 multaque gerenda

reverse their course and flow
backwards to their fount. Lest thou
perchance think these be but idle
boasts behold the change of thine
own house.” At these words the
white pillars, to his amazement,
began to turn into gold and the
beams of a sudden to shine with
metal.

His senses are captured by the bait,
and, thrilled beyond measure, he
feasts his greedy eyes on the sight.
So Midas, king of Lydia, swelled at
first

[52] ~~mutosque caueo~~
~~quamvis, parcarum testantur~~
gramina. *E. other codd.* gramine.
carmina. *I take Postgate's* crimina.
filia, perem.

ire vagas quercus et fulmen
stare coegi

versaue non prono curvavi
flumina lapsu

in fontes reditura suos. ne vana
locutum 160

me fortasse putes, mutatos
cerne penates.”

dixerat, et niveae (mirum!)
coepere columnae

ditari subitoque trabes lucere
metallo.

Inlecebris capitur nimiumque
elatus avaro

pascitur aspectu. sic rex ad
prima tumebat 165

with pride when he found he could transform everything he touched to gold: but when he beheld his food grow rigid and his drink harden into golden ice then he understood that this gift was a bane and in his loathing for the gold cursed his prayer. Thus Rufinus, overcome, cried out: "Whithersoever thou summonest me I follow, be thou man or god." Then at the Fury's bidding he left his fatherland and approached the cities of the East, threading the once floating Symplegades and the seas renowned for the voyage of the Argo, ship of Thessaly, till he came to where, beneath its high-walled town, the gleaming Bosphorus separates Asia from the Thracian coast.

When he had completed this long journey and, led by the evil thread of the fates, had won his way into the far-famed palace, then did ambition straightway come to birth and right was no more. Everything had its price. He betrayed secrets, deceived dependents, and sold honours that had been wheedled from the emperor. He followed up one crime with another, heaping fuel on the inflamed mind and probing and embittering the erstwhile trivial wound. And yet, as Nereus knows no addition from the infinitude of rivers

Maeonius, pulchro cum verteret
omnia tactu;
sed postquam riguisse dapes
fulvamque revinctos
in glaciem vidit latices, tum
munus acerbum
sensit et invisum votum damnavit
in auro.
ergo animi victus “sequimur
quocumque vocabis, 170
seu tu vir seu numen” ait,
patriaque relictas
Eoas Furiae iussu tendebat ad
arces
instabilesque olim Symplegadas
et freta remis
inclita Thessalicis, celsa qua
Bosporus urbe
splendet et Odrysiis Asiam
discriminat oris. 175
Ut longum permensus iter
ductusque maligno
stamine fatorum claram
subrepsit in aulam,
ilicet ambitio nasci, discedere
rectum,
venum cuncta dari; profert
arcana, clientes
fallit et ambitos a principe
vendit honores. 180
ingeminat crimen, commoti
pectoris ignem
nutrit et exiguum stimulando
vulnus acerbatur.
ac velut innumeros amnes
accedere Nereus
nescit et undantem quamvis
hinc hauriat Histrum

that flow into him and though here
he drains Danube's wave and there
Nile's summer flood with its
sevenfold mouth, yet ever remains
his same and constant self, so
Rufinus' thirst knew no abatement
for all the streams of gold that
flowed in upon him. Had any a
necklace studded with jewels or a
fertile demesne he was sure prey for
Rufinus: a rich property assured the
ruin of its own possessor: fertility
was the husbandman's bane. He
drives them from their homes, expels
them from the lands their sires had

hinc bibat aestivum septeno
gurgite Nilum, 185
par semper similisque manet:
sic fluctibus auri
expleri calor ille nequit.
cuicumque monile
contextum gemmis aut praedia
cultu fuissent,
Rufino populandus erat,
dominoque parabat
exitium fecundus ager;
metuenda colonis 190
fertilitas: laribus pellit, detrudit
avitis

[41]

left them, either wresting them from the living owners or fastening upon them as an inheritor. Massed riches are piled up and a single house receives the plunder of a world; whole peoples are forced into slavery, and thronging cities bow beneath the tyranny of a private man.

Madman, what shall be the end? Though thou possess either Ocean, though Lydia pour forth for thee her golden waters, though thou join Croesus' throne to Cyrus' crown, yet shalt thou never be rich nor ever contented with thy booty. The greedy man is always poor. Fabricius, happy in his honourable poverty, despised the gifts of monarchs; the consul Serranus sweated at his heavy plough and a small cottage gave shelter to the warlike Curii. To my mind such poverty as this is richer than thy wealth, such a home greater than thy palaces. There pernicious luxury seeks for the food that satisfieth not; here the earth provides a banquet for which is nought to pay. With thee wool absorbs the dyes of Tyre; thy patterned clothes are stained with purple; here are bright flowers and the meadow's breathing charm which owes its varied hues but to itself. There are beds piled on glittering bedsteads; here stretches the soft grass, that breaks not sleep

finibus; aut aufert vivis aut
occupat heres
congestae cumulantur opes
orbisque ruinas
accipit una domus: populi
servire coacti
plenaque privato succumbunt
oppida regno. 195
Quo, vesane, ruis? teneas
utrumque licebit
Oceanum, laxet rutilos tibi
Lydia fontes,
iungatur solium Croesi Cyrique
tiara:
numquam dives eris, numquam
satiabere quaestu.
semper inops quicumque cupit.
contentus honesto
Fabricius parvo spernebat
munera regum 201
sudabatque gravi consul
Serranus aratro
et casa pugnaces Curios angusta
tegebat.
haec mihi paupertas opulentior,
haec mihi tecta
culminibus maiora tuis. ibi
quaerit inanes 205
luxuries nocitura cibos; hic
donat inemptas
terra dapes. rapiunt Tyrios ibi
vellera sucos
et picturatae saturantur murice
vestes;
hic radiant flores et prati viva
voluptas
ingenio variata suo. fulgentibus
illic 210

with anxious cares. There a crowd of
clients dines through the spacious
halls, here is song of birds and the
murmur of the gliding stream. A
frugal life is best. Nature has given
the opportunity of happiness to all,
knew they but how to use it. Had we
realized this we should now have
been enjoying a simple life, no
trumpets would be sounding, no
whistling spear would speed, no ship
be buffeted by the wind, no siege-
engine overthrow battlements.

surgunt strata torris; hic mollis
 panditur herba
 sollicitum curis non abruptura
 soporem.
 turba salutantum latas ibi
 perstrepat aedes;
 hic avium cantus, labentis
 murmura rivi.
 vivitur exiguo melius; natura
 beatis 215
 omnibus esse dedit, si quis
 cognoverit uti.
 haec si nota forent, frueremur
 simplice cultu,
 classica non gemerent, non
 stridula fraxinus iret,
 nec ventus quateret puppes nec
 machina muros.

Still grew Rufinus' wicked greed,
 and his impious passion for new-
 won wealth blazed yet fiercer; no
 feeling of shame kept him from
 demanding and extorting money. He
 combines perjury with ceaseless
 cajolery, ratifying with a hand-clasp
 the bond he purposes to break.
 Should any dare to refuse his
 demand for one thing out of so
 many, his fierce heart would be
 stirred with swelling wrath. Was ever
 lioness wounded with a Gaetolian's
 spear, or Hyrcan tiger pursuing the
 robber of her young, was ever
 bruised serpent so fierce? He swears
 by the majesty of the gods and
 tramples on his oath. He reverences
 not the laws of hospitality. To kill a
 wife and her husband with her and
 her children sates not his anger; 'tis
 not enough to slaughter relations and
 drive friends into exile; he strives to
 destroy every citizen of Rome and to
 blot out the very name of our race.
 Nor does he even slay with a swift
 death; ere that he enjoys the
 infliction of cruel torture; the rack,
 the chain, the lightless cell, these he
 sets before the final blow. Why, this
 remission is more savage, more
 madly cruel, than the sword—this
 grant of life that agony may
 accompany it! Is death not enough
 for him? With treacherous charges he
 attacks; dazed wretches find him at

Crescebat scelerata sitis
 praedaeque recentis 220
incestus flagrabat amor,
 nullusque petendi
cogendive pudor: crebris
 periuria nectit
blanditiis; sociat perituro
 foedere dextras.
si semel e tantis poscenti
 quisque negasset,
effera praetumido quatiebat
 corda furore. 225
quae sic Gaetuli iaculo percussa
 leaena
aut Hyrcana premens raptorem
 belua partus
aut serpens calcata furit? iurata
 deorum
maiestas teritur; nusquam
 reverentia mensae.
non coniunx, non ipse simul,
 non pignora caesa 230
sufficiunt odiis; non extinxisse
 propinquos,
non notos egisse sat est;
 exscindere cives
funditus et nomen gentis delere
 laborat.
nec celeri perimit leto;
 crudelibus ante
suppliciis fruitur; cruciatus,
 vincla, tenebras 235
dilato mucrone parat. pro
 saevior ense
parcendi rabies concessaque
 vita dolori!
mors adeone parum est? causis
 fallacibus instat

once accuser and judge. Slow to all
else he is swift to crime and tireless
to visit the ends of the earth in its
pursuit. Neither the Dog-star's heat
nor the wintry blasts of the Thracian
north wind detain him. Feverish
anxiety torments his cruel heart lest
any escape his sword, or an
emperor's pardon lose him an
opportunity for injury. Neither age
nor youth can move his pity: before
their father's eyes his bloody axe
severs boys' heads

ianacibus instat,
 arguit attonitos^[44] se iudice. cetera
 segnis,
 ad facinus velox, penitus
 regione remotas 240
 impiger ire vias: non illum
 Sirius ardens
 brumave Riphæo stridens
 Aquilone retardat.
 effera torquebant avidae
 praecordia curae,
 effugeret ne quis gladios neu
 perderet ullum
 Augusto miserante nefas. non
 flectitur annis, 245
 non aetate labat: iuvenum
 rorantia colla
 ante patrum vultus stricta
 cecidere securi;

[45]

from their bodies; an aged man, once
 a consul, survived the murder of his
 son but to be driven into exile. Who
 can bring himself to tell of so many
 murders, who can adequately mourn
 such impious slaughter? Do men tell
 that cruel Sinis of Corinth e'er
 wrought such wickedness with his
 pine-tree, or Sciron with his
 precipitous rock, or Phalaris with his
 brazen bull, or Sulla with his prison?
 O gentle horses of Diomedes! O
 pitiful altars of Busiris! Henceforth,
 compared with Rufinus thou, Cinna,
 shalt be loving, and thou, Spartacus,
 a sluggard.

All were a prey to terror, for men
 knew not where next his hidden
 hatred would break forth, they sob in
 silence for the tears they dare not
 shed and fear to show their
 indignation. Yet is not the spirit of
 great-hearted Stilicho broken by this
 same fear. Alone amid the general
 calamity he took arms against this
 monster of greed and his devouring
 maw, though not borne on the swift
 course of any winged steed nor aided
 by Pegasus' reins. In him all found
 the quiet they longed for, he was
 their one defence in danger, their
 shield out-held against the fierce foe,
 the exile's sanctuary, standard
 confronting the madness of Rufinus,

ibat grandaevus nato moriente
superstes
post trabeas exul. quis prodere tanta
relatu
funera, quis caedes possit deflere
nefandas? 250
quid tale inmanes umquam gessisse
feruntur
vel Sinis Isthmiaca pinu vel rupe
profunda
Sciron vel Phalaris tauro vel carcere
Sulla?
o mites Diomedis equi! Busiridis
arae
clementes! iam Cinna pius, iam
Spartace segnis 255
Rufino collatus eris!

Deiecerat omnes
occultis odiis terror tacitique sepultos
suspirant gemitus indignarique
verentur.
at non magnanimi virtus Stilichonis
eodem
fracta metu; solus medio sed turbine
rerum 260
contra letiferos rictus contraque
rapacem
movit tela feram, volucris non
praepete cursu
vectus equi, non Pegaseis adiutus
habenis.
hic cunctis optata quies, hic sola
pericli
turris erat clipeusque trucem
porrectus in hostem,
hic profugis sedes adversaque signa
furori, 266
servandis hic castra bonis

fortress for the protection of the
good.

Thus far Rufinus advanced his
threats and stayed; then fell back in
coward flight: even as a torrent
swollen with winter rains rolls down
great stones in its course,
overwhelms woods, tears away
bridges, yet is broken by a jutting
rock, and, seeking a way through,
foams and thunders about the cliff
with shattered waves.

How can I praise thee worthily, thou
who

minatus
 haerebat retroque fuga cedebat inertit
 haud secus hiberno tumidus cum
 vertice torrens
 saxa rotat volvitque nemus
 pontesque revellit, 270
 frangitur obiectu scopuli
 quaerensque meatum
 spumat et inlisa montem circumtona
 unda.
 Qua dignum te laude feram, qui
 paene ruenti

sustainedst with thy shoulders the
 tottering world in its threatened fall?
 The gods gave thee to us as they
 show a welcome star to frightened
 mariners whose weary bark is
 buffeted with storms of wind and
 wave and drifts with blind course
 now that her steersman is beaten.
 Perseus, descendant of Inachus, is
 said to have overcome Neptune's
 monsters in the Red Sea, but he was
 helped by his wings; no wing bore
 thee aloft: Perseus was armed with
 the Gorgons' head that turneth all to
 stone; the snaky locks of Medusa
 protected not thee. His motive was
 but the love of a chained girl, thine
 the salvation of Rome. The days of
 old are surpassed; let them keep
 silence and cease to compare
 Hercules' labours with thine. 'Twas
 but one wood that sheltered the lion
 of Cleonae, the savage boar's tusks
 laid waste a single Arcadian vale,
 and thou, rebel Antaeus, holding thy
 mother earth in thine embrace, didst
 no hurt beyond the borders of Africa.
 Crete alone re-echoed to the
 bellowings of the fire-breathing bull,
 and the green hydra beleaguered no
 more than Lerna's lake. But this
 monster Rufinus terrified not one
 lake nor one island: whatsoever lives
 beneath the Roman rule, from distant
 Spain to Ganges' stream, was in fear
 of him. Neither triple Geryon nor

to day by reason of the infected air, fastens first upon the bodies of animals but soon sweeps away peoples and cities, and when the winds blow hot spreads its hellish poison to the polluted streams, so the ambitious rebel marks down no private prey, but hurls his eager threats at kings, and seeks to destroy Rome's army and overthrow her might. Now he stirs up the Getae^[53] and the tribes on Danube's banks, allies himself with Scythia and exposes what few his cruelties have spared to the sword of the enemy. There march against us a mixed horde of Sarmatians and Dacians, the Massagetes who cruelly wound their horses that they may drink their blood, the Alans who break the ice and drink the waters of Maeotis' lake, and the Geloni who tattoo their limbs: these form Rufinus' army. And he brooks not their defeat; he frames delays and postpones the fitting season for battle. For when thy right hand, Stilicho, had scattered the Getic bands and avenged the death of thy brother general, when one section of Rufinus' army was thus weakened and made an easy prey, then that foul traitor, that conspirator with the Getae, tricked the emperor and put off the instant day of battle, meaning

ac velut infecto morbus
 crudescere caelo
incipiens primos pecudum
 depascitur artus,
mox populos urbesque rapit
 ventisque perustis
corruptos Stygiam pestem
 desudat in amnes:
sic avidus praedo iam non per
 singula saevit. 305
sed sceptris inferre minas
 omnique perempto
milite Romanas ardet
 prosternere vires,
iamque Getas Histrumque
 movet Scythiamque
 receptat
auxilio traditque suas hostilibus
 armis
relliquias. mixtis descendit
 Sarmata Dacis 310
et qui cornipedes in pocula
 vulnerat audax
Massagetes caesamque bibens
 Maeotin Alanus
membraque qui ferro gaudet
 pinxisse Gelonus,
Rufino collecta manus. vetat
 ille domari
innectitque moras et congrua
 tempora differt. 315
nam tua cum Geticas stravisset
 dextra catervas,
ulta ducis socii letum, parsque
 una maneret
debilior facilisque capi, tunc
 impius ille
proditor imperii coniuratusque

to ally himself with the Huns, who, as he knew, would fight and quickly join the enemies of Rome. ^[54]

These Huns are a tribe who live on the extreme eastern borders of Scythia, beyond frozen Tanais; most infamous of all the children of the north. Hideous to look upon are their faces and loathsome their bodies, but indefatigable is their spirit. The chase supplies their food; bread they will not eat. They love to slash their faces and hold it a

^[53] Here and throughout his poems Claudian refers to the Visigoths as the Getae.

^[54] Cf. Introduction, p. x.

procurator imperii comitatusque
Getarum^[50]

distulit instantes eluso principe
pugnas 320

Hunorum laturus opem, quos
adfore hello
norat et invisus mox se
coniungere castris.

Est genus extremos Scythiae
vergentis in ortus
trans gelidum Tanain, quo non
famosius ullum
Arctos alit. turpes habitus
obscaenaque visu 325
corpora; mens duro numquam
cessura labori;
praeda cibus, vitanda Ceres
frontemque secari

[51]

righteous act to swear by their murdered parents. Their double nature fitted not better the two-formed Centaurs to the horses that were parts of them. Disorderly, but of incredible swiftness, they often return to the fight when little expected.

Fearless, however, against such forces, thou, Stilicho, approachest the waters of foaming Hebrus and thus prayest ere the trumpets sound and the fight begins: "Mars, whether thou reclinest on cloud-capped Haemus, or frost-white Rhodope holdeth thee, or Athos, severed to give passage to the Persian fleet, or Pangaeus, gloomy with dark holm-oaks, gird thyself at my side and defend thine own land of Thrace. If victory smile on us, thy meed shall be an oak stump adorned with spoils."

The Father heard his prayer and rose from the snowy peaks of Haemus shouting commands to his speedy servants: "Bellona, bring my helmet; fasten me, Panic, the wheels upon my chariot; harness my swift horses, Fear. Hasten: speed on your work. See, my Stilicho makes him ready for war; Stilicho whose habit it is to load me with rich trophies and hang upon the oak the plumed helmets of his enemies. For us together the

ludus et occisos pulchrum
iurare parentes.
nec plus nubigenas duplex
natura biformes
cognatis aptavit equis; acerrima
nullo 330
ordine mobilitas insperatique
recursus.
Quos tamen impavidus
contra spumantis ad
Hebri
tendis aquas, sic ante tubas
aciemque precatus:
“Mavors, nubifero seu tu
procumbis in Haemo
seu te cana gelu Rhodope seu
remige Medo 335
sollicitatus Athos seu caligantia
nigris
ilicibus Pangaea tenent,
accingere mecum
et Thracas defende tuos. si
laetior adsit
gloria, vestita spoliis donabere
quercu.”
Audiit illa pater scopulisque
nivalibus Haemi 340
surgit et hortatur celeres
clamore ministros:
“fer galeam, Bellona, mihi
nexusque rotarum
tende, Pavor. frenet rapidos
Formido iugales.
festinas urgete manus. meus
ecce paratur
ad bellum Stilicho, qui me de
more tropaeis 345
ditat et hostiles suspendit in

trumpets ever sound the call to
battle; yoking my chariot I follow
wheresoever he pitch his camp.” So
spake he and leapt upon the plain,
and on this side Stilicho scattered the
enemy bands in broadcast flight and
on that Mars; alike the twain in
accoutrement and stature. The
helmets of either tower with bristling
crests, their breastplates flash as they
speed along and their spears take
their fill of widely dealt wounds.

Meanwhile Megaera, more eager
now she has got her way, and
revelling in this widespread

unat et hostes suspendant in
arbore ^[52] cristas.

communes semper litui,
 communia nobis
signa canunt iunctoque sequor
 tentoria curru.”

sic fatus campo insiluit lateque
 fugatas

hinc Stilicho turmas, illinc
 Gradivus agebat 350

et clipeis et mole pares; stat
 cassis utrique

sidereis hirsuta iubis loricaque
 cursu

aestuat et largo saturatur
 vulnere cornus.

Acrior interea voto multisque
 Megaera

luxuriata malis maestam
 deprendit in arce 355

[53]

calamity, comes upon Justice sad at heart in her palace, and thus provokes her with horrid utterance: “Is this that old reign of peace; this the return of that golden age thou fondly hopedst had come to pass? Is our power gone, and no place now left for the Furies? Turn thine eyes this way. See how many cities the barbarians’ fires have laid low, how vast a slaughter, how much blood Rufinus hath procured for me, and on what widespread death my serpents gorge themselves. Leave thou the world of men; that lot is mine. Mount to the stars, return to that well-known tract of Autumn sky where the Standard-bearer dips towards the south. The space next to the summer constellation of the Lion, the neighbourhood of the winter Balance has long been empty. And would I could now follow thee through the dome of heaven.”

The goddess made answer: “Thou shalt rage no further, mad that thou art. Now shall thy creature receive his due, the destined avenger hangs over him, and he who now wearies land and the very sky shall die, though no handful of dust shall cover his corpse. Soon shall come Honorius, promised of old to this fortunate age, brave as his father Theodosius, brilliant as his brother

Iustitiam diroque prior sic ore
 laccessit:
“en tibi prisca quies
 renovataque saecula
 rursus,
ut rebare, vigent? en nostra
 potentia cessit
nec locus est usquam Furiis?
 huc lumina flecte.
adspice barbaricis iaceant quot
 moenia flammis, 360
quas mihi Rufinus strages
 quantumque cruoris
praebeat et quantis epulentur
 caedibus hydri.
linque homines sortemque
 meam, pete sidera; notis
Autumni te redde plagis, qua
 vergit in Austrum
Signifer; aestivo sedes vicina
 Leoni 365
iam pridem gelidaeque vacant
 confinia Librae.
atque utinam per magna sequi
 convexa liceret!”
Diva refert: “non ulterius
 bacchabere demens.
iam poenas tuus iste dabit, iam
 debitus ultor
inminet, et, terras qui nunc
 ipsumque fatigat 370
aethera, non vili moriens
 condetur harena.
iamque aderit laeto promissus
 Honorius aevo
nec forti genitore minor nec
 fratre corusco,
qui subigat Medos, qui cuspide

Arcadius; he shall subdue the Medes
and overthrow the Indians with his
spear. Kings shall pass under his
yoke, frozen Phasis shall bear his
horses' hooves, and Araxes submit
perforce to be bridged by him. Then
too shalt thou be bound with heavy
chains of iron and cast out from the
light of day and imprisoned in the
nethermost pit, thy snaky locks
overcome and shorn from thy head.
Then the world shall be owned by all
in common, no field marked off from
another

qui subiget medios, qui cuspidat
proteret Indos.^[54]

discingatur ager; reges vomere
calceabitur asper³⁷⁵

Phaeis, equos postremosque pati
gagdebit Anaxis.

tonantem simul gravitas ferri
religata catenis

expellere diademata, nec
draconum

vellet ous quare barbaros, sed
sponte rubeant³⁸⁵

tum telus communis erit, tum
ponte nullo per

ridebunt virides gemmis
nascentibus algae."

[55]

by any dividing boundary, no furrow
cleft with bended ploughshare; for
the husbandman shall rejoice in corn
that springs untended. Oak groves
shall drip with honey, streams of
wine well up on every side, lakes of
oil abound. No price shall be asked
for fleeces dyed scarlet, but of
themselves shall the flocks grow red
to the astonishment of the shepherd,
and in every sea the green seaweed
will laugh with flashing jewels."

IN RUFINUM LIBER SECUNDUS

INCIPIT PRAEFATIO

(IV.)

THE SECOND BOOK AGAINST RUFINUS

PREFACE

(IV.)

Return, ye Muses, and throw open rescued Helicon; now again may your company gather there. Nowhere now in Italy does the hostile trumpet forbid song with its viler bray. Do thou too, Delian Apollo, now that Delphi is safe and fear has been dispelled, wreath thy avenger's head with flowers. No savage foe sets profane lips to Castalia's spring or those prophetic streams. Alpheus' [\[55\]](#) flood ran all his length red with slaughter and the waves bore the bloody marks of war across the Sicilian sea; whereby Arethusa, though herself not present, recognized the triumphs freshly won and knew of the slaughter of the Getae, to which that blood bore witness.

Let peace, Stilicho, succeed these age-long labours and ease thine heart by graciously listening to my song. Think it no shame to interrupt thy long toil and to consecrate a few moments to the Muses. Even unwearying Mars is said to have

Pandite defensum reduces
Heliconae sorores,
pandite; permissis iam licet
ire choris:
nulla per Aonios hostilis bucina
campos
carmina mugitu deteriore
vetat.
tu quoque securis pulsa
formidine Delphis 5
floribus ultorem, Deliae, cinge
tuum.
nullus Castalios latices et
praescia fati
flumina polluto barbarus ore
bibit.
Alpheus late rubuit Siculumque
per aequor
sanguineas belli rettulit unda
notas 10
agnovitque novos absens
Arethusa triumphos
et Geticam sensit teste cruore
necem.

Immensis, Stilicho, succedant
otia curis
et nostrae patiens corda
remitte lyrae,
nec pudeat longos interrupsisse
labores 15
et tenuem Musis constituisse
moram.
fertur et indomitus tandem post
proelia Mavors
lassa per Odrysias fundere
membra nives
oblitusque sui nosita clementior

stretched his tired limbs on the
snowy Thracian plain when at last
the battle was ended, and, unmindful
of his wonted fierceness, to have laid
aside his spear in gentler mood,
soothing his ear with the Muses'
melody.

[55] A reference to Stilicho's campaign
against Alaric in the Peloponnese in
397 (see Introduction, p. x).

omnibusque sui posita clementia
hasta [58]
Pieriis aures pacificare
modis. 20
LIBER II

(V.)

[59]

BOOK II

(V.)

After the subjugation of the Alpine tribes and the salvation of the kingdoms of Italy the heavens welcomed the Emperor Theodosius^[56] to the place of honour due to his worth, and so shone the brighter by the addition of another star. Then was the power of Rome entrusted to thy care, Stilicho; in thy hands was placed the governance of the world. The brothers' twin majesty and the armies of either royal court were given into thy charge. But Rufinus (for cruelty and crime brook not peace, and a tainted mouth will not forgo its draughts of blood), Rufinus, I say, began once more to inflame the world with wicked wars and to disturb peace with accustomed sedition. Thus to himself: "How shall I assure my slender hopes of survival? By what means beat back the rising storm? On all sides are hate and the threat of arms. What am I to do? No help can I find in soldier's weapon or emperor's favour. Instant dangers ring me round and a gleaming sword hangs above my head. What is left but to plunge the world into fresh troubles and draw down innocent

Iam post edomitas Alpes
defensaue regna
Hesperiae merita complexus
sede parentem
auctior adiecto fulgebat sidere
mundus,
iamque tuis, Stilicho, Romana
potentia curis
et rerum commissus apex, tibi
credita fratrum 5
utraque maiestas geminaeque
exercitus aulae.
Rufinus (neque enim patiuntur
saeva quietem
crimina pollutaeque negant
arescere fauces)
infandis iterum terras accendere
bellis
incohat et solito pacem vexare
tumultu. 10
haec etiam secum: "quanam
ratione tuebor
spem vitae fragilem? qua tot
depellere fluctus
arte queam? premor hinc odiis,
hinc milite cingor.
heu quid agam? non arma mihi,
non principis ullus
auxiliatur amor. matura pericula
surgunt 15
undique et impositi radiant
cervicibus enses.
quid restat, nisi cuncta novo
confundere luctu
insontesque meae populos
miscere ruinae?
everso iuvat orbe mori; solacia
lato

peoples in my ruin? Gladly will I
perish if the world does too; general
destruction shall console me for

[56] Theodosius died in January 395,
not long after his defeat of Eugenius at
the Frigidus River (near Aquileia),
September 5-6, 394 (see Introduction,
p. ix).

mine own death, nor will I die (for I am no coward) till I have accomplished this. I will not lay down my power before my life."

So spake he, and as if Aeolus unchained the winds so he, breaking their bonds, let loose the nations, clearing the way for war; and, that no land should be free therefrom, apportioned ruin throughout the world, parcelling out destruction. Some pour across the frozen surface of swift-flowing Danube and break with the chariot wheel what erstwhile knew but the oar; others invade the wealthy East, led through the Caspian Gates and over the Armenian snows by a newly-discovered pass. The fields of Cappadocia reek with slaughter; Argaeus, father of swift horses, is laid waste. Halys' deep waters run red and the Cilician cannot defend himself in his precipitous mountains. The pleasant plains of Syria are devastated, and the enemy's cavalry thunders along the banks of Orontes, home hitherto of the dance and of a happy people's song. Hence comes mourning to Asia, while Europe is left to be the sport and prey of Getic hordes even to the borders of fertile Dalmatia. All that tract of land lying between the stormy Euxine and the Adriatic is laid waste and plundered,

exitium commune dabit nec
 territus ante 20
discedam: cum luce simul
 linquenda potestas.”
 Haec fatus, ventis veluti si
 frena resolvat
Aeolus, abrupto gentes sic
 obice fudit
laxavitque viam bellis et, nequa
 maneret
inmunis regio, cladem divisit in
 orbem 25
disposuitque nefas. alii per terga
 ferocis
Danuvii solidata ruunt
 expertaque remos
frangunt stagna rotis; alii per
 Caspia claustra
Armeniasque nives inopino
 tramite ducti
invadunt Orientis opes. iam
 pascua fumant 30
Cappadocum volucrumque
 parens Argaeus
 equorum,
iam rubet altus Halys nec se
 defendit iniquo
monte Cilix. Syriae tractus
 vastantur amoeni
adsuetumque choris et laeta
 plebe canorum
proterit imbellem sonipes
 hostilis Orontem. 35
hinc planctus Asiae; Geticis
 Europa catervis
ludibrio praedaeque datur
 frondentis ad usque
Dalmatiae fines: omnis quae

no inhabitants dwell there; 'tis like
torrid Africa whose sun-scorched
plains never grow kindlier through
human tillage. Thessaly is afire;
Pelion silent, his shepherds put to
flight; flames bring destruction on
Macedonia's crops. For Pannonia's
plain, the Thracians' helpless cities,
the fields of Mysia were ruined but
now none wept; year by year came
the invader, unsheltered was the
countryside from havoc and custom
had robbed suffering of its sting.
Alas, in how swift ruin perish

Damnaque times. Omnis quae
mobile ^[62]Ponti
aequor et Adriacas tellus
interiacet undas
squalet inops pecudum, nullis
habitata colonis, 40
instar anhelantis Libyae, quae
torrida semper
solibus humano nescit
mansuescere cultu.
Thessalus ardet ager; reticet
pastore fugato
Pelion; Emathias ignis
populatur aristas.
nam plaga Pannoniae
miserandaque moenia
Thracum
arvaeque Mysorum iam nulli
flebile damnum, 46
sed cursus sollemnis erat
campusque furori
expositus, sensumque malis
detraxerat usus.
eheu quam brevibus pereunt
ingentia fati!

[63]

even the greatest things! An empire won and kept at the expense of so much bloodshed, born from the toils of countless leaders, knit together through so many years by Roman hands, one coward traitor overthrew in the twinkling of an eye.

That city, ^[57]too, called of men the rival of great Rome, that looks across to Chalcedon's strand, is stricken now with terror at no neighbouring war; nearer home it observes the flash of torches, the trumpet's call, and its own roofs the target for an enemy's artillery. Some guard the walls with watchful outposts, others hasten to fortify the harbour with a chain of ships. But fierce Rufinus is full of joy in the leaguered city and exults in its misfortunes, gazing at the awful spectacle of the surrounding country from the summit of a lofty tower. He watches the procession of women in chains, sees one poor half-dead wretch drowned in the water hard by, another, stricken as he fled, sink down beneath the sudden wound, another breathe out his life at the tower's very gates; he rejoices that no respect is shown to grey hairs and that mother's breasts are drenched with their children's blood. Great is his pleasure thereat; from time to time he laughs and knows but one

imperium tanto quaesitum
 sanguine, tanto 50
servatum, quod mille ducum
 peperere labores,
quod tantis Romana manus
 contexuit annis,
proditor unus iners angusto
 tempore vertit.
 Urbs etiam, magnae quae
 ducitur aemula Romae
et Calchedonias contra
 despectat harenas, 55
iam non finitimo Martis terrore
 moveretur,
sed propius lucere faces et
 rauca sonare
cornua vibratisque peti fastigia
 telis
adspicit. hi vigili muros statione
 tueri,
hi iunctis properant portus
 munire carinis. 60
obsessa tamen ille ferus laetatur
 in urbe
exultatque malis summaeque ex
 culmine turris
impia vicini cernit spectacula
 campi:
vinctas ire nurus, nunc in vada
 proxima mergi
seminecem, hunc subito
 percussum vulnere labi
65
dum fugit, hunc animam portis
 efflare sub ipsis;
nec canos prodesse seni
 puerique cruore
maternos undare sinus. immensa

regret—that it is not his own hand
that strikes. He sees the whole
countryside (except for his own
lands) ablaze, and has joy of his
great wickedness, making no secret
of the fact that the city's foes are his
friends. It is his boast, moreover, that
to him alone the enemy camp opened
its gates, and that there was allowed
right of parley between them.
Whene'er he issued forth to arrange
some wondrous truce his
companions thronged him round and
an armed band of dependents

[57] Constantinople.

maternos undare sinus. immensa
voluptas^[64]

et risus plerumque subit; dolor
afficit unus,
quod feriat non ipse manu. videt
omnia late 70
exceptis incensa suis et crimine
tanto
luxuriat carumque sibi non
abnuit hostem;
iactabatque ultro, quod soli
castra paterent
sermonumque foret vicibus
permissa potestas.
egregii quotiens exisset foederis
auctor, 75
stipatur sociis, circumque
armata clientum

[65]

danced attendance on a civilian's standards. Rufinus himself in their midst drapes tawny skins of beasts about his breast (thorough in his barbarity), and uses harness and huge quivers and twanging bows like those of the Getae—his dress openly showing the temper of his mind. One who drives a consul's chariot and enjoys a consul's powers has no shame to adopt the manners and dress of barbarians; Roman law, obliged to change her noble garment, mourns her slavery to a skin-clad judge.

What looks then on men's faces! What furtive murmurs! For, poor wretches, they could not even weep nor, without risk, ease their grief in converse. "How long shall we bear this deadly yoke? What end shall there ever be to our hard lot? Who will free us from this death-fraught anarchy, this day of tears? On this side the barbarian hems us in, on that Rufinus oppresses us; land and sea are alike denied us. A pestilence stalks through the country: yes, but a deadlier terror haunts our houses. Stilicho, delay no more but succour thy dying land; of a truth here are thy children, here thy home, here were taken those first auspices for thy marriage, so blessed with children, here the palace was illumined with

agmina privatis ibant
famulantia signis;
ipse inter medios, ne qua de
parte relinquat
barbariem, revocat fulvas in
pectora pelles
frenaque et inmanes pharetras
arcusque sonoros 80
adsimulat mentemque palam
proclamat amictu,
nec pudet Ausonios currus et
iura regentem
sumere deformes ritus
vestemque Getarum;
insignemque habitum Latii
mutare coactae
maerent captivae pellito iudice
leges. 85
Quis populi tum vultus erat!
quae murmura furtim!
(nam miseris ne flere quidem
aut lenire dolorem
colloquiis impune licet):
“quonam usque feremus
exitiale iugum? durae quis
terminus umquam
sortis erit? quis nos funesto
turbine rerum 90
aut tantis solvet lacrimis, quos
barbarus illinc,
hinc Rufinus agit, quibus arva
fretumque negatur?
magna quidem per rura lues,
sed maior oberrat
intra tecta timor. tandem
succurre ruenti
heu patriae, Stilicho! dilecta hic
nigra certe 95

the torches of happy wedlock. Nay,
come even though alone, thou for
whom we long; wars will perish at
thy sight and the ravening monster's
rage subside.”

Such were the tempests that vexed
the turbulent East. But so soon as
ever winter had given place to the
winds of spring and the hills began
to lose their covering of snow,
Stilicho, leaving the fields of Italy in
peace and safety, set in motion his
two armies and hastened to the lands
of the sunrise, combining

pignora certe, 99
hic domus, hic ^[66]thalamis primum
 genialibus omen,
hic tibi felices erexit regia
 taedas.
vel solus sperate veni. te proelia
 viso
languescant avidique cadet
 dementia monstri.”
Talibus urgetur discors
 Aurora procellis. 100
at Stilicho, Zephyris cum
 primum bruma remitti
et iuga diffusis nudari coepta
 pruinis,
partibus Italiae tuta sub pace
 relictis
utraque castra movens Phoebi
 properabat ad ortus,

[67]

the so different squadrons of Gaul and of the East. Never before did there meet together under one command such numerous bands, never in one army such a babel of tongues. Here were curly-haired Armenian cavalry, their green cloaks fastened with a loose knot, fierce Gauls with golden locks accompanied them, some from the banks of the swift-flowing Rhone, or the more sluggish Saône, some whose infant bodies Rhine's flood had laved, or who had been washed by the waves of the Garonne that flow more rapidly towards, than from, their source, whenever they are driven back by Ocean's full tide. One common purpose inspires them all; grudges lately harboured are laid aside; the vanquished feels no hate, the victor shows no pride. And despite of present unrest, of the trumpet's late challenge to civil strife, and of warlike rage still aglow, yet were all at one in their support of their great leader. So it is said that the army that followed Xerxes, gathered into one from all quarters of the world, drank up whole rivers in their courses, obscured the sun with the rain of their arrows, passed through mountains on board ship, and walked the bridged sea with contemptuous foot.

Gallica discretis Eoaque robora
turmis 105
amplexus. numquam tantae
dicatione sub una
convenere manus nec tot
discrimina vocum:
illinc Armeniae vibratis crinibus
alae
herbida collectae facili
velamina nodo;
inde truces flavo comitantur
vertice Galli, 110
quos Rhodanus velox, Araris
quos tardior ambit
et quos nascentes explorat
gurgite Rhenus
quosque rigat retro perniciosior
unda Garunnae,
Oceani pleno quotiens
impellitur aestu.
mens eadem cunctis animique
recentia ponunt 115
vulnera; non odit victus
victorve superbit.
et quamvis praesens tumor et
civilia nuper
classica bellatrixque etiam nunc
ira caleret,
in ducis eximii conspiravere
favorem.
haud aliter Xerxen toto simul
orbe secutus. 120
narratur rapuisse vagos
exercitus amnes
et telis umbrasse diem, cum
classibus iret
per scopulos tectumque pedes
contemneret aequor

Scarce had Stilicho crossed the Alps when the barbarian hordes began to restrict their forays and for fear of his approach gathered together in the plain and enclosed their pasture lands within a defensive ring. They then built an impregnable fortification with a double moat, planted stakes two deep at intervals along its summit and set wagons rigged with ox-hide all round like a wall.

Panic fear seized upon Rufinus as he saw this from afar, and his cheeks grew pale. He stood with ice-cold face, not knowing whether to fly, to own himself

conemmeret aequor.

Vix Alpes egressus erat nec
iam amplius errat
barbarus adventumque timens
se cogit in unam 125
planitiem tutoque includit
pascua gyro:
tum duplici fossa non
exuperabile vallum
asperat alternis sudibus murique
locata
in speciem caesis obtendit
plaustra iuvencis.
At procul exanguis Rufinum
perculit horror; 130
infectae pallore genae; stetit ore
gelato
incertus peteretne fugam,
veniamne subactus

[69]

beaten and sue for mercy, or go over to an enemy whose good faith his treachery had assured. Of what use now were his riches, his vast stores of golden ore, his halls upheld with red marble pillars, his sky-towering palace? He hears of Stilicho's march and counts the days, measuring his term of life according to the distance of his enemy from him. He is troubled with thoughts of coming peace and cannot sleep, often starts up distraught from his bed and suffers as punishment the fear of punishment. But his fury repossesses him and, regaining his genius for crime, he enters the sacred portal of the rich palace and addresses Arcadius with prayers and threats: "By thy brother's royal star, by the deeds of thy divine sire and the flower of thine own age, I beg thee deliver me from the edge of the sword; let me escape the cruel threatenings of Stilicho. All Gaul is sworn to my destruction. Tethys' extreme coasts, the wandering tribes beyond the farthest Britons are stirred up against me. Am I thought fit prey for all those armies? Are so many standards advanced against a solitary man? Whence comes this lust for blood? Stilicho lays claim to either hemisphere and will brook no equal. The world forsooth must lie at his feet. Italy is his kingdom, Libya

posceret an fidos sese
transferret in hostes.
quid nunc divitiae, quid fulvi
vasta metalli
congeries, quid purpureis
effulta columnis 135
atria prolataeve iuvant ad sidera
moles?
audit iter numeratque dies
spatioque viarum
metitur vitam. torquetur pace
futura
nec recipit somnos et saepe
cubilibus amens
excutitur poenamque luit
formidine poenae. 140
sed redit in rabiem scelerumque
inmane resunit
ingenium sacrasque fores
praedivitis aulae
intrat et Arcadium mixto terrore
precatur:
“Per fratris regale iubar, per
facta parentis
aetherii floremque tui te
deprecor aevi, 145
eripe me gladiis; liceat
Stilichonis iniquas
evitare minas. in nostram Gallia
caedem
coniurata venit. quidquid rigat
ultima Tethys,
extremos ultra volitat gens si
qua Britannos,
mota mihi. tantis capiendi
credimur armis? 150
tot signis unum petitur caput?
unda cruoris

his dominion, Spain and Gaul his
empire. The sun's path circumscribes
him not, no nor the whole universe.
All the wealth collected here by
Theodosius or received by him after
the war is Stilicho's alone, and he
has small mind to restore what he
has once acquired. Is he to enjoy his
gains in peace and quietness while
'tis mine to stand a siege? Why
should he encroach on thy share? Let
him leave Illyria, send back his
Eastern troops, divide the

unde caelis
 ista sitis? ^[70]geminum caeli sibi
 vindicat axem
 et nullum vult esse parem.
 succumbere poscit
 cuncta sibi: regit Italiam
 Libyamque coerces;
 Hispanis Gallisque iubet; non
 orbita solis, 155
 non illum natura capit.
 quascumque paravit
 hic Augustus opes et quas post
 bella recepit,
 solus habet, possessa semel nec
 reddere curat.
 scilicet ille quidem tranquilla
 pace fruatur;
 nos premat obsidio? quid
 partem invadere
 temptat?
 deserat Illyricos fines; Eoa
 remittat 161

[71]

hosts fairly between the two
 brothers, and do thou not be heir to
 the sceptre only but to thy forces.
 But if thou neglect to come to mine
 aid and make not ready to prevent
 my death, this head of mine shall not
 fall alone—by the dead and the stars
 I swear it. The blood of another shall
 be mingled with mine. I will not go
 unaccompanied to the waters of Styx
 nor shall the victor be free to exult in
 my death.”

So saying he dictates a treasonable
 letter and sends therewith an
 emissary to bear the message
 extorted from the emperor’s
 unwilling lips.

Meanwhile Stilicho, exulting in the
 thought of advancing upon the foe
 and of the narrow stretch of country
 that separated him from the
 fortifications, inflames with his
 words the hearts of his troops
 already thirsting for battle. On the
 left wing are posted the Armenians,
 farther to the right the Gauls. A
 beholder might have seen bits
 covered with warm foam, clouds of
 dust uprising, and on all sides
 waving banners bearing the device
 of a scarlet dragon; the very air
 seemed to teem with these fierce
 flying monsters. The glint of steel
 fills all Thessaly and the cave of the
 wise Centaur; the river whose banks

agmina; fraternas ex aequo
 dividat hastas,
 nec sceptri tantum fueris, sed
 militis heres.
 quodsi dissimulas nostrae
 succurrere morti
 nec prohibere paras, Manes et
 sidera testor: 165
 haec cervix non sola cadet;
 miscebitur alter
 sanguis; nec Stygias ferar
 incomitatus ad undas
 nec mea securus ridebit funera
 victor!”
 Haec ubi, dictatur facinus
 missusque repente
 qui ferat extortas invito principe
 voces. 170
 Interea Stilicho iam laetior
 hoste propinquo
 nec multo spatii distantibus
 aequore vallis
 pugnandi cupidus accendit voce
 cohortes.
 Armeniis frons laeva datur; per
 cornua Gallos
 dexteriora locat. spumis
 ignescere frena, 175
 pulveris extolli nimbos lateque
 videres
 surgere purpureis undantes
 anguibus hastas
 serpentumque vago caelum
 saevire volatu.
 implet Thessaliam ferri nitor
 antraque docti
 cornipedis, teneroque amnis
 reptatus Achilli 180

supported Achilles' baby footsteps
 and the forests of Oeta are agleam
 with arms, snowy Ossa re-echoes to
 the sound and Olympus smitten
 therewith sends it back twofold.
 Hearts beat high with a courage that
 is lavish of life. Neither precipice
 nor deep river could check their
 advance: their headlong speed would
 have overthrown all barriers.

If the two armies had then joined
 battle in this temper ruined Greece
 would not have witnessed such
 disaster as she did, the cities of the
 Peloponnese would still have been
 flourishing untouched by the hand

et nemo Oetaeum radiat.
 clamore nivalis
 Ossa tonat pulsoque fragor
 geminatur Olympo.
 intumuit virtus et lucis prodigus
 arsit
 impetus; haud illos rupes, haud
 alta vetarent
 flumina: praecipiti stravissent
 omnia cursu. 185
 Si tunc his animis acies
 collata fuisset,
 prodita non tantas vidisset
 Graecia caedes,
 oppida semoto Pelopeia Marte
 vigerent,

[73]

of war, Arcadia and Sparta's citadel
 would have remained unravaged.
 Burning Corinth would not have
 heated the waves of her two seas, nor
 would cruel chains have led in
 captivity the matrons of Athens. That
 day might have set an end to our
 disasters and destroyed the seeds of
 future calamities. For shame,
 envious Fortune, of what a triumph
 didst thou rob us! The kingly
 mandate came to Stilicho in arms
 amid the cavalry and the trumpets'
 din.

He stood amazed; anger and great
 grief o'erwhelm the hero and he
 wonders that such power for ill is
 allowed a coward. His wavering
 mind ponders the uncertain issue:
 shall he continue his advance or fail
 his brave beginnings? He longs to
 stem Illyria's ruin but fears to
 disobey orders. Loyalty annuls the
 prickings-on of valour. The public
 good urges him one way, fear of the
 emperor's displeasure another. At
 length in his distress he raises his
 hands to heaven and speaks from
 deep within his heart: "Ye gods not
 yet glutted with Rome's destruction,
 if ye will that our empire be utterly
 uprooted, if ye have resolved to blot
 out all the centuries with one blow, if
 ye repent you of the race of man,
 then let the sea's unrestrained fury

starent Arcadiae, starent
 Lacedaemonis arces;
non mare fumasset geminum
 flagrante Corintho 190
nec fera Cecropiae traxissent
 vincula matres.
illa dies potuit nostris imponere
 finem
cladibus et sceleris causas
 auferre futuri.
invida pro quantum rapuit
 Fortuna triumphum!
inter equos interque tubas
 mandata feruntur 195
regia et armati veniunt ductoris
 ad aures.
 Obstupuit; simul ira virum,
 simul obruit ingens
maeror et ignavo tantum
 licuisse nocenti
miratur. dubios anceps sententia
 volvitur
eventus: peragat pugnas an
 fortia coepta 200
deserat? Illyricis ardet
 succurrere damnis;
praeceptis obstare timet.
 reverentia frangit
virtutis stimulos: hinc publica
 commoda suadent,
hinc metus invidiae. tandem
 indignatus ad astra
extollit palmas et ab imo
 pectore fatur: 205
 “Numina Romanis necdum
 satiata ruinis,
si iuvat imperium penitus de
 stirpe revelli

burst forth upon the land or let
Phaëthon, deviating from his
ordained course, drive his straying
chariot at random. Shall Rufinus be
your tool? 'Twere shame that such
an one should be the author of the
world's destruction. O the grief of it!
recalled in mid fight; forced to lay
down the swords we have drawn!
Cities marked out for the flames,
walls doomed to destruction, I call
you to witness: see, I retire; I leave
the unhappy world to its fate. Turn
your banners, captains; to your
homes, soldiers of the east. Needs
must we obey.

super te veni,
 uno si placuit deferi saecula
 lapsu,
 si piget humani generis,
 prorumpat in arva
 libertas effrena maris vel limite
 iusto 210
 devius errantes Phaëthon
 confundat habenas.
 cur per Rufinum geritur?
 procumbere mundum
 hoc auctore pudet. mediis
 revocamur ab armis
 (pro dolor!) et strictos deponere
 cogimur enses.
 vos, arsuræ urbes perituraque
 moenia, testor: 215
 cedo equidem et miserum
 permitto casibus orbem
 flectite signa, duces. redeat iam
 miles Eous.

[75]

Silence, ye clarions; men, forbear to
 shoot. The foe is at hand, spare him;
 'tis Rufinus' command."

At these words an unanimous roar
 went up from all the companies.
 With less din are the cliffs of
 Ceraunia buffeted by the Italian sea
 or the thunders evoked from the
 western winds' wet storm-clouds.
 They will not separate, and demand
 the battle of which they have been
 defrauded. East and west claim the
 leadership of that illustrious chief. It
 is a contest of affection;
 insubordination that none can blame
 threatens to sap the loyalty of both
 armies who thus utter their common
 complaint: "Who is it robs us of our
 drawn swords? Who strikes the lance
 from our hand and bids us unstring
 the bent bow? Who dares dictate to
 an army under arms? Valour once
 roused knows no abatement. Spears
 thirsting for barbarian blood cast
 themselves from out our hands; our
 headlong blades force our vengeful
 arms to follow them; our very
 scabbards refuse to sheath an
 unblooded sword. I will not bear it.
 Shall the Getae ever profit by our
 dissension? Behold once more the
 shadow of civil war. Why dost thou
 seek to separate armies whose blood
 is one, standards of immemorial
 alliance? We are a body one and

parendum est. taceant litui.
prohibete sagittas.
parcite contiguo—Rufinus
praecipit!—hosti.”
His dictis omnes una
fremuere manipuli 220
quantum non Italo percussa
Ceraunia fluctu,
quantum non madidis elisa
tonitrua Cauris,
secernique negant ereptaque
proelia poscunt,
insignemque ducem populus
defendit uterque
et sibi quisque trahit. magno
certatur amore, 225
alternamque fidem non
inlaudata laccessit
seditio talique simul clamore
queruntur:
“Quis mihi nudatos enses,
quis tela lacertis
excutit et solvi curvatos imperat
arcus?
quisnam audet stricto leges
imponere ferro? 230
inflammata semel nescit
mitescere virtus.
iam mihi barbaricos sitientia
pila cruores
sponte volant ultroque manus
mucrone furenti
ducitur et siccum gladium
vagina recusat.
non patiar. semperne Getis
discordia nostra 235
proderit? en iterum belli civilis
imago!

indivisible. Thee will we follow
whithersoever thou goest; thee will
we accompany even as far as Thule
lying ice-bound beneath the pole-
star, or to the burning sands of
Libya. Should thy path be by the
waters of Ind, or the bays of the Red
Sea, ^[58] I would go drink Hydaspes’
golden stream. Shouldst thou bid me
fare south and search out the hidden
sources of the stripling Nile, I would
leave behind me the world

^[58] By the *mare rubrum* the ancients
meant the Indian Ocean. The Hydaspes
is the modern Jhylum.

imago:
quid consanguineas acies, quid
dividis olim^[76]
concordes aquilas? non
dissociabile corpus
coniunctumque sumus. te qua
libet ire sequemur.
te vel Hyperboreo damnatam
sidere Thylen, 240
te vel ad incensas Libyae
comitabor harenas.
Indorum si stagna petas
Rubrique recessus
litoris, auriferum veniam
poturus Hydaspen;
si calcare Notum secretaque
noscere Nili
nascentis iubeas, mundum post
terga relinquam; 245

[77]

I know. Wheresoever Stilicho plants his tent there is my fatherland."

But Stilicho said them nay: "Cease, I beg you," he cried, "stay your eager hands. Suffer to disperse the mountain of hatred that towers over me. I hold not victory so dear that I would fain seem to win it for myself. Loyal gentlemen, so long my fellow-soldiers, get you gone." He said no more but turned away, as a lion loath to retire makes off with empty maw when the serried spears and the burning branches in the hands of the shepherd band drive him back and he droops his mane and closes his downcast eyes and with a disappointed roar pushes his way through the trembling forest.

When the armies saw that they had been parted and left, they groaned deeply and bedewed their helmets with a stream of tears. The sighs that refused egress to their smothered words shook the strong fastenings of their breastplates. "We are betrayed," they cried, "and forbidden to follow him we love so well. Dost thou despise, matchless chief, thine own right hands which have so often won thee the victory? Are we thus vile? Is the Western sky to be the happier which has won the right to enjoy thy rule? What boots it to return to our country, to see once more our

et quocumque loco Stilicho
tentoria figat,
haec patria est.”

Dux inde vetat:
“desistite, quaeso.
atque avidam differte manum.
cadat iste minacis
invidiae cumulus. non est
victoria tanti,
ut videar vicisse mihi. vos fida
iuventus 250
ite, mei quondam socii.” nec
plura locutus
flexit iter: vacuo qualis discedit
hiatu
impatiens remeare leo, quem
plurima cuspis
et pastores pepulerunt igne
catervae,
inclinatque iubas demissaque
lumina velat 255
et trepidas maesto rimatur
murmure silvas.

Ut sese legio vidit disiuncta
relinqui,
ingentem tollit gemitum
galeasque solutis
umectat lacrimis pressamque
morantia vocem
thoracum validos pulsant
suspiria nexus: 260
“tradimur, heu, tantumque sequi
prohibemur
amorem!”
exclamant. “spernisne tuas, dux
optime, dextras,
quas tibi victrices totiens
Bellona probavit?

children dear after so long an
absence, to live again in the home
we love? Without thee is no joy.
Now must I face the tyrant’s dread
wrath; mayhap e’en now he is
making ready against me some
wicked snare and will make me a
slave to the foul Huns or restless
Alans. Yet is not my strength
altogether perished nor so complete
my powerlessness to wield the
sword. Rest thou beneath the sun’s
westerling course, Stilicho, thou art
still

DEIONA PROBARE:
 nos adeo viles? ¹⁷⁸¹adeo felicior
 axis
 Hesperius, meruit qui te rectore
 teneri? 265
 quid nobis patriam, quid cara
 revisere tandem
 pignora dilectosve iuvat
 coluisse penates?
 te sine dulce nihil. iam
 formidata tyranni
 tempestas subeunda mihi, qui
 forte nefandas
 iam parat insidias, qui nos aut
 turpibus Hunis 270
 aut impacatis famulos praebebit
 Alanis;
 quamquam non adeo robur
 defecerit omne
 tantave gestandi fuerit penuria
 ferri.
 tu, licet occiduo maneat sub
 cardine caeli,

[79]

ever our general, and though we be
 not together thou shalt still know our
 loyalty. Long has a victim been owed
 thee; he shall be sacrificed and thou
 placated by an immolation promised
 of old."

Sad at heart the army left Thessaly,
 reached the borders of Macedon, and
 arrived before the walls of
 Thessalonica. Indignation deep hid
 in their hearts prepares the silent
 wrath of revenge. They look for a
 place where they may wreak their
 vengeance and a moment propitious
 for the blow, and of all that vast
 army not one is found to divulge
 with incautious speech his heart's
 intent. What succeeding age and
 time but will marvel that a plot so
 widespread could be kept hid, a deed
 of such vast import concealed; that
 the ardour of their minds was not
 rendered of no avail by the chance
 word of a soldier on the march or a
 drunkard's babbling? But discretion
 ruled all alike and the people's secret
 was kept. The army crossed the
 Hebrus, left Rhodope behind, and
 struck across the uplands of Thrace
 until it came to the city called after
 Hercules. ^[59]

When Rufinus learned that Stilicho
 had retired and that his troops were
 approaching he held his head high in
 triumph, believing everything safe,

tu mihi dux semper, Stilicho,
nostramque vel absens
experire fidem. dabitur tibi
debita pridem 276
victima: promissis longe
placabere sacris.”
Tristior Haemoniis miles
digressus ab oris
tangebatur Macetum fines
murosque subibat,
Thessalonica, tuos. sensu dolor
haeret in alto 280
abditus et tacitas vindictae
praestruit iras,
spectaturque favens odiis locus
aptaque leto
tempora. nec quisquam tanta de
pube repertus,
proderet incautis qui corda
minantia verbis.
quae non posteritas, quae non
mirabitur aetas 285
tanti consilium vulgi potuisse
taceri
aut facinus tam grande tegi
mentisque calorem
non sermone viae, non inter
pocula rumpi?
aequalis tantam tenuit
constantia turbam
et fuit arcanum populo.
percurritur Haemus, 290
deseritur Rhodope Thracumque
per ardua tendunt,
donec ad Herculei perventum
nominis urbem.
Ut cessasse ducem, propius
venisse cohortes

and, anxious to seize the power, inflamed his traitorous minions with this speech: “We have conquered; have driven off our enemy; empire is within my grasp, nor have we anything to fear from the foe. Will one who dared not approach me when I stood alone defeat me now that I am strengthened by the addition of so great a force? Who could stand against him armed whom unarmed he could not conquer? Plot my destruction in exile, friend

[59] Probably Heraclea, at the west end of the Propontis.

VENISSE COMITES
cognita Rufino,^[80] magna cervice
triumphat
omnia tuta ratus sceptrumque
capessere fervet 295
et coniuratos hortatur voce
clientes:
“vicimus, expulimus, facilis
iam copia regni.
nullus ab hoste timor. quis
enim, quem poscere
solum
horruit, hunc tanto munitum
milite vincat?
quis ferat armatum, quem non
superavit inermem?
i nunc, exitium nobis meditare
remotus 301

[81]

Stilicho. What harm can that do so long as a vast stretch of country divide us and Nereus' waves thunder between? Thou shalt have no chance of crossing the rocky Alps while I live. Transfix me from thence with thine arrows, if thou canst. Seek in thy fury a sword that from Italy shall reach my city's walls. Does not the experience and the example of those who have tried before deter thee? Who that has dared approach can boast escape from my hands? I have driven thee from the centre of the civilized world and at the same time deprived thee of thy great army. Now, my friends, is come the time for feasting and making ready bountiful gifts and bestowing gold upon these new legions. Tomorrow's light dawns prosperously for my purpose. Needs must the emperor will what he would not and bid a portion of his empire to be given to me. Mine alone be the happy fortune to rise above a private estate and yet escape the charge of tyranny."

To such words they shout acclaim—that vile band of traitors, waxed fat on plunder, whom one principle makes fellows with Rufinus, the holding nothing unlawful, and whose bond of friendship is to guard guilt in silence. Straightway they joyfully

incassum, Stilicho, dum nos
longissima tellus
dividat et mediis Nereus
interstrepit undis.
Alpinas transire tibi me sospite
rupes
haud dabitur. iaculis illinc me
figere tempta. 305
quaere ferox ensem, qui nostra
ad moenia tendi
possit ab Italia. non te
documenta priorum,
non exempla vetant? quisnam
conatus adire
has iactat vitasse manus?
detrusimus orbe
te medio tantisque simul
spoliavimus armis. 310
nunc epulis tempus, socii, nunc
larga parare
munera donandumque novis
legionibus aurum!
opportuna meis oritur lux
crastina votis.
quod nolit rex ipse velit
iubeatque coactus
in partem mihi regna dari.
contingat in uno 315
privati fugisse modum
crimenque tyranni.”
Talibus adclamat dictis
infame nocentum
concilium, qui perpetuis crevere
rapinis
et quos una facit Rufino causa
sodales,
inlicitum duxisse nihil; funesta
tacere 320

promise themselves foreign wives
and all to no purpose forecast the
booty they will win and the cities
they will sack.

Night had begun to soothe human
toils in her deep bosom and sleep
had spread his black wings when
Rufinus, whose mind had long been
a prey to anxiety, sank into a
troubled slumber. Scarce had quiet
fastened on his heart when, lo, he
sees flit before his eyes the dread
ghosts of those whom he

tacere 320
 nexus amicitiae. ^[82]iamiam
 conubia laeti
 despondent aliena sibi
 frustraue vicissim
 promittunt, quae quisque petat,
 quas devoret urbes.
 Coeperat humanos alto sopire
 labores
 nox gremio, nigrasque sopor
 diffuderat alas. 325
 ille diu curis animum
 stimulantibus aegre
 labitur in somnos. toto vix
 corde quierat,
 ecce videt diras adludere
 protinus umbras,

[83]

had killed. Of them one, more distinct than the rest, seemed thus to address him: "Up from thy couch! why schemes thine anxious mind further? This coming day shall bring thee rest and end thy toils. High above the people shalt thou be raised, and happy crowds shall carry thee in their arms." Such was the ambiguous prophecy of the ghost, but Rufinus observed not the hidden omen and saw not it foretold the elevation of his severed head upon a spear.

Now Lucifer touched the peak of Haemus with his rays and Titan urged his hastening wheel quicker than his wont, so soon to see at last the death of Rufinus. Rufinus himself leapt from his bed and bade make ready the capacious palace with regal splendour in preparation for the feast; the gold to be given in largesse he ordered to be stamped with his own fateful image. Himself went to welcome the troops returning from the battle in kingly pride and arrogance above a prince's. Sure now of empire he wore a woman's raiment about his neck; as though the purple already clothed his limbs and the jewelled crown blazed upon his brow.

Hard by a crowded quarter of the city of Constantinople, towards the

quas dedit ipse neci; quarum
 quae clarior una
visa loqui: “pro! surge toro.
 quid plurima volvis 330
anxius? haec requiem rebus
 finemque labori
adlatura dies: omni iam plebe
 redibis
altior et laeti manibus portabere
 vulgi.”
has canit ambages. occulto
 fallitur ille
omine nec capitis sentit
 praesagia fixi. 335
Iam summum radiis
 stringebat Lucifer
 Haemum
festinamque rotam solito
 properantior urget
tandem Rufini visurus funera
 Titan:
desiluit stratis densaeque
 capacia turbae
atria regifico iussit splendere
 paratu 340
exceptura dapes et, quod post
 vota daretur,
insculpi propriis aurum fatale
 figuris.
ipse salutatum reduces post
 proelia turmas
iam regale tumens et principe
 celsior ibat
collaque femineo solvebat
 mollia gestu 345
imperii certus, tegeret ceu
 purpura dudum
corpus et ardentis ambirent

south, there lies a plain. The rest is
surrounded by the sea which here
allows itself to be parted by a narrow
way. Here the avenging army, bright
with the panoply of the war god,
disposes its squadrons. On the left
stands the infantry. Over against
them the cavalry seek to restrain
their eager steeds by holding tight
the reins. Here nod the savage
waving plumes whose wearers
rejoice to shake the flashing colours
of their shoulder-armour; for steel
clothes them on and gives them their
shape; the limbs within

corpus et argentes amment
tempora ^[84]gemmae.

Urbis ab angusto tractu, qua
vergit in austrum,
planities vicina patet: nam
cetera pontus
circuit exiguo dirimi se limite
passus. 350
hic ultrix acies ornatu lucida
Martis
explicuit cuneos. pedites in
parte sinistra
consistunt. equites illinc
poscentia cursum
ora reluctantur pressis sedare
lupatis;
hinc alii saevum cristato vertice
nutant 355
et tremulos umeris gaudent
vibrare colores,
quos operit formatque chalybs;
coniuncta per artem

[85]

give life to the armour's pliant scales
so artfully conjoined, and strike
terror into the beholder. 'Tis as
though iron statues moved and men
lived cast from that same metal. The
horses are armed in the same way;
their heads are encased in
threatening iron, their forequarters
move beneath steel plates protecting
them from wounds; each stands
alone, a pleasure yet a dread to
behold, beautiful, yet terrible, and as
the wind drops the parti-coloured
dragons^[60] sink with relaxing coils
into repose.

The emperor first salutes the
hallowed standards; Rufinus follows
him, speaking with that crafty voice
wherewith he deceived all, praising
their devoted arms and addressing
each by name. He tells those who
have returned that their sons and
fathers are still alive. The soldiers,
observing a feigned rivalry in asking
questions, begin to extend their long
lines behind his back and to join up
the ends so as to form a circle
unnoticed by Rufinus. The space in
the centre grows smaller and the
wings meeting with serried shields
gradually form into one lessening
circle. Even so the huntsman
surrounds the grassy glades with his
widespread snares: so the spoiler of
the ocean drives to land the

flexilis inductis animatur
 lamina membris;
horribiles visu: credas
 simulacra moveri
ferrea cognatoque viros spirare
 metallo. 360
par vestitus equis: ferrata fronte
 minantur
ferratosque levant securi
 vulneris armos.
diviso stat quisque loco,
 metuenda voluptas
cernenti pulcherque timor,
 spirisque remissis
mansuescunt varii vento
 cessante dracones. 365
 Augustus veneranda prior
 vexilla salutat.
Rufinus sequitur, quo fallere
 cuncta solebat
callidus adfatu, devotaque
 brachia laudat;
nomine quemque vocat; natos
 patresque reversis
nuntiat incolumes. illi dum
 plurima ficto 370
certatim sermone petunt,
 extendere longos
a tergo flexus insperatoque
 suprema
circuitu sociare parant;
 decrescere campus
incipit, et clipeis in se redeuntia
 iunctis
curvo paulatim sinuantur
 cornua ductu: 375
sic ligat inmensa virides
 indagine saltus

frightened fish, narrowing the circuit
of his nets and closing up all
possible ways of egress. All others
they exclude. In his eagerness he
notes not yet that he is being
surrounded and, strongly seizing his
robe, chides the hesitating emperor:
let him mount the lofty platform and
declare him sharer in his sceptre,
partaker in his dignities—when
suddenly they draw their swords and
above the rest there rang out a
mighty voice; “Basest of the base,
didst

[60] Claudian refers to the devices
emblazoned upon the banners.

~~imagine~~ ^[86] ~~satus~~
 venator; sic attonitos ad litora
 pisces
 aequoreus populator agit
 rarosque plagarum
 contrahit anfractus et hiantes
 colligit oras.
 excludunt alios. cingi se
 fervidus ille 380
 nescit adhuc graviterque
 adpressa veste
 morantem
 increpat Augustum: scandat
 sublime tribunal,
 participem sceptri, socium
 declaret honoris—cum
 subito stringunt gladios; vox
 desuper ingens
 infremuit: “nobis etiam,
 detrime, nobis 385

[87]

thou hope to cast upon *us* the yoke of slavery? Knowest thou not whence I return? Shall I allow myself to be called another's servant, I who gave laws to others and restored the reign of liberty? Two civil wars have I quenched, twice forced the barrier of the Alps. These many battles have taught me to serve no tyrant.”

Rufinus stood rooted to earth. There is no hope of escape, for a forest of flashing spears hems him in. Shut in on the right hand and on the left he stood and gazed in wonder on the drawn blades of the armed throng; as a beast who has lately left his native hills, driven in exile from the wooded mountains and condemned to the gladiatorial shows, rushes into the arena while over against him the gladiator, heartened by the crowd's applause kneels and holds out his spear. The beast, alarmed at the noise, gazes with head erect upon the rows of seats in the amphitheatre and hears with amazement the murmuring of the crowd.

Then one more daring than the rest drew his sword and leapt forward from the crowd and with fierce words and flashing eye rushed upon Rufinus crying: “It is the hand of Stilicho whom thou vauntest that thou didst expel that smites thee; his sword, which thou thoughtest far

sperasti famulas imponere
posse catenas?
unde redi nescis? patiarne
audire satelles,
qui leges aliis libertatemque
reduxi?
bis domitum civile nefas, bis
rupimus Alpes.
tot nos bella docent nulli servire
tyranno.” 390

Deriguit. spes nulla fugae;
seges undique ferri
circumfusa micat; dextra
laevaue revinctus
haesit et ensiferae stupuit
mucrone coronae,
ut fera, quae nuper montes
amisit avitos
altorumque exul nemorum
damnatur harenae 395
muneribus, commota ruit; vir
murmure contra
hortatur nixusque genu
venabula tendit;
illa pavet strepitus cuneosque
erecta theatri
respicit et tanti miratur sibila
vulgi.

Unus per medios audendi
pronior ense 400
prosilit exerto dictisque et
vulnere torvus
impetit: “hac Stilicho, quem
iactas pellere, dextra
te ferit; hoc absens invadit
viscera ferro.”
sic fatur meritoque latus
transverberat ictu

away, that pierces thy heart.” So
spake he and transfixed Rufinus’ side
with a well-deserved thrust.

Happy the hand that first spilt such
vile blood and poured out vengeance
for a world made weary. Straightway
all pierce him with their spears and
tear quivering limb from limb; one
single body warms all these weapons
with its blood; shame to him whose
sword returns unstained therewith.

[88]

Felix illa manus, talem quae
 prima cruorem 405
 hauserit et fessi poenam
 libaverit orbis!
 mox omnes laniant hastis
 artusque trementes
 dilacerant; uno tot corpore tela
 tepescunt
 et non infecto pudit mucrone
 reverti.

They stamp on that face of greed and while yet he lives pluck out his eyes; others seize and carry off his severed arms. One cuts off his foot, another wrenches a shoulder from the torn sinews; one lays bare the ribs of the cleft spine, another his liver, his heart, his still panting lungs. There is not space enough to satisfy their anger nor room to wreak their hate. Scarce when his death had been accomplished do they leave him; his body is hacked in pieces and the fragments borne on the soldiers' spears. Thus red with blood ran the Boeotian mountain when the Maenads caused Pentheus' destruction or when Latona's daughter seen by Actaeon betrayed the huntsman, suddenly transformed into a stag, to the fury of her Molossian hounds. Dost thou hope, Fortune, thus to right thy wrongs? Seekest thou to atone by this meting out of punishment for favour ill bestowed? Dost thou with one death make payment for ten thousand murders? Come, portion out Rufinus' corpse among the lands he has wronged. Give the Thracians his head; let Greece have as her due his body. What shall be given the rest? Give but a limb apiece, there are not enough for the peoples he has ruined.

hi vultus avidos et adhuc
spirantia vellunt 410
lumina, truncatos alii rapuere
lacertos.
amputat ille pedes, umerum
quatit ille solutis
nexibus; hic fracti reserat
curvamina dorsi;
hic iecur, hic cordis fibras, hic
pandit anhelas
pulmonis latebras. spatium non
invenit ira 415
nec locus est odiis. consumpto
funere vix tum
deseritur sparsumque perit per
tela cadaver.
sic mons Aonius rubuit, cum
Pentheia ferrent
Maenades aut subito mutatum
Actaeona cornu
traderet insanis Latonia visa
Molossis. 420
criminibusne tuis credis,
Fortuna, mederi
et male donatum certas aequare
favorem
suppliciis? una tot milia morte
rependis?
eversis agedum Rufinum divide
terris.
da caput Odrysiis, truncum
mereantur Achivi. 425
quid reliquis dabitur? nec
singula membra
peremptis
sufficiunt populis.
Vacuo plebs
undique muro

The citizens leave the town and
hasten exulting to the spot from
every quarter, old men and girls
among them whom nor age nor sex
could keep at home. Widows whose
husbands he had killed, mothers
whose children he had murdered
hurry to the joyful scene with eager
steps. They are fain to trample the
torn limbs and stain their deep
pressed feet with the blood. So, too,
they eagerly hurl a shower of stones
at the monstrous head, nodding from
the summit of the spear that
transfixed it as it

unusquisque maritus
iam secunda fluit,^[90] senibus non
obstitit aetas
virginibusve pudor; viduae,
quibus ille maritos
abstulit, orbataeque ruunt ad
gaudia matres 430
insultantque alacres. laceros
iuvat ire per artus
pressaue calcato vestigia
sanguine tingui.
nec minus adsiduis flagrant
elidere saxis
prodigiale caput, quod iam de
cuspidis summa

[91]

was carried back in merited splendour to the city. Nay his hand too, made over to their mockery, goes a-begging for alms, and with its awful gains pays the penalty for his greedy soul, while forced, in mimicry of its living clutch, to draw up the fingers by their sinews.

Put not now your trust in prosperity; learn that the gods are inconstant and heaven untrustworthy. That hand which sought to wield a sceptre, which a humbled nobility stooped so often to kiss, now torn from its wretched trunk and left long unburied begs after death a baneful alms. Let him gaze on this whoso carries his head high in pride of prosperity, see trodden under foot at the cross-roads him who built pyramids for himself and a tomb, large as a temple, to the glory of his own ghost. He who trusted to be clothed in Tyrian purple is now a naked corpse and food for birds. See, he who owns the world lies denied six foot of earth, half covered with a sprinkling of dust, given no grave yet given so many.

Heaven knew of his death and earth is freed of her hated burden, now that the stars can breathe again. His shade oppresses the rivers of Hell. Old Aeacus shudders and Cerberus bays to stop, in this case, the *entry* of

nutabat digna rediens ad moenia
pompa. 435
dextera quin etiam ludo
concessa vagatur
aera petens poenasque animi
persolvit avari
terribili lucro vivosque imitata
retentus
cogitur adductis digitos
inflectere nervis.
Desinat elatis quisquam
confidere rebus 440
instabilesque deos ac lubrica
numina discat.
illa manus, quae sceptrum sibi
gestanda parabat,
cuius se totiens summisit ad
oscula supplex
nobilitas, inhumata diu
miseroque revulsa
corpore feralem quaestum post
fata reposcit. 445
adspiciat quisquis nimium
sublata secundis
colla gerit: triviis calcandus
spargitur ecce,
qui sibi pyramidas, qui non
cedentia templis
ornatura suos extruxit culmina
manes,
et qui Sidonio velari credidit
ostro, 450
nudus pascit aves. iacet en, qui
possidet orbem,
exiguae telluris inops et pulvere
raro
per partes tegitur nusquam
totiensque sepultus

a ghost. Then those shades which he
had sent to death beneath his cruel
laws flock round him and hale him
away with horrid shoutings to the
tribunal of the gloomy judge: even as
bees whom a shepherd has disturbed
swarm round his head when he
would rob them of their sweet honey,
and flutter their wings and put forth
their stings, making them ready for
battle in the fastnesses of their little
rock, and seek to defend the

volensque separatus.
 ^[92]
Senserunt convexa necem
 tellusque nefandum
amolitur onus iam respirantibus
 astris. 455
infernus gravat umbra lacus.
 pater Aeacus horret
intransemque etiam latratu
 Cerberus urget.
tunc animae, quas ille fero sub
 iure peremit,
circumstant nigrique trahunt ad
 iudicis urnam
infesto fremitu: veluti pastoris
 in ora 460
commotae glomerantur apes,
 qui dulcia raptu
mella vehit, pennasque cunctas et
 spicula tendunt
et tenuis saxi per propugnacula
 cinctae

[93]

crevices of their home, their beloved
pumice-stone cave, swarming over
the honeycombs therein.

There is a place where the
unhallowed rivers of Cocytus and
Phlegethon mingle their dread
streams of tears and fire. Between
the rivers yet nearer to that of
Phlegethon there juts a tower stiff
with solid adamant that bathes its left
side in the flames; its right hand wall
extends into Cocytus' stream and
echoes the lamentation of the river of
tears. Hither come all the children of
men whose life is ended; here there
abide no marks of earthly fortune; no
reverence is shown; the common
beggar ousts the king, now stripped
of his empty title. Seen afar on his
lofty throne the judge Minos
examines the charges and separates
the wicked from the righteous. Those
whom he sees unwilling to confess
their sins he remits to the lash of his
stern brother; for he, Rhadamanthus,
is busy close at hand. When he has
closely examined the deeds of their
earthly life and all that they did
therein, he suits the punishment to
their crimes and makes them
undergo the bonds of dumb animals.
The spirits of the cruel enter into
bears, of the rapacious into wolves,
of the treacherous into foxes. Those,
on the other hand, who were ever

rimosam patriam dilectaque
pumicis antra
defendunt pronoque favos
examine velant. 465
Est locus infaustis quo
conciliantur in unum
Cocytos Phlegethonque vadis;
inamoenus uterque
alveus; hic volvit lacrimas, hic
igne redundat.
turris per geminos, flammis
vicinior, amnes
porrigitur solidoque rigens
adamante sinistrum 470
proluit igne latus; dextro
Cocytia findit
aequora triste gemens et fletu
concita plangit.
huc post emeritam mortalia
saecula vitam
deveniunt. ibi nulla manent
discrimina fati,
nullus honos vanoque exutum
nomine regem 475
proturbat plebeius egens.
quaesitor in alto
conspicuum solio pertemptat
crimina Minos
et iustis dirimit sontes. quos
nolle fateri
viderit, ad rigidi transmittit
verbera fratris.
nam iuxta Rhadamanthys agit.
cum gesta superni
curriculi totosque diu
perspexerit actus, 481
exaequat damnum meritis et
muta ferarum

sunk in sloth, sodden with wine,
given to venery, sluggish from
excesses, he compelled to enter the
fat bodies of filthy swine. Was any
above measure talkative, a betrayer
of secrets, he was carried off, a fish,
to live in the waters amid his kind,
that in eternal silence he might atone
for his garrulity. When for thrice a
thousand years he had forced these
through countless diverse shapes, he
sends them back once more to the
beginnings of human form purged at
last with Lethe's stream.

muta rerum
 cogit vincla pati.^[94] truculentos
 ingerit ursis
 praedonesque lupis; fallaces
 vulpibus addit.
 at qui desidia semper vinoque
 gravatus, 485
 indulgens Veneri, voluit
 torpescere luxu,
 hunc suis inmundi pingues
 detrudit in artus.
 qui iusto plus esse loquax
 arcanaque suevit
 prodere, piscosas fertur victurus
 in undas,
 ut nimiam pensent aeterna
 silentia vocem. 490
 quos ubi per varias annis ter
 mille figuras
 egit, Lethaeo purgatos flumine
 tandem
 rursus ad humanae revocat
 primordia formae.

[95]

So then while he settles these suits,
 dread business of that infernal court,
 while he examines in due order the
 criminals of old, he marks afar
 Rufinus, scans him with a stern
 scrutiny and speaks, shaking his
 throne to its foundation. "Hither,
 Rufinus, scourge of the world,
 bottomless sink of gold who wouldst
 dare aught for money; hither
 conscienceless seller of justice (that
 crime of crimes), faithless cause of
 that northern war whose thousand
 slaughtered victims now throng
 Hell's narrow entry and weigh down
 Charon's crowded barque. Madman,
 why deny what all know? The foul
 stains of wickedness are branded
 upon thy heart, thy crimes have
 made their impress on thy spirit and
 thy sins cannot be hid. Right glad I
 am to sentence thee to every kind of
 punishment. O'er thee shall hang the
 threatening rock the moment of
 whose fall thou knowest not. The
 circling wheel shall rack thee. Thy
 lips the stream's waves shall flee,
 thirst shall parch thee to whose chin
 its elusive waters mount. The vulture
 shall leave his former prey and feast
 for ever on thy heart. And yet all
 these, Rufinus, whom the like
 punishments torment, how paltry
 their wickedness compared with
 thine! Did bold Salmoneus'
 thunderbolt or Tantalus' tongue ever

Tum quoque, dum lites
Stygiique negotia solvit
dura fori veteresque reos ex
ordine quaerit, 495
Rufinum procul ecce notat
visuque severo
lustrat et ex imo concussa sede
profatur:

“Huc superum labes, huc
insatiabilis auri
proluviis pretioque nihil non
ause parato,
quodque mihi summum scelus
est, huc improbe legum
venditor, Arctoi stimulator
perfide Martis! 501
cuius ob innumeras strages
angustus Averni
iam sinus et plena lassatur
portitor alno.
quid demens manifesta negas?
en pectus inustae
deformant maculae vitiisque
inolevit imago 505
nec sese commissa tegunt.
genus omne dolorum
in te ferre libet: dubio tibi
pendula rupes
inmineat lapsu, volucer te
torqueat axis,
te refugi fallant latices atque ore
natanti
arescat decepta sitis,
dapibusque relictis 510
in tua mansurus migret
praecordia vultur.
quamquam omnes alii, quos
haec tormenta fatigant

do like wrong or Tityos so offend
with his mad love? Join all their
crimes together yet wilt thou surpass
them. What sufficient atonement can
be found for such wickedness? What
to match thy sum of crimes whose
single misdeeds outmatch all
punishment? Shades, remove from
this our ghostly company that
presence that disgraces it. To have
seen once is enough. Have mercy
now on our eyes, and cleanse the
realm of Dis. Drive

haec tormenta laugant,
 pars quota sunt,^[96] Rufine, tui!
 trans Stygia, trans Erebus,
 fulmine vacuum mandate lingua
 infra Titani tenebras infraque
 aut incoerens recessus Tityos deliquit
 Tartareos ipsamque^[61] Chaos,
 cunctorum si facta simul
 fundamenta latent, praecipos ibi
 praecedens numero qui tanta
 dum rotat astra polus, feriunt
 supplicio conferre valet? quid
 denique dignum
 omnibus inveniam, vincant cum
 singula poenas?
 tollite de mediis animarum
 dedecus umbris. 520
 adspexisse sat est. oculis iam
 parcite nostris
 et Ditis purgate domos. agitate
 flagellis

[97]

him with whips beyond the Styx,
 beyond Erebus; thrust him down into
 the empty pit beneath the lightless
 prison of the Titans, below the
 depths of Tartarus and Chaos' own
 realm, where lie the foundations of
 thickest midnight; deep hidden there
 let him live while ever the vault of
 heaven carries round the stars and
 the winds beat upon the land."

DE BELLO GILDONICO**LIBER I**

(XV.)

THE WAR AGAINST**GILDO^[62]****BOOK I**

(XV.)

The kingdom of the south is restored to our empire, the sky of that other hemisphere is once more brought into subjection. East and West live in amity and concord beneath the sway of one ruler. We have joined Europe again to Africa, and unswerving singleness of purpose unites the brother emperors. The would-be third participant of empire has fallen before the prowess of Honorius the son—that one victory that failed to grace the arms of Theodosius, the father. Still is my mind troubled and admits not the universal joy for very amazement, nor can believe the fulfilment of its heart-felt prayers. Not yet had the army landed upon Africa's^[63] coasts when Gildo yielded to defeat. No difficulties delayed our victorious arms, neither length of march nor intervening ocean. One and the same word brings news of the conflict, the flight, the capture of Gildo. The news of victory outstripped the news of the war that occasioned it. What

Redditus imperiis Auster
subiectaque rursus
alterius convexa poli. rectore
sub uno
conspirat geminus frenis
communibus orbis.
iunximus Europen Libyae.
concordia fratrum
plena redit. patriis solum quod
defuit armis, 5
tertius occubuit nati virtute
tyrannus.
horret adhuc animus
manifestaque gaudia
differt,
dum stupet et tanto cunctatur
credere voto.
necdum Cinyphias exercitus
attigit oras:
iam domitus Gildo. nullis
victoria nodis 10
haesit, non spatio terrae, non
obice ponti.
congressum profugum captum
vox nuntiat una
rumoremque sui praevenit
laurea belli.
quo, precor, haec effecta deo?
robusta vetusque
tempore tam parvo potuit
dementia vinci? 15
quem veniens indixit hiems, ver
perculit hostem.

god wrought this for us? Could
madness so strong, so deep-seated be
overcome so soon? The enemy
whom early winter brought upon us,
spring destroyed.

[62] For the details of Gildo's rebellion
see Introduction, p. x.

[63] The Cinyps is a river in Libya; *cf.*
Virg. *Georg.* iii. 312.

Rome, the goddess, fearing for her city's destruction and weak with corn withheld, hastened to the threshold of revolving Olympus with looks unlike her own; not with such countenance does she assign laws to the Britons, or subject the frightened Indians to her rule. Feeble her voice, slow her step, her eyes deep buried. Her cheeks were sunken and hunger had wasted her limbs. Scarce can her weak shoulders support her unpolished shield. Her ill-fitting helmet shows her grey hairs and the spear she carries is a mass of rust. At last she reaches heaven and falls at the Thunderer's feet and utters this mournful complaint: "If prophecy rightly foretold the permanence of the rising walls of Rome; if the Sibyl's verse is unalterable; if thou art not yet wearied of our city and the Capitol, I come to thee as a suppliant. My prayer is not that a consul may march in triumph along Araxes' banks, nor that Rome's power may crush the archer Persians and Susa their capital, nor yet that we may plant our standards on the Red Sea's strand. All this thou grantedst us of old. 'Tis but food I, Rome, ask for now; father, take pity on thy chosen race and ease us of this hunger unto death. Whatever thy displeasure, we have surely sated it. The very Getae and Suebi would pity

Exitium iam Roma timens et
fessa negatis
frugibus ad rapidi limen
tendebat Olympi
non solito vultu nec qualis iura
Britannis
dividit aut trepidos summittit
fascibus Indos. 20
vox tenuis tardique gradus
oculique iacentes
interius; fugere genae; ieiuna
lacertos
exedit macies. umeris vix
sustinet aegris
squalentem clipeum; laxata
casside prodit
canitiem plenamque trahit
rubiginis hastam. 25
attigit ut tandem caelum
genibusque Tonantis
procubuit, tales orditur maesta
querellas:
“Si mea mansuris meruerunt
moenia nasci,
Iuppiter, auguriis, si stant
inmota Sibyllae
carmina, Tarpeias si necdum
respuit arces: 30
advenio supplex, non ut
proculcet Araxen
consul ovans nostraeve premant
pharetrata secures
Susa, nec ut Rubris aquilas
figamus harenis.
haec nobis, haec ante dabas;
nunc pabula tantum
Roma precor. miserere tuae,
pater optima gentis. 35

our sufferings; Parthia's self would shudder at my disasters. What need have I to mention the pestilence, the heaps of corpses, the numberless deaths wherewith the very air is corrupted? Why tell of Tiber's flooded stream, sweeping betwixt roofs and threatening the very hills? My submerged city has borne mighty ships, echoed the sound of oars, and experienced Pyrrha's flood.

“Woe is me, whither are fled the power of Latium

pater opulac, genus, 33
[103]
extremam defende famem.

satiavimus iram
si qua fuit; lugenda Getis et
flenda Suebis
hausimus; ipsa meos horreret
Parthia casus.
quid referam morbive luem
tumulosve repletos
stragibus et crebras corrupto
sidere mortes? 40
aut fluvium per tecta vagum
summisque minatum
collibus? ingentes vexi
summersa carinas
remorumque sonos et Pyrrhae
saecula sensi.
“Ei mihi, quo Latiae vires
urbisque potestas

[103]

and the might of Rome? To what a shadow of our former glory are we by gradual decline arrived! Time was when my men bore arms and my greybeards met in council; mistress of the world was I and lawgiver to mankind. From rising to setting sun I sped in triumph. When proud Caesar had transferred my people's power to himself, when manners became corrupt and forgetful of war's old discipline I declined into the servile lap of peace, the emperors rewarded me with Africa and Egypt that they might nourish the sovereign people and the Senate, arbiter of peace and war, by means of summer-spiced fleets, and that the winds, blowing alternately from either shore, should fill our granaries with corn. Our provisioning was secure. Should Memphis perchance have denied us food, I would make up for the failure of Egypt's harvest by the African supply. I saw competition between grain-bearing vessels, and where'er I looked I beheld the fleet of Carthage strive in rivalry with that of the Nile. When a second Rome arose and the Eastern Empire assumed the toga of the West, Egypt fell beneath that new sway. Africa remained our only hope and scarcely did she suffice to feed us, whose corn-ships none but the south wind wafted across. Her promise for the future was insecure,

decidit! in qualem paulatim
 fluximus umbram! 45
 armato quondam populo
 patrumque vigebam
 conciliis; domui terras urbesque
 revinxi
 legibus: ad solem victrix
 utrumque cucurri.
 postquam iura ferox in se
 communia Caesar
 transtulit et lapsi mores
 desuetaque priscis 50
 artibus in gremium pacis servile
 recessi,
 tot mihi pro meritis Libyam
 Nilumque dedere,
 ut dominam plebem
 bellatoremque senatum
 classibus aestivis alerent
 geminoque vicissim
 litore diversi complerent horrea
 venti. 55
 stabat certa salus: Memphis si
 forte negasset,
 pensabam Pharium Gaetulis
 messibus annum,
 frugiferas certare rates lateque
 videbam
 Punica Niliacis concurrere
 carbasa velis.
 cum subiit par Roma mihi
 divisaque sumpsit 60
 aequales Aurora togas, Aegyptia
 rura
 in partem cessere novae. spes
 unica nobis
 restabat Libyae, quae vix
 aegreque fovebat.

as, ever helpless, she demanded the
 loyalty of the wind and of the
 season. [64] This province, too, Gildo
 seized towards the close of autumn.
 Anxiously and prayerfully we scan
 the blue sea to glance a coming sail
 in the fond hope that perchance a
 sense of shame has extorted
 somewhat from the powerful tyrant,
 or the conqueror left some corner
 unconquered. We are fed at the
 pleasure of the Moor,

[64] Claudian means that the African
 corn-supply was not always to be relied
 upon because (1) there might be a bad
 season, (2) there might be unfavourable
 winds.

aegreque lovebat,
solo ducta Noto,^[104] humquam
secura futuri,
semper inops, ventique fidem
poscebat et anni. 65
hanc quoque nunc Gildo rapuit
sub fine cadentis
autumni. pavidō metimur
caerula voto,
puppis si qua venit, si quid
fortasse potenti
vel pudor extorsit domino vel
praedo reliquit.
pascimur arbitrio Mauri nec
debita reddi, 70

[105]

who boasts that he does not repay a debt but that he gives us of his own, and rejoices to apportion out my daily food to me, as though I were his slave; with a barbarian's pride he weighs me life or death by hunger, triumphs in a people's tears, and holds above our heads an universal destruction. He sells Rome's crops and possesses land won by my wounds. Was it for this that I waged lamentable war with proud Carthage for so many years? For this that Regulus reckoned his life as naught and would fain return to his captors? Is this my reward, father, for my losses on Cannae's field? Have the Spanish and Sicilian seas resounded so often to our navies' clarion for naught? For naught my lands been laid waste, so many of my generals slain, the Carthaginian invader broken his way through the Alps, Hannibal approached my affrighted capital? Have I kept the foe at bay with my walls and spent nights of slaughter before the Colline gate to enable a barbarian to reap the fruits of conquered Africa? Has thrice-conquered Carthage fallen for Gildo's benefit? Was this the object of mourning Italy's thousand disasters, of centuries spent in war, of Fabius' and Marcellus' deeds of daring—that Gildo should heap him up riches? We forced cruel Syphax to

sed sua concedi iactat
gaudetque diurnos
ut famulae praeberere cibos
vitamque famemque
librat barbarico fastu vulgique
superbit
fletibus et tantae suspendit fata
ruinae.
Romuleas vendit segetes et
possidet arva 75
vulneribus quaesita meis.
ideone tot annos
flebile cum tumida bellum
Carthagine gessi?
idcirco voluit contempta luce
reverti
Regulus? hoc damnis, genitor,
Cannensibus emi?
incassum totiens lituis
navalibus arsit 80
Hispanum Siculumque fretum
vastataque tellus
totque duces caesi ruptaque
emissus ab Alpe
Poenus et attonitae iam
proximus Hannibal
urbi?
scilicet ut domitis frueretur
barbarus Afris,
muro sustinui Martem
noctesque cruentas 85
Collina pro turre tuli? Gildonis
ad usum
Carthago ter victa ruit? hoc
mille gementis
Italiae clades impensa
saecula bellis,
hoc Fabius fortisque mihi

drink poison, drove fierce Iugurtha,
whose power Metellus had broken,
beneath Marius' yoke—and shall
Africa be Gildo's? Alas for our toil
and those many deaths: the two
Scipios have laboured, it seems, to
further Bocchus' ^[65] native rule;
Roman blood has given victory to
the Moors. That long warlike race,
lord of the world, that appointed
consuls and kings, whom foreign
nations found ever formidable in
war, though gentle once they had

[65] Bocchus, properly a king of
Mauritania, stands here typically for
any native monarch.

HOE FABRIS TOTUSQUE MINIM

Marcellus^[106] agebant,
ut Gildo cumlaret opes?
haurire venena 90
compulimus dirum Syphacem
fractumque Metello
traximus inmanem Marii sub
vincla Iugurtham,
et Numidae Gildonis erunt? pro
funera tanta,
pro labor! in Bocchi regnum
sudavit uterque
Scipio. Romano vicistis
sanguine Mauri. 95
ille diu miles populus, qui
praefuit orbi,
qui trabeas et scepra dabat,
quem semper in armis
horribilem gentes, placidum
sensere subactae,

[107]

been subdued, dishonoured now and poverty-stricken, bends beneath the cruel lash of peace, and though not openly beleaguered by any foe yet has all the hazard of a siege. Destruction threatens me hourly; a few days will set a limit to my uncertain food-supply. Out upon thee, prosperity! Why hast thou given me seven hills and such a population as a small supply cannot nourish? Happier I, had my power been less. Better to have put up with the Sabines and Veii; in narrower bonds I passed securer days. My very magnitude undoes me; would that I could return to my former boundaries and the walls of poor Ancus. Enough for me then would be the ploughlands of Etruria and Campania, the farms of Cincinnatus and Curius, and at his country's prayer the rustic dictator^[66] would bring his home-grown wheat.

“What am I to do now? Gildo holds Libya, another^[67] Egypt; while I, who subdued land and sea with my strong arm, am left to perish. Veteran of so many wars, can I claim no reward in mine old age? Ye gods in whose despite, it seems, I increased, now aid me at the last; pray Jove for me. And thou, Cybele, if ever of thine own free will thou wert carried over the sea and in exchange for

nunc inhonoris egens perfert
 miserabile pacis
 supplicium nulloque palam
 circumdatus hoste 100
 obsessi discrimen habet. per
 singula letum
 impendet momenta mihi
 dubitandaque pauci
 praescribunt alimenta dies, heu
 prospera fata!
 quid mihi septenos montes
 turbamque dedistis,
 quae parvo non possit ali?
 felicior essem 105
 angustis opibus; mallet
 tolerare Sabinos
 et Veios; brevior duxi securius
 aevum.
 ipsa nocet moles. utinam
 remeare liceret
 ad veteres fines et moenia
 pauperis Anci.
 sufficerent Etrusca mihi
 Campanaque culta 110
 et Quincti Curiique seges,
 patriaeque petenti
 rusticus inferret proprias
 dictator aristas.
 “Nunc quid agam? Libyam
 Gildo tenet, altera
 Nilum.
 ast ego, quae terras umeris
 pontumque subegi,
 deseror: emeritae iam praemia
 nulla senectae. 115
 di, quibus iratis crevi, succurrite
 tandem,
 exorate patrem: tu quoque o si

Mount Ida tookest the hills of Rome
 and didst bathe thy Phrygian lions in
 Almo's more favoured stream, move
 now thy son^[68] with a mother's
 entreaties. But if the fates forbid and
 our first founder was misled by
 augury untrue, o'erwhelm me at least
 in some different ruin, and change
 the nature of my punishment. Let
 Porsenna bring back the Tarquins; let
 Allia renew her bloody battle. Let
 me fall rather into the hands of cruel

^[66] Doubtless a reference to Cincinnatus.

^[67] Claudian means by “*altera*” the Eastern Empire.

^[68] *i.e.* Jupiter.

exorate patrem, tuque o si
 sponte ^[108] per altum
 vecta Palatinis mutasti collibus
 Idam
 praelatoque lavas Phrygios
 Almone leones,
 maternis precibus natum iam
 flecte, Cybebe. 120
 sin prohibent Parcae falsisque
 elusa vetustas
 auspiciis, alio saltem prosternite
 casu
 et poenae mutate genus.
 Porsenna reducat
 Tarquinius; renovet ferales Allia
 pugnas;
 me potius saevi manibus
 permittite Pyrrhi, 125

[109]

Pyrrhus; abandon me to the fury of the Senones or the flames of Brennus. Welcome all this rather than to starve!”

So spake she, and upwelling tears choked her voice. Venus, mother of Aeneas, wept, and Mars, father of Romulus and Minerva, mindful of Vesta’s sacred charge. ^[69] Nor Cybele nor Juno stood with dry eyes. The heroes mourn and all the gods whose worship Rome received from without or herself inaugurated. And now began the heart of Jove to soften. With hand outstretched he was checking the murmurings of the gods when, shaking heaven with distraught cries, Africa, her cheeks torn, appeared in the distance advancing amid the stars. Torn was her raiment, scattered her crown of corn. Her head was wounded and the ivory comb that secured her hair hung loose and broken. She rushed into Heaven’s halls shouting thus: “Great Jove, why delayest thou to loose the bonds of sea, to break its decree and hurl thy brother ^[70] in wrath against the land? May I be the first to be overwhelmed. Welcome the broken waters from Pachynus’ cape; sink my cities in the freed Syrtes. If so be fate cannot rid me of Gildo, rid Gildo of me. Happier that region of Libya that defends itself by

me Senonum furiis, Brenni me
reddite flammis.
cuncta fame leviora mihi.”

Sic

fata refusis
obticuit lacrimis. mater Cytherea
parensque
flet Mavors sanctaeque memor
Tritonia Vestae,
nec Cybele sicco nec stabat
lumine Iuno. 130
maerent indigetes et si quos
Roma recepit
aut dedit ipsa deos. genitor iam
corde remitti
coeperat et sacrum dextra sedare
tumultum,
cum procul insanis quatiens
ululatibus axem
et contusa genas mediis adparet
in astris 135
Africa: rescissae vestes et spicea
passim
serta iacent; lacero crinales
vertice dentes
et fractum pendebat ebur, talique
superbas
inrupit clamore fores:

“Quid

magne moraris
Iuppiter avulso nexu pelagique
solutis 140
legibus iratum populis inmittere
fratrem?
mergi prima peto; veniant
praerupta Pachyno
aequora, laxatis subsidant
Suntibus urbes

means of its own excessive heat and thus knows not the irksome rule of so savage a tyrant. Let the torrid zone spread. Let the midmost path of the scorching sky burn me also. Better I lay a desert nor ever suffered the plough. Let the dust-snake lord it in a cornless land and the thirsty earth give birth to nought but vipers. What avails me a healthy climate, a milder air? My fruitfulness is but for

[69] *i.e.* the Palladium, the image of Pallas (=Minerva), rescued by Metellus from the burning temple of Vesta, 241 B.C.

[70] *i.e.* Neptune.

si mihi Gildoni^[110] nequeunt
 abducere fata,
 me rape Gildoni. felicior illa
 perustae 145
 pars Libyae, nimio quae se
 munita calore
 defendit tantique vacat securam
 tyranni.
 crescat zona rubens; medius
 flagrantis Olympi
 me quoque limes agat; melius
 deserta iacebo
 vomeris impatiens. pulsus
 dominantur aristis 150
 dipsades et sitiens attollat glaeba
 cerastas.
 quid me temperies iuvit? quid
 mitior aether?
 Gildoni fecunda fui. iam solis
 habenae

[111]

Gildo. Twelve courses has the sun's
 chariot run since first I wore this
 sorry yoke. He has now grown old
 amid our miseries and these many
 years have set their seal upon his
 rule. Rule—would it were rule: a
 private owner possesses me, as it had
 been some pelting farm. From Nile
 to Atlas' mount, from scorched
 Barce to western Gades, from
 Tingi^[71] to Egypt's coast Gildo has
 appropriated the land as his own. A
 third of the world belongs to one
 robber-chief.

“He is a prey to the most diverse
 vices: whatsoe'er his bottomless
 greed has stolen, a yet more
 insatiable profligacy squanders. He
 is the terror of the living, the heir of
 the dead, the violator of the unwed,
 and the foul corrupter of the
 marriage-bed. He is never quiet;
 when greed is sated lust is rampant;
 day is a misery to the rich, night to
 the married. Is any wealthy or
 known to possess a beautiful wife,
 he is overwhelmed by some
 trumped-up charge. If no charge be
 brought against him, he is asked to a
 banquet and there murdered. No
 form of death but is known to this
 artist in crime. He investigates the
 properties of different poisons and
 serpents' livid venom and knows of
 deadly herbs unknown even to

bis senas torquent hiemes, cervicibus stepmothers. If any condemns what
 ex quo he sees by a look or sighs with too
 haeret triste iugum. nostris iam luctibus much freedom, at the very festal
 ille 155 board out darts some henchman with
 consenuit regnumque sibi tot vindicadrawn sword at a nod from his
 annos. master. Each glued to his seat tastes
 atque utinam regnum! privato iure in silent fear of the deadly banquet;
 tenemur drains, pale of face, the treacherous
 exigui specie fundi. quod Nilus et Atlas, and looks around at the
 dissidet, occiduis quod Gadibus arida weapons that threaten his life. The
 Barce deadly board is decked in infernal
 quodque Paraetonio secedit litore Tinglendlour, wet with slaughter,
 160 dreadful with fear of sword and
 hoc sibi transcripsit proprium. pars suspected poison. When wine has
 tertia mundi [\[71\]](#) Tangiers.
 unius praedonis ager.

“Distantibus

idem
 inter se vitiis cinctus: quodcumque
 profunda
 traxit avaritia, luxu peiore refundit.
 instat terribilis vivis, morientibus heres,
 165
 virginibus raptor, thalamis obscaenus
 adulter.
 nulla quies: oritur praeda cessante
 libido,
 divitibusque dies et nox metuenda
 maritis.
 quisquis vel locuples pulchra vel
 coniuge notus,
 crimine pulsatur falso; si crimina
 desunt, 170
 accitus conviva perit. mors nulla refugit
 artificem: varios sucos spumasque
 requirit
 serpentum virides et adhuc ignota
 novercis

gramina. si quisquam vultu praesentia

[113]

damnet

liberiusve gemat, dapibus crudelis in

ipsis 175

emicat ad nutum stricto mucrone

minister.

fixus quisque toro tacita formidine libat

carnifices epulas incertaque pocula

pallens

haurit et intentos capiti circumspicit

enses.

splendet Tartareo furialis mensa parata

180

caede madens, atrox gladio, suspecta

veneno.

inflamed the passions, his lust rages

more savagely; 'midst the mingled

smell of scents and flowers, 'midst

curled minions and youthful choirs

he bids go sport the widowed wives

whose husbands he but a moment

ago has murdered. Better Phalaris

and the torments of his furnace,

better to listen to the bellowings of

the Sicilian bull than to such songs

as these. Nor is the base sacrifice of

their good name enough. When tired

of each noblest matron Gildo hands

her over to the Moors. Married in

Carthage city these Sidonian mothers

needs must mate with barbarians. He

thrusts upon me an Ethiopian as a

son-in-law, a Berber as a husband.

The hideous half-breed child

affrights its cradle. Thanks to those

base allies his state is more regal

than that of the emperor himself.

Before him goes a body of foot-

soldiers, squadrons of cavalry

surround him and client kings whom

he enriches with our spoils. He

drives one and all from their

ancestral houses and expels

husbandmen from farms so long

theirs. My people are scattered in

exile. Are my citizens never to return

from their wanderings to their native

soil?"

She would have spoken further in

her grief had not Jove begun from

ut vino calefacta Venus, tum
 saevior ardet
 luxuries, mixtis redolent
 unguenta coronis:
 crinitos inter famulos
 pubemque canoram
 orbatas iubet ire nurus nuperque
 peremptis 185
 adridere viris. Phalarim
 tormentaue flammae
 profuit et Siculi mugitus ferre
 iuuenci
 quam tales audire choros. nec
 damna pudoris
 turpia sufficiunt: Mauris
 clarissima quaeque
 fastidita datur. media
 Carthagine ductae 190
 barbara Sidoniae subeunt
 conubia matres;
 Aethiopem nobis generum,
 Nasamona maritum
 ingerit; exterret cunabula
 discolor infans.
 his fretus sociis ipso iam
 principe maior
 incedit; peditum praecurrunt
 agmina longe; 195
 circumdant equitum turmae
 regesque clientes,
 quos nostris ditat spoliis.
 proturbat avita
 quemque domo; veteres detrudit
 rure colonos.
 exiliis dispersa feror.
 numquamne reverti
 fas erit errantesque solo iam
 reddere cives? 200

his lofty throne—Atropos wrote
 down his words in adamant and
 Lachesis spun them in with her
 thread—“Neither thou, Rome, nor
 yet thou, Africa, will we suffer to go
 long unavenged. Honorius shall
 disperse your common foe. Go in
 peace. No violence shall part your
 companionship; Africa shall serve
 Rome, and Rome alone.”

He spake and breathed into Rome a
 youth renewed. Straightway her
 former strength returned, and her
 hair put off its grey of eld; her
 helmet grew solid,

Iret adhuc in verba dolor, ni
 Iuppiter alto
 coepisset solio (voces adamante
 notabat
 Atropos et Lachesis iungebat
 stamina dictis):
 “nec te, Roma, diu nec te
 patiemur inultam,
 Africa. communem prosternet
 Honorius hostem. 205
 pergite securae. vestrum vis
 nulla tenorem
 separat et soli famulabitur
 Africa Romae.”
 Dixit et adflavit Romam
 meliore iuventa.
 continuo redit ille vigor
 senique colorem
 mutavere comae. solidatam
 crista resurgens 210

upright stood the plumes, the round
 shield shone once more, and gone
 was every trace of rust from her
 wingèd, gleaming spear.

Sleep was now driving the dew-
 drenched steeds of night, guiding
 them with the reins of Lethe and
 carrying round the stars in her silent
 course, when the elder and the
 younger Theodosius, [72] chief among
 the heroes divine, came to bring
 peace to men. They bore Jove’s
 secret message and mandate to the
 two brothers and ratified the treaty
 between the two empires. So when at
 dead of night the driving tempest has
 brought the helmsman’s skill to
 nought and the sinking ship groans
 and shudders at the waves’ ceaseless
 shock, Leda’s Spartan-born sons
 sustain the foundering bark in
 answer to the sailors’ prayers. At the
 rise of the full moon the twain
 parted. The elder directed his steps
 towards the coasts of Italy, the
 younger visited the couch of
 Arcadius, gliding down to that
 Eastern city where Bosphorus narrows
 the entrance to the Euxine. As soon
 as the son saw his father (for the
 moon was shining brightly), he wept,
 yet trembled for joy, and embracing
 that form he had little hoped ever to
 embrace again, said: “O thou
 restored now to me for the first time

erexit galeam clipeique
 recanduit orbis
et levis excussa micuit rubigine
 cornus.

Umentes iam noctis equos
 Lethaeaque Somnus
frena regens tacitoolvebat
 sidera curru.

iam duo divorum proceres,
 maiorque minorque 215

Theodosii, pacem laturi
 gentibus ibant,
qui Iovis arcanos monitus
 mandataque ferrent

fratribus et geminis sancirent
 foedera regnis:
sic cum praecipites artem vicere
 procellae

adsiduoque gemens undarum
 verbere nutat 220

descensura ratis, caeca sub
 nocte vocati

naufraga Ladaei sustentant vela
 Lacones.

circulus ut patuit Lunae,
 secuere meatus

diversos: Italas senior tendebat
 in oras;

at pater, intrantem Pontum qua
 Bosphorus artat,

Arcadii thalamis ubique
 inlapsus Eoae. 226

quem simulac vidit natus (nam
 clara nitebat

Cynthia), permixto tremuerunt
 gaudia fletu

complexuque fovens, quos non
 conspexerat artus

since thy triumphs in the Alps,
whence comest thou to thy loving
son? Let me touch that hand that has
conquered so many barbarian races!
Who hath robbed the world of such a
defender? How long a while has
mankind prayed thine aid, and
missed thy goodness and thy might!"

Sighing, the father made answer:
"Was it for this? Is a Moor become a
cause of discord between two
brothers? Does the empire and court
of the

[72] Theodosius the younger is, of course, Theodosius I., the Emperor (see Introduction, p. vii). Theodosius the elder was his father. He was an able and trusted general of Valentinian I., who restored quiet in Britain (368-370), defeated the Alamanni (370), and crushed the revolt of Firmus, Gildo's brother (see line 333 of this poem) in Africa (? 372-374). His death was brought about by Merobaudes, Gratian's minister (cf. viii. 26-9).

spectaverat, atque
[116]
"O mihi post Alpes nunc
primum reddite," dixit,
230
"unde tuis optatus ades? da
tangere dextram,
qua gentes cecidere ferae. quis
tale removet
praesidium terris? ut te mortalia
pridem
implorant longeque pium
fortemque requirunt!"
Cui pater in tales rupit
suspiria voces: 235
"hoc erat? in fratres medio
discordia Mauro
nascitur et mundus germanaque
dissidet aula?"

[117]

East quarrel with those of the West?
Can Gildo's salvation be fit guerdon
for this mad rivalry? Great no doubt
are his virtues, great should be the
price paid to preserve them and such
his merits as to banish affection in a
brother. Look you, though I, thy sire,
willed it not, civil war raged; the
fortunes of Rome stood on a razor's
edge. Was there a distant king of
Armenia, an unknown monarch by
Maeotis' shore but sent aid to mine
enterprises? The Getae gave me
succour, the Geloni came to my
assistance. Gildo alone sent not a
man, not a ship, but waited the issue
in wavering loyalty. Had he sought
the confronting host as an open foe
my wrath had been less bitter. He
stood apart on Fortune's watchtower
and, withdrawn from the throng,
weighed this side against that,
meaning to let the event decide him,
dependent upon the turn things
might take and ready to embrace the
side of the victor. His fortune hung
in the balance as well as his
intention. Had I not been hurried to
heaven by the impatient stars I
would have followed the example of
Tullus Hostilius and dragged the
impious wretch limb from limb
fastened to chariots driven different
ways through thorn bushes. ^[74] Up to
this time he has owed obedience to

Gildonisne salus tanti sit palma
 furoris?
 scilicet egregius morum
 magnoque tuendus
 et cuius meritis pietas in fratre
 recedat! 240
 invito^[73] genitore, vide, civile
 calebat
 discidium; dubio stabant
 Romana sub ictu;
 quis procul Armenius vel quis
 Maeotide ripa
 rex ignotus agit, qui me non
 iuvit euntem
 auxilio? fovere Getae, venere
 Geloni. 245
 solus at hic non puppe data, non
 milite misso
 subsedit fluitante fide. si signa
 petisset
 obvia, detecto summissius hoste
 dolerem:
 restitit in speculis fati turbaque
 reductus
 libravit geminas eventu iudice
 vires 250
 ad rerum momenta cliens
 seseque daturus
 victori; fortuna simul cum
 mente pependit.
 o si non cupidis essem
 praereptus ab astris,
 exemplum sequerer Tulli
 laniandaque dumis
 impia diversis aptarem membra
 quadrigis. 255
 germani nunc usque tui
 responso calebat.

thy brother, now behold he spurns
 his commands. After thy father's and
 thy brother's fate art thou ready to
 trust thyself to such a villain? Is
 thine answer that he maketh great
 return and hath brought over many
 cities to thine allegiance? Shall
 honour, then, give place to utility?
 Can gain render treachery welcome?
 I make no mention of his cruel
 betrayal of thy brother; of his fickle
 nature; were a traitor to bring safety
 even when at peril's height death
 threatened, never shall he win
 gratitude. When our life is saved

^[74] See note on viii. 401.

[73] ^{MSS. in primo, *Birt* suggests invito,}
enimmo alcat. tali te credere
 monstro
post patrem fratremque paras?
 sed magna rependit
inque tuam sortem numerosas
 transtulit urbes!
ergo fas pretio cedet? mercede
 placebit 260
proditio? taceo, laesi quod
 transfuga fratris,
quod levis ingenio. quamvis
 discrimine summo
proditor adportet suspensa
 morte salutem
numquam gratus erit.
 damnamus luce reperta

we condemn the treachery nor brook to entrust ourselves to such protection. 'Tis this sort that offers for purchase cities and their inhabitants, that sells its fatherland. Most make use of such for the moment but soon learn to hate them. 'Twas thus that Philip held the cities of Greece; liberty fell before the attack of Macedonian gold. Rome has ever despised the ministers of guilt. Fabricius, discovering the plot, sent back to King Pyrrhus the slave who had promised to mingle deadly poison for his lord; fierce war raged between them, but Fabricius refused to end it by means of the treachery of a slave. Camillus, too, gave back to the beleaguered city the boys brought to his camp from out the walls.

“These were consigned to punishment for seeking to put an end to wars. Is Gildo to live that he may kindle them? Takest thou such measures against thy brother as another would disdain to take against an enemy? O shame for unending ages! Gildo entrusts the governance of the south to whom he will; the great province of Africa obeys a tyrant's whim. To whichever side his fickle mind inclines, he carries Libya over with him and malignantly subjects it to a rule shifting as the

perfidiam nec nos patimur
 committere tali. 265
hoc genus emptori cives cum
 moenibus offert,
hoc vendit patriam. plerique in
 tempus abusi
mox odere tamen: tenuit sic
 Graia Philippus
oppida; Pellaeo libertas concidit
 auro.
Romani scelerum semper
 sprevere ministros. 270
noxia pollicitum domino miscere
 venena
Fabricius regi nudata fraude
 remisit,
infesto quem Marte petit,
 bellumque negavit
per famuli patrare nefas,
 ductosque Camillus
trans murum pueros obsessae
 reddidit urbi. 275
“Traduntur poenis alii, cum
 proelia tollunt;
hic manet ut moveat? quod
 respuit alter in hostem,
suscipis in fratrem? longi pro
 dedecus aevi!
cui placet, australes Gildo
 condonat habenas
tantaque mutatos sequitur
 provincia mores. 280
quaslibet ad partes animus
 nutaverit anceps,
transfundit secum Libyam
 refluumque malignus
commodat imperium. Mauri fuit
 Africa munus

tide. Africa was the gift of the Moor.
Away with the trickery of the
Massyli, their treacherous wiles and
their words that breathe forth the
poison of their land. Let not brother
wage war on brother, I pray. That
were worthy of cruel Thebes and
Mycenae; let that accusation be
levelled against the Moors.

“What wrong is Stilicho devising?
when did he fail in his obedience?
than him what more loyal

AMICA MANUS.

tollite Massylas^[120] fraudes,
removete bilingues
insidias et verba soli spirantia
virus. 285

ne consanguineis certetur
comminus armis,
ne, precor. haec trucibus Thebis,
haec digna Mycenis;
in Mauros hoc crimen eat.

“Quid

noster iniquum
molitur Stilicho? quando non ille
iubenti
paruit? an quisquam nobis
devinctior extat? 290

[121]

supporter have we? I will not mention the various brave deeds he did while yet with me; of those only I will tell which I saw after my death. When I was raised to heaven disorder—I admit it—and tumult did I leave behind me. The army was still drawing the forbidden sword in that Alpine war, and conquerors and conquered gave alternate cause for dissension. Scarce could this madness have been calmed by my vigilance, much less by a boy's rule. Ah, how I feared for you what the uncontrolled might of such vast armies might dare, when, your sire removed, there came the fevered delight in change! Dangerous was discord, more dangerous still unanimity. 'Twas then that Stilicho took my place in paternal love for thee, tended thine immature youth, and brought thee to the years and estate of an emperor. 'Twas he drove back Rufinus whom thou didst confess thou fearedst. Gratitude and loyalty I find in him alone. Did I want or seem to want aught, while yet I lived he accomplished it. Now I am dead he worships me as worthy of veneration and an ever present helper. If the thought of his goodness move thee not, at least show respect to thy brother's father-in-law: bethink thee of Honorius' marriage, the royal espousal of my niece

ut sileam varios mecum quos
gesserit actus,
quae vidi post fata, loquar. cum
divus abirem,
res incompositas (fateor)
tumidasque reliqui.
stringebat vetitos etiamnum
exercitus enses
Alpinis odiis, alternaque iurgia
victi 295
victoresque dabant. vix haec
amentia nostris
excubiis, nedum puero rectore
quiesset.
heu quantum timui vobis, quid
libera tanti
militis auderet moles, cum patre
remoto
ferveret iam laeta novis!
dissensus acerbus 300
et gravior consensus erat. tunc
ipse paterna
successit pietate mihi
tenerumque rudemque
fovit et in veros eduxit principis
annos,
Rufinumque tibi, quem tu
tremuisse fateris,
depulit. hunc solum memorem
solumque fidelem 305
experior. volui si quid, dum vita
maneret,
aut visus voluisse, gerit;
venerabilis illi
ceu praesens numenque vocor.
si tanta recusas,
at soceri reverere faces, at
respice fratris

Serena. Thou oughtest to face thy
brother's foes, he thine. Could any
nation, could the combined forces of
Rhine and Danube have stood
against you twain allied? Enough!
bring about but the defeat of Gildo: I
ask nought else. Though he entrench
himself behind the protecting Syrtes
and rely for safety on the intervening
ocean; though he think to be
defended by reason of his serpent-
infested country and the fierce

respice haus
 conubium pignusque meae^[122]
 regale Serenae. 310
 debueras etiam fraternis obuius
 ire
 hostibus, ille tuis. quae gens,
 quis Rhenus et Hister
 vos opibus iunctos
 conspirantesque
 tulisset?
 sed tantum permitte, cadat. nil
 poscimus ultra.
 ille licet sese praetentis Syrtibus
 armet 315
 oppositoque Atlante tegat, licet
 arva referta
 anguibus et solis medios
 obiecerit aestus:

[123]

sun's mid-day heat, yet well I know
 Stilicho's ingenuity—that mind of
 his equal to any emergency. He will
 force his way through the desert, his
 own greatness will lead him.”

Thus spake the dead emperor,
 whereon thus the son answered:
 “Right willingly, father, will I fulfil
 thy commands: ever ready am I to
 welcome thy behests. None is dearer
 to me than my kinsman Stilicho. Let
 the impious Gildo atone for his
 wrongs, and Africa be restored to my
 brother still safer than before.”

While father and son thus debated in
 long converse, Theodosius the
 grandfather made his way to Italy
 and entered the chaste bedchamber
 where on his couch of Tyrian purple
 Honorius lay in sweet sleep by the
 side of his wife Maria. At his head
 he stood and thus spake to him in a
 dream. “What rash confidence is
 this, dear grandson, that fills the
 conquered Moors? Does the mad
 race descended from Juba, the
 people whom I subdued, once more
 conspire to oppose Rome's power
 and recommence the war with its
 conqueror's grandson? Have they
 forgotten the defeat of Firmus^[75]?
 Do they think to repossess Libya
 won back by the sweat of battle?
 Dares Gildo strive with Rome? Does
 he not fear his brother's fate. Fain

let the bays of Mauretania deck
 chariots twain and one house
 triumph thus many times over one
 race. Thanks be to the gods who
 have interposed so many years
 between the sacrifice of Firmus to
 my arms and that of Firmus' brother
 to those of my grandson." He spake,
 then fled, as he felt the breath of the
 approaching dawn.

Then emulous courage roused the
 emperor with insistent goad. He
 burns to set sail, to cleave the main,
 to assail with the spear the distant
 Moors. So he summons his father-in-
 law^[76] and clasping his hand asks
 what course of action he advises.
 "Full often, reverend sire, is the
 future revealed to me in dreams;
 many a night brings prophecy.
 Methought I surrounded in hunting
 the distant glades of Africa and
 scoured the Gaetolian mountains
 with my hounds. The district was
 distressed by reason of the
 incursions of a ravening lion. On all
 sides were slaughtered beasts and
 mangled heifers, and still their
 homesteads ran red with blood, and
 corpses of many a shepherd lay
 weltering in the bloody fields. I
 approached the beast's cave and saw
 a sight wonderful to relate. Gone
 was that noble form, drooping on the
 neck the threatening mane; there he

exornet geminos Maurusia
 laurea currus:
una domus totiens una de gente
 triumphet. 345
di bene, quod tantis
 interlabentibus annis
servati Firmusque mihi
 fraterque nepoti.”
dixit et adflatus vicino sole
 refugit.
At iuvenem stimulis
 inmanibus aemula virtus
exacuit; iam puppe vehi, iam
 stagna secare 350
fervet et absentes invadere
 cuspide Mauros.
tum iubet acciri socerum
 dextramque vocato
conserit et, quae sit potior
 sententia, quaerit:
 “Per somnos mihi, sancte
 pater, iam saepe futura
panduntur multaeque canunt
 praesagia noctes. 355
namque procul Libycos venatu
 cingere saltus
et iuga rimari canibus Gaetula
 videbar.
maerebat regio saevi vastata
 leonis
incursu; pecudum strages
 passimque iuveni
semineces et adhuc infecta
 mapalia tabo 360
sparsaque sanguineis pastorum
 funera campis.
adgredior latebras monstri
 mirumque relatu

crouched, defeated, humbled, with
slavish moans; fetters were upon his
paws and a chain clanked of a
sudden on his neck. Now, too, my
grandsire eagerly urges me to rival
his triumphs with my own. Why, he
asked, did I delay and hesitate so
long? Already my ships should have
been manned and the sea’s
threatened opposition overcome. I
myself am ready to cross in the first
vessel. Let every foreign nation that
is bound beneath my rule come to
our aid. Let all Germany be
transported and

[76] *i.e.* Stilicho.

~~minimeque telata~~
 conspicio: dilapsus^[126] honos,
 cervice minaces
 defluxere iubae; fractos
 inglorius armos
 supposuit, servile gemens;
 iniectaque vincla 365
 unguibus et subitae collo
 sonuere catenae.
 nunc etiam paribus secum
 certare tropaeis
 hortator me cogit avus. quonam
 usque remoti
 cunctamur? decuit pridem
 complere biremes
 et pelagi superare moras.
 transmittere primus 370
 ipse paro; quaecumque meo
 gens barbara nutu
 stringitur, adveniat: Germania
 cuncta feratur

[127]

the Sygambri come with allied fleet.
 Let trembling Africa now have
 experience of the dwellers on
 Rhine's banks. Or shall I sit here and
 submit to such disgrace? Shall I
 relinquish, now that I am a man,
 what I ruled and governed as a boy?
 Twice my father hurried to the Alps
 to defend another's realm. Am I to
 be an easy prey, an object of scorn?"

He ended and Stilicho thus made
 answer: "Wilt thou, an emperor,
 deign to challenge a Moor to fight?
 Is that coward to have the
 consolation of death in battle at thy
 hand? Shall Honorius fight on our
 side and Gildo on the other? Ere that,
 chaos shall plunge the stars into
 Hell. 'Tis enough to command his
 punishment. Thy name shall strike
 greater terror into him than thy
 sword. Presence will minish awe; he
 who stands in the lists admits
 equality, and struggling hosts regard
 not majesty. Listen and I will tell
 thee something at once more
 profitable for thyself and of more
 effect against the enemy. Gildo has a
 brother of like descent but unlike in
 character, Mascezel, who, avoiding
 the evil courses of his brother, has
 entrusted his hopes and his life to thy
 keeping. When Gildo, after many
 vain attempts, found no means to kill
 Mascezel, he turned his anger from

navibus et socia comitentur
 classe Sygambri.
pallida translatus iam sentiat
 Africa Rhenum. 374
an patiar tot probra sedens
 iuvenisque relinquam
quae tenui rexique puer? bis
 noster ad Alpes
alterius genitor defensum regna
 cucurrit.
nos praedae faciles
 insultandique iacemus?”
Finierat. Stilicho contra cui
 talìa reddit:
“adversine tubam princeps
 dignabere Mauri? 380
auferet ignavus clari solacia
 leti.
te bellante mori? decernet
 Honorius inde,
hinc Gildo? prius astra Chaos
 miscebit Averno.
vindictam mandasse sat est;
 plus nominis horror
quam tuus ensis aget. minuit
 praesentia famam. 385
qui stetit aequatur campo,
 collataque nescit
maiestatem acies. sed quod
 magis utile factu
atque hosti gravius (sensus
 adverte) docebo
est illi patribus, sed non et
 moribus isdem
Mascezel, fugiens qui dira
 piacula fratris 390
spesque suas vitamque tuo
 commisit asylo

the father to the children and slew
those whom himself had nursed as
infants in his arms; then cast aside
their unburied bodies and refused
sepulchre to the shades of those that
had been his kin. The bloody tyrant
stifled all natural feelings, forgot he
was a brother, forgot he was a man,
and begrudged the slain a handful of
dust. 'Twas a like deed brought its ill
repute upon Mycenae, that put the
sun to rout and turned back the day.
But while Atreus paid back crime for
crime and had excuse

COMMISSIT ASYLUM.
hunc ubi temptatus frustra^[128]
mactare nequivit
insidiis, patrias in pignora
contulit iras
et, quos ipse sinu parvos
gestaverat, una
occidit iuvenes inhumataque
corpora vulgo 395
dispulit et tumulo cognatas
arcuit umbras
naturamque simul fratremque
hominemque cruentus
exuit et tenuem caesis invidit
harenam.
hoc facinus refugo damnavit
sole Mycenae
avertitque diem; scelere sed
reddidit Atreus 400

[129]

for the bloody banquet in the unfaithfulness of his wife, Gildo's motive was hatred, not vengeance. Violated rights, the sorrowing father, the unburied dead, the unnatural crime all call upon thee as avenger. If thou, Athens, didst dedicate an altar to the sorrowing and ordain to those that mourn a special deity, if the women of Argos won to their aid the Athenian phalanx by their tears and bought burial for their slain lords at the price of war,^[77] if Adherbal, driven from his throne, roused the Senate against the Numidians by the sad appeal of unkempt locks and by his tears, then let Gildo be sorry that now this man also whom he has crushed by so many murders is come into the field against him, and let him learn that he must bow before thy suppliants. Let Gildo flee headlong before him whom he put to flight and fear him whom he o'erwhelmed with the murder of his children. As he is being dragged off to the slaughter let him recognize his brother's hand."

When this advice had been accepted by his son-in-law, Stilicho made ready for war the most famous regiments in the army, selecting therefrom special companies of picked men; he further prepared the fleet in the harbours of Etruria.

crimen et infandas excusat
 coniuge mensas.
 hic odium, non poena fuit. te
 perdita iura,
 te pater ultorem, te nudi pulvere
 manes,
 te pietas polluta rogat; si
 flentibus aram
 et proprium miseris numen
 statuistis, Athenae, 405
 si Pandionias planctu traxere
 phalanges
 Inachides belloque rogos
 meruere maritis,
 si maesto squalore comae
 lacrimisque senatum
 in Numidas pulsus solio
 commovit Adherbal:
 hunc quoque nunc Gildo, tanto
 quem funere mersit,
 hunc doleat venisse ducem
 seseque minorem 411
 supplicibus sciat esse tuis.
 quem sede fugavit,
 hunc praeceps fugiat, fregit
 quem clade, tremiscat
 agnoscatque suum, trahitur dum
 victima, fratrem.”
 Haec ubi sederunt genero,
 notissima Marti 415
 robora, praecipuos electa pube
 maniplos
 disponit portuque rates instaurat
 Etrusco.
 Herculeam suus Alcides
 Ioviamque cohortem
 rex ducit superum, premitur nec
 signifer ullo

Alcides himself commands the Herculean cohort; the king of the gods leads the Jovian. No standard-bearer feels the weight of his eagle, so readily do the very standards press forward. The Nervian cohort follows and the Felix, well deserving its name, the legion, too, named after Augustus, that well called The Unconquered, and the brave regiment of the Lion^[78] to whose name their shields bear witness.

But before they start the emperor, standing upon a platform of earth, heartens them with his words:

^[77] A reference to the support given by Theseus, King of Athens, to Adrastus, King of Argos, when the Thebans had refused to allow the burial of the Argives slain at Thebes; cf. Eur. *Supplices*.

^[78] Orosius (vii. 36. 6) says Mascezel only had 5000 men. The legion may have been leg. viii. Augusta. The other names are those of various *numeri* (the unit of the post-Diocletianic army).

ponderare: festinant adeo vexilla
moveri. 420
Nervius insequitur meritusque
vocabula Felix
dictaque ab Augusto legio
nomenque probantes
invicti clipeoque animosi teste
Leones.
Dictis ante tamen princeps
confirmat ituros

[131]

leaning upon their spears the soldiers throng around him and attune their ready ears to his inspiring voice. "My men, so soon to bring defeat upon Gildo, now is the time to fulfil your promises and make good your threats. If you felt indignation on my behalf, now take up arms and prove it. Wash out the stain of civil war by means of a great and deserved triumph. Let the empire of the East know, let it be plain to all the world, that Gaul can only owe defeat to the badness of a cause, not to her enemies' strength.^[79] Let not Gildo affright you though he have all barbarity at his back. Shall Moors stand up against the shock of your clashing shields and the near threat of your swords? You shall not oppose men armed with shields or shining blades. These savages put their trust in javelins hurled from afar. Once he has discharged his missile the enemy will be disarmed. With his right hand he hurls his spear, with his left he holds his cloak before him; no other armour has the horseman. His steed knows not the rein; a whip controls it. Obedience and discipline are unknown in their ranks. Their arms are a burden to them, their salvation lies in flight. Though each has many wives, ties of family bind them not, nor have they

aggere conspicuus; stat
 circumfusa iuventus 425
 nixa hastis pronasque ferox
 accommodat aures:
 “Gildonem domitura manus,
 promissa minasque
 tempus agi. si quid pro me
 doluistis, in armis
 ostentate mihi; iusto magnoque
 triumpho
 civiles abolete notas; sciat orbis
 Eous 430
 sitque palam Gallos causa, non
 robore vinci.
 nec vos, barbariem quamvis
 collegerit omnem,
 terreat. an Mauri fremitum
 raucosque repulsus
 umbonum et vestros passuri
 comminus enses?
 non contra clipeis tectos
 gladiisque micantes 435
 ibitis: in solis longe fiducia
 telis.
 exarmatus erit, cum missile
 torserit, hostis.
 dextra movet iaculum,
 praetentat pallia laeva;
 cetera nudus eques. sonipes
 ignarus habenae;
 virga regit. non ulla fides, non
 agminis ordo: 440
 arma oneri, fuga praesidio.
 conubia mille;
 non illis generis nexus, non
 pignora curae:
 sed numero languet pietas. haec
 conia vulgi

any love for their children whose
 very number causes affection to fail.
 Such are the troops. The chief will
 come to battle crowned with roses,
 drenched with scents, his last feast
 still undigested; drunken with wine,
 foredone with eld, enervated with
 disease and venery. Let the war
 trumpet rouse him from a bed of
 incest, let him beg aid of lutes and
 choirs, for he likes not the clarion's
 note, and let him learn (all
 unwilling) to spend in war nights
 that he now dedicates to love.

[\[79\]](#) He appeals to the Gallic element
 of the army to atone for its previous
 support of Maximus and Eugenius.

copia vultu.
 umbratus dux ipse^[132] rosis et
 marcidus ibit
 unguentis crudusque cibo
 titubansque Lyaeo, 445
 confectus senio, morbis
 stuprisque solutus.
 excitet incestos turmalis bucina
 somnos,
 imploret citharas cantatricesque
 choreas
 offensus stridore tubae
 discatque coactus,
 quas vigilat Veneri, castris
 impendere noctes. 450

[133]

“Is not death preferable to a life disgraced? If, in addition to the loss of Illyria, Africa is to be surrendered to Moorish kings, what lands still remain to us? The empire of Italy, once bounded by the Nile and the Red Sea, is limited to-day by the sea of Tuscany; shall Sicily now be the most distant province of Roman rule, to which in days of old neither Egypt nor India set an end? Go: win back that southern realm a rebel has reft from me. It depends on your arms whether Rome, the unconquerable mistress of the world, stands or falls. You owe me so many peoples, countries, cities lost. Fight but one battle in defence of Libya. Let empire restored attend on your oars and sails. Give back to Africa the laws of Rome she now disregards. Let history repeat itself, and the sword smite from its trunk the head of this third tyrant^[80] and so end at last the series of bloody usurpers.”

An omen confirms his word and before the eyes of all, the tawny bird, armour-bearer of Jove, swoops down from the open sky and seizes a snake in his curved talons; and while the eagle tears his struggling prey with his hooked beak, his claws are embedded in its head. The severed body falls to earth. Straightway the soldiers come hurrying up, crossing

“Nonne mori satius, vitae
 quam ferre pudorem?
nam quae iam regio restat, si
 dedita Mauris
regibus Illyricis accesserit
 Africa damnis?
ins Latium, quod tunc Meroë
 Rubroque solebat
Oceano cingi, Tyrrhena
 clauditur unda; 455
et cui non Nilus, non intulit
 India metas,
Romani iam finis erit Trinacria
 regni.
ite recepturi, praedo quem
 sustulit, axem
ereptumque Notum; caput
 insuperabile rerum
aut ruet in vestris aut stabit
 Roma lacertis. 460
tot mihi debetis populos, tot
 rura, tot urbes
amissas. uno Libyam defendite
 bello.
vestros imperium remos et
 vestra sequatur
carbasa. despectas trans aequora
 ducite leges.
tertia iam solito cervix mucrone
 rotetur 465
tandem funereis finem positura
 tyrannis.”
Omina conveniunt dicto
 fulvusque Tonantis
armiger a liquida cunctis
 spectantibus aethra
correptum pedibus curvis
 innexuit hydram

rocks and streams in their eagerness
at the call of this portent. Neither
mountains nor woods delay them.
Even as the cranes leave their
summer home of Thrace
clamorously to join issue in doubtful
war with the Pygmies, when they
desert the Strymon for warm-
watered Nile, the letter^[81] traced by
the speeding line stands out against
the clouds and the heaven is stamped
with the figure of their flight.

When they reached the coast still
fiercer blazed

^[80] The other two being Maximus and
Eugenius.

^[81] i.e. the Greek Λ.

dumque reluctantem morsu^[134]
 partitur obunco, 470
 haesit in ungue caput; truncatus
 decidit anguis.
 ilicet auguriis alacres per saxa
 citati
 torrentesque ruunt; nec mons
 aut silva retardat:
 pendula ceu parvis moturae
 bella colonis
 ingenti clangore grues aestiva
 relinquunt 475
 Thracia, cum tepido permutant
 Strymona Nilo:
 ordinibus variis per nubila
 textitur ales
 littera pennarumque notis
 conscribitur aër.
 Ut fluctus tetigere maris, tunc
 acrior arsit

[135]

their enthusiasm. They seize upon the ships and themselves make ready the hawsers; furl the sails and fix the yards to the masts. Etruria's shore is shaken with their uproar and Arcadian-founded Pisa cannot contain so great a number of ships. So Aulis rang with countless voices what time avenging Greece loosed the cables of Agamemnon's fleet. No storm-blast deterred them nor threat of coming tempest nor the presence of the treacherous south wind. "Seize the rope, fellow-soldiers," they cry, "seize the rope: let us sail against Gildo though the very seas be against us. Let the storm drive us to battle by how crooked so ever a course. Fain would I seize upon that shore though my ships' beaks be shattered. Cowards ye, who cautiously observe whether or no the sea-gulls fly back or the crow pace the beach. What if clouds fleck the face of the setting sun or a stormy moon wear the halo that betokens hurricane? What if comets wave their spreading tails, or the constellation of the Kids threatens rain, or the cloudy Hyades lead forth the Bull and all Orion sink 'neath the waves? Put your trust in the sky, but put more in Honorius. Beneath his auspices I, his soldier, range the boundless seas nor look to the Plough or the Bear to guide me.

impetus; adripiunt naves
ipsique rudentes 480
expediunt et vela legunt et
cornua summis
adsociant malis; quatitur
Tyrrhena tumultu
ora nec Alpheae capiunt navalia
Pisae:
sic Agamemnoniam vindex cum
Graecia classem
solveret, innumeris fervebat
vocibus Aulis. 485
non illos strepitus
impendentisque
procellae
signa nec adventus dubii
deterruit Austri.
“vellite” proclamant “socii, iam
vellite funem.
per vada Gildonem quamvis
adversa petamus.
ad bellum nos trumat hiems per
devia ponti. 490
quassatis cupio tellurem figere
rostris.
heu nimium segnes, cauta qui
mente notatis,
si revolant mergi, graditur si
litore cornix.
ora licet maculis adperserit
occiduus sol
lunaque conceptis livescat
turgida Cauris 495
et contusa vagos iaculentur
sidera crines;
imbribus umescant Haedi
nimbosaque Taurum
ducat Hyas totusque fretis

Make no account of Boötes, sailor;
launch your bark in mid tempest. If
winds and storms deny me Libya,
my emperor's fortune will grant it.”

The fleet is launched. They pass
Liguria on their right hand, Etruria
on their left, avoiding the sunken
reefs of Corsica. There lies an island
formed like a human foot (Sardinia
its former inhabitants called it), an
island rich in the produce of its
fields, and conveniently situated for
them who sail either to

ualeat Hyas totusque neas
 descendat Orion:
 opportides caeli, sed maior
 Honoris Arctos,
 illius aspiciisbus elapsa per;
 aequora miles Arcton,
 non Plautois Arctos, pro regor.
 continetur Boota,
 flavit, turbanibus in mediis navita
 permissa carinas.
 hic in hinc tempestas Libyam
 venit, [82] que negabunt,
 saesit et Exclusa regnant
 Aquilonibus Austris, 515
 Quos ubi fluctatis procul
 provehitur, dextra Ligures,
 effugere carinas,
 per diversa laeva 505
 linquitur, et caecis vitatur
 terrae.
 pars adit antiqua tuetos
 humanae species plantae se
 Carthagine sulcos,
 partem in hinc complacet
 insula (Sardiniam veteres dixere
 coloni)
 urbs Libyam contra Tyrio
 dives ager frugum, Pannos
 tenditur in longum Caralis
 Italoque potenti
 tenuemque per undas
 obvia dimittit fracturum flamina
 collem;
 efficitur portus medium mare,
 tutaque ventis
 omnibus ingenti mansuescunt
 stagna recessu.
 hanc omni petiere manu
 prorisque reductis 525
 suspensa Zephyros expectant
 classe faventes.

[137]

Africa or Italy. The part that faces Africa is flat and affords good anchorage for ships; the northern shore is inhospitable, rock-bound, stormy, and loud with sudden gales. The sailor curses these wild cliffs. Here the pestilence falls on men and beasts, so plague-ridden and deadly is the air, so omnipotent the South wind and the North winds banished.

When their much buffeted vessels had given a wide berth to these dangers, they came to land at different places on the broken coastline. Some are beached at Sulci, a city founded by Carthage of old. The sea-wall of Olbia shelters others. The city of Caralis over against the coast of Libya, a colony of great Phoenician Carthage, juts out into the sea and extends into the waves, a little promontory that breaks the force of the opposing winds. Thus in the midst a harbour is found and in a huge bay the quiet waters lie safe from every wind. For this harbour they make with every effort, and reversing their vessels they await the favouring breezes of the west wind with fleet at anchor. [83]

[83] This poem was never properly finished; see Introduction, p. xi.

[\[82\]](#) *Birt, following the MSS., si. Older editions huic ... huic. I print sic.*

IN EUTROPIUM**LIBER I**

(XVIII.)

AGAINST EUTROPIUS**BOOK I**

(XVIII.)

Let the world cease to wonder at the births of creatures half human, half bestial, at monstrous babes that affright their own mothers, at the howling of wolves heard by night in the cities, at beasts that speak to their astonished herds, at stones falling like rain, at the blood-red threatening storm clouds, at wells of water changed to gore, at moons that clash in mid heaven and at twin suns. All portents pale before our eunuch consul. O shame to heaven and earth! Our cities behold an old woman decked in a consul's robe who gives a woman's name to the year.^[84] Open the pages of the Cumaean Sibyl, ye pontifs; let wise Etrurian seers consult the lightning's flash, and the soothsayer search out the awful portent hidden in the entrails. What new dread warning is this the gods give? Does Nile desert his bed and leaving Roman soil seek to mix his waters with those of the Red Sea? Does cleft Niphates^[85] once more let through a host of eastern barbarians to ravage our lands? Does a pestilence threaten us?

Semiferos partus
 metuendaque pignora
 matri
 moenibus et mediis auditum
 nocte luporum
 murmur et attonito pecudes
 pastore locutas
 et lapidum duras hiemes
 nimboque minacem
 sanguineo rubuisse Iovem
 puteosque cruore 5
 mutatos visasque polo
 concurrere lunas
 et geminos soles mirari desinat
 orbis:
 omnia cesserunt eunucho
 consule monstra.
 heu terrae caelique pudor!
 trabeata per urbes
 ostentatur anus titulumque
 effeminat anni. 10
 pandite pontifices Cumanæ
 carmina vatis,
 fulmineos sollers Etruria
 consulat ignes
 inmersumque nefas fibris
 exploret haruspex,
 quae nova portendant superi.
 Nilusne meatu
 devius et nostri temptat iam
 transfuga mundi 15
 se Rubro miscere mari? ruptone
 Niphate
 rursum barbaricis Oriens
 vastabitur armis?
 an morbi ventura lues? an nulla
 colono
 responsura sedes? quae tantas

Or shall no harvest repay the farmer?
 What victim can expiate divine
 anger such as this? What offering
 appease the cruel altars? The
 consul's

[\[84\]](#) For the consulship of Eutropius
 see Introduction, p. xv.

[\[85\]](#) A mountain in Armenia.

responsura seges: quae tantas
expiet iras^[140]
victima? quo diras iugulo
placabimus aras? 20

[141]

own blood must cleanse the consular insignia, the monster itself must be sacrificed. Whatever it be that fate prepares for us and shows forth by such an omen, let Eutropius' death, I pray, avert it all.

Fortune, is thy power so all-embracing? What is this savage humour of thine? To what lengths wilt thou sport with us poor mortals? If it was thy will to disgrace the consul's chair with a servile occupant let some "consul" come forward with broken chains, let an escaped jail-bird don the robes of Quirinus—but at least give us a man. There are grades even among slaves and a certain dignity; that slave who has served but one master holds a position of less infamy. Canst thou count the waves of the sea, the grains of Africa's sands, if so thou canst number Eutropius' masters. How many owners has he had, in how many sale-catalogues has he appeared, how often has he changed his name! How often has he been stripped while buyer consulted doctor whether there lurked any flaw by reason of some hidden disease! All repented having bought him and he always returned to the slave-market while he could yet fetch a price. When he became but a foul corpse-like body, a mass of senile

consule lustrandi fasces ipsoque
litandum
prodigio; quodcumque parant
hoc omine fata,
Eutropius cervice luat sic omnia
nobis. [\[86\]](#)

Hoc regni, Fortuna, tenes?
quaenam ista iocandi
saevitia? humanis quantum
bacchabere rebus? 25
si tibi servili placuit foedare
curules
crimine, procedat laxata
compede consul,
rupta Quirinales sumant
ergastula cinctus;
da saltem quemcumque virum.
discrimina quaedam
sunt famulis splendorque suus,
maculamque minorem
condicionis habet, domino qui
vixerit uno. 31
si pelagi fluctus, Libyae si
discis harenas,
Eutropii numerabis eros. quot
iura, quot ille
mutavit tabulas vel quanta
vocabula vertit!
nudatus quotiens, medicum
dum consulit emptor, 35
ne qua per occultum lateat
iactura dolorem!
omnes paenituit pretii
venumque redibat,
dum vendi potuit. postquam
deforme cadaver
mansit et in rugas totus defluxit

pendulous flesh, his masters were
anxious to rid their houses of him by
giving him away as a present and
made haste to foist the loathsome
gift on an unsuspecting friend. To so
many different yokes did he submit
his neck, this slave, old in years but
ever new to the house; there was no
end to his servitude though many
beginnings.

He is destined from his very cradle
to bloody tortures; straight from his
mother's womb he is hurried away to
be made a eunuch; no sooner born

[86] ^{anues} Birt begins the new paragraph at
iam specie doni certatim linobae
Alternatively, read volvis for nobis (so
Cuiacius codd.).
penunt 40

et foedum ignaris properant

obtrudere munus.

tot translata iugis summisit

colla, vetustum

servitium semperque novum,

nec destitit umquam,

saepe tamen coepit.

Cunabula

prima cruentis

debet suppliciis; rapitur

castrandus ab ipso 45

than he becomes a prey to suffering. Up hastens the Armenian, skilled by operating with unerring knife to make males womanish and to increase their loathly value by such loss. He drains the body's life-giving fluid from its double source and with one blow deprives his victim of a father's function and the name of husband. Eutropius lay doubtful of life, and the severed sinews drew a numbness deep down into his furthest brain.

Are we to praise the hand that robbed an enemy of his strength? Or shall we rather blame the fates? It would have been better had he remained a man; his very disgrace has proved a blessing to him. Had he had his full manly vigour he would still have been a slave.

After this he is dragged from one Assyrian mart to another; next in the train of a Galatian slave-merchant he stands for sale in many a market and knows many diverse houses. Who could tell the names of all his buyers? Among these Ptolemy, servant of the post-house,^[88] was one of the better known. Then Ptolemy, tired of Eutropius' long service to his lusts, gives him to Arinthaëus;—gives, for he is no longer worth keeping nor old enough to be bought. How the scorned

ubere; suscipiunt matris post
 viscera poenae.
 advolat Armenius certo
 mucrone recisos
 edoctus mollire mares
 damnoque nefandum
 aucturus pretium; fecundum
 corporis imbrem^[87]
 sedibus exhaurit geminis
 unoque sub ictu 50
 eripit officium patris nomenque
 mariti.
 ambiguus vitae iacuit,
 penitusque supremum
 in cerebrum secti traxerunt
 frigora nervi.
 Laudemusne manum, quae
 vires abstulit hosti,
 an potius fato causam tribuisse
 queramur? 55
 profuerat mansisse virum;
 felicior extat
 opprobrio; serviret adhuc, si
 fortior esset.
 Inde per Assyriae trahitur
 commercia ripae;
 hinc fora venalis Galata ductore
 frequentat
 permutatque domos varias; quis
 nomina possit 60
 tanta sequi? miles stabuli
 Ptolomaeus in illis
 notior: hic longo lassatus
 paelicis usu
 donat Arinthaëo; neque enim
 iam dignus haberi
 nec maturus emi. cum fastiditus
 abicit

minion wept at his departure, with
 what grief did he lament that
 divorce! “Was this thy fidelity,
 Ptolemy? Is this my reward for a
 youth lived in thine arms, for the bed
 of marriage and those many nights
 spent together in the inn? Must I lose
 my promised liberty? Leav’st thou
 Eutropius a widow, cruel wretch,
 forgetful of such wonderful nights of
 love? How hard is the lot of my
 kind! When a woman grows old her
 children cement the marriage tie and

^[88] I take Ptolemy to have been a
stationarius, i.e. a servant in a public
 post-house, but there is possibly some
 covert allusion to *stabulum* in the sense
 of *prostibulum*, a brothel.

^{durell}
[87] *codd. ignem; Postgate imbrem.*
quam gemuit, quanto planxit
divortia luctu! 65
“haec erat, heu, Ptolomaeae,
fides? hoc profuit aetas
in gremio consumpta tuo
lectusque iugalis
et ducti totiens inter praesaepia
somni?
libertas promissa perit?
viduumne relinquis
Eutropium tantasque premunt
oblivia noctes, 70
crudelis? generis pro sors
durissima nostri!
femina, cum senuit, retinet
conubia partu,

a mother's dignity compensates for the lost charms of a wife. Me Lucina, goddess of childbirth, will not come near; I have no children on whom to rely. Love perishes with my beauty; the roses of my cheeks are faded. What wits can save my wretched back from blows? How can I, an old man, please?"

So saying he entered upon the skilled profession of a pander. His whole heart was in his work; he knew his business well and was master of every stratagem for the undoing of chastity. No amount of vigilance could protect the marriage-bed from his attack; no bars could shut him out. He would have haled even Danaë from her refuge in the brazen tower. He would represent his patron as dying of love. Was the lady stubborn, he would win her by his patience; was she greedy, by a gift; flighty, he would corrupt her with a jest. None could arrest the attention of a maidservant with so neat a touch as he, none twitch aside a dress so lightly and whisper his shameful message in her ear. Never was any so skilled to choose a scene for the criminal meeting, or so clever at avoiding the wrath of the cuckold husband should the plot be discovered. One thought of Lais of Corinth, to whom the enamoured

uxorisque decus matris
 reverentia pensat.
 nos Lucina fugit, nec pignore
 nitimur ullo.
 cum forma dilapsus amor;
 defloruit oris 75
 gratia: qua miseri scapulas
 tutabimur arte?
 qua placeam ratione senex?”
 Sic
 fatus acutum
 adgreditur lenonis opus, nec
 segnis ad artem
 mens erat officiique capax
 omnesque pudoris
 hauserat insidias. custodia nulla
 tuendo 80
 fida toro; nulli poterant
 excludere vectes:
 ille vel aerata Danaën in turre
 latentem
 eliceret. fletus domini fingeat
 amantis,
 indomitasque mora, pretio
 lenibat avaras
 lascivasque iocis; non blandior
 ullus euntis 85
 ancillae tetigisse latus
 leviterque reductis
 vestibibus occulto crimen
 mandasse susurro
 nec furtis quaesisse locum nec
 fraude reperta
 cautior elusi fremitus vitare
 mariti.
 haud aliter iuvenum flammis
 Ephyreia Lais 90
 e gemino ditata mari: cum sertis

youth of that city brought wealth from its twin seas, who, when her grey hair could no longer go crowned with roses, when the emulous crowd of her admirers ceased nightly to haunt her doors and but few were left to knock thereat, when before the mirror's verdict age shrank back in horror from itself, yet stood, still faithful to her calling, and as a pander dressed others for the part, haunting still the brothel she had loved so well and so long, and still pandering to the tastes old age forbade her.

et gemino citata manu, cum secula
refudit^[146]

canities, iam turba procax
noctisque recedit
ambitus et raro pulsatur ianua
tactu,
seque reformidat speculo
damnante senectus;
stat tamen atque alias succingit
lena ministras 95
dilectumque diu quamvis
longaeva lupanar
circuit et retinent mores, quod
perdidit aetas.

[147]

Hence sprang Eutropius' fame; for, though a eunuch's one virtue be to guard the chastity of the marriage-chamber, here was one (and one only) who grew great through adulteries. But the lash fell as before on his back whenever his master's criminal passion was through him frustrated. Then it was in vain that he prayed for forgiveness and reminded his lord of all those years of faithful service; he would find himself handed over to a son-in-law as part of the bride's dowry. Thus he would become a lady's-maid, and so the future consul and governor of the East would comb his mistress' locks or stand naked holding a silver vessel of water wherein his charge could wash herself. And when overcome by the heat she threw herself upon her couch, there would stand this patrician fanning her with bright peacock feathers.

And now his skin had grown loose with age; his face, more wrinkled than a raisin, had fallen in by reason of the lines in his cheeks. Less deep the furrows cloven in the cornfield by the plough, the folds wrought in the sails by the wind. Loathsome grubs ate away his head and bare patches appeared amid his hair. It was as though clumps of dry barren corn dotted a sun-parched field, or as

Hinc honor Eutropio;
cumque omnibus unica
virtus
esset in eunuchis thalamos
servare pudicos,
solus adulteriis crevit. nec
verbera tergo 100
cessavere tamen, quotiens
decepta libido
irati caluisset eri, frustra
rogantem
iactantemque suos tot iam per
lustra labores
dotalet genero nutritoremque
puellae
tradidit. Eous rector consulque
futurus 105
pectebat dominae crines et
saepe lavanti
nudus in argento lympham
gestabat alumnae.
et cum se rapido fessam
proiecera aestu,
patricius roseis pavonum
ventilat alis.
Iamque aevo laxata cutis,
sulcisque genarum 110
corruebat passa facies rugosior
uva:
flava minus presso finduntur
vomere rura,
nec vento sic vela tremunt.
miserabile turpes
exedere caput tineae; deserta
patebant
intervalla comae: qualis
sitiens arvis 115
arida ieiunae seges interlucet

if a swallow were dying in winter
sitting on a branch, moulting in the
frosty weather. Truly, that the
outrage to the consul's office might
one day be the greater, Fortune
added to her gift of wealth this brand
upon his brow, this deformity of
face. When his pallor and fleshless
bones had roused feelings of
revulsion in his masters' hearts, and
his foul complexion and lean body
offended all who came

anua ieiunae seges interuocet
aristae^[148]

vel qualis gelidis pluma labente
pruinis
arboris inmoritur trunco
brumalis hirundo.
scilicet ut trabeis iniuria
cresceret olim,
has in fronte notas, hoc dedecus
addidit oris 120
luxuriae Fortuna suae: cum
pallida nudis
ossibus horrorem dominis
praeberet imago
decolor et macies occursu
laederet omnes,

[149]

in contact with him, scaring children, disgusting those that sat at meat, disgracing his fellow-slaves, or terrifying as with an evil omen those that met him; when his masters ceased to derive any advantage from that withered trunk (for his wasted limbs refused even to make the beds or cut wood for the kitchen fire, while his faithless nature forbade their entrusting him with the charge of gold or vesture or the secrets of the house—who could bring him to entrust his marriage-chamber to a pander?), then at last they thrust him from their houses like a troublesome corpse or an ill-omened ghost. He was now free—for everyone despised him. So a shepherd chains up a dog and fattens him with milk while yet his strength avails to guard the flock and, ever watchful, to scare away wolves with his barking. But when later this same dog grows old and dirty and droops his mangy ears he looses him, and, taking off his collar, at least saves that.

Universal contempt is sometimes a boon. Driven out by all, he could freely range amid every sort of crime, and open a way for destiny. Oh thou, whosoe'er thou art, that holdest sway in Olympus, was it thy humour to make such mockery of mankind? He who was not suffered

aut pueris latura metus aut
taedia mensis
aut crimen famulis aut
procedentibus omen, 125
et nihil exhausto caperent in
stipite lucri:
(sternere quippe toros vel
caedere ligna culinae
membra negant; aurum, vestes,
arcana tueri
mens infida vetat; quis enim
committere vellet
lenoni thalamum?): tandem ceu
funus acerbum 130
infaustamque suis trusere
penatibus umbram.
contemptu iam liber erat: sic
pastor obesum
lacte canem ferroque ligat
pascitque revinctum,
dum validus servare gregem
vigilique rapaces
latratu terrere lupos; cum
tardior idem 135
iam scabie laceras deiecit
sordidus aures,
solvit et exuto lucratur vincula
collo.
Est ubi despectus nimius
iuvat. undique pulso
per cunctas licuit fraudes
impune vagari
et fatis aperire viam. pro
quisquis Olympi 140
summa tenes, tanto libuit
mortalia risu
vertere? qui servi non est
admissus in usum

to perform the duties of a slave is admitted to the administration of an empire; him whom a private house scorned as a servant, a palace tolerates as its lord. When first the consular residence received this old vixen, who did not lament? Who grieved not to see an oft-sold corpse worm itself into the sacred service of the emperor? Nay, the very palace-servants, holding a prouder rank in slavery, murmured at such a colleague and long haughtily scorned his company.

admissus in usum,
suscipitur regnis,^[150] et quem
privata ministrum
dedignata domus, moderantem
sustinet aula.
ut primum vetulam texere
palatia vulpem, 145
quis non ingemuit? quis non
inreperere sacris
obsequiis doluit totiens venale
cadaver?
ipsi quin etiam tali consorte
fremebant
regales famuli, quibus est
inlustrior ordo
servitii, sociumque diu sprevere
superbi. 150

[151]

See what manner of man they seek to connect with the annals of Rome: the very eunuchs were ashamed of him. At first of no account, he lay hid, the most unknown unit of an unregarded throng, till thanks to the mad folly of Abundantius^[89] (who brought ruin on the empire of the East and, ere that, upon himself) he was advanced from the most menial office to the highest honours. What a happy dispensation of providence it is that in this world the results of ill counsel fall first upon its instigators! Thus the seer who advised Busiris to placate the Thunderer's wrath, what time Nile's flood had long run dry, with a stranger's blood himself first stained that tyrant's altar with his own and fell a victim of the horrid sacrifice he had advised. Thus he who made the brazen bull and devised that new form of torture, casting the deadly bronze as an instrument of torment, was (at the bidding of the Sicilian tyrant) the first to make trial of the unhanselled image, and to teach his own bull to roar. So with Eutropius: on no man's goods did he sooner seize than on those of him by whom he had been raised to power; none did he drive sooner into exile and thus, by the condemnation of his patron, was to thank for one righteous action.

Cernite, quem Latiis poscant
 adnectere fastis:
 cuius et eunuchos puduit! sed
 vilior ante
 obscurae latuit pars ignotissima
 turbae,
 donec Abundanti furiis—qui
 rebus Eois
 exitium primumque sibi
 produxit—ab imis 155
 euectus thalamis summos
 invasit honores.
 quam bene dispositum terris, ut
 dignus iniqui
 fructus consilii primis
 auctoribus instet.
 sic multos fluvio vates arente
 per annos
 hospite qui caeso monuit
 placare Tonantem, 160
 inventas primus Busiridis
 imbuit aras
 et cecidit saevi, quod dixerat,
 hostia sacri.
 sic opifex tauri tormentorumque
 repertor,
 qui funesta novo fabricaverat
 aera dolori,
 primus inexpertum Siculo
 cogente tyranno 165
 sensit opus docuitque suum
 mugire iuvenum.
 nullius Eutropius, quam qui se
 protulit, ante
 direptas possedit opes
 nullumque priorem
 perculit exilio solumque hoc
 rite perdidit

When this half-man, worn out with
 age, had been raised to that pinnacle
 of glory for which he never would
 have dared to pray, of which never to
 dream; when he had seen law at his
 feet, the heads of the nobility
 inclined before him, and fortune
 heaping such gifts upon one whose
 only hope and prayer had been to
 gain his freedom, he straightway
 forgot

[89] By birth a Scythian. Entered the
 Roman army under Gratian and
 reached the position of *magister*
utriusque militiae under Theodosius.
 Consul in 393 (Zosim. v. 10. 5) and
 banished three years later to Pityus,
 thanks to the machinations of
 Eutropius.

me peregit,
auctorem dammare suum.^[152]

Postquam obsitus aevo 170
semivir excelsam rerum
 sublatus in arcem,
quod nec vota pati nec fingere
 somnia possunt,
vidit sub pedibus leges
 subiectaque colla
nobilium tantumque sibi
 permittere fata,
qui nihil optasset plus libertate
 mereri, 175

[153]

his former masters, and his slave's mind swelled high within him. The prisons were filled with degraded nobles, Meroë and the plains of Ethiopia re-echoed to the weeping of exiles; the desert rang with the punishment of men; the temple of Jupiter Ammon in Africa was stained with gentle blood.

Nothing is so cruel as a man raised from lowly station to prosperity; he strikes everything, for he fears everything; he vents his rage on all, that all may deem he has the power. No beast so fearful as the rage of a slave let loose on free-born backs; their groans are familiar to him, and he cannot be sparing of punishment that he himself has undergone; remembering his own master he hates the man he lashes. Being a eunuch also he is moved by no natural affection and has no care for family or children. All are moved to pity by those whose circumstances are like their own; similitude of ills is a close bond. Yet he is kind not even to eunuchs.

His passion for gold increases—the only passion his mutilated body can indulge. Of what use was emasculation? The knife is powerless against reckless avarice. That hand so well practised in petty thefts, accustomed to rifle a

iamiam dissimulat dominos
 alteque tumescunt
serviles animi. procerum
 squalore repletus
carcer et exulibus Meroë
 campique gemescunt
Aethiopum; poenis hominum
 plaga personat ardens;
Marmaricus claris violatur
 caedibus Hammon. 180
Asperius nihil est humili cum
 surgit in altum:
cuncta ferit dum cuncta timet,
 desaevit in omnes
ut se posse putent, nec belua
 taetrior ulla
quam servi rabies in libera terga
 furentis;
agnoscit gemitus et poenae
 parcere nescit, 185
quam subiit, dominique memor,
 quem verberat, odit.
adde, quod eunuchus nulla
 pietate movetur
nec generi natisve cavet.
 clementia cunctis
in similes, animosque ligant
 consortia damni;
iste nec eunuchis placidus.

Sed

 peius in aurum 190
aestuat; hoc uno fruitur succisa
 libido.
quid nervos secuisse iuvat? vis
 nulla cruentam
castrat avaritiam. parvis
 exercita furtis
quae vastare penum

cupboard or remove the bolt from
the unwatched coffer, now finds
richer spoils and the whole world to
rob. All the country between the
Tigris and Mount Haemus he
exposes for sale at a fixed price, this
huckster of empire, this infamous
dealer in honours. This man governs
Asia for the which his villa has paid.
That man buys Syria with his wife's
jewels. Another repents of having
taken Bithynia in exchange for his
paternal mansion. Fixed above the
open doors of his hall is a list giving
the provinces and their

quae vastare penum

neglectaque^[154] sueverat

arcae

claustra remoliri, nunc uberiore

rapina 195

peccat in orbe manus. quidquid

se Tigris ab Haemo

dividit, hoc certa proponit

merce locandum

institor imperii, caupo famosus

honorum.

hic Asiam villa pactus regit; ille

redemit

coniugis ornatu Syriam; dolet

ille paterna 200

Bithynos mutasse domo.

subfixa patenti

vestibulo pretiis distinguit

regula gentes:

[155]

prices: so much for Galatia, for Pontus so much, so much will buy one Lydia. Would you govern Lycia? Then lay down so many thousands. Phrygia? A little more. He wishes everything to be marked with its price to console him for his own fortune and, himself so often sold, he wants to sell everything. When two are rivals he suspends in the balance their opposed payment; along with the weight the judge inclines, and a province hangs wavering in a pair of scales.

Ye gods, are ye not ashamed that whole peoples are sold beneath the hammer? At least let it shame you of the seller, when a slave, a chattel the law counts dead, possesses so many kingdoms and retails so many cities. Did Cyrus' victory oust mighty Croesus from his throne that Pactolus and Hermus should roll their waves for a eunuch? Did Attalus make you, Rome, his heir, was Antiochus confined within the appointed bounds of Taurus, did Servilius enjoy a triumph over the hitherto unconquered Isaurians, did Egypt fall before Augustus, and Crete before Metellus, to ensure Eutropius a sufficient income?^[90] Cilicia, Judaea, Sophene, all Rome's labours and Pompey's triumphs, are there to sell.

tot Galatae, tot Pontus eat, tot
 Lydia nummis;
 si Lyciam tenuisse velis, tot
 millia ponas,
 si Phrygas, adde; parum!
 propriae solacia sorti 205
 communes vult esse notas et
 venditus ipse
 vendere cuncta cupit. certantum
 saepe duorum
 diversum suspendit onus; cum
 pondere index
 vergit, et in geminas nutat
 provincia lances.
 Non pudet heu, superi,
 populos venire sub
 hasta?
 videntis certe pudeat, quod
 iure sepultum 211
 mancipium tot regna tenet, tot
 distrahit urbes.
 pollentem solio Croesum
 victoria Cyri
 fregit, ut eunucho flueret
 Pactolus et Hermus?
 Attalus heredem voluit te,
 Roma, relinqui, 215
 restitit Antiochus praescripto
 margine Tauri,
 indomitos curru Servilius egit
 Isauros
 et Pharos Augusto iacuit vel
 Creta Metello,
 ne non Eutropio quaestus
 numerosior esset?
 in mercem veniunt Cilices,
 Iudaea, Sophene 220
 Romanusque labor

Why heap up these riches? Hast thou
 children to succeed to them? Marry
 or be married, thou canst never be a
 mother or a father: the former nature
 hath denied thee, the latter the
 surgeon's knife. India may enrich
 thee with enormous jewels, Arabia
 with her spices, China with her silks;
 none so needy, none so poverty-
 stricken as to wish to have
 Eutropius' fortune and therewith
 Eutropius' body.

And now his mind, forgetful of its
 true nature and

[\[90\]](#) Attalus, King of Pergamum, left
 his kingdom by will to Rome, 133 B.C.
 It became the province of Asia. The
 terms mentioned here were imposed on
 Antiochus, King of Syria, in 189 B.C.
 P. Servilius crossed the Taurus and
 subdued the Isauri 78 B.C.; Crete was
 conquered by Q. Metellus between 68
 and 66 B.C.

ROMANUSQUE LABORI

Pompeian^[156]que triumphi.

Quo struis hos auri cumulos?
quae pignora tantis
succedent opibus? nugas
ducasve licebit:
numquam mater eris, numquam
pater; hoc tibi ferrum,
hoc natura negat. te grandibus
India gemmis, 225
te foliis Arabes ditent, te vellere
Seres:
nullus inops adeo, nullum sic
urget egestas,
ut velit Eutropii fortunam et
membra pacisci.
Iamque oblita sui nec sobria
divitiis mens

[157]

drunken with riches, makes sport of
wretched law and the affairs of men.
A eunuch is judge. Why now wonder
that he is consul? Whatever he does
is a prodigy. Can the annals of the
law show cases so mishandled?
What age or what country has ever
witnessed a eunuch's jurisdiction?
That nought might remain
undisgraced, nought unattempted, he
even makes him ready to outrage
arms, heaps portent on portent and
wanton folly seeks to outdo itself.
Mars blushed, Bellona scoffed and
turned her from the disgrace of the
East whene'er with arrows strung
and flashing quiver the aged Amazon
practises battle or hurries back as
arbiter of peace and war to hold
parley with the Getae. Our enemies
rejoiced at the sight and felt that at
last we were lacking in *men*. Towns
were set ablaze; walls offered no
security. The countryside was
ravaged and brought to ruin. Mid-
ocean alone gave hope. Women of
Cappadocia were driven into
captivity across the river Phasis;
stolen from the stalls of their
homesteads, the captive herds drink
the snowy streams of Caucasus, and
the flocks exchange the pastures of
Mount Argaeus^[91] for the woods of
Scythia. Beyond the Cimmerian
marshes, defence of the Tauric tribes,

in miseras leges hominumque
 negotia ludit. 230
 iudicat eunuchus; quid iam de
 consule miror?
 prodigium, quodcumque gerit.
 quae pagina lites
 sic actas meminit? quibus
 umquam saecula terris
 eunuchi videre forum? sed ne
 qua vacaret
 pars ignominia neu quid restaret
 inausum, 235
 arma etiam violare parat
 portentaque monstis
 aggerat et secum petulans
 amentia certat.
 erubuit Mavors aversaque risit
 Enyo
 dedecus Eoum, quotiens intenta
 sagittis
 et pharetra fulgens anus
 exercetur Amazon 240
 arbiter aut quotiens belli
 pacisque recurrit
 adloquiturque Getas. gaudet
 cum viderit hostis
 et sentit iam deesse viros.
 incendia fumant,
 muris nulla fides, squalent
 populatibus agri
 et medio spes sola mari. trans
 Phasin aguntur 245
 Cappadocum matres,
 stabulisque abducta
 paternis
 Caucasias captiva bibunt
 armenta pruinas
 et Scythicis mutant Argaei

the youth of Syria are slaves. Too
 vast for the fierce barbarians are the
 spoils; gluttoned with booty they turn
 to slaughter.

Yet Eutropius (can a slave, an
 effeminate, feel shame? Could a
 blush grace such a countenance?),
 Eutropius returns in triumph. There
 follow companies of foot, squadrons
 like their general, maniples of
 eunuchs, an army worthy Priapus'
 standards. His creatures meet him
 and embrace their saviour on his
 return.^[92] Great is his self-esteem;
 he struggles

^[91] A mountain in Cappadocia.

^[92] Claudian is scarcely fair to
 Eutropius. The reference here is to the
 campaign of 398 in which Eutropius
 succeeded in driving the Huns back
 behind the Caucasus.

et Scythiacis mutam Argaei
pabula^[158] silvis.

extra Cimmerias, Taurorum
claustra, paludes
flos Syriae servit. spoliis nec
sufficit atrox 250
barbarus: in caedem vertunt
fastidia praedae.

Ille tamen (quid enim servum
mollemque pudebit?
aut quid in hoc poterit vultu
flagrare ruboris?)
pro victore redit: peditum
vexilla sequuntur
et turmae similes
eunuchorumque
manipuli, 255
Hellespontiacis legio
dignissima signis.
obvius ire cliens defensoremque
reversum
complecti. placet ipse sibi
laxasque laborat

[159]

to swell out his pendulous cheeks
and feigns a heavy panting; his lousy
head dust-sprinkled and his face
bleached whiter by the sun, he sobs
out some pitiful complaint with
voice more effeminate than
effeminacy's self and tells of battles.
In tremulous tones he calls his sister
to witness that he has spent his
strength for his country's need; that
he yields to envy and cannot stand
up against the storms of jealousy and
prays to be drowned in the foaming
seas. Would God his prayer had been
granted! Thus speaking, he wipes
away the silly tears, sighing and
sobbing between each word; like a
withered old dame travelled far to
visit her son's daughter—scarce
seated aweary and already she asks
for wine.

Why busy thy foul self with wars?
Why attempt battle on the bloody
field? 'Tis to the arts of that other
Minerva thou shouldst apply thyself.
The distaff, not the dart should be
thine; thine to spin the thread, and,
cunning craftsman that thou art, to
urge on the spinning-maids when
lazy; thine to wind the snowy wool
for thy mistress' weaving. Or,
wouldst thou be a devotee, let
Cybele, not Mars, be the object of
thy worship. Learn to imitate the
madness of the Corybantes to the

distendisse genas fictumque
 inflatus anhelat,
pulvere respersus tineas et
 solibus ora 260
pallidior, verbisque sonat
 plorabile quiddam
ultra nequitiam fractis et proelia
 narrat:
perque suam tremula testatur
 voce sororem,
defecisse vagas ad publica
 commoda vires;
cedere livori nec sustentare
 procellas 265
invidiae; mergique fretis
 spumantibus orat.
exoretque utinam! dum talia
 fatur ineptas
deterget lacrimas atque inter
 singula dicta
flebile suspirat: qualis venit
 arida socrus
longinquam visura nurum; vix
 lassa resedit 270
et iam vina petit.

 Quid te,
 turpissime, bellis
inseris aut saevi pertemptas
 Pallada campi?
tu potes alterius studiis haerere
 Minervae
et telas, non tela pati, tu stamina
 nosse,
tu segnes operum sollers urgere
 puellas 275
et niveam dominae pensis
 involvere lanam.
vel si sacra placent, habes pro

accompaniment of rolling drums.
Thou mayest carry cymbals, pierce
thy breast with the sacred pine, and
with Phrygian knife destroy what yet
is left of thy virility. Leave arms to
men. Why seek to divide the two
empires and embroil loving brothers
in strife? Madman, remember thy
former trade; 'twere more fitting
thou shouldst endeavour to reconcile
them.

It is for deeds like this that Eutropius
demands

vet, si sacra placent, habeas pro

Marte Cybeben;

rauca Celaenaeos ad tympana
disce furores.

cymbala ferre licet pectusque
inlidere pinu

inguinis et reliquum Phrygiis
abscidere cultris. 280

arma relinque viris. geminam
quid dividis aulam

conarisque pios odiis
committere fratres?

te magis, ah demens, veterem si
respicis artem,

conciliare decet.

Gestis pro

talibus annum

[161]

this year of office, to ensure that by his efforts alone he leaves nothing not dishonoured, ruining the army as its general, the courts as their judge, the imperial fasti as a consul.

No portent so monstrous but time past has given it birth and the labour of bygone centuries produced it. Legend tells us that Oedipus married his mother and Thyestes his daughter; Jocasta bare brothers to her husband, Thyestes's daughter gave birth to her own brother. Athenian tragedy tells the sad tale of Thebes and the baneful war of Troy. Tereus was changed into a bird, Cadmus into a snake; Scylla looked in amaze on the dogs that girt her waist. Ancient story relates how one was transformed into a tree and thus attached to earth, how another grew wings and flew, how a third was clothed with scales and yet another melted into a river. But no country has ever had a eunuch for a consul or judge or general. What in a man is honourable is disgraceful in an emasculate. Here is an example to surpass all that is most laughable in comedy, most lamentable in tragedy.

A pleasant sight in truth to see him strain his sapless limbs beneath the weight of the toga, borne down by the wearing of his consular dress; the gold of his raiment rendered his

flagitet Eutropius, ne quid non
polluat unus, 285
dux acies, iudex praetoria,
tempora consul!
Nil adeo foedum, quod non
exacta vetustas
ediderit longique labor
commiserit aevi.
Oedipodes matrem, natam
duxisse Thyestes
cantatur, peperit fratres Iocasta
marito 290
et Pelopea sibi. Thebas ac
funera Troiae
tristis Erechthei deplorat scaena
theatri.
in volucrem Tereus, Cadmus se
vertit in anguem.
Scylla novos mirata canes. hunc
arbore figit,
elevat hunc pluma, squamis
hunc fabula vestit, 295
hunc solvit fluvio. numquam
spado consul in orbe
nec iudex ductorve fuit!
quodcumque virorum
est decus, eunuchi scelus est.
exempla creantur
quae socci superent risus
luctusque cothurni.
Quam pulcher conspectus
erat, cum tenderet artus
exangues onerante toga
cinctuque gravatus 301
indutoque senex obscaenior iret
in auro:
humani qualis simulator simius
oris

decrepitude even more hideous.
'Twas as though an ape, man's
imitator, had been decked out in
sport with precious silken garments
by a boy who had left his back and
quarters uncovered to amuse the
guests at supper. Thus richly dressed
he walks upright and seems the more
loathsome by reason of his brilliant
trappings. Dressed in white the
senate, perhaps even his master,^[93]
accompanies the dishonoured fasces.
Behold a portent! A lictor more
noble than the

^[93] i.e. the Emperor.

quis,
quem puer adridens pretioso
stamine Serum
velavit nudasque nates ac terga
reliquit, 305
ludibrium mensis; erecto
pectore dives
ambulat et claro sese deformat
amictu.
candida pollutos comitatur curia
fasces,
forsitan et dominus. praebet
miracula lictor

[163]

consul, and a man about to grant to others a liberty which he has not yet himself won. He mounts the lofty platform and amid a torrent of self-laudation boasts of a prophetic dream he had in Egypt^[94] and of the defeat of tyrants which he foretold. No doubt the goddess of war stayed her avenging hand and waited till that emasculate Tiresias, that unmanned Melampus, could crawl back with oracles culled from farthest Nile.

Loud sang the prophetic birds in warning. The year shuddered at the thought of bearing Eutropius' name, and Janus proclaimed the madness of the choice from his two mouths, forbidding a eunuch to have access to his annals. Had a woman assumed the fasces, though this were illegal it were nevertheless less disgraceful. Women bear sway among the Medes and swift Sabaeans; half barbary is governed by martial queens. We know of no people who endure a eunuch's rule. Worship is paid to Pallas, Phoebe, Vesta, Ceres, Cybele, Juno, and Latona; have we ever seen a temple built or altars raised to a eunuch god? From among women are priestesses chosen; Phoebus enters into their hearts; through their voices the Delphian oracle speaks; none but the Vestal Virgins approach

consule nobilior libertatemque
daturus, 310
quam necdum meruit. scandit
sublime tribunal
atque inter proprias laudes
Aegyptia iactat
somnia prostratosque canit se
vate tyrannos.
scilicet in dubio vindex Bellona
pependit,
dum spado Tiresias
enervatusque Melampus
315

reptat ab extremo referens
oracula Nilo.
Obstrepuere avium voces,
exhorruit annus
nomen, et insanum gemino
proclamat ab ore
eunuchumque vetat fastis
accedere Ianus:
sumeret inlicitos etenim si
femina fasces, 320
esset turpe minus. Medis
levibusque Sabaeis
imperat hic sexus,
reginarumque sub armis
barbariae pars magna iacet:
gens nulla probatur,
eunuchi quae sceptrum ferat.
Tritonia, Phoebe,
Terra, Ceres, Cybele, Iuno,
Latona coluntur: 325
eunuchi quae templa dei, quas
vidimus aras?
inde sacerdotes; haec intrat
pectora Phoebus;
inde capunt Delphi: Troianam

the shrine of Trojan Minerva and
tend her flame: eunuchs have never
deserved the fillet and are always
unholy. A woman is born that she
may bear children and perpetuate the
human race; the tribe of eunuchs was
made for servitude. Hippolyte fell
but by the arrow of Hercules; the
Greeks fled before Penthesilea's axe;
Carthage, far-famed citadel, proud
Babylon with her hundred gates, are
both said to have been built by a
woman's hand. What noble deed did

[94] In 394 Arcadius had sent
Eutropius to the Thebaid to consult a
certain Christian prophet, John, upon
the result of Eugenius' revolt (Sozom.
vii. 22. 7, 8).

inde canunt Delphi, Trojanam

sola Minervam

virginitas Vestalis adit

flammasque tuetur:

hi nullas meriti vittas

semperque profani. 330

nascitur ad fructum mulier

prolemque futuram:

hoc genus inventum est ut

serviat. Herculis arcu

concidit Hippolyte; Danai

fugere bipennem,

Penthesilea, tuam; claras

Carthaginis arces

creditur et centum portis

Babylona superbam 335

femineus struxisse labor. quid

nobile gessit

[165]

a eunuch ever do? What wars did such an one fight, what cities did he found? Moreover, nature created the former, the hand of man the latter, whether it was from fear of being betrayed by her shrill woman's voice and her hairless cheeks that clever Semiramis, to disguise her sex from the Assyrians, first surrounded herself with beings like her, or the Parthians employed the knife to stop the growth of the first down of manhood and forced their boys, kept boys by artifice, to serve their lusts by thus lengthening the years of youthful charm.

At first the rumour of Eutropius' consulship seemed false and invented as a jest. A vague story spread from city to city; the crime was laughed at as one would laugh to hear of a swan with black wings or a crow as white as privet. Thus spake one of weighty character: "If such things are believed and swollen lies tell of unheard of monsters, then the tortoise can fly, the vulture grow horns, rivers flow back and mount the hills whence they spring, the sun rise behind Gades and set amid the Carmanians of India; I shall soon see ocean fit nursery for plants and the dolphin a denizen of the woods; beings half-men, half-snails and all

eunuchus? quae bella tulit? quas
 condidit urbes?
illas praeterea rerum natura
 creavit,
hos fecere manus: seu prima
 Semiramis astu
Assyriis mentita virum, ne
 vocis acutae 340
mollities levesve genae se
 prodere possent,
hos sibi coniunxit similes; seu
 Parthica ferro
luxuries vetuit nasci lanuginis
 umbram
servatoque diu puerili flore
 coegit
arte retardatam Veneri servire
 iuventam. 345
 Fama prius falso similis
 vanoque videri
ficta ioco; levior volitare per
 oppida rumor
riderique nefas: veluti
 nigrantibus alis
audiretur olor, corvo certante
 ligustris.
atque aliquis gravior morum:
 “si talibus, inquit, 350
creditur et nimis turgent
 mendacia monstris,
iam testudo volat, profert iam
 cornua vultur;
prona petunt retro fluvii iuga;
 Gadibus ortum
Carmani texere diem; iam
 frugibus aptum
aequor et adsuetum silvis
 delphina videbo. 355

the vain imaginings of India depicted
on Jewish curtains.”

Then another adds, jesting with a
more wanton wit: “Dost thou
wonder? Nothing great is there that
Eutropius does not conceive in his
heart. He ever loves novelty, ever
size, and is quick to taste everything
in turn. He fears no assault from the
rear; night and day he is ready with
watchful care; soft, easily moved by
entreaty, and, even in the midst of his
passion, tenderest of men, he never
says ‘no,’ and is ever at the disposal
even of

uelipinna video, 333
 iam cochleis homines iunctos et
 quidquid inane
 nutrit Iudaicis quae pingitur
 India velis.”
 Subicit et mixtis salibus
 lascivior alter:
 “miraris? nihil est, quod non in
 pectore magnum
 concipit Eutropius. semper
 nova, grandia semper
 diligit et celeri degustat singula
 sensu. 361
 nil timet a tergo; vigilantibus
 undique curis
 nocte dieque patet; lenis
 facilisque moveri
 supplicibus mediaque tamen
 mollissimus ira
 nil negat et sese vel non
 poscentibus offert; 365

[167]

those that solicit him not. Whatever
 the senses desire he cultivates and
 offers for another's enjoyment. That
 hand will give whatever thou
 wouldest have. He performs the
 functions of all alike; his dignity
 loves to unbend. His meetings^[95]
 and his deserving labours have won
 him this reward,^[96] and he receives
 the consul's robe in recompense for
 the work of his skilful hand.”

When the rumour concerning this
 disgrace of the eastern empire was
 known to be true and had impressed
 belief on Roman ears, Rome's
 goddess thus spake: “Is Eutropius
 worthy of mine ire? Is such an one
 fit cause for Roman grief?” So
 saying the mighty goddess winged
 her way through the heavens and
 with one stroke of her pinions passed
 beyond the Po and approached the
 camp of her emperor. It happened
 that even then the august Honorius,
 assisted by his father-in-law Stilicho,
 was making answer to the Germans
 who had come of their own accord to
 sue for peace. From his lofty throne
 he was dictating laws to the Cauci
 and giving a constitution to the
 flaxen-haired Suebi. Over these he
 sets a king, with those he signs a
 treaty now that hostages have been
 demanded; others he enters on the
 list as serviceable allies in war, so

quod libet ingenio, subigit
 traditque fruendum;
 quidquid amas, dabit ilia
 manus; communiter
 omni
 fungitur officio gaudetque
 potentia flecti.
 hoc quoque conciliis peperit
 meritoque laborum,
 accipit et trabeas argutae
 praemia dextrae.” 370
 Postquam vera fides facinus
 vulgavit Eoum
 gentibus et Romae iam certius
 impulit aures,
 “Eutropiumne etiam nostra
 dignabimur ira?
 hic quoque Romani meruit pars
 esse doloris?”
 sic effata rapit caeli per inania
 cursum 375
 diva potens unoque Padum
 translapsa volatu
 castra sui rectoris adit. tum forte
 decorus
 cum Stilichone gener pacem
 implorantibus ultro
 Germanis responsa dabat,
 legesque Caucis
 arduus et flavis signabat iura
 Suebis. 380
 his tribuit reges, his obside
 foedera sancit
 indicto; bellorum alios
 transcribit in usus,
 militet ut nostris detonsa
 Sygambria signis.
 laeta subit Romam pietas et

that in future the Sygambrians will
 cut off their flowing locks and serve
 beneath our banners. Joy and love so
 fill the goddess’ heart that she well
 nigh weeps, so great is her happy
 pride in her illustrious foster-child.
 So when a bullock fights in defence
 of the herd his mother lifts her own
 horns more proudly; so the African
 lioness gazes with admiration on her
 cub as he grows to be the terror of
 the farmsteads and the future king of
 beasts. Rome lays aside her veil of
 cloud and towers above the youthful
 warrior, then thus begins.

[\[95\]](#) With a play upon the sexual
 meaning of the word: indeed the whole
 passage, from l. 358 is a mass of
 obscene innuendo.

[\[96\]](#) i.e. the consulship.

laeta subit Romanam pietas et
gaudia^[168] paene
moverunt lacrimas tantoque
exultat alumno: 385
sic armenta suo iam defensante
iuvenco
celsius adsurgunt erectae cornua
matri,
sic iam terribilem stabulis
dominumque ferarum
crescere miratur genetrix
Massyla leonem.
dimovit nebulam iuvenique
adparuit ingens. 390
tum sic orsa loqui:

[169]

“Examples near at hand testify to the extent of my power now thou art emperor. The Saxon is conquered and the seas safe; the Picts have been defeated and Britain is secure. I love to see at my feet the humbled Franks and broken Suebi, and I behold the Rhine mine own, Germanicus.^[97] Yet what am I to do? The discordant East envies our prosperity, and beneath that other sky, lo! wickedness flourishes to prevent our empire’s breathing in harmony with one body. I make no mention of Gildo’s treason, detected so gloriously in spite of the power of the East on which the rebel Moor relied. For what extremes of famine did we not then look? How dire a danger overhung our city, had not thy valour or the ever-provident diligence of thy father-in-law supplied corn from the north in place of that from the south! Up Tiber’s estuary there sailed ships from the Rhine, and the Saône’s fertile banks made good the lost harvests of Africa. For me the Germans ploughed and the Spaniards’ oxen sweated; my granaries marvel at Iberian corn, nor did my citizens, now satisfied with harvests from beyond the Alps, feel the defection of revolted Africa. Gildo, however, paid the penalty for his treason as

“Quantum
te principe possim,
non longinqua docent, domito
quod Saxone Tethys
mitior aut fracto secura
Britannia Picto;
ante pedes humili Franco
tristique Suebo
perfruor et nostrum video,
Germanice, Rhenum. 395
sed quid agam? discors Oriens
felicibus actis
invidet atque alio Phoebi de
cardine surgunt
crimina, ne toto conspiret
corpore regnum.
Gildonis taceo magna cum
laude receptam
perfidiam et fretos Eoo robore
Mauros. 400
quae suscepta fames, quantum
discriminis urbi,
ni tua vel soceri numquam non
provida virtus
australem Arctois pensasset
frugibus annum!
invectae Rhodani Tiberina per
ostia classes
Cinyphiisque ferax Araris
successit aristis. 405
Teutonicus vomer Pyrenaeique
iuvenci
sudavere mihi; segetes mirantur
Hiberas
horrea; nec Libyae senserunt
damna rebellis
iam transalpina contenti messe
Quirites

Tabraca can witness. So perish all
who take up arms against thee!

“Lo! on a sudden from that same
clime comes another scourge, less
terrible indeed but even more
shameful, the consulship of
Eutropius. I admit I have long
learned to tolerate this unmanned
tribe, ever since the court exalted
itself with Arsacid pomp and the
example of Parthia corrupted our
morals. But till now they were but
set to guard jewels and raiment, and
to secure silence for the imperial
slumber. Never beyond the sleeping-
chamber

[97] She calls him *Germanicus* because
of his pacification of Germany; see
Introduction, p. x.

Quintus.

ille quidem solvit^[170] meritas (scit
Tabraca) poenas, 410

ut pereat quicumque tuis
confluxerit armis.

“Ecce repens isdem clades a
partibus exit
terrorisque minus, sed plus
habitura pudoris
Eutropius consul, pridem
tolerare fatemur
hoc genus, Arsacio postquam se
regia fastu 415
sustulit et nostros corrumpit
Parthia mores,
praefecti sed adhuc gemmis
vestique dabantur
custodes sacroque adhibere
silentia somno;

[171]

did the eunuch's service pass; not their lives gave guarantee of loyalty but their dull wits were a sure pledge. Let them guard hidden store of pearls and Tyrian-dyed vestments; they must quit high offices of state. The majesty of Rome cannot devolve upon an effeminate. Never have we seen so much as a ship at sea obey the helm in the hands of a eunuch-captain. Are we then so despicable? Is the whole world of less account than a ship? Let eunuchs govern the East by all means, for the East rejoices in such rulers, let them lord it over cities accustomed to a woman's sway: why disfigure warlike Italy with the general brand and defile her austere peoples with their deadly profligacy? Drive this foreign pollution from out the boundaries of manly Latium; suffer not this thing of shame to cross the Alps; let it remain fixed in the country of its birth. Let the river Halys or Orontes, careless of its reputation, add such a name to its annals: I, Rome, beg thee by thy life and triumphs, let not Tiber suffer this disgrace—Tiber whose way was to give the consulship to such men as Dentatus and Fabius though they asked not for it. Shall the Field of Mars witness the canvassing of an eunuch? Is Eutropius to stand with Aemilii and Camilli, saviours of

militia eunuchi numquam
 progressa cubili,
non vita spondente fidem, sed
 inertia tutum 420
mentis pignus erat. secreta
 monilia servent,
ornatus curent Tyrios: a fronte
 recedant
imperii. tenero tractari pectore
 nescit
publica maiestas. numquam vel
 in aequore puppim
vidimus eunuchi clavo parere
 magistri. 425
nos adeo sperni faciles?
 orbisque carina
vilior? auroram sane, quae talia
 ferre
gaudet, et adsuetas sceptris
 muliebribus urbes
possideant; quid belliferam
 communibus urunt
Italiam maculis nocituraque
 probra severis 430
ammiscent populis? peregrina
 piacula forti
pellantur longe Latio nec
 transeat Alpes
dedecus; in solis, quibus extitit,
 haereat arvis.
scribat Halys, scribat famae
 contemptor Orontes:
per te perque tuos obtestor
 Roma triumphos, 435
nesciat hoc Thybris, numquam
 poscentibus olim
qui dare Dentatis annos
 Fabiisque solebat

their country? Is thy office, Brutus,
now to be given to a Chrysogonus or
a Narcissus^[98]? Is this the reward for
giving up thy sons to punishment
and setting the citizen's duty before
the father's grief? Was it for this that
the Tuscans made their camp on the
Janiculum and Porsenna was but the
river's span from our gates? For this
that Horatius kept the bridge and
Mucius braved the flames? Was it all
to no purpose that

[98] Notorious freedmen and tools
respectively of Sulla and the Emperor
Claudius.

tabulisque sordet.

Martius eunuchi^[172] repetet
suffragia campus?
Aemilios inter servatoresque
Camillos
Eutropius? iam Chrysogonis
tua, Brute, potestas 440
Narcissisque datur? natos hoc
dedere poenae
profuit et misero civem
praeponere patri?
hoc mihi Ianiculo positis Etruria
castris
quaesiit et tantum fluvio
Porsenna remotus?
hoc meruit vel ponte Cocles vel
Mucius igne? 445
visceribus frustra castum
Lucretia ferrum

[173]

chaste Lucretia plunged the dagger into her bosom and Cloelia swam the astonished Tiber? Were the fasces reft from Tarquin to be given to Eutropius? Let Hell ope her jaws and all who have sat in my curule chair come and turn their backs upon their colleague. Decii, self-sacrificed for your country's good, come forth from your graves; and you, fierce Torquati; and thou, too, great-hearted shade of poor Fabricius. Serranus, come thou hither, if now thou plougest the acres of the holy dead and cleavest the fallow lands of Elysium. Come Scipios, Lutatius, famed for your victories over Carthage, Marcellus, conqueror of Sicily, rise from the dead, thou Claudian race, you progeny of Curius. Cato, thou who wouldst not live beneath Caesar's rule, come thou forth from thy simple tomb and brave the sight of Eutropius. Immortal bands of Bruti and Corvini, return to earth. Eunuchs don your robes of office, sexless beings assume the insignia of Rome. They have laid hands on the toga that inspired Hannibal and Pyrrhus with terror. They now despise the fan and aspire to the consul's cloak. No longer do they carry the maidenly parasol for they have dared to wield the axes of Latium.

mersit et attonitum tranavit
 Cloelia Thybrim?
 Eutropio fasces adservabantur
 adempti
 Tarquiniis? quemcumque meae
 vexere curules,
 laxato veniat socium aversatus
 Averno. 450
 impensi sacris Decii prorumpite
 bustis
 Torquatique truces animosaque
 pauperis umbra
 Fabricii tuque o, si forte inferna
 piorum
 iugera et Elysias scindis,
 Serrane, novales.
 Poeno Scipiadae, Poeno
 praeclare Lutati, 455
 Sicania Marcelle ferox, gens
 Claudia surgas^[99]
 et Curii veteres; et, qui sub iure
 negasti
 vivere Caesareo, parvo procede
 sepulcro
 Eutropium passure Cato;
 remcate tenebris,
 agmina Brutorum
 Corvinorumque
 catervae. 460
 eunuchi vestros habitus,
 insignia sumunt
 ambigui Romana mares;
 rapuere tremendas
 Hannibali Pyrrhoque togas;
 flabella perosi
 adspirant trabeis; iam non
 umbracula gestant
 virginibus Latiae cuiuslibet aevi

“Unhappy band, leave your
 womanly fastnesses, you whom the
 male sex has discarded and the
 female will not adopt. The knife has
 cut out the stings of love and by that
 wounding you are pure. A mixture
 are you of two ages—child and
 greybeard and nought between. Take
 your seats, fathers in name alone.
 Come new lords, come sterile senate,
 throng your leader Eutropius. Fill the
 judgement-seat, not the bedchamber.
 Change your habits and learn to
 follow the consul’s chair, not the
 woman’s litter.

VIRGINIUS. Laudas ausi vibrare
[95] mss. *have surgat*.
securis! 465

“Liquite femineas infelix
turba latebras,
alter quos pepulit sexus nec
suscipit alter,
execti Veneris stimulos et
vulnere casti
(mixta duplex aetas; inter
puerumque senemque
nil medium): falsi complete
sedilia patres; 470
ite novi proceres infecundoque
senatu
Eutropium stipate ducem;
celebrate tribunal
pro thalamis, verso iam discite
more curules,
non matrum pilenta sequi.

“I would not cite examples from remote antiquity nor count the countless magistrates of past history whom he thus outrages. But think how the reverence due to all past ages will be impaired, on how many centuries one man’s shame will set its mark. Amid the annals that record the name of Arinthaëus,^[100] his master, will be found the slave, and he will enter his own honours as equal to those of his owner. The slaves of Egypt’s kings have ever been a curse to the world; behold I suffer from a worse than Pothinus and bear a wrong more flagrant than that of which Egypt was once the scene. Pothinus’ sword at Alexandria spilled the blood of a single consul;^[101] Eutropius brings dishonour on all.

“If the fate of subjects cannot move thee, yet have thou regard for princes, for your common cause, and remove this stain on royalty. The consulship is the sole office the emperor deigns to accept; alternately the honour passes to Court and Senate. Thou who hast thyself been four times consul spare succeeding consuls this infamy. I pray thee, protect the fasces, so often thine, from the pollution of a eunuch’s hand; let not the omens handed down in our sacred books, let not those

“Ne
 prisca revolvam
 neu numerem, quantis iniuria
 mille per annos 475
 sit retro ducibus, quanti
 foedabitur aevi
 canities, unam subeant quot
 saecula culpam:
 inter Arinthaevi fastos et nomen
 erile
 servus erit dominoque suos
 aequalis honores
 inseret! heu semper Ptolomaei
 noxia mundo 480
 mancipia! en alio laedor
 graviore Pothino
 et patior maius Phario scelus.
 ille cruorem
 consulis unius Pellaeis ensibus
 hausit;
 inquinat hic omnes.

“Si nil
 privata movebunt,
 at tu principibus, vestrae tu
 prospice causae 485
 regalesque averte notas. hunc
 accipit unum
 aula magistratum: vobis
 patribusque recurrit
 hic alternus honos. in crimen
 euntibus annis
 parce, quater consul! contagia
 fascibus, oro,
 defendas ignava tuis neu tradita
 libris 490
 omina vestitusque meos, quibus
 omne, quod ambit
 oceanus, domui tanta caligine

robes of mine wherewith I have
 subdued everything within Ocean's
 stream, be plunged in so great
 darkness and trodden under foot.
 What kind of wars can we wage now
 that a eunuch takes the auspices?
 What marriage, what harvest will be
 fruitful? What fertility, what
 abundance is possible beneath a
 consul stricken with sterility? If
 eunuchs shall give judgement and
 determine laws, then let men card
 wool and live like the Amazons,
 confusion and licence dispossessing
 the order of nature.

[\[100\]](#) Arinthaëus had held the high
 position of *magister peditum*. He died
 in 379.

[\[101\]](#) Pothinus, the creature of Ptolemy
 Dionysius, was instrumental in killing
 Pompey in Egypt in 48 B.C.

oceanus, domui, tanta caangine
mergi [176]

calce quoque shasultem quae iam
belli geramur vincere
mollibus diffusiis? quae iam
dum certare pudet? nescis quod
vel frugum plura seges? quid
laetitia fertile tendis? piratica
quid plebi Magni sterili possit sub
erigit, in consule casulis laurea
eunuchi Crassum dabunt legesque
adnuis. tenebunt, fremitum, quo
ducant palli et iura, tatoque
quo Maure Gildoque ruit. quid
vivat Ambrasiae signa confusa
sollicitas? non est iaculis
hastisve petendus:
conscia succumbent audito
verbere terga,
ut Scythia post multos rediens
exercitus annos,
cum sibi servilis pro finibus
obvia pubes
iret et arceret dominos tellure
reversos, 510
armatam ostensis aciem fudere
flagellis:
notus ab inceptis ignobile
reppulit horror
vulgus et addictus sub verbere
torpuit ensis.”

[177]

“What need of further words? Why, Stilicho, dost thou delay to conquer because ashamed to fight? Knowest thou not that the viler a foe the greater the rejoicing at his overthrow? His defeat of the pirates extended the fame of great Pompey; his victory in the Servile War gave an added glory to Crassus. Thou acceptest my charge: I recognize the clamour that terrified the East and drove Gildo and his Moors to their destruction. Why sound the trump of war? No need to attack him with javelin or spear. At the crack of the whip will be bowed the back that has felt its blows. Even so when after many years the Scythian army came back from the wars and was met on the confines of its native land by the usurping crowd of slaves who sought to keep their returning masters from their country; with displayed whips they routed the armed ranks; back from its enterprise the familiar terror drove the servile mob, and at threat of the lash the bondsman’s sword grew dull.”

IN EUTROPIUM**LIBER SECUNDUS.
PRAEFATIO**

(XIX.)

AGAINST EUTROPIUS**BOOK II. PREFACE**

(XIX.)

The nobly born Eutropius who but lately wielded the reins of supreme power once more fears the familiar blows; and, soon to feel the wonted shackles about his halting feet, he laments that his threats against his masters have idly vanished. Fortune, having had enough of her mad freak, has thrust him forth from his high office and restored him to his old way of life. He now prepares to hew wood with axe other than the consular and is at last scourged with the rods he once proudly carried. To the punishment set in motion by him when consul he himself as consul succumbed; the year that brought him his robe of office brought him his exile. That omen of evil augury for the people turns against itself, the portent of that consulship brings ruin to the consul. That name erased, our annals breathe once more, and better health is restored to the palace now that it has at last vomited forth its poison. His friends deny him, his accomplices abandon him; in his fall is involved all the eunuch band, overcome not in battle, subdued not

Qui modo sublimes rerum
 flectebat habenas
 patricius, rursum verbera
 nota timet
et solitos tardae passurus
 compedis orbes
 in dominos vanas luget abisse
 minas.
culmine deiectum vitae Fortuna
 priori 5
 reddidit, insano iam satiata
 ioco.
scindere nunc alia meditatur
 ligna securi
 fascibus et tandem vapulat
 ipse suis.
ille citas consul poenas se
 consule solvit:
 annus qui trabeas hic dedit
 exilium. 10
infaustum populis in se quoque
 vertitur omen;
 saevit in auctorem
 prodigiosus honos.
abluto penitus respirant nomine
 fasti
 maturamque luem sanior aula
 vomit.
dissimulant socii coniuratique
 recedunt, 15
 procumbit pariter cum duce
 tota cohors;
non acie victi, non seditione
 coacti;
 nec pereunt ritu quo periire
 viri.
concidit exiguae dementia
 vulnere chartae.

by strife—they may not die a man's
death. A mere stroke of the pen has
wrought their undoing, a simple
letter has fulfilled Mars' savage
work.

vulnere charitae,
[180]
confecit saevum littera
Martis opus. 20

[181]

The unsexed tyrant has been routed from out his fastness in the women's quarters and, driven from the bedchamber, has lost his power. Thus sadly, when her lover's fidelity wavers and a former favourite has been recalled, does a mistress leave his house. With handfuls of dust he sprinkles his scanty hairs and floods his wrinkles with senile tears; as he lies in humble supplication before the altars of the gods his trembling voice seeks to soften the anger of the women. His countless masters gather around, each demanding back his slave, useless except for chastisement. For loathsome though he is and fouler in mind even than in face, yet the very anger they feel against him will make them pay; he is worth buying simply to punish.

What land or country wilt thou now visit, eunuch? Here hate surrounds thee, there thy popularity is fled; both courts have uttered thy condemnation in either half of the world; never wert thou of the West, now the East repudiates thee too. I marvel that thou, blind Sibyl, [\[102\]](#) who foretold'st the fates of others, art silent about thine own. No longer does fallacious Nile interpret thy dreams; no longer, poor wretch, do thy prophets see visions. What doth thy sister? Will she dare to embark

Mollis feminea detruditur arce
tyrannus
et thalamo pulsus perdidit
imperium:
sic iuvenis nutante fide
veterique reducta
paelice defletam linquit
arnica domum.
canitiem raram largo iam
pulvere turpat 25
et lacrimis rugas implet anile
gemens
suppliciterque pias humilis
prostratus ad aras
mitigat iratas voce tremante
nurus.
innumeri glomerantur eri sibi
quisque petentes
mancipium solis utile
suppliciis. 30
quamvis foedus enim
mentemque obscaenior
ore,
ira dabit pretium; poena
meretur emi.

Quas, spado, nunc terras aut
quem transibis in axem?
cingeris hinc odiis, inde
recessit amor,
utraque te gemino sub sidere
regia damnat: 35
Hesperius numquam, iam nec
Eous eris.
miror cur, aliis qui pandere fata
solebas,
ad propriam cladem caeca
Sihvlla taces

with thee and bear thee faithful
company over the distant seas?
Mayhap she scorns the couch of an
impoverished eunuch, and now that
she herself is rich will not love thee
who now art poor. Thou dost confess
thou wert the first to cut a eunuch's
throat, but the example will not
secure thine own death. Live on that
destiny may blush. Lo! this is he
whom so many cities have held in
awe, whose yoke so many peoples
have borne. Why lament the loss of
that

[102] Claudian calls Eutropius the
Sibyl because both were "old women."
He is referring to Eutropius'
consultation of the Egyptian oracle; *cf.*
In Eutrop. i. 312 and note.

iam tibi nulla vi¹⁸²et fallax
 insomnia Nilus;
 pervigilant vates iam,
 miserande, tui. 40
 quid soror? audebit tecum
 conscendere puppim
 et veniet longum per mare
 fida comes?
 an fortasse toros eunuchi
 pauperis odit
 et te nunc inopem dives
 amare negat?
 eunuchi iugulum primus
 secuisse fateris; 45
 sed tamen exemplo non
 feriere tuo.
 vive pudor fati. en quem
 tremuere tot urbes,
 en cuius populi sustinuere
 iugum!

[183]

wealth thy son shall inherit? In no
 other way couldst thou have been
 father to an emperor. ^[103] Why
 insatiably weary heaven with a
 woman's complaints? A haven of refuge
 is prepared for thee on the shores of
 Cyprus. Thou hast plunged the world
 in war with barbarity; the sea, believe
 me, is safer than the land.

No longer wilt thou strike terror into
 the Armenians with javelin and bow,
 no more scour the plain on thy fleet
 charger. The senate of Byzantium
 has been deprived of thy loved
 voice; uncertainty holds the august
 assembly that is now deprived of thy
 counsels. Hang up thy toga, retired
 consul; hang up thy quiver, veteran
 soldier; return to Venus' service; that
 is thy true calling. The pander's hand
 knows not to serve Mars featly;
 Cytherea will right gladly take back
 her slave. Dancing fills the island of
 Cyprus, home of the happy loves;
 there purity commands no respect.
 Paphian maidens gaze forth from the
 high cliffs, anxious till the wave has
 brought thy bark safe to land. Yet
 fear I lest the Tritons detain thee in
 the deep to teach them how they may
 seduce the sportive Nereids, or that
 those same winds which hindered
 Gildo's flight may seek to drown
 thee in the sea. Tabraca owes its
 fame to the overthrow of the Moor;

direptas quid plangis opes, quas
natus habebit?
non aliter poteris principis
esse pater. 50
improbe, quid pulsas
muliebribus astra
querellis,
quod tibi sub Cypri litore
parta quies?
omnia barbarico per te concussa
tumultu.
crede mihi, terra tutius
aequor erit.

Iam non Armenios iaculis
terrebis et arcu, 55
per campos volucrem non
agitabis equum;
dilecto caruit Byzantius ore
senatus;
curia consiliis aestuat orba
tuis:
emeritam suspende togam,
suspende pharetram;
ad Veneris partes
ingeniumque redi. 60
non bene Gradivo lenonia
dextera servit.
suscipiet famulum te
Cytherea libens.
insula laeta choris, blandorum
mater Amorum:
nulla pudicitiae cura placere
potest.
prospectant Paphiae celsa de
rupe puellae 65
sollicitae, salvam dum ferat
unda ratem.

may Cyprus win prestige from thy shipwreck. In vain will thy last breath be spent in calling on the dolphin to carry thee to shore: his back bears only men.^[104] Hereafter should any eunuch attempt to emulate thine actions let him turn his eye towards Cyprus and abate his pride.

^[103] Eutropius had been raised by Arcadius to the highest of all ranks, that of Patrician. These *patricii* were called the “fathers” of the Emperor. Hence Eutropius, a patrician, left (*i.e.* forfeited) his property on his banishment to Cyprus to his “son” Arcadius.

^[104] A reference to the rescue of Arion by the dolphin.

sed vereor, teneant ne te

Tritones in alto

IN EUTROPIUM

Nereidas,

aut idem cupido te

mergere venti,

Gildonis nuper qui tenuere

fugam. 70

inclita captivo memoratur

Tabraca Mauro,

naufragio Cyprus sit

memoranda tuo.

vecturum moriens frustra

delphina vocabis;

ad terram solos devehit ille

viros.

quisquis adhuc similes

eunuchus tendit in actus,

75

respiciens Cyprum desinat

esse ferox.

[185]

AGAINST EUTROPIUS

BOOK II

(XX.)

Ashes of Phrygia and you last remnants of the ruined East (if any such remain), the augury was but too true, too clear the threats of heaven: now that the blow has fallen what use to learn the presagings of this year of portents? The sailor is more cautious; he foresees the violence of the North wind and hauls in his canvas before the swelling storm. Of what avail to acknowledge a mistake when his vessel is already sunk? Can tears extenuate a crime? The sinister auspices of your consul live on; the atonement due to unmoved fate remains fixed. Ere the deed was done you should have realized its horror; you should have erased the blot ere it had dried. When the body is overwhelmed by long-standing disease 'tis all in vain that thou makest use of healing medicines. When an ulcer has penetrated to the marrow of the bones the touch of a hand is useless, steel and fire must sane the place that the wound heal not on the surface, like any moment to re-open. The flame must penetrate to the quick to make a way for the

Mygdonii cineres et si quid
 restat Eoi,
quod pereat, regni: certe non
 augure falso
prodigii patuere minae,
 frustraue peracto
vulnere monstriferi praesagia
 discitis anni.
cautior ante tamen violentum
 navita Caurum 5
prospicit et tumidae subducit
 vela procellae.
quid iuvat errorem mersa iam
 puppe fateri?
quid lacrimae delicta levant?
 stant omina vestri
consulis: inmotis haesere
 piacula fati.
tunc decuit sentire nefas, tunc
 ire recentes 10
detersum maculas. veteri post
 obruta morbo
corpora Paeonias nequiquam
 admoveris herbas.
ulcera possedis alte suffusa
 medullis
non leviori manu, ferro
 sanantur et igni,
ne noceat frustra mox eruptura
 cicatrix. 15
ad vivum penetrant flammae,
 quo funditus umor
defluat et vacuis corrupto
 sanguine venis

foul humours to escape; in order
that, once the veins are emptied of
corrupted blood, the

fountain-head of the evil may be dried up. Nay, even limbs are amputated to assure the healthy life of the rest of the body. Think you the Court fitly cleansed by Eutropius' exile in Cyprus? The world avenged by the banishment of a eunuch? Can any ocean wash away that stain? any age bring forgetfulness of so great a crime?

Ere yet he had donned the consul's robe there came a rumbling from the bowels of the earth; a hidden madness shook the subterranean caverns and buildings crashed one on another. Chalcedon, shaken to the foundations, tottered like a drunken man, and Bosphorus, straying from his course, flooded the cities on his either bank. The shores of the strait came together and the sailors once more had to avoid the Clashing Rocks, torn from their foundation and errant. Surely such presages were sent by the sister deities of Styx, rejoicing that under this consul at last all peoples were delivered into their hands. Soon arose divers forms of ruin: here the fire-god spread his flames; there Nereus, god of the sea, brake his bounds. Here men's homes were burned, there flooded. Ye gods, what punishment do ye hold in store for the scoundrel whose rise to power was marked by such portents?

arescat fons ipse mali; truncatur
 et artus,
 ut liceat reliquis securum
 degere membris.
 at vos egregie purgatam creditis
 aulam, 20
 Eutropium si Cyprus habet?
 vindictaque mundi
 semivir exul erit? qui vos
 lustrare valebit
 oceanus? tantum facinus quae
 diluet aetas?
 Induerat necdum trabeas:
 mugitus ab axe
 redditus inferno, rabies arcana
 cavernas 25
 vibrat et alterno confligunt
 culmina lapsu.
 bacchatus per operta tremor
 Calchedona movit
 pronus et in geminas nutavit
 Bosphorus urbes.
 concurrere freti fauces, radice
 revulsa
 vitant instabilem rursum
 Symplegada nautae. 30
 scilicet haec Stygiae
 praemittunt signa
 sorores
 et sibi iam tradi populos hoc
 consule gaudent.
 mox oritur diversa lues: hinc
 Mulciber ignes
 sparserat, hinc victa proruperat
 obice Nereus;
 haec flagrant, haec tecta natant.
 quam, numina,
 nocentem 35

O'ercome us, Neptune, with thy
 trident and overwhelm our defiled
 soil along with all the guilt. One city
 we yield to the Furies, a scapegoat
 for the sins of the world.

Once the way was open for portents,
 prodigies of every sort hasted to
 disclose themselves. Rain of blood
 fell, children of weird form were
 born and offspring discordant with
 their breed. Statues wept, not seldom
 the herds dared to speak, and wild
 beasts braved an entrance into the
 city. Then seers raved

servatis sceler^[188], cuius tot
 cladibus omen
 constitit? incumbas utinam,
 Neptune, tridenti
 pollutumque solum toto cum
 crimine mergas.
 unam pro mundo Furiis
 concedimus urbem. 39
 Utque semel patuit monstris
 iter, omnia tempus
 nacta suum properant: nasci
 tum decolor imber
 infantumque novi vultus et
 dissona partu
 semina, tum lapidum fletus
 armentaue vulgo
 ausa loqui mediisque ferae se
 credere muris;
 tum vates sine more rapi
 lymphataque passim 45

[189]

strangely and frenzied hearts were everywhere ablaze, stirred by the fires of the dread god Phoebus. Yet even had no god warned us, whose mind shall be so dull as to doubt that the year of an emasculate consul must be fatal to those lands? Blind folly ever accompanies crime; of the future no account is taken; sufficient for the day is its short-lived pleasure; heedless of loss passion plunges into forbidden joys, counting the postponement of punishment a gain and believing distant the retribution that even now o'erhangs. In face of such portents I would not have entrusted Camillus' self with the fasces, let alone a sexless slave (oh! the shame of it!), to yield it to whom were, for men, a disgrace, even though every oracle decreed it, and the insistent deities gave pledges of prosperity.

Look back in the annals of crime, read o'er all past history, unroll the volumes of Rome's story. What can the Capri of Tiberius' old age, what can Nero's theatre offer like to this? [\[105\]](#) A eunuch, clad in the cloak of Romulus, sat within the house of the emperors; the staled palace lay open to the eager throng of visitors; hither hasten senators, mingling with the populace, anxious generals and magistrates of every degree; all are

pectora terrifici stimulis ignescere
 Phoebi.
 fac nullos cecinisse deos: adeone
 retusi
 quisquam cordis erit, dubitet qui
 partibus illis
 adfore fatalem castrati consulis
 annum?
 sed quam caecus inest vitiis amor!
 omne futurum 50
 despicitur suadentque brevem
 praesentia fructum
 et ruit in vetitum damni segura
 libido,
 dum mora supplicii lucro serumque
 quod instat
 creditur, haud equidem contra tot
 signa Camillo
 detulerim fascēs, nedum (pro
 sexus!) inerti 55
 mancipio, cui, cuncta licet responsa
 iuberent
 hortantesque licet sponderent
 prospera divi,
 turpe fuit cessisse viros.

Exquirite

retro
 crimina continui lectis annalibus
 aevi,
 prisca recensitis evolvite saecula
 fastis: 60
 quid senis infandi Capreae, quid
 scaena Neronis
 tale ferunt? spado Romuleo
 succinctus amictu
 sedit in Augustis laribus. vulgata
 patebat
 aula salutarum studiis: hic plebs

fain to be the first to fall at his feet
 and to touch his hand; the prayer of
 all is to set kisses on those hideous
 wrinkles. He is called defender of
 the laws, father of the emperor, and
 the court deigns to acknowledge a
 slave as its overlord. Ye who come
 after, acknowledge that it is true!
 Men must needs erect monuments to
 celebrate this infamy; on many an
 anvil groans the bronze that is to
 take upon it the form of this monster.
 Here gleams his statue as a judge,

[105] Suetonius draws a lurid (and
 probably exaggerated) picture of the
 debaucheries of Tiberius' old age at
 Capri. The same author describes the
 "scaena Neronis." The curious may
 find the account in Suet, *Nero*, xxix.

aura salutantum studiis, huc piebe

senatus^[190]

[191]

permixta trepidique duces omnisque there as a consul, there as a warrior.

potestas 65

On every side one sees that figure of

confluit. advolvi genibus, contingere this mounted on his horse; before the

dextram

very doors of the senate-house

ambitus et votum deformibus oscula behold a eunuch's countenance. As

rugis

though to rob virtue of any place

figere. praesidium legum genitorque where she might sojourn undefiled,

vocatur

men labour to befoul every street

principis et famulum dignatur regia with this vile image. May they rest

patrem.

for ever undisturbed, indisputable

posteritas, admitte fidem:

proofs of our eternal shame; such is

monumenta petuntur 70

my prayer. Beneath the statues one

dedecoris multisque gemunt

reads flattering titles and praises too

incudibus aera

great even for *men*. Do they tell of

formatura nefas. haec iudicis, ilia

his noble race and lineage while his

togati,

owners are still alive? What soldier

brooks to read that single-handed he,

Eutropius, won great battles? Are

Byzas^[106] and Constantine to be told

that he is the third founder of Rome?

Meanwhile the arrogant pander

prolongs his revels till the dawn,

stinking of wine and scattering

money amid the crowd to buy their

applause. He spends whole days of

amusement in the theatres, prodigal

of another's money. But his sister

and spouse (if such a prodigy can be

conceived) wins the favour of

Rome's matrons by entertainments,

and, like a chaste wife, sings the

praises of her eunuch husband. 'Tis

her he loves, her he consults on all

matters of importance, be it of peace

or war, to her care he entrusts the

haec nitet armati species;
 numerosus ubique
 fulget eques: praefert eunuchi
 curia vultus.
 ac veluti caveant ne quo
 consistere virtus 75
 possit pura loco, cunctas hoc
 ore laborant
 incestare vias. maneant inmota
 precamur
 certaue perpetui sint
 argumenta pudoris.
 subter adulantes tituli
 nimiaeque leguntur
 vel maribus laudes: claro quod
 nobilis ortu 80
 (cum vivant domini!), quod
 maxima proelia solus
 impleat (et patitur miles!), quod
 tertius urbis
 conditor (hoc Byzas
 Constantinusque
 videbant!).
 inter quae tumidus leno
 producere cenas
 in lucem, foetere mero,
 dispergere plausum 85
 empturas in vulgus opes,
 totosque theatris
 indulgere dies, alieni prodigus
 auri.
 at soror et, si quid portentis
 creditur, uxor
 mulcebat matres epulis et more
 pudicae
 coniugis eunuchi celebrabat
 vota mariti. 90
 hanc amat hanc summa de re

keys of the palace, as one would of a
 stable or empty house. Is the
 guardianship of a mighty empire
 thus naught? Is it thus he makes a
 mockery of a world's obedience?

Winter, passing into spring, had now
 felt the returning warmth of
 Zephyrus' breezes and the earliest
 flowers had oped their buds when, in
 the lap of peace, they were preparing
 the annual journey to thy walls,
 Ancyra. 'Twas Eutropius' device that
 weariness of the sea^[107] might not
 come upon him,

^[106] Mythical founder of Byzantium
 (= Constantinople): said to have been
 contemporaneous with the Argonauts
 (Diod. iv. 49. 1).

^[107] i.e. to prevent his being bored
 with the view of the Bosphorus.

namque animat, namque summa de te

vel pace^[192] vel armis

consulit, huic curas et clausa

palatia mandat

ceu stabulum vacuumque

domum. sic magna tueri

regna nihil, patiensque iugi

deluditur orbis?

Mitior alternum Zephyri iam

bruma teporem 95

senserat et primi laxabant

germina flores,

iamque iter in gremio pacis

sollemne parabant

ad muros, Ancyra, tuos, auctore

repertum

Eutropio, pelagi ne taedia longa

subirent,

[193]

but a roaming summer might slide away in pleasure journeys. But so magnificent was their return, you would have imagined they brought conquered Persia in their train and had drunk of the waters of Indus. Look you! Mars, returning from the distant lands of the yellow-haired Geloni, was re-seeking the lands of Thrace in his bloody chariot. Pangaeus subsided beneath his wheels, the mountain snows cried out under his sounding axle. Scarce had the father stayed on Haemus' summit and, reining in his coursers, looked upon the toga-clad woman, when he smiled a cruel smile and shook his gleaming crested helm; then he addressed Bellona, implacable goddess, who, her raiment all stained with blood, was combing her snake-hair, fattened on the slaughter of Illyrians.

"Sister, shall we never succeed in curing the East of effeminacy? Will this corrupt age never learn true manliness? Argaeus yet reeks with those heaps of dead Cappadocians not yet cold; Orontes is still pale from misery. But they only remember evil while they suffer it; give them a moment's respite and all their slaughter fades from their minds unfelt; little they reckon of bloodshed that is past.

sed vaga lascivis flueret
 discursibus aestas: 100
 unde tamen tanta sublimes mole
 redibant,
 ceu vinctos traherent Medos
 Indumque bibissent.
 ecce autem flavis Gradivus ab
 usque Gelonis
 arva cruentato repetebat Thracia
 curru:
 subsidunt Pangaea rotis
 altaeque sonoro 105
 stridunt axe nives. ut vertice
 constitit Haemi
 femineasque togas pressis
 conspexit habenis,
 subrisit cradele pater cristisque
 micantem
 quassavit galeam; tunc
 implacabile numen
 Bellonam adloquitur, quae
 sanguine sordida vestem
 Illyricis pingues pectebat
 stragibus hydros: 111
 “Necdum mollitiae, necdum,
 germana, mederi
 possumus Eoae? numquam
 corrupta rigescent
 saecula? Cappadocum tepidis
 Argaeus acervis
 aestuat; infelix etiamnum pallet
 Orontes. 115
 dum pereunt, meminere mali; si
 corda parumper
 respirare sinas, nullo tot funera
 sensu
 praetereunt: antiqua levis
 iactura cruoris!

“Seest thou this foul deed? Why veil
 thy face with thine hair? See what
 crimes a short spell of peace has
 wrought! what a curse has the
 sheathed sword proved! The year
 that has known no war has had a
 eunuch for its consul. The consulship
 would have been at an end had a like
 spirit animated Italy; this age-long
 office had fallen amid mockery and
 no traces been left of its trampled
 rights, had not Stilicho, heedful of
 the empire and of the character and
 morals of a past age, banished from
 Tiber’s city

“Adspicis obscaenum^[194]
 facinus? quid crinibus
 ora
 protegis? en quales sese diffudit
 in actus 120
 parva quies, quantum nocuerunt
 otia ferri!
 qui caruit bellis, eunucho
 traditur annus.
 actum de trabeis esset, si
 partibus una
 mens foret Hesperiiis; rueret
 derisa vetustas
 nullaue calcati starent vestigia
 iuris, 125
 ni memor imperii Stilicho
 morumque priorum
 turpe relegasset defenso
 Thybride nomen

this shameful name and kept Rome
 unsullied by an unheard of crime. He
 has given us a harbour to which the
 exiled majesty of Latium and the
 disgraced fasces might retire; he has
 given us annals wherein, abandoning
 the East, an age polluted with servile
 stains might find a refuge.

“How like to its lord the inhabitants
 of the palace! Turn your eyes to the
 city walls. Surely they at least mutter
 disapprobation, though fear forbids
 them speak out? Do they not
 condemn him in their hearts? No: list
 the plaudits of the senate, of the
 lords of Byzantium, of the Grecian
 citizens of Rome. O people worthy
 of such a senate, senate worthy of
 such a consul! To think that all these
 bear arms and use them not, that
 manly indignation reminds not of
 their sex those many whose thighs
 bear a sword! Has my descendants’
 robe of office sunk so low? Is
 Brutus’ renown thus brought to
 scorn?

“Romulus, forgive thy sire for
 coming so tardy an avenger of those
 outraged fasces. Right soon will I
 make them pay for this joy with
 liberal tears. Why delayest thou,
 Bellona, to sound the trumpet of hell
 and to arm thyself with the scythe
 wherewith thou mowest the people
 to the ground? Foment discord,

[196]

[197]

to precipitate them into revolt;
readily does nature return to her old
ways. So be it. Since our soldiers'
valour is numbed and they have
learned to obey an unmanned master,
let a stranger from the north avenge
our outraged laws and barbarian
arms bring relief to disgraced
Rome."

So spake he and thundered with his
shield nigh as loud as the ruler of the
gods when he shakes his aegis from
out the lowering cloud. Athos
replies, Haemus re-echoes; again and
again shaken Rhodope repeats the
hoarse uproar. Hebrus raised from
out the wondering waters his horns
hoary with frost, and bloodless Ister
froze in fear. Then the god cast his
javelin, ^[109] heavy with steel, and
stiff with knotted shaft, a mighty
weapon such as none other god
could wield. The clouds part before
its onset and give it free passage;
through the air it speeds o'er seas
and mountains by one mighty cast
and comes to earth amid the plains
of Phrygia. The ground felt the
shock; Hermus blessed with
Dionysus' vines groaned thereat,
Pactolus' golden urn shuddered, all
Dindymus bent his forest fleece and
wept.

Bellona, too, hastens forth with
speed no less than that of Mars'

in scelus; ad mores facilis
 natura reverti. 155
 sic eat: in nostro quando iam
 milite robur
 torpuit et molli didicit parere
 magistro,
 vindicet Arctous violatas
 advena leges;
 barbara Romano succurrant
 arma pudori.”
 Sic fatus clipeo, quantum vix
 ipse deorum 160
 arbiter infesto cum percutit
 aegida nimbo,
 intonuit. responsat Athos
 Haemusque remugit;
 ingeminat raucum Rhodope
 concussa fragorem.
 cornua cana gelu mirantibus
 extulit undis
 Hebrus et exanguem glacie
 timor adligat Histrum.
 165
 tunc, adamante gravem
 nodisque rigentibus
 hastam,
 telum ingens nullique deo
 iaculabile, torsit.
 fit late ruptis via nubibus; ilia
 per auras
 tot freta, tot montes uno
 contenta volatu
 transilit et Phrygiae mediis
 adfigitur arvis. 170
 sensit humus; gemuit Nysaeo
 palmite felix
 Hermus et aurata Pactolus
 inhorruiit urna

whistling spear; a hundred ways of
 hurt she pondered and at last
 approached Tarbigilus, ^[110] fierce
 leader of the Getic squadron. It
 chanced he had but late returned
 with empty hands from a visit to
 Eutropius; disappointment and
 indignation aggravated his ferocity,
 and poverty, that can incite

^[109] Alluding to the Roman custom of
 casting a spear as a sign of the
 declaration of war; *cf.* Ovid, *Fasti*, vi.
 207—

Hinc solet hasta manu belli
 praenuntia mitti
 In regem et gentes cum placet
 arma capi.

^[110] Tarbigilus seems to have
 belonged to the nation of the
 Gruthungi. The exact form of his name
 is a matter of uncertainty. The mss.
 vary: Zosimus (v. 13. 2) calls him
 Τριβίγιλδος. His revolt in Phrygia (*cf.*
 ll. 274, etc.) took place in 399.

~~totaque summissis fleverunt~~
~~totaque summissis fleverunt~~
[108] alae Rubenū; MSS. (followed by
totaque summissis fleverunt
Dindyma silvis.
Nec dea praemissae
stridorem segnius hastae
consequitur, centumque vias
meditata nocendi 175
tandem Tarbigilum (Geticae
dux improbus alae [108]
hic erat) adgreditur. viso tum
forte redibat
Eutropio vacuus donis,
feritasque dolore
creverat et, teneris etiam quae
crimina suadet

the gentlest heart to crime, inflamed his savage breast. Taking upon her the similitude of his wife she comes to meet him; proudly she steps forth like the barbarian queen, clothed in linen raiment. Close to her breast a brooch fastened her dress that trailed behind her; she had bound her locks into a coil that a polished circlet confined, and bidden her green snakes turn to gold. She hastens to greet him on his return and throws her snowy arms about his neck, instilling the poison of the furies into his soul by her kisses. Guilefully to stir his rage she asks if the great man has been generous to him; if he brings back rich presents. With tears he recounts his profitless journey, his useless toil, the pride and insults, moreover, which he had to bear at the eunuch's hands. At once she seized the favourable moment, and tearing her cheek with her nails, discloses her complaints.

“Go then, busy thyself with the plough, cleave the soil, bid thy followers lay aside their swords and sweat o'er the harrow. The Gruthungi will make good farmers and will plant their vines in due season. Happy those other women whose glory is seen in the towns their husbands have conquered, they whose adornment is the spoils so

ingeniis, Scythicum pectus
 flammabat egestas. 180
huic sese vultu simulatae
 coniugis offert
mentitoque ferox incedit
 barbara gressu,
carbaseos induta sinus: post
 terga reductas
uberibus propior mordebat
 fibula vestes,
inque orbem tereti mitra
 retinente capillum 185
strinxerat et virides flavescere
 iusserat angues.
advolat ac niveis reducem
 complectitur ulnis
infunditque animo furiale per
 oscula virus.
principe quam largo veniat,
 quas inde reportet
divitias, astu rabiem motura
 requirit. 190
ille iter ingratum, vanos deflere
 labores,
quos super eunuchi fastus, quae
 probra tulisset.
continuo secat ungue genas et
 tempore pandit
adrepto gemitus:
 “I nunc, devotus aratri
scinde solum positoque tuos
 mucrone sodales 195
ad rastros sudare doce. bene
 rura Gruthungus
excolet et certo disponet sidere
 vites.
felices aliae, quas debellata
 maritic

hardly won from an enemy, whose
servants are fair captives of Argos or
Thessaly, and who have won them
slaves from Sparta. Fate has mated
me with too timid, too indolent a
husband, a degenerate who has
forgotten the valour of Ister's tribes,
who deserts his country's ways,
whom a vain reputation for justice
attracts, while he longs to live as a
husbandman by favour rather than as
a prince by plunder. Why give fair
names to shameful weakness?

^{maius}
 oppida, quas ^[200] magnis quaesitae
 viribus ornant
 exuviae, quibus Argivae
 pulchraeque ministrant
 200
 Thessalides, famulas et quae
 meruere Lacenas.
 me nimium timido, nimium
 iunxere remisso
 fata viro, totum qui degener
 exiit Histrum,
 qui refugit patriae ritus, quem
 detinet aequi
 gloria concessoque cupit vixisse
 colonus 205
 quam dominus rapto. quid
 pulchra vocabula pigris

[201]

Cowardice is called loyalty; fear, a sense of justice. Wilt thou submit to humiliating poverty though thou bearest arms? Wilt thou weep unavenged, though so many cities open to thee their undefended gates?

“Dost thou fear the consequences? Rome’s old way was to reward merit and vent on rebels a hate that knew no bound. Now he who breaks a treaty wins riches, while he who observes one lives in want. The ravager of Achaea and recent devastator of defenceless Epirus is lord of Illyria^[111]; he now enters as a friend within the walls to which he was laying siege, and administers justice to those whose wives he has seduced and whose children he has murdered. Such is the punishment meted out to an enemy, such the vengeance exacted for wholesale slaughter—and dost thou still hesitate? Hast thou regard to the small numbers of thy followers? Nay, have done with peace: war will give thee allies. Nor would I urge thee so instantly hadst thou to face men. It is another sex that is in arms against thee; the world has entrusted itself to the protection of eunuchs; ’tis such leaders the eagles and standards of Rome follow. Time it is thou didst return to a barbarian life; be thou in thy turn an object of

praetentas vitiis? probitatis
 inertia nomen,
iustitiae formido subit. tolerabis
 iniquam
pauperiem, cum tela geras? et
 flebis inultus,
cum pateant tantae nullis
 custodibus urbes? 210
 “Quippe metus poenae.
 pridem mos ille vigeat,
ut meritos colerent
 impacatisque rebelles
urgerent odiis; at nunc, qui
 foedera rumpit,
ditatur; qui servat, eget. vastator
 Achivae
gentis et Epirum nuper
 populates inultam 215
praesidet Illyrico; iam, quos
 obsedit, amicos
ingreditur muros illis responsa
 daturus,
quorum coniugibus potitur
 natosque peremit.
sic hostes punire solent, haec
 praemia solvunt
excidiis. cunctaris adhuc
 numerusque tuorum 220
respicis exiguamque manum? tu
 rumpe quietem;
bella dabunt socios. nec te tam
 prona monerem,
si contra paterere viros: nunc
 alter in armis
sexus et eunuchis se
 defensoribus orbis
credidit; hos aquilae
 Romanaeque signa

terror, and let men marvel at thy crimes who despised thy virtues. Laden with booty and plunder thou shalt be a Roman when it pleases thee.”

So saying she suddenly changed into an ill-omened bird, a loathsome sight with its hooked beak and plumage blacker than Hell’s darkness, and perched, a sinister augury, on an old tomb.

So soon as repose from terror came to his freed

[111] Alaric was made *magister militum* in Illyricum: see Introduction, p. x.

romanaeque signa
sequuntur.^[202]

incipere barbaricae tandem te
reddere vitae, 226
te quoque iam timeant
admiranturque
nocentem,
quem sprevere pium. spoliis
praedaeque repletus
cum libeat Romanus eris.”

Sic fata repente
in diram se vertit avem
rostrumque recurvo 230
turpis et infernis tenebris
obscurior alas
auspiciis veteri sedit feralis
sepulchro.
Ille, pavor postquam resolutus
corde quievit

[203]

heart, and his stiffened hair sank down again, he made all haste to carry out the commands of the goddess. He told his followers all that he had seen and urged them to follow him. Rebellious Barbary had found a champion and openly threw off the Latin yoke.

That part of Phrygia which lies towards the north beneath the cold constellation of the Wain borders on Bithynia; that towards the sunset on Ionia, and that towards the sunrise on Galatia. On two sides runs the transverse boundary of Lydia while the fierce Pisidians hem it in to the south. All these peoples once formed one nation and had one name: they were of old called the Phrygians, but (what changes does time not bring about?) after the reign of a king Maeon, were known as Maeones. Then the Greeks settled on the shores of the Aegean, and the Thyni from Thrace cultivated the region now called Bithynia. Not long since a vast army of Gauls, nomads hitherto, came at last to rest in the district; these laid by their spears, clothed them in the civilized robe of Greece and drank no longer from Rhine's, but from Halys', waters. All antiquity gives priority to the Phrygian, even Egypt's king had perforce to recognize it when the

et rigidae sedere comae, non
 distulit atrox
 iussa deae; sociis, quae viderat,
 ordine pandit 235
 inritatque sequi. Coniurat
 barbara pubes
 nacta ducem Latiisque palam
 descivit ab armis.
 Pars Phrygiae, Scythicis
 quaecumque Trionibus
 alget
 proxima, Bithynos, solem quae
 condit, Ionas,
 quae levat, attingit Galatas.
 utrimque propinqui 240
 finibus obliquis Lydi Pisidaeque
 feroces
 continuant australe latus. gens
 una fuere
 tot quondam populi, priscum
 cognomen et unum
 appellata Phryges; sed (quid
 non longa valebit
 permutare dies?) dicti post
 Maeona regem 245
 Maeones. Aegaeos insedit
 Graecia portus;
 Thyni Thraces arant quae nunc
 Bithynia fertur;
 nuper ab Oceano Gallorum
 exercitus ingens
 illis ante vagus tandem
 regionibus haesit
 gaesaque deposuit, Graio iam
 mitis amictu, 250
 pro Rheno poturus Halyn. dat
 cuncta vetustas
 principium Phrygiis; nec rex

babe, nourished at no human breast,
 first opened his lips to lisp the
 Phrygian tongue. ^[112]

Here fell the pipe once hurled into
 the marshes of Libya, what time the
 stream reflected Minerva's
 disfigured countenance. ^[113] Here,
 too, there perished, conquered by
 Apollo's lyre, the shepherd Marsyas
 whose flayed skin brought renown to
 the city of

^[112] The reference is to Herodotus ii.
 2. Psammetichus, King of Egypt,
 wishing to find out which was the most
 ancient nation, had two children reared
 in complete silence. As the first word
 they uttered was "Becos," the Phrygian
 word for "bread," Phrygia was
 accorded the honour.

^[113] Minerva is said to have thrown
 her pipe into the river when she
 observed in the reflection the facial
 contortions apparently necessary to
 play it; cf. Ovid, *Fasti*, vi. 699.

principium Phrygius, nec rex

Aegyptius^[204] ultra

restitit, humani postquam puer
uberis expers

in Phrygiam primum laxavit
murmura vocem.

Hic cecidit Libycis iactata
paludibus olim ²⁵⁵
tibia, foedatam cum reddidit
umbra Minervam,
hic et Apollinea victus testudine
pastor
suspensa memores inlustrat
pelle Celaenas.

[205]

Celaenae. Hence flow four broad auriferous rivers. Small wonder that the waters in which King Midas bathed so often glitter with the rare metal. Two flow north, two southwards. Dindymus gives birth to the river Sangarius, which, swollen by the clear stream of the Gallus, hastens on to the Euxine, the sea of the Amazon. The conjoined streams of Marsyas and Meander make for the Icarian main and Mycale's strand. Marsyas flows fast and straight while his course is his own; mingled with thy waters, Meander, he goes slowly—unlike the Saône whose waters are hastened by the Rhone's inflowing. Between these rivers is a sun-kissed plain; kindly is it to the corn, thick-set with vines and displaying the fruit of the grey-green olive; rich, too, in horses, fertile in flocks, and wealthy with the purple-veined marble that Synnada quarries.

Such was Phrygia then when the gods allowed it to be ravaged by Getic brigands. The barbarian burst in upon those cities so peaceful, so easy of capture. There was no hope of safety, no chance of escape. Long and peaceful ages had made the crumbling stones of their battlements to fall.

quattuor hinc magnis procedunt
fontibus amnes
auriferi; nec miror aquas radiare
metallo, 260
quae totiens lavere Midan.
diversus ad Austrum
cursus et Arctoum fluvii mare.
Dindyma fundunt
Sangarium, vitrei puro qui
gurgite Galli
auctus Amazonii defertur ad
ostia Ponti.
Icarium pelagus Mycalaeaque
litora iuncti 265
Marsya Maeanderque petunt;
sed Marsya velox,
dum suus est, flexuque carens
iam flumine mixtus
mollitur, Maeandre, tuo;
contraria passus,
quam Rhodano stimulatus Arar:
quos inter aprica
planities Cererique favet
densisque ligatur 270
vitibus et glaucae fructus attollit
olivae,
dives equis, felix pecori
pretiosaque picto
marmore purpureis, caedit quod
Synnada, venis.
Talem tum Phrygiam Geticis
populatibus uri
permisere dei. securas barbarus
urbes 275
inrupit facilesque capi. spes
nulla salutis,
nulla fugae: putribus iam
propugnacula saxo

Meanwhile Cybele was seated amid
the hallowed rocks of cold Ida,
watching, as is her wont, the dance,
and inciting the joyous Curetes to
brandish their swords at the sound of
the drum, when, lo, the golden-
turreted crown, the eternal glory of
her blessèd hair, fell from off her
head and, rolling from her brow, the
castellated diadem is profaned in the
dust. The Corybantes stopped in
amazement at this omen; general
alarm checked their orgies and
silenced their pipes. The mother of
the gods wept; then spake thus in
sorrow.

propugnacula saxis
 longo corruerant^[206] deo pacisque
 senecta.
 Interea gelidae secretis
 rupibus Idae
 dum sedet et thiasos spectat de
 more Cybebe 280
 Curetumque alacres ad tympana
 suscitāt enses,
 aurea sanctarum decus
 immortale comarum
 defluxit capiti turris summoque
 volutus
 vertice crinalis violatur pulvere
 murus.
 obstipuerunt truces omen
 Corybantes et uno 285
 fixa metu tacitas presserunt
 orgia buxos.
 indoluit genetrix, tum sic
 commota profatur:

[207]

“This is the portent that aged
 Lachesis foretold long years ago. My
 fallen crown assures me that
 Phrygia’s final crisis is upon her.
 Alas for the blood that shall redden
 Sangarius’ waves; for all the corpses
 that shall retard Meander’s slow
 stream. The hour is fixed
 irrevocably; such, long since, was
 my son’s, the Thunderer’s, will. A
 like disaster awaits the neighbouring
 peoples; in vain does Lydia invoke
 the thyrsus of Bacchus in her
 defence. Now fare thee well, land of
 Phrygia, farewell, walls doomed to
 the flames, walls that now rear aloft
 proud towers but will soon be
 levelled with the ground and the bare
 earth. Farewell, dear rivers: never
 more shall I hold my inspired revels
 in your grottoes; no more shall my
 chariot leave the traces of its wheels
 on Berecynthus’ heights.” So spake
 she, and turned her drums to strains
 of mourning. Attis filled his devoted
 country with holy lamentations and
 Cybele’s tawny lions burst into tears.

Eutropius, although this terrible
 revolt could not be hid and although
 rumour had spread everywhere the
 dread news, none the less affects to
 ignore it and shuts his eyes to the
 empire’s peril. ’Twas some poor
 troop of wandering brigands; such
 wretches call for punishment not

“Hoc mihi iam pridem
Lachesis grandaeva
canebat
augurium: Phrygiae casus
venisse supremos
delapsus testatur apex, heu
sanguine qualis 290
ibit Sangarius quantasque
cadavera lenti
Maeandri passura moras!
immobilis haeret
terminus, haec dudum nato
placueret Tonanti.
par et finitimis luctus,
frustraue Lyaei
non defensuros implorat Lydia
thyrsos. 295
iamque vale Phrygiae tellus
perituraque flammis
moenia, conspicuas quae nunc
attollitis arces,
mox campi nudumque solum!
dilecta valete
flumina! non vestris ultra
bacchabor in antris
nec iuga sulcabit noster
Berecynthia currus.” 300
dixit et ad tristes convertit
tympana planctus.
labentem patriam sacris
ululatibus Attis
personat et torvi lacrimis
maduere leones.
Eutropius, nequeat quamvis
metuenda taceri
clades et trepidus vulgaverit
omnia rumor, 305
ignorare tamen fingit regnumque

war; a judge—so he brags—not a
general should crush their strength.
Even so the great Libyan bird, hard
pressed by the cries of its pursuers,
runs o’er the burning sands and flies
through the dust, curving its wings
like sails to catch the breeze; but
when it clearly hears the footsteps
close behind it, it forgets its flight,
standing with closed eyes and hiding
its head, believing, poor fool, it
cannot be seen by those whom itself
cannot see. None the less Eutropius

ignorat tamen ingit regniq[ue]
ruinas [208]

dissimulat: parvam latronum
errare catervam,
ad sontes tormenta magis quam
tela parari
nec duce frangendas iactat, sed
iudice vires:
vasta velut Libyae venantum
vocibus ales 310
cum premitur calidas cursu
transmittit harenas
inque modum veli sinuatis
flamine pennis
pulverulenta volat; si iam
vestigia retro
clara sonent, oblita fugae stat
lumine clauso
(ridendum!) revoluta caput
creditque latere, 315
quem non ipsa videt. furtim
tamen ardua mittit

[209]

sends towering promises with new gifts, if haply his foe may pause at his entreaty. But the barbarian, in whose heart was once waked the old love of plunder, refuses to submit to a slave; for him the gifts of fear have no charm; haughtily he disdains any rank, [114] even the highest, for under such a consul what honour would not be disgrace?

When Eutropius saw that no prayers could move him nor any gold win him over; when messenger after messenger returned, his mission unfulfilled, and all hopes of an alliance were at an end, he at last recognized the necessity for war and summoned the council to his palace. Thither they came—wanton lads and debauched greybeards whose greatest glory was gluttony, and whose pride it was to diversify the outraged banquet. Their hunger is only aroused by costly meats, and they tickle their palates with foods imported from overseas, the flesh of the many-eyed fowl of Juno, [115] or of that coloured bird brought from farthest Ind that knows how to speak. Not the Aegean, not deep Propontis, not Maeotis' lake afar can sate their appetites with fish. Perfumed garments are their care, their pride to move foolish laughter with their silly jests. On their

cum donis promissa novis, si
forte rogatus
desinat. ille semel nota
dulcedine praedae
se famulo servire negat, nec
grata timentum
munera; militiam nullam nec
prima superbus 320
cingula dignari; nam quis non
consule tali
vilis honos?

Postquam precibus
mitescere nullis,
non auro cessisse videt
creberque recurrit
nuntius incassum nec spes iam
foederis extat:
tandem consilium belli
confessus agendi 325
ad sua tecta vocat. iuvenes
venere protervi
lascivique senes, quibus est
insignis edendi
gloria corruptasque dapes
variasse decorum,
qui ventrem invitant pretio
traduntque palato
sidereas Iunonis aves et si qua
loquendi 330
gnara coloratis viridis defertur
ab Indis,
quaesitos trans regna cibos,
quorumque profundam
ingluviem non Aegaeus, non
alta Propontis,
non freta longinquis Maeotia
piscibus explent.
vestis odoratae studium: laus

adornment and toilette they bestow a
woman's care and find even the silk
they wear too heavy a burden.
Should the Hun, the Sarmatian,
strike at the city's gates yet trouble
they for nought but the theatre.
Rome they despise and reserve their
admiration for their own houses—
may Bosphorus' waters overwhelm
them! Skilful dancers they and
clever judges of charioteers.

Some sprung from the dregs of the
people are generals; some
magistrates—though their legs and

[114] Claudian uses the word *cingulum*
(= a soldier's belt) as = military service
—a not uncommon late use, cf. Serv.
Aen. viii. 724 and (frequently) *cingi* =
to serve, in the Digests.

[115] i.e. the peacock.

vesus odiorum studium, laus

maxima risum 335

per vanos movisse sales

minimeque viriles

munditiae; compti vultus;

onerique vel ipsa

serica. si Chunus feriat, si

Sarmata portas,

solliciti scaenae; Romam

contemnere sueti

mirarique suas, quas Bosphorus

obruat! aedes; 340

saltandi dociles aurigarumque

periti.

Pars humili de plebe duces;

pars compede suras

[211]

ankles are still scarred and livid with their wearing of the fetters of servitude and though their branded foreheads deny their owners' right to office and disclose their true title. Among them Eutropius holds the first place; Hosius, on whom he relies, comes next. He of a truth is more popular, a cunning artificer of justice who knows well how to steam his cases; at times boiling with anger, yet well able to render down that anger when aroused. [\[117\]](#) These sit enthroned, joint rulers of the eastern empire, the one a cook the other a pander. The backs of both are scarred with the whip, each was a slave though of a different kind. The one had been bought and sold a hundred times, the other brought up a dependant in a Spanish household.

When, therefore, the chief men were gathered together for consultation in this strait and to comfort the sickness of the state, forthwith they forget Phrygia and, setting aside the question of war, start their accustomed fooling and engage in disputes about the Circus. With heat as fierce as it is pointless they wrangle what boy can best whirl quivering limbs in an easy somersault or sweep the marble floor with his drooping locks; who can most twist his flanks into a boneless

cruraque signati nigro liventia
 ferro
 iura regunt, facies quamvis
 inscripta repugnet
 seque suo prodat titulo. sed
 prima potestas 345
 Eutropium praefert Hosio
 subnixa secundo.
 dulcior hic sane cunctis
 prudensque movendi
 iuris et admoto qui temperet
 omnia fumo,
 fervidus, accensam sed qui bene
 decoquat iram.
 considunt apices gemini
 dicionis Eoae, 350
 hic cocus, hic leno, defossi
 verbere terga,
 servitio, non arte pares, hic
 saepius emptus,
 alter ad Hispanos nutritus verna
 penates.
 Ergo ubi collecti proceres,
 qui rebus in artis
 consulerent tantisque darent
 solacia morbis, 355
 obliti subito Phrygiae bellisque
 relictis
 ad solitos coepere iocos et
 iurgia circi
 tendere. nequiquam magna
 confligitur ira,
 quis melius vibrata puer
 vertigine molli
 membra rotet, verrat quis
 marmora crine supino?
 360
 quis magis anodes laterum

arch; who can best suit his gestures
 to his words and his eyes to his
 character. Some recite speeches from
 tragedy, others chant the play of
 Tereus, others again that of Agave,
 never before staged.

Eutropius chides them; the present
 moment, says he, demands other
 spectacles than these; it is war which
 now should claim all their care. For
 his part (for he is an old man and a
 weary) it is enough to defend the
 frontiers of Armenia; single-handed

[\[117\]](#) Hosius, by birth a Spaniard, had
 been a slave and a cook—whence these
 various double meanings. He rose to be
magister officiorum at the court of
 Arcadius (circa 396-8).

QUIA HIBETIS ENIM ES TALE TUM
[116] *But artus; I return to the* vulg.
arcus. detorqueat arcus, [116]

quis voci digitos, oculos quis
moribus aptet?

hi tragicos meminere modos;
his fabula Tereus,

his necdum commissa choro
cantatur Agave.

Increpat Eutropius: non haec
spectacula tempus

poscere; nunc alias armorum
incumbere curas; 366

se satis Armenio fessum pro
limite cingi

he cannot cope with all these perils. They must pardon his age and send younger men to the war:—it is as though a hated forewoman were sitting among a crowd of poor working-girls and bidding them in her raucous voice ply the loom and gain their livelihood, while they beg to be allowed the enjoyment of a holiday, to lay aside their tasks and visit their friends; angered at her refusal and wearied of their work they crush the threads in their hands and wipe away their gentle tears with the cloth.

Sudden from out that trembling throng upleaps bold Leo^[118] with his vast bulk, he whose single prowess Cyclopean hunger could scarce match, whom starving Celaeno could not outvie. 'Tis to this fact that he is said to have owed his name. Bold (when his foe was absent), brave (as a speaker), great in bulk but small of heart, once a highly skilled spinner of thread and a cunning carder, none other could so well cleanse the dirt from out the fleece and fill the baskets, none other pull the thick wool over the iron teeth of the comb as could he. He was then Eutropius' Ajax and far and near he raged, shaking not a huge shield compact of seven layers of ox-hide, but that belly of his, laden with continuous

nec tantis unum subsistere
 posse periclis;
 ignoscant senio, iuvenes ad
 proelia mittant:—
 qualis pauperibus nutrix invisae
 puellis 370
 adsidet et tela communem
 quaerere victum
 rauca monet; festis illae lusisse
 diebus
 orant et positis aequaevas visere
 pensis,
 irataeque operi iam lasso pollice
 fila
 turbant et teneros detergent
 stamine fletus. 375
 Emicat extemplo cunctis
 trepidantibus audax
 crassa mole Leo, quem vix
 Cyclopia solum
 aequatura fames, quem non
 ieiuna Celaeno
 vinceret; hinc nomen fertur
 meruisse Leonis.
 acer in absentes linguae
 iactator, abundans 380
 corporis exiguusque animi,
 doctissimus artis
 quondam lanificae, moderator
 pectinis unci.
 non alius lanam purgatis
 sordibus aequae
 praebuerit calathis, similis nec
 pinguia quisquam
 vellera per tenues ferri
 producere rimas. 385
 tunc Ajax erat Eutropii lateque
 frangebatur

feasting, as he sat lazily among old
 dames and distaffs. At length he
 arose and, panting, said, "What
 unwonted sluggishness is this, my
 friends? How long must we sit
 closeted in the women's apartments
 and suffer our perils to increase by
 reason of our sloth? Fate weaves for
 us a network of ill while we waste
 our time in useless vows. This
 difficult task demands my action;
 never was my hand slow to use iron.
 Let but Minerva favour

[\[118\]](#) Gainas and Leo were sent by
 Eutropius to put down the revolt of
 Tarbigilus. Gainas, however, never left
 the Hellespont and Leo, advancing into
 Pamphylia, there met, and was defeated
 by, Tarbigilus (Zosim. v. 16. 5). We
 gather from Claudian that he had once
 been a weaver.

non septem vasto^[214] quatiens
 umbone iuencos,
 sed, quam perpetuis dapibus
 pigroque sedili
 inter anus interque colos
 oneraverat, alvum.
 adsurgit tandem vocemque
 expromit anhelam: 390
 “Quis novus hic torpor, socii?
 quonam usque sedemus
 femineis clausi thalamis
 patimurque periculum
 gliscere desidia? graviorum
 turba malorum
 textitur, ignavis trahimus dum
 tempora votis.
 me petit hic sudor. numquam
 mea dextera segnis
 ad ferrum. faveat tantum
 Tritonia coeptis, 396

[215]

mine attempts and the work begun
 will be the work completed. Now
 will I render proud Tarbigilus, whose
 madness has caused all this turmoil,
 of less weight than a ball of wool,
 the faithless Gruthungi I will drive
 before me like a flock of wretched
 sheep; and when I have restored
 peace I will set the women of
 Phrygia once more beside their
 ancient spinning.”

So saying he sat down again. Great
 clamour and applause filled the
 council-chamber, applause such as
 rises from the rows of spectators in
 the theatre when some curled youth
 impersonates Niobe turned to stone,
 or Hecuba in tears. Straightway Leo
 unfolds his banners and starts on the
 journey whence there is to be no
 return. To the accompaniment of the
 screech-owl’s ill-omened cry he bids
 march the host destined so soon to
 feed the vultures of Mygdonia.

’Tis a well-favoured army,
 enamoured of the city’s shade, ever
 present at the games, anxious to
 shine in the baths, not to bear sun-
 scorch and rain, and oh! how
 different to that former army who,
 ’neath the leadership of Stilicho,
 endured under arms the frosts of
 Thrace and were wont to winter in
 the open air and break with their
 axes the frozen waters of Hebrus for

inceptum peragetur opus. iam
 cuncta furorem
 qui gravat, efficiam leviozem
 pondere lanae
 Tarbigilum tumidum,
 desertoresque
 Gruthungos
 ut miseras populabor oves et
 pace relata 400
 pristina restituum Phrygias ad
 stamina matres.”
 His dictis iterum sedit; fit
 plausus et ingens
 concilii clamor, qualis
 resonantibus olim
 exoritur caveis, quotiens
 crinitus ephebus
 aut rigidam Nioben aut flentem
 Troada fingit. 405
 protinus excitis iter inremeabile
 signis
 adripit infaustoque iubet
 bubone moveri
 agmina Mygdonias mox
 impletura volucres.
 Pulcher et urbanae cupiens
 exercitus umbrae,
 adsiduus ludis, avidus splendore
 lavacris 410
 nec soles imbresve pati,
 multumque priori
 dispar, sub clipeo Thracum qui
 ferre pruinas,
 dum Stilicho regeret, nudoque
 hiemare sub axe
 sueverat et duris haurire
 bipennibus Hebrum.
 cum duce mutatae vires

a draught. Changed is the leader and
 changed their character. Byzantium’s
 luxury and Ancyra’s pomp^[119] have
 destroyed their vigour. No longer
 does the cavalry ride ahead of the
 foot; suitable ground is not chosen
 for camps; no constant change of
 sentries safeguards the ramparts, no
 scouts are sent forward to discover
 which roads to take or which to
 avoid; their evolutions are performed
 without drill or discipline, in
 confusion they stray hither and
 thither amid dark forests, along
 narrow

^[119] *Triumph* is ironical. Claudian
 refers to Eutropius’ pleasure journey to
 Ancyra; cf. l. 98 of this poem.

Cum duce mutatae vires.

Byzantia^[216] robur 415
fregit luxuries Ancyranique
triumphi.
non peditem praecedit eques;
non commoda castris
eligitur regio; vicibus custodia
nullis
advigilat vallo; non explorantur
eundae
vitandaeque viae; nullo se
cornua flectunt 420
ordine: confusi passim per
opaca vagantur
lustra, per ignotas angusto
tramite valles.

[217]

paths in unexplored valleys. So goes a horse that has lost his rider, thus a ship whose helmsman has been drowned is swept to the abyss, chance guiding her and not the stars. So too the sea monster^[120] is dashed to pieces against the rocks when it has lost the comrade fish that swam before it and guided its course through the waves, piloting the great beast with the motion of its tiny tail according to the compact which is between it and its huge companion. Aimlessly the monster swims all unguided through the deep; then, surprised in the shallow water and knowing not how to return to the sea, pants and to no purpose dashes its gaping jaws against the rocks.

Tarbigilus feigns retreat and raises the presumptuous hopes of Leo, then suddenly he bursts all unexpected upon the wine-sodden army, as, overcome by the heavy feast, they brag over their cups of leading the foe in chains. Some are slain as they lift their sluggish limbs from the couch, others know not any break between sleep and death. Others rush pell-mell into a neighbouring swamp and heap the marsh high with their dead bodies. Leo himself, swifter than deer or antelope, fled trembling on his foam-flecked horse, and it falling under his weight Leo sank in

sic vacui rectoris equi, sic orba
 magistro
 fertur in abruptum casu, non
 sidere, puppis;
 sic ruit in rupes amisso pisce
 sodali 425
 belua, sulcandas qui praeuius
 edocet undas
 inmensumque pecus parvae
 moderamine caudae
 temperat et tanto coniungit
 foedera monstro;
 illa natat rationis inops et caeca
 profundi;
 iam brevibus deprensa vadis
 ignara reverti 430
 palpitat et vanos scopulis inludit
 hiatus.
 Tarbigilus simulare fugam
 flatusque Leonis
 spe nutrire leves improvisusque
 repente,
 dum gravibus marcent epulis
 hostique catenas
 inter vina erepant, largo sopita
 Lyaeo 435
 castra subit. pereunt alii, dum
 membra cubili
 tarda levant; alii leto iunxere
 soporem;
 ast alios vicina palus sine more
 ruentes
 excipit et cumulis inmanibus
 aggerat undas.
 ipse Leo damma ceruoque
 fugacior ibat 440
 sudanti tremebundus equo: qui
 pondera postquam

the mire and on all fours fought his
 way through the clinging slime. Held
 up at first by the thick mud, his fat
 body gradually settles down panting
 like a common pig, which, destined
 to grace the coming feast, squeals
 when Hosius arms him with flashing
 knife, and gathers up his garments,
 pondering the while what portions he
 will transfix with spits, which pieces
 of the flesh he will boil and how
 much sea-urchin

[\[120\]](#) The *balaena* or whale. According
 to ancient naturalists the *balaena*
 entered into an alliance with the
musculus or sea-mouse which, in
 Pliny's words, "vada praeantans
 demonstrat oculorumque vice fungitur"
 (Pliny, *H.N.* ix. 186).

pondere postquam
decidit, implicitus^[218] limo
cunctantia pronus
per vada reptabat. caeno
subnixa tenaci
mergitur et pingui suspirat
corpore moles
more suis, dapibus quae iam
devota futuris⁴⁴⁵
turpe gemit, quotiens Hosius
mucrone corusco
armatur cingitque sinus
secumque volutat,
quas figat verubus partes, quae
frusta calenti

[219]

stuffing will be needed to fill the empty skin. The work of preparation goes on apace, Bosphorus echoes to many a blow and the savoury smell envelops Chalcedon.

Suddenly a gentle breeze stirs the foliage behind Leo's back. He thinks it an arrow, and terror, taking a missile's place, does duty for a wound. Untouched and stricken only by fear he breathes his last. Degenerate Roman, by whose advice didst thou exchange the comb for the sword, thine ancestral calling for the field of battle? How much better to praise in safety the work of the weavers at their looms and keep out the cold by means of morning feasts. Here thou hast suffered a wretched death; here, while thou soughtest to shirk thy spinning, the Fates have at last spun for thee the final thread.

Now spreading rumour shakes the palace, pale with terror upon terror. It told how that the army was destroyed, the troops butchered, the plain of Maeonia red with slaughter, Pamphylia and Pisidia o'errun by the enemy. On all sides rings the dread name of Tarbigilus. He is now said to be bearing down upon Galatia, now to be meditating an attack on Bithynia. Some say he has crossed the Taurus and is descending upon Cilicia, others that he has possessed

mandet aquae quantoque cutem
distendat echino.
flagrat opus; crebro pulsatus
perstrepit ictu; ^[121] 450
contextit varius penetrans
Calchedona nidor.
Ecce levis frondes a tergo
concutit aura:
credit tela Leo; valuit pro
vulnere terror
implevitque vicem iaculi,
vitamque nocentem
integer et sola formidine
saucius efflat. 455
quis tibi tractandos pro pectine,
degener, enses,
quis solio campum praeponere
suasit avito?
quam bene texentum laudabas
carmina tutus
et matutinis pellebas frigora
mensis!
hic miserande iaces; hic, dum
tua vellera vitas, 460
tandem fila tibi neverunt ultima
Parcae.
Iam vaga pallentem densis
terroribus aulam
fama quatit; stratas acies, deleta
canebat
agmina, Maeonios foedari
caedibus agros,
Pamphylos Pisidasque rapi.
metuendus ab omni 465
Tarbigilus regione tonat; modo
tendere cursum
in Galatas, modo Bithynis
in summae fortunae

himself of a fleet and is advancing
both by land and sea. Truth is
doubled by panic's fancy; they say
that from the ships far cities are seen
ablaze, that the straits are aglow and
that ashes driven by the wind catch
in the sails of every ship at sea.

Amid all this confusion comes a yet
more terrible

[121] ~~incumbere terui~~
~~sunt qui per Cilicas rupto~~
~~descendere tauro,~~
~~sunt qui correptis ratibus~~
~~terraeque marique~~
~~adventare terant; gemmantur~~
~~vera pavoris~~
~~ingenio: longe spectant~~
~~pupibus urbes~~
~~accensas, lucere fretum~~
 ventoque citatas
 omnibus in pelago velis haerere
 favillas.
 Hos inter strepitus funestior
 advolat alter

rumour—that Babylon is again in arms and, under a new monarch,^[122] threatens our Empire; the Parthians, long inactive, and now scorning slothful ease, seek to put an end to the peace imposed by Rome. Rare among the Medes is the murder of a king, for punishment falls on the regicide's whole family. Thus equal obedience is offered to their overlords, cruel as well as kind. But what would not the year of Eutropius' consulship dare? 'Tis that has stricken down our faithful ally Sapor and roused the Persians' swords against their own king; that has cast the torch of the Furies across the Euphrates, there to kindle rebellion, that no quarter of the globe may escape carnage.

Then indeed men's hearts failed them, their courage ebbed away amid all these storms; surrounded as they were on every side by the din of war, at last they recognized the wrath of heaven and their consul's evil omen, learning too late—schooled by the stubborn issue—their now irrevocable doom. They say that the twin sons of Iapetus formed our first parents of the same materials but with unequal skill. Those whom Prometheus fashioned, and with whose clay he mingled abundant ether, foresee the distant future and,

nuntius: armatam rursus
 Babylona minari 475
 rege novo; resides Parthos
 ignava perosos
 otia Romanae finem iam
 quaerere paci.
 rarus apud Medos regum cruor;
 unaque cuncto
 poena manet generi: quamvis
 crudelibus aequae
 paretur dominis. sed quid non
 audeat annus 480
 Eutropii? socium nobis
 fidumque Saporem
 perculit et Persas in regia
 vulnera movit
 rupturasque fidem, leto pars ne
 qua vacaret,
 Eumenidum taedas trans
 flumina Tigridis egit.
 Tum vero cecidere animi
 tantisque procellis 485
 deficiunt. saepti latrantibus
 undique bellis
 infensos tandem superos et
 consulis omen
 agnovere sui, nec iam
 revocabile damnum
 eventu stolido serum didicere
 magistro.
 namque ferunt geminos uno de
 semine fratres 490
 Iapetionidas generis primordia
 nostri
 dissimili finxisse manu:
 quoscumque
 Prometheus
 excoluit multumque innoxuit

thanks to their more careful making
 by a better workman, are thus
 prepared to meet what fate has in
 store for them. Those framed of
 baser clay by the sorry artificer the
 Greek poets so well call Epimetheus,
 men through whose limbs no
 ethereal vigour spreads—these, like
 sheep, cannot avoid the dangers that
 o’erhang them, nor foresee aught.
 Not till the blow has fallen do they
 protest and weep too late the
 accomplished deed.

[\[122\]](#) Varanes IV., who, like his three
 predecessors, Artaxerxes, Sapor III.,
 and Varanes III., had observed a truce
 with Rome, died in 399 and was
 succeeded by Isdigerdes. For all
 Claudian’s real or simulated anxiety
 this monarch was as peaceably
 disposed as the previous ones (see
 Oros. vii. 34). Claudian seems to have
 made an error in calling him Sapor (l.
 481).

EXCIDIUNT MUTUQUE INLEXUNT

aethera^[222] limo,

hi longe ventura notant
dubiisque parati
casibus occurrunt fabro meliore
politi. 495
deteriore luto pravus quos edidit
auctor,
quem merito Grai perhibent
Epimethea vates,
et nihil aetherii sparsit per
membra vigoris,
hi pecudum ritu non
impendentia vitant
nec res ante vident; accepta
clade queruntur 500
et seri transacta gemunt.

[223]

There now shone forth but one hope of salvation—Stilicho. Him the expectation of whose visits the consciousness of deeds ill-done had ever rendered bitter and unpleasant, him whose approach even as far as the Alps afflicted the Byzantines with fear of death and punishment, all now wish to come, repentant of their former wrongdoing. To him they look as to a star amid this universal shipwreck of war; to him innocent and guilty alike address their prayers. So children whose sire carries merchandise across the sea, wrapt up in their amusements and heedless of their studies, wander afield more joyfully now that their guardian is absent, yet, should a dangerous neighbour invade their defenceless home and seek to drive them forth unprotected as they are from their fireside, *then* they beg their father's help, call upon his name with useless cries and all to no purpose direct their gaze towards the shore.

All admit that they deserve punishment and death for deserting Stilicho and entrusting themselves to the governance of slaves. Long they stood dazed with altered thoughts, and as their senses slowly return they marvel at the results of their own madness and turn away their eyes;

Iam
sola renidet
in Stilichone salus, et cuius
semper acerbum
ingratumque sibi factorum
consciis horror
credidit adventum, quem si
procedere tantum
Alpibus audissent, mortem
poenasque tremebant,
iam cuncti venisse volunt,
scelerumque priorum 506
paenitet; hoc tantis bellorum
sidus in undis
sperant, hoc pariter iusti
sontesque precantur:
ceu pueri, quibus alta pater
trans aequora merces
devehit, intenti ludo studiisque
soluti 510
latius amoto passim custode
vagantur;
si gravis auxilio vacuas
invaserit aedes
vicinus laribusque suis
proturbet inultos,
tum demum patrem implorant et
nomen inani
voce cuncti frustra que oculos ad
litora tendunt. 515
Omnes supplicio dignos
letoque fatentur,
qui se tradiderint famulis
Stilichone relicto.
mutati stupuere diu sensuque
reducto
paulatim proprii mirantur
monstra furoris

flinging down his rods the lictor
shudders, and the dishonoured axes
fall of their own accord. Even so the
Maenads returning to Thebes from
the Aonian mount, their thyrses
dripping with Pentheus' blood,
learning the true character of their
dreadful hunting and seeing the head
cast by the mother herself, hide them
in the darkness and lament the end of
their madness. Thereupon suppliant
Aurora turned her flight towards
powerful Italy, her hair no

avertuntque oculos: proiectis
 ^[224]
 fascibus horret 520
 lictor et infames labuntur sponte
 securae:
 quales Aonio Thebas de monte
 reversae
 Maenades infectis Pentheo
 sanguine thyrsis,
 cum patuit venatus atrox
 matrique rotatum
 conspexere caput, gressus
 caligine figunt 525
 et rabiem desisse dolent. quin
 protinus ipsa
 tendit ad Italiam supplex Aurora
 potentem

longer aureole-crowned and she no
 more bright of countenance nor
 clothed with the saffron of the dawn.
 She stands wan with woe, even as
 when she buried Memnon in his
 Phrygian grave. Stilicho recognized
 her and stayed, well knowing the
 reason of her visit. Long time she
 clasped his victorious hand and at
 length amid tears and sighs
 addressed him.

"Why art thou so wearied of the
 world whereon I shine? Leavest thou
 me thus to be the sport and laughing-
 stock of slaves and carest only for
 Italy, thou that wert once my guide
 and my leader? Since thy victory
 over the tyrant Eugenius I have not
 seen thee. Has victory thus robbed
 me of thee and given thee to Gaul?
 Rufinus was the prime cause of the
 trouble; 'twas he who wrought
 disunion between the two empires.
 But when he aimed at more there
 met him an army returning in
 righteous wrath, an army still strong,
 still mindful of its former prowess.
 For a moment I was dazzled by the
 mirage of liberty: I hoped that
 Stilicho would once more hold the
 reins of our empire. Alas for my
 short-sighted happiness! The world
 had begun to form one single empire
 under the rule of the two brothers
 (for who, with the awful

non radiis redimita comam, non
 flammea vultu
nec croceum vestita diem; stat
 livida luctu,
qualis erat Phrygio tegeret cum
 Memnona busto.
quam simul agnovit Stilicho nec
 causa latebat, 531
restitit; illa manum victricem
 amplexa moratur
altaque vix lacrimans inter
 suspiria fatur:
 “Tantanc te nostri ceperunt
 taedia mundi?
sic me ludibrium famulis
 risumque relinquis 535
dux quondam rectorque meus?
 solamque tueris
Hesperiam? domiti nec te post
 bella tyranni
cernere iam licuit? sic te
 victoria nobis
eripuit Gallisque dedit? Rufinus
 origo
prima mali: geminas inter
 discordia partes 540
hoc auctore fuit. sed iam maiora
 moventi
occurrit iusta rediens exercitus
 ira,
fortis adhuc ferrique memor.
 brevis inde reluxit
falsaque libertas; rursum
 Stilichonis habenis
sperabam me posse regi. pro
 caeca futuri 545
gaudia! fraterno coniungi
 coeperat orbis

example^[123] so fresh in his mind, would dare embark upon a like venture?) when suddenly (it is a monstrous story which scarce bears the telling) a eunuch came forward as Rufinus' heir. Thus fortune brought back my former miseries with this one difference—that of changing my master's sex.

At first he kept his crimes hidden behind the doors of his chamber, an unseen and timid ruler; power was his that all envied, yet only a eunuch's, nor dared he yet arrogate to himself the right of

[123] i.e. that of Rufinus.

coepit orbis
 imperio (quis enim tanto terrore
 recentis
 exempli paribus sese
 committeret ausis?),
 cum subito (monstruosa mihi
 turpisque relatu
 fabula) Rufini castratus prosilit
 heres, 550
 et similes iterum luctus Fortuna
 reduxit,
 ut solum domini sexum mutasse
 viderer.
 “Hic primum thalami
 claustris delicta tegebat
 clam timideque iubens; erat
 invidiosa potestas,
 sed tamen eunuchi, necdum sibi
 publica iura 555

[227]

governing the state or of trampling
 on the laws. But when he had
 banished the good and, retaining the
 dregs of the people, had chosen
 therefrom advisers of no worth;
 when his creature Hosius stood on
 his one side and Leo on the other,
 then indeed his self-confidence
 waxed and his lust for power broke
 forth into open flame. Patrician and
 consul he brought defilement on the
 honours he sold; even greater
 defilement on those he carried
 himself. The very standards and
 trumpets of war grew feeble; a palsy
 seized upon our swords. What
 wonder the nations rejoiced and we
 became the easy prey of any who
 would subdue us? Gone are ploughs
 and ploughmen; the East is more a
 desert than Thrace and snowy
 Haemus. Alas! how many cities, how
 long unused to war's alarms, have
 perished in a single invasion! Not
 long since a mounted band coming
 from Araxes' farthest banks
 threatened the walls of Antioch and
 all but set fire to the chief city of the
 fair province of Syria. Laden with
 spoil and rejoicing in the vast
 carnage it had wrought the band
 returned with none to bar its passage;
 now it pursues its victorious career
 inflicting on me wound upon wound.
 'Tis not now Caucasus nor cold
 Phasis that send forces against me;

sumere nec totas audebat
 vertere leges.
at postquam pulsisque bonis et
 faece retenta
peiores legit socios dignusque
 satelles
hinc Hosius stetit, inde Leo,
 fiducia crevit
regnandique palam flagravat
 aperta libido. 560
patricius, consul maculat quos
 vendit honores,
plus maculat quos ipse gerit.
 iam signa tubaeque
mollescunt, ipsos ignavia fluxit
 in enses.
exultant merito gentes
 facilisque volenti
praeda sumus. iam Bistoniis
 Haemoque nivali 565
vastior expulsis Oriens
 squaescit aratris.
ei mihi, quas urbes et quanto
 tempore Martis
ignaras uno rapuerunt proelia
 cursu!
nuper ab extremo veniens
 equitatus Araxe
terrui Antiochi muros,
 ipsumque decorae 570
paene caput Syriae flammis
 hostilibus arsit.
utque gravis spoliis nulloque
 obstante profunda
lactus caede redit, sequitur
 mucrone secundo
continuum vulnus; nec iam mihi
 Caucasus hostes

wars arise in the very centre of my
empire. Time was when the
Gruthungi formed a Roman legion;
conquered we gave them laws; fields
and dwelling-places we apportioned
them. Now they lay waste with fire
Lydia and the richest cities of Asia,
ay, and everything that escaped the
earlier storm. 'Tis neither on their
own valour or numbers that they
rely; it is our cowardice urges them
on, cowardice and the treason of
generals, through whose guilt our
soldiers now

Caucasus hostes
nec mittit gelidus Phasis;
nascuntur in ipso 575
bella sinu. legio pridem
Romana Gruthungi,
iura quibus victis dedimus,
quibus arva domusque
praeuimus, Lydos Asiaeque
uberrima vastant
ignibus et si quid tempestas
prima reliquit.
nec vi nec numero freti; sed
inertia nutrit 580
proditioque ducum, quorum per
crimina miles

[229]

flee before their own captives,
whom, as Danube's stream well
knows, they once subdued; and those
now fear a handful who once could
drive back all.

Meanwhile the palace devotes its
attention to dances and feasting, and
cares not what be lost so something
remain. But lest our salesman lose
aught by this dismemberment of the
empire he has divided each
remaining province into two, and
forces the two halves, each under its
own governor, to compensate him
for the loss of other provinces. 'Tis
thus they give me back my lost
peoples: by this ingenious device
they increase the number of my
rulers while the lands they should
rule are lost.

In thee is now my only hope; in
place of Minerva's supplicating
branch I offer thee my tears. Help
me in my distress. Save me from this
tyranny of a slave master; do not
condemn all for the fault of a few,
and let not a recent offence cancel
former merits. Grant me now my
request; extreme danger ever
exonerates from blame. Camillus,
though justly angered at his
banishment, forebore not to succour
his country when in flames. I seek
not to draw thee away from Italy;
thou art enough defence for both

captivis dat terga suis, quos
 teste subegit
Danuvio partemque timet qui
 reppulit omnes.
 “Aula choris epulisque vacat
 nec perdita curat,
dum superest aliquid. ne quid
 tamen orbe reciso
venditor amittat, provincia
 quaeque superstes 586
dividitur geminumque duplex
 passura tribunal
cogitur alterius pretium sarcire
 peremptae.
sic mihi restituunt populos; hac
 arte reperta
rectorum numerum terris
 pereuntibus augent. 590
 “In te iam spes una mihi. pro
 fronde Minervae
has tibi protendo lacrimas:
 succurre ruenti,
eripe me tandem, servilibus
 eripe regnis.
neve adeo cunctos paucorum
 crimine damnes
nec nova tot meritis offensa
 prioribus obstet. 595
iamiam flecte animum. suprema
 pericula semper
dant veniam culpa. quamvis
 iratus et exul
pro patriae flammis non distulit
 arma Camillus.
nec te subtrahimus Latio;
 defensor utrique
sufficis. armorum liceat
 splendore tuorum 600

empires. Let both have the benefit of
thine illustrious arms; let the same
shield defend us and one hero work
the salvation of a twofold world”

splendore tuorum
 in commune fru^[230], clipeus nos
 protegat idem
FESCENNINA DE NUPTIIS
 unaque pro gemino desudet
HONORII AUGUSTI
 curam virtus

I. (XI.)

[231]

FESCENNINE VERSES IN
HONOUR OF THE
MARRIAGE OF THE
EMPEROR HONORIUS [\[124\]](#)

I. (XI.)

Prince, fairer than the day-star, who
 shootest thine arrows with an aim
 more sure than the Parthian's, rider
 more daring than the Geloni, what
 praise shall match thy lofty mind,
 what praise thy brilliant beauty?
 Leda would rather have thee her son
 than Castor; Thetis counts thee
 dearer than her own Achilles; Delos'
 isle admits thee Apollo's victor;
 Lydia puts Bacchus second to thee.
 When in the heat of the chase thou
 guidest thy coursing steed amid the
 towering holm-oaks and thy tossing
 locks stream out upon the wind, the
 beasts of their own accord will fall
 before thine arrows and the lion,
 right gladly wounded by a prince's
 sacred hand, will welcome thy spear
 and be proud so to die. Venus scorns
 Adonis returned from the dead,
 Diana disapproves Hippolytus
 recalled to life.

When after thy toils thou seekest the
 shade of a green plane-tree or
 shunnest Sirius' extreme heat in
 some cool grot and freest thy

Princeps corusco sidere
 pulchrior,
 Parthis sagittas tendere doctior,
 eques Gelonis imperiosior,
 quae digna mentis laus erit
 arduae?
 quae digna formae laus erit
 igneae? 5
 te Leda mallet quam dare
 Castorem;
 praefert Achilli te proprio
 Thetis;
 victum fatetur Delos
 Apollinem;
 credit minorem Lydia Liberum.
 tu cum per altas impiger ilices
 10
 praedo citatum cornipedem
 reges
 ludentque ventis instabiles
 comae,
 telis iacebunt sponte tuis ferae
 gaudensque sacris vulneribus
 leo
 admittet hastam morte
 superbior. 15
 Venus reversum spernit
 Adonidem,
 damnat reductum Cynthia
 Virbium.
 Cum post labores sub platani
 voles
 virentis umbra vel gelido specu
 torrentiorem fallere Sirium 20
 et membra somno fessa
 resolveris:
 o quantus uret tum Dryadas
 calor!

wearied limbs in sleep, what a
 passion of love will inflame the
 Dryads' hearts! how many a Naiad
 will steal up with trembling foot and
 snatch an unmarked kiss! Who,

[\[124\]](#) The marriage of Honorius and
 Maria, daughter of Stilicho, took place
 at Milan, Feb. 398.

quot aestuantes ancipiti gradu
 furtiva carpentibus hinc illinc
 Scythis, 25
 quis beluarum corde furentior,
 qui, cum micantem te prope
 viderit,
 non optet ultro servitium pati,
 qui non catenas adripiat libens
 colloque poscat vincula libero?
 tu si nivalis per iuga Caucasii 30
 saevas petisses pulcher
 Amazonas,
 peltata pugnas desereret cohors
 sexu recepto; patris et inmemor
 inter frementes Hippolyte tubas
 strictam securim languida
 poneret 35
 et seminudo pectore cingulum
 forti negatum solveret Herculi,
 bellumque solus conficeret
 decor.
 Beata, quae te mox faciet
 virum 40
 primisque sese iunget amoribus.

II. (XII.)

[233]
 though he be more uncivilized than
 the wild Scythians and more cruel
 even than the beasts, but will, when
 he has seen near at hand thy
 transcendent loveliness, offer thee a
 ready servitude? Who will not
 willingly seize the chains of slavery
 and demand the yoke for a neck as
 yet free? Hadst thou o'er the heights
 of snowy Caucasus gone against the
 cruel Amazons in all thy beauty, that
 warrior band had fled the fight and
 called to mind again their proper sex;
 Hippolyte, amid the trumpets' din,
 forgetful of her sire, had weakly laid
 aside her drawn battle-axe, and with
 half-bared breast loosed the girdle all
 Hercules' strength availed not to
 loose. Thy beauty alone would have
 ended the war.

Blessed is she who will soon call
 thee husband and unite herself to
 thee with the bonds of first love.

II. (XII.)

Come, earth, wreathed about with
 nuptial spring, do honour to thy
 master's marriage-feast. Sing, woods
 and rivers all, sing, deep of ocean.
 Give your blessing, too, Ligurian
 plains and yours, Venetian hills. Let
 Alpine heights on a sudden clothe
 themselves with rose-bushes and the
 fields of ice grow red. Let the Adige

Age cuncta nuptiali
 redimita vere tellus
 celebra toros eriles;
omne nemus cum fluviis,
 omne canat profundum 5
Ligures favete campi,
 Veneti favete montes,
 subitisque se rosetis
 vestiat Alpinus apex
 et rubeant pruinae. 10
Athesis strepat choreis
 calamisque flexuosus
 leve Mincius susurret

re-echo the sound of choric lays and
meandering Mincius whisper gently
through his

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et Padus electriferis
admoduletur alnis; 15
epulisque iam repleto
resonet Quirite Thybris
dominique laeta votis
aurea septemgeminas
Roma coronet arces. 20
procul audiant Hiberi,
fluit unde semen aulae,
ubi plena laurearum
imperio feta domus
vix numerat triumphos. 25
habet hinc patrem maritus,
habet hinc puella matrem
gemmaeque parte ductum
Caesareum flumineo
stemma recurrit ortu. 30
decorent virecta Bactim,
Tagus intumescat auro
generisque procreator
sub vitreis Oceanus
luxurietur antris. 35
Oriensque regna fratrum
simul Occidensque
plaudat;
placide iocentur urbes,
quaeque novo quaeque nitent
deficiente Phoebus. 40
Aquiloniae procellae,
rabidi tacete Cauri,
taceat sonorus Auster.
solus ovantem Zephyrus
perdominetur annum. 45

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reeds and Padus make answer with
his amber-dripping alders. Let
Tiber's banks now ring with the
voices of Rome's full-fed citizens
and the golden city, rejoicing in her
lord's marriage, crown her seven
hills with flowers.

Let Spain hear afar, Spain the cradle
of the imperial race, where is a house
that is mother of emperors, rich in
crowns of laurel, whose triumphs
can scarce be numbered. Hence
came the bridegroom's sire, hence
the bride's mother; from either
branch flows the blood of the
Caesars, like twin streams reunited.
Let rich herbage clothe Baetis' banks
and Tagus swell his golden flood;
may Ocean, ancestor of the imperial
race, make merry in his crystal
caves. Let East and West, the two
brothers' realms, join in their
applause, and peace and joy fill the
cities illumined by the sun at his
rising and at his setting. Be still, ye
storms of the north and ye mad
blasts of Caurus; sounding Auster,
sink to rest. Let Zephyrus have sole
rule over this year of triumph.

III. (XIII.)

Solitas galea fulgere comas,
 Stilicho, molli necte corona.
 cessent litui saevumque procul
 Martem felix taeda releget.
 tractus ab aula rursus in aulam 5
 redeat sanguis. patris officiis
 iunge potenti pignora dextra.
 gener Augusti pridem fueras,
 nunc rursus eris socer Augusti.
 quae iam rabies livoris erit? 10
 vel quis dabitur color invidiae?
 Stilicho socer est, pater est
 Stilicho.

IV. (XIV.)

III. (XIII.)

Twine with a soft garland, Stilicho,
 the locks whereon a helmet is wont
 to shine. Let the trumpets of war
 cease and the propitious torch of
 marriage banish savage Mars afar.
 Let regal blood unite once more with
 regal blood. Perform a father's office
 and unite these children with thine
 illustrious hand. Thou didst marry an
 emperor's daughter, now, in turn, thy
 daughter shall marry an emperor.
 What room is here for the madness
 of jealousy? What excuse for envy?
 Stilicho is father both of bride and
 bridegroom.

IV. (XIV.)

Hesperus, loved of Venus, rises and
 shines for the marriage with his
 Idalian^[125] rays. Maiden shame now
 overcomes the anxious bride; her
 veil now shows traces of innocent
 tears. Hesitate not to be close in
 thine attacks, young lover, e'en
 though she oppose thee savagely
 with cruel finger-nail. None can
 enjoy the scents of spring nor steal
 the honey of Hybla from its
 fastnesses if he fears that thorns may
 scratch his face. Thorns arm the rose
 and bees find a defence for their
 honey. The refusals of coyness do

Attollens thalamis Idalium
iubar
dilectus Veneri nascitur
Hesperus.
iam nuptae trepidat sollicitus
pudor,
iam produnt lacrimas flammea
simplices.
ne cessa, iuvenis, comminus
adgredi, 5
impacata licet saeviat unguibus.
non quisquam fruitur veris
odoribus
Hyblaeos latebris nec spoliat
favos,
si fronti caveat, si timeat rubos;
armat spina rosas, mella tegunt
apes. 10
crescunt difficili gaudia iurgio
accenditque magis, quae
refugit, Venus.
quod flenti tuleris, plus sapit
osculum.
dices “o!” quotiens, “hoc mihi
dulcius
quam flavos deciens vincere
Sarmatas!” 15

but increase the joy; the desire for
that which flies us is the more
inflamed; sweeter is the kiss
snatched through tears. How oft wilt
thou say: “Better this than ten
victories over the yellow-haired
Sarmatae”!

[125] Idalian: from Idalium, a
mountain in Cyprus, sacred to Venus.

Breathe a new loyalty into your breasts and let your senses kindle a flame that shall never be extinguished. May your clasped hands form a bond more close than that betwixt ivy and leafy oak tree or poplar and pliant vine. Be the frequent kisses that ye give and receive breathed more softly than those of plaintive doves, and when lips have united soul to soul let sleep still your throbbing breath. Be the purple couch warm with your princely wooing, and a new stain ennoble coverlets ruddy with Tyrian dye. Then leap victorious from the marriage-bed, scarred with the night's encounter.

All night long let the music of the flute resound and the crowd, set free from law's harsh restraints, with larger licence indulge the permitted jest. Soldiers, make merry with your leaders, girls with boys. Be this the cry that re-echoes from pole to pole, among the peoples, over the seas: "Fair Honorius weds with Maria."

Adspirate novam pectoribus
fidem
mansuramque facem tradite
sensibus.
tam iunctis manibus nectite
vincula,
quam frondens hederæ stringitur
aesculus,
quam lento premitur palmitæ
populus, 20
et murmur querula blandius
alite
linguis adsiduo reddite mutuis.
et labris animum conciliantibus
alternum rapiat somnus
anhelitum.
amplexu caleat purpura regio 25
et vestes Tyrio sanguine
fulgidas
alter virgineus nobilitet cruor.
tum victor madido prosilias toro
nocturni referens vulnera
proelii.
Ducant pervigiles carmina
tibiae 30
permissisque iocis turba
licentior
exultet tetricis libera legibus.
passim cum ducibus ludite
milites,
passim cum pueris ludite
virgines.
haec vox aetheriis insonet
axibus, 35
haec vox per populos, per mare
transeat:
“formosus Mariam ducit
Honorius ”

**EPITHALAMIUM DE
NUPTIIS HONORII
AUGUSTI**

PRAEFATIO

(IX.)

**EPITHALAMIUM OF
HONORIUS AND MARIA**

PREFACE

(IX.)

When Pelion reared his height to form a bridal chamber with long-drawn arches, and his hospitable land could not contain so many gods; when Nereus, sire of the bride, and all the throng of her sisters strove to link day to day with feastings; when Chiron, lying at ease with his horse-flanks curled under him, offered the loving-cup to Jove; when Peneus turned his cold waters to nectar and frothing wine flowed down from Oeta's summit, Terpsichore struck her ready lyre with festive hand and led the girlish bands into the caves. The gods, the Thunderer himself, disdained not these songs, for they knew that lovers' vows ever harmonized with tender strains. Centaurs and Fauns would have none of it: what lyre could touch Rhoetus or move inhuman Pholus?

The seventh day had flamed in heaven, seven times had Hesperus relumed his lamp and seen the dances completed; then Phoebus touched his lyre with that nobler

Surgeret in thalamum ducto
cum Pelion arcu
nec caperet tantos hospita
terra deos,
cum socer aequoreus
numerosaque turba
sororum
certarent epulis continuare
dies
praeberetque Iovi communia
pocula Chiron, 5
molliter obliqua parte refusus
equi,
Peneus gelidos mutaret nectare
fontes,
Oetaeis fluerent spumaea vina
iugis:
Terpsichore facilem lascivo
pollice movit
barbiton et molles duxit in
antra choros. 10
carmina nec superis nec
displicuere Tonanti,
cum teneris nossent congrua
vota modis.
Centauri Faunique negant. quae
flectere Rhoeton,
quae rigidum poterant plectra
movere Pholum?

Septima lux aderat caelo
totiensque renato 15
viderat exactos Hesperus
igne choros:
tum Phoebus, quo saxa domat,
quo pertrahit ornos,
pectine temptavit nobiliore
lvram

quill, wherewith he leads captive
rocks and mountain-ashes, and sang
to his sacred strings now the
promised birth of Achilles, now the
slaughter of the Trojans and the river
Simois. The happy marriage-cry re-
echoed o'er leafy Olympus, and
Othrys and Ossa gave back their
mistress Thetis' name.

venturumque ^[242] sacris fidibus iam
 spondet Achillem,
 iam **EPITHALAMIUM**
 Simoënta canit. 20
 frondoso strepuit felix
 (X.)
 Hymenaeus Olympo;
 reginam resonant Othrys et
 Ossa Thetim.

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EPITHALAMIUM

(X.)

Unfelt before was the fire the
 Emperor Honorius had conceived for
 his promised bride, and he burned,
 all unexperienced, with passion's
 first fever, nor knew whence came
 the heat, what meant the sighs—a
 tyro and as yet ignorant of love.
 Hunting, horses, javelins—for none
 of these he now cares nor yet to fling
 the spear; Love's wound occupies all
 his thoughts. How often he groaned
 from the very heart; how often a
 blush, mantling to his cheeks,
 betrayed his secret; how often,
 unbidden of himself, his hand would
 write the loved one's name. Already
 he prepares gifts for his betrothed
 and selects to adorn her (though their
 beauty is less than hers) the jewels
 once worn by noble Livia of old and
 all the proud women of the imperial
 house. The impatient lover chafes at
 the delay; the long days seem as
 though they stood still and the moon
 as though she moved not her slow
 wheel. Thus Deidamia, girl of
 Scyros, e'er yet she sees through his
 disguise, inflamed with love the
 young Achilles, and taught his
 warrior hands to draw the slender
 thread and passed her rosy fingers

Hauserat insolitos promissae
 virginis ignes
Augustus primoque rudis
 flagraverat aestu;
nec novus unde calor nec quid
 suspiria vellent,
noverat incipiens et adhuc
 ignarus amandi.
non illi venator equus, non
 spicula curae, 5
non iaculum torquere libet;
 mens omnis aberrat
in vulnus, quod fixit Amor.
 quam saepe medullis
erupit gemitus! quotiens
 incanduit ore
confessus secreta rubor
 nomenque beatum
iniussae scripsere manus! iam
 munera nuptae 10
praeparat et pulchros Mariae
 sed luce minores
eligit ornatus, quidquid
 venerabilis olim
Livia divorumque nurus gessere
 superbae.
incusat spes aegra moras
 longique videntur
stare dies segnemque rotam non
 flectere Phoebe. 15
Scyria sic tenerum virgo
 flammabat Achillem
fraudis adhuc expers
 bellatricesque docebat
ducere fila manus et, mox quos
 horruit Ide,
Thessalicos roseo nectebat
 pollice crines

through the locks of that Thessalian
of whom all Ida was soon to stand in
awe.

Thus too he communed with
himself: "How long

prince comes.

Haec etiam ^[244]queritur secum:

“quonam usque
verendus 20

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will honoured Stilicho forbear to grant my prayers? Why postpones he the union of those whose love he has approved? Why should he refuse to fulfil my chaste desires? I follow not the example of luxurious princes in seeking the beauties of a pictured countenance, whereby the pander canvass may pass from house to house to make known the charms demanded; nor yet have I sought to choose the uncertain object of my love from this house or from that, and thus entrusted to deceptive wax the difficult selection of a bride. I sever not in violence the bonds that unite a wedded woman to her lord; her I seek who hath long been betrothed to me, who by a father's orders was left my affianced bride and who through her mother shares with me a common grandsire. A suppliant I have laid aside my rank and acted the suitor. Princes, second only to myself in rank, have I sent from my imperial palace to present my petition. 'Tis no small thing I ask, Stilicho; that I admit; yet surely to me, an emperor, son of that other emperor who, by giving thee his brother's adopted daughter to wife, made thee his son-in-law,—to me thou dost owe Maria. Pay back to the son the interest due to his sire; restore to the palace those who are

cunctatur mea vota socer? quid
iungere differt,
quam pepigit, castasque preces
implere recusat?
non ego luxuriam regum
moremque secutus
quaesivi vultum tabulis^[126] ut
nuntia formae
lena per innumeros iret pictura
penates, 25
nec variis dubium thalamis
lecturus^[127] amorem
ardua commisi falsae conubia
cerae.
non rapio praeceps alienae
foedera taedae,
sed quae sponsa mihi pridem
patrisque relictæ
mandatis uno materni sanguinis
ortu 30
communem partitur avum.
fastidia supplex
deposui gessique procum; de
limine sacro
oratum misi proceres, qui
proxima nobis
iura tenent. fateor, Stilicho, non
parva poposci,
sed certe mereor princeps, hoc
principe natus 35
qui sibi te generum fraterna
prole revinxit,
cui Mariam debes. faenus mihi
solve paternum,
redde suos aulae. mater fortasse
rogari
mollior. o patrui germen, cui

its own. Mayhap her mother^[128] will
be less inexorable. Daughter of mine
uncle Honorius, whence I derive my
name, chief glory of the land of
swift-flowing Ebro, cousin by birth,
by mother's love a mother, to thy
care was mine infancy entrusted, in
thine arms I grew to boyhood; save
for my birth thou, rather than
Flacilla, art my mother. Why dost
thou separate thy two

^[128] Serena, daughter of Honorius, the
elder, the brother of Theodosius the
Great. Theodosius adopted Serena so
that by adoption Honorius and Serena
were brother and sister, by birth
cousins. Serena was probably born in
376; Honorius not till Sept. 9, 384.

[126] ~~nominis heres~~ ^{tabulis vulg.} ~~thalamis~~
with the better ^{with} ~~sublimis~~ decus

[127] ~~torrentis Hiberi~~ ^{torrentis Hiberi 40; other}
mss. ~~lecturus~~ stirpe soror, pietate parens, tibi

creditus infans
inque tuo crevi gremio,
partuque remoto
tu potius Flaccilla mihi. quid
dividis ergo

children? Why not bestow a daughter born upon an adopted son? Will the longed-for day ever come; the marriage-night ever be sanctioned?"

With such complaint he assuages the wounds of love. Cupid laughed and speeding across the deep bore the news to his gentle mother, proudly spreading his wings to their full extent.

Where Cyprus looks out over the Ionian main a craggy mountain overshadows it; unapproachable by human foot it faces the isle of Pharos, the home of Proteus and the seven mouths of the Nile. The hoar frost dares not clothe its sides, nor the rude winds buffet it nor clouds obscure. It is consecrate to pleasure and to Venus. The year's less clement seasons are strangers to it, whereover ever brood the blessings of eternal spring. The mountain's height slopes down into a plain; that a golden hedge encircles, guarding its meadows with yellow metal. This demesne, men say, was the price paid by Mulciber for the kisses of his wife, these towers were the gift of a loving husband. Fair is the enclosed country, ever bright with flowers though touched with no labouring hand, for Zephyr is husbandman enough therefor. Into its shady groves no bird may enter save such

pignora? quid iuveni natam non
reddis alumno?
optatusne dies aderit? dabiturne
iugalis 45
nox umquam?"

Tali solatur
vulnera questu.
risit Amor placidaeque volat
trans aequora matri
nuntius et totas iactantior
explicat alas.

Mons latus Ionium Cypri
praeruptus obumbrat,
inuius humano gressu,
Phariumque cubile 50
Proteos et septem despectat
cornua Nili.

hunc neque candentes audent
vestire pruinae,
hunc venti pulsare timent, hunc
laedere nimbi.

luxuriae Venerique vacat. pars
acrior anni
exulat; aeterni patet indulgentia
veris. 55

in campum se fundit apex; hunc
aurea saepes
circuit et fulvo defendit prata
metallo.

Mulciber, ut perhibent, his
oscula coniugis emit
moenibus et tales uxorius
obtulit arces.

intus rura micant, manibus quae
subdita nullis 60
perpetuum florent, Zephyro
contenta colono,

umbrosaeque nemus, quo non

as has first won the goddess'
approval for its song. Those which
please her may flit among the
branches; they must quit who cannot
pass the test. The very leaves live for
love and in his season every happy
tree experiences love's power: palm
bends down to mate with palm,
poplar sighs its passion for poplar,
plane whispers to plane, alder to
alder.

Here spring two fountains, the one of
sweet water, the other of bitter,
honey is mingled with the first,
poison with the second, and in these
streams 'tis said

umbrosamque nemus, quo non
admittitur^[248] ales,
ni probet ante suos diva sub
iudice cantus:
quae placuit, fruitur ramis; quae
victa, recedit.
vivunt in Venerem frondes
omnisque vicissim 65
felix arbor amat; nutant ad
mutua palmae
foedera, populeo suspirat
populus ictu
et platani platanis alnoque
adsibilat alnus.
Labuntur gemini fontes, hic
dulcis, amarus
alter, et infusis corrumpunt
mella venenis, 70

[249]

that Cupid dips his arrows. A thousand brother Loves with quivers play all around upon the banks, a tender company like to Cupid himself in face and of equal age. The nymphs are their mothers; Cupid is the only child of golden Venus. He with his bow subdues the stars and the gods and heaven, and disdains not to wound mighty kings; of the others the common people is the prey. Other deities, too, are here: Licence bound by no fetters, easily moved Anger, Wakes dripping with wine, inexperienced Tears, Pallor that lovers ever prize, Boldness trembling at his first thefts, happy Fears, unstable Pleasure, and lovers' Oaths, the sport of every lightest breeze. Amid them all wanton Youth with haughty neck shuts out Age from the grove.

Afar shines and glitters the goddess' many-coloured palace, green gleaming by reason of the encircling grove. Vulcan built this too of precious stones and gold, wedding their costliness to art. Columns cut from rock of hyacinth support emerald beams; the walls are of beryl, the high-built thresholds of polished jasper, the floor of agate trodden as dirt beneath the foot. In the midst is a courtyard rich with fragrant turf that yields a harvest of

unde Cupidineas armari fama
sagittas.
mille pharetrati ludunt in margine
fratres,
ore pares, aevo similes, gens
mollis Amorum.
hos Nymphae pariunt, illum
Venus aurea solum
edidit. ille deos caelumque et
sidera cornu 75
temperat et summos dignatur
figere reges;
hi plebem feriunt. nec cetera
numina desunt:
hic habitat nullo constricta
Licentia nodo
et flecti faciles Irae vinoque
madentes
Excubiae Lacrimaeque rudes et
gratus amantum 80
Pallor et in primis titubans
Audacia furtis
iucundique Metus et non secura
Voluptas;
et lasciva volant levibus Periuria
ventis.
quos inter petulans alta cervice
Iuventas
excludit Senium luco. 85

Procul

atria divae
permutant radios silvaeque
obstante virescunt.
Lemnius haec etiam gemmis
extruxit et auro
admiscens artem pretio
trabibusque smaragdi
supposuit caesas hyacinthi rursus

perfume; there grows sweet
spikenard and ripe cassia, Panchaeon
cinnamon-flowers and sprays of
oozy balm, while balsam creeps
forth slowly in an exuding stream.

Hither Love glided down, winging
his way o'er the long journey.
Joyfully and with prouder gait than
e'er his wont he enters. Venus was
seated on her glittering throne, tiring
her hair. On her right hand and on
her left stood the Idalian sisters. [129]
Of these one pours a rich stream of
nectar over Venus'

[129] i.e. the Graces.

supposita caesas hyacinthi rupe
columnas.^[250]

beryllo paries et iaspide lubrica
surgunt 90
limina despectusque solo calcatur
achates.
in medio glaebis redolentibus
area dives
praebet odoratas messes; hic
mitis amomi,
hic casiae matura seges,
Panchaeaque turgent
cinnama, nec sicco frondescunt
vimina costo 95
tardaue sudanti prorepunt
balsama rivo.
Quo postquam delapsus Amor
longasque peregit
penna vias, alacer passuque
superbior intrat.
caesariem tunc forte Venus
subnixa corusco
fingebat solio. dextra laevaue
sorores 100
stabant Idaliae: largos haec
nectaris imbres

[251]

head, another parts her hair with a fine ivory comb. A third, standing behind the goddess, braids her tresses and orders her ringlets in due array, yet carefully leaving a part untended; such negligence becomes her more. Nor did her face lack the mirror's verdict; her image is reflected over all the palace and she is charmed wheresoever she looks. While she surveys each detail and approves her beauty she notes the shadow of her son as he approaches and catches the fierce boy to her fragrant bosom. "Whence comes thy joy?" she asks; "cruel child, what battles hast thou fought? What victim has thine arrow pierced? Hast thou once more compelled the Thunderer to low among the heifers of Sidon? Hast thou overcome Apollo, or again summoned Diana to a shepherd's cave? Methinks thou hast triumphed over some fierce and potent god."

Hanging upon his mother's kisses he answered: "Mother, be thou glad; a great victory is ours. Now has Honorius felt our arrows. Thou knowest Maria and her sire, the general whose spear protects Gaul and Italy; the fame of noble Serena is not hidden from thee. Haste thee, assent to their princely prayers and seal this royal union."

inrigat, haec morsu numerosi
 dentis eburno
 multifidum discrimen arat; sed
 tertia retro
 dat varios nexus et iusto dividit
 orbes
 ordine, neglectam partem
 studiosa relinquens: 105
 plus error decuit. speculi nec
 vultus egebat
 iudicio; similis tecto monstratur
 in omni
 et capitur^[130] quocumque videt.
 dum singula cernit,
 seque probat, nati venientis
 conspicit umbram
 ambrosioque sinu puerum
 complexa ferocem 110
 “quid tantum gavisus?” ait;
 “quae proelia sudas
 improbe? quis iacuit telis?
 iterumne Tonantem
 inter Sidonias cogis mugire
 iuuencas?
 an Titana domas? an pastoralia
 Lunam
 rursus in antra vocas? durum
 magnumque videris
 debellasse deum.” 116
 Suspensus
 in oscula matris
 ille refert: “Laetare, parens;
 inmane tropaeum
 rettulimus, nostrum iam sensit
 Honorius arcum.
 scis Mariam patremque ducem,
 qui cuspide Gallos
 Italiamque feret, nos te

Cytherea freed her from her son's
 embrace, hastily bound up her hair,
 gathered up her flowing dress and
 girt herself about with the divine
 girdle whose all-compelling charm
 can stay the rain-swollen torrent and
 appease the sea, the winds and angry
 thunderbolts. Soon as she stood on
 the shore she thus addressed her
 small foster-children. “Come,
 children, which of you will plunge
 beneath the glassy wave and
 summon me hither fleet Triton to
 bear me

Ita huiusque Iovis, nec Ie
[150] Bnt, following the mss., rapitur;
capitur praecleara Serenae
fama latet. propera, regalibus
adnue votis:
iunge toros.”

Gremio natum
Cytherea removit
et crines festina ligat
peplumque fluentem
adlevat et blando spirantem
numine ceston
cingitur, impulsos pluviis quo
mitigat amnes, 125
quo mare, quo ventos irataque
fulmina solvit.
ut stetit ad litus, parvos adfatur
alumnos:
“Heus! quis erit, pueri,
vitreas qui lapsus in
undas
huc rapidum Tritona vocet, quo
vecta per altum

quickly o'er the deep? Never will he
 have come to do us better service.
 Sacred is the marriage that I seek.
 Make all speed in your search; may
 be the Libyan sea rings to his conch,
 may be he cleaves the Aegean main.
 Whoso shall find and bring him
 hither shall have a golden quiver as a
 reward."

She spake and, dividing into various
 bands, the scouts set out. Triton was
 swimming beneath the waves of the
 Carpathian sea, pursuing reluctant
 Cymothoë. She feared her rough
 lover and eluded his pursuit, her wet
 form gliding through the embraces
 of his strong arms. One of the Loves
 espied him and cried, "Stay! the
 deeps cannot hide your amours.
 Make ready to carry our mistress; as
 a reward for thy services (and 'tis no
 meagre one) thou shalt have
 Cymothoë, a complaisant mistress
 shall she be though she flout thee
 now. Come and win thy
 recompense."

The dread monster uprose from the
 abyss; his billowing hair swept his
 shoulders; hoofs of cloven horn
 grown round with bristles sprang
 from where his fishy tail joined his
 man's body. He swam three strokes
 and at the fourth stranded upon the
 shore of Cyprus. To shade the
 goddess the monster arched back his

deferar? haud umquam tanto
 mihi venerit usu. 130
 sacri, quos petimus, thalami.
 pernicius omnes
 quaerite, seu concha Libycum
 circumsonat aequor,
 Aegaeas seu frangit aquas.
 quicumque repertum
 duxerit, aurata donabitur ille
 pharetra.”
 Dixerat et sparsa diversi
 plebe feruntur 135
 exploratores. pelagi sub
 fluctibus ibat
 Carpathiis Triton
 obluctantemque petebat
 Cymothoën. timet illa ferum
 sesequē sequenti
 subripit et duris elabatur uda
 lacertis.
 “heus,” inquit speculatus Amor,
 “non vestra sub imis
 furta tegi potuere vadis.
 accingere nostram 141
 vecturus dominam: pretium non
 vile laboris
 Cymothoën facilem, quae nunc
 detrectat, habebis.
 hac mercede veni.”
 Prorupit
 gurgite torvus
 semifer; undosi verrebant
 brachia crines; 145
 hispida tendebant bifido
 vestigia cornu,
 qua pistrix commissa viro. ter
 pectora movit;
 iam quarto Danhiae tractu

tail; then his back, rough with living
 purple, was bedded with scarlet
 coverlets; resting in such a retreat
 does Venus voyage, her snowy feet
 just dipping in the sea. A great
 company of wingèd Loves fly after
 her, troubling the calm surface of
 Ocean. Neptune's palace is all
 adorned with flowers. Leucothoë,
 daughter of Cadmus, sports on the
 water, and Palaemon drives his
 dolphin with a bridle of roses.
 Nereus sets violets here

toris A, followed by Birt; but
[131] sulcabat harenas.
rosis VP is intrusive.

umbratura deam retro sinuatur
[132] antro P¹; vulg. ostro.
in arcum

belua; tum vivo squalentia

murice terga 150

purpureis mollita toris [131]: hoc

navigat antro [132]

fulta Venus; niveae delibant

aequora plantae.

prosequitur volucer late

comitatus Amorum

tranquillumque choris quatitur

mare.serta per omnem

Neptuni dispersa domum.

Cadmeia ludit 155

Leucothoë, frenatque rosis

delphina Palaemon;

alternas violis Nereus interserit

algas;

and there among the seaweed and Glaucus wreathes his grey hair with deathless flowers. Hearing the tale the Nereids, too, came mounted on various beasts: one (maiden above but fish below) rides the dread sea-tiger of Tartessus; another is carried by that fierce ram, the terror of the Aegean, who shatters ships with his forehead; a third bestrides the neck of a sea-lion; another is borne along by the sea-calf to which she clings. They vie with one another in bringing gifts to the newly-wedded pair. Cymothoë presents a girdle, Galatea a precious necklace, Psamathe a diadem heavily encrusted with pearls gathered by herself from the depths of the Red Sea. Doto suddenly dives to gather coral, a plant so long as it is beneath the water, a jewel once it is brought forth from the waves.

The nude crowd of Nereids throng around Venus, following her and singing praises after this manner: "We beg thee, Venus, our queen, to bear these our gifts, these adornments, to queen Maria. Tell her that never did Thetis receive their like nor even our sister Amphitrite when she espoused our Jupiter. [\[133\]](#) Let the daughter of Stilicho hereby realize the devotion of the sea and know that Ocean is her slave. 'Tis

canitiem Glaucus ligat
 inmortalibus herbis.
 nec non et variis vectae
 Nereides ibant
 audito rumore feris (hanc pisce
 voluta 160
 sublevat Oceani monstrum
 Tartesia tigris;
 hanc timor Aegaei rupturus
 fronte carinas
 trux aries; haec caeruleae
 suspensa leaenae
 innatat; haec viridem trahitur
 complexa iuvenum)
 certatimque novis onerant
 conubia donis. 165
 cingula Cymothoë, rarum
 Galatea monile
 et gravibus Psamathe baxis
 diadema ferebat
 intextum, Rubro quas legerat
 ipsa profundo.
 mergit se subito vellitque
 corallia Doto:
 vimen erat dum stagna subit;
 processerat undis: 170
 gemma fuit.

 Nudae Venerem
 cinxere catervae
 plaudentesque simul tali cum
 voce sequuntur:
 “hos Mariae cultus, haec
 munera nostra precamur
 reginae regina feras. dic talia
 numquam
 promeruisse Thetis nec cum
 soror Amphitrite 175
 nostro nupta Iovi devotum

we who bore up her father's fleet,
 the hope of his victorious land, what
 time he set out to avenge the ruined
 Greeks.”

And now Triton's foam-flecked
 breast had touched the Ligurian
 shore and his wearied coils were
 extended over the surface of the
 water. Straightway Venus flew high
 in the air to the city founded by the
 Gauls, the city that shows as its
 device the fleece-covered pelt of a
 sow.^[134] At the coming of the
 goddess the routed clouds retire;
 bright shine the Alps beneath

^[133] i.e. Neptune.

^[134] Milan; cf. Isid. *Orig.* XV. 1
vocatum Mediolanum ab eo, quod ibi
sus in medio lanæ perhibetur inventa;
 Sidon. *Apol.* vii. 17 *et quæ lanigero de*
sue nomen habent.

nostro nupta Iovi. devotum

sentiat^[256] aequor,

agnoscat famulum virgo

Stilichonia pontum.

victrices nos saepe rates

classemque paternam

veximus, attritis cum tenderet

ultor Achivis.”

Iam Ligurum terris

spumantia pectora

Triton 180

adpulerat lassosque fretis

extenderat orbes.

continuo sublime volans ad

moenia Gallis

condita, lanigeri suis ostentantia

pellem,

pervenit. adventu Veneris

pulsata recedunt

nubila, clarescunt puris

Aquilonibus Alpes. 185

[257]

the clear North wind. The soldier rejoices though he cannot tell why. The standards of war burgeon with red flowers and the spears on a sudden sprout with living leaves. Then Venus thus addresses her attendant throng. “Comrades mine, keep away for a while the god of war that the palace may be mine and mine alone. Banish afar the terror of the flashing breastplate; let its scabbard sheath the threatening sword. Advance not the standards of war, the eagles and savage dragons. This day the camp shall yield to my standards; the flute shall sound instead of the bugle, the soft strains of the happy lyre take the place of the trumpets’ blare. Let the soldiers feast even when on guard and the beakers foam in the midst of arms. Let regal majesty lay by its awful pride and power, disdaining not to associate with the people, make one the nobles with the crowd. Let joy be unrestrained and sober Law herself be not ashamed to laugh.

“Hymen, choose thou the festal torches, and ye Graces gather flowers for the feast. Thou, Concord, weave two garlands. You, winged band, divide and hasten whithersoever you can be of use: let none be slothful or lazy. You others hang numberless lamps in order

laetitiae causas ignorat dicere
miles
laetaturque tamen; Mavortia
signa rubescunt
floribus et subitis animantur
frondibus hastae.
illa suum dictis adfatur talibus
agmen:
“Gradivum, nostri comites,
arcete parumper, 190
ut soli vacet aula mihi. procul
igneus horror
thoracum, gladiosque tegat
vagina minaces.
stent bellatrices aquilae
saevique dracones.
fas sit castra meis hodie
succumbere signis:
tibia pro lituis et pro clangore
tubarum 195
molle lyrae festumque canant.
epulentur ad ipsas
excubias; mediis spirent
crateres in armis.
laxet terribiles maiestas regia
fastus
et sociam plebem non indignata
potestas
confundat turbae procures.
solvantur habenis 200
gaudia nec leges pudeat ridere
severas.
“Tu festas, Hymenaeae, faces,
tu, Gratia, flores
elige, tu geminas, Concordia,
necte coronas.
vos, pennata cohors,
quocumque vocaverit

from their brackets against the
coming of night. Let these haste to
entwine the gleaming door-posts
with my sacred myrtle. Do you
sprinkle the palace with drops of
nectar and kindle a whole grove of
Sabaeen incense. Let others unfold
yellow-dyed silks from China and
spread tapestries of Sidon on the
ground. Do you employ all your arts
in decorating the marriage-bed.
Woven with jewels and upborne on
carved columns be its canopy, such

quocumque vocaverit
usus, [258]

divisa properate manu, neu
marceat ulla 205
segnities: alii funalibus ordine
ductis
plurima venturae suspendite
lumina nocti;
hi nostra nitidos postes
obducere myrto
contendant; pars nectareis
adspergite tecta
fontibus et flamma lucos
adolete Sabaeos; 210
pars infecta croco velamina
lutea Serum
pandite Sidoniasque solo
prosternite vestes.
ast alii thalamum docto
componite textu;
stamine gemmato picturatisque
columnis

[259]

as rich Lydia ne'er built for Pelops
nor yet the Bacchae for Lyaeus,
decked as his was with the spoils of
Ind and the mantling vine. Heap up
there all the gathered wealth of the
family, all the spoil that Honorius the
elder, our emperor's grandsire, won
from Moor and Saxon, all that his
dread father with Stilicho at his side
gained from numberless wars, all
that the Geloni and Armenians have
contributed or Meroë added—Meroë
encircled by furthest Nile whose
people decorate their hair with
arrows; whatever the Medes sent
from the banks of Persian Tigris
when suppliant Parthia bought peace
of Rome. Let the lofty couch be
adorned with the barbaric splendour
of kings' treasures; be all the wealth
of all our triumphs gathered in that
marriage-chamber."

So spake she and all unannounced
sought the bride's home. But Maria,
with no thoughts of wedlock nor
knowing that the torches were being
got ready, was listening with rapt
attention to the discourse of her
saintly mother, drinking in that
mother's nature and learning to
follow the example of old-world
chastity; nor does she cease under
that mother's guidance to unroll the
writers of Rome and Greece, all that
old Homer sang, or Thracian

aedificetur apex, qualem non
Lydia dives 215
erexit Pelopi nec quem struxere
Lyaeo
Indorum spoliis et opaco
palmite Bacchae.
illic exuvias omnes cumulate
parentum:
quidquid avus senior Mauro vel
Saxone victis,
quidquid ab innumeris socio
Stilichone tremendus 220
quaesivit genitor bellis,
quodcumque Gelonus
Armeniusve dedit; quantum
crinita sagittis
attulit extremo Meroë
circumflua Nilo;
misit Achaemenio quidquid de
Tigride Medus,
cum supplex emeret Romanam
Parthia pacem. 225
nobilibus gazis opibusque
cubilia surgant
barbaricis; omnes thalamo
conferte triumphos.”
Sic ait et sponsae petit
improvisa penates.
illa autem secura tori taedasque
parari
nescia divinae fruitur sermone
parentis 230
maternosque bibit mores
exemplaue discit
prisca pudicitiae Latios nec
volvere libros
desinit aut Graios, ipsa
genetrix magistra

Orpheus, or that Sappho set to music
with Lesbian quill; (even so Latona
taught Diana; so gentle Mnemosyne
in her cave gave instruction to meek
Thalia)—when the sky from afar
grows more bright, a sweeter air
breathes through the astonished
palace and there is spread the happy
fragrance of scented locks. Soon
came the proof; in all her beauty the
goddess bursts upon them. Yet Venus
stands amazed, admiring now the
daughter’s

gentile magis,
Maeonius quaecumque senex
aut Thracius Orpheus
aut Mytilenaeo modulatur
pectine Sappho 235
(sic Triviam Latona monet; sic
mitis in antro
Mnemosyne docili tradit
praecepta Thaliae):
cum procul augeri nitor et
iucundior aër
attonitam lustrare domum
fundique comarum
gratus odor. mox vera fides
numenque refulsit. 240
cunctatur stupefacta Venus;
nunc ora puellae,

[261]

loveliness, now the snowy neck and golden hair of the mother. The one is like unto the crescent moon, the other to the full. So grows a young laurel beneath the shadow of its parent tree and, small as it now is, gives promise of great branches and thick foliage to come. Or as 'twere two roses of Paestum on one stalk; the one day's fulness has brought to maturity; steeped in the dews of spring it spreads abroad its petals; the other yet nestles in its bud nor dares receive the sun's warmth within its tender heart.

Venus stood and addressed Maria with these gentle words: "All hail! revered daughter of divine Serena, scion of great kings and destined to be the mother of kings. For thy sake have I left my home in Paphos' isle and Cyprus; for thy sake was I pleased to face so many labours and cross so many seas lest thou shouldst continue to live a private life little befitting thy true worth and lest young Honorius should still feed in his heart the flame of unrequited love. Take the rank thy birth demands, resume the crown to bequeath it to thy children and re-enter the palace whence thy mother sprang. E'en though no ties of blood united thee to the royal house, though thou wert in no way related

nunc flavam niveo miratur
 vertice matrem.
 haec modo crescenti, plenae par
 altera lunae:
 adsurgit ceu forte minor sub
 matre virenti
 laurus et ingentes ramos
 olimque futuras 245
 promittit iam parva comas; vel
 flore sub uno
 ceu geminae Paestana rosae per
 iugera regnant:
 haec largo matura die
 saturataque vernis
 roribus indulget spatio; latet
 altera nodo
 nec teneris audet foliis
 admittere soles. 250
 Adstitit et blande Mariam
 Cytherea salutat:
 “salve sidereae proles augusta
 Serena,
 magnorum suboles regum
 parituraque reges.
 te propter Paphias sedes
 Cyprumque reliqui,
 te propter libuit tantos explere
 labores 255
 et tantum transnare maris, ne
 vilior ultra
 privatos paterere lares neu
 tempore longo
 dilatos iuvenis nutriret
 Honorius ignes.
 accipe fortunam generis,
 diadema resume,
 quod tribuas natis, et in haec
 non otia rursus 260

thereto, yet would thy beauty render
 thee worthy of a kingdom. What face
 could rather win a sceptre? What
 countenance better adorn a palace?
 Redder than roses thy lips, whiter
 than the hoar-frost thy neck,
 cowslips^[135] are not more yellow
 than thine hair, fire not more bright
 than thine eyes. With how fine an
 interspace do the delicate eyebrows
 meet upon thy forehead! How just
 the blend that makes thy blush, thy
 fairness not o’ermantled with too
 much

^[135] The *viola* was probably a pansy
 or wallflower, Gk λευκόϊον.

unde parens progressa, redi. fac
 nulla subesse
 vincula cognatae: quamvis
 aliena fuisses
 principibus, regnum poteras hoc
 ore mereri.
 quae propior sceptris facies? qui
 dignior aula 264
 vultus erit? non labra rosae, non
 colla pruinae,
 non crines aequant violae, non
 lumina flammae.
 quam iuncti leviter sese
 discrimine confert
 umbra supercilii! miscet quam
 iusta pudorem
 temperies nimio nec sanguine
 candor abundat!

red! Pinker thy fingers than Aurora's,
 firmer thy shoulders than Diana's;
 even thy mother dost thou surpass. If
 Bacchus, Ariadne's lover, could
 transform his mistress' garland into a
 constellation how comes it that a
 more beauteous maid has no crown
 of stars? Even now Boötes is
 weaving for thee a starry crown,
 even now heaven brings new stars to
 birth to do thee honour. Go, mate
 with one who is worthy of thee and
 share with him an empire co-
 extensive with the world. Ister now
 shall do thee homage; all nations
 shall adore thy name. Now Rhine
 and Elbe shall be thy slaves; thou
 shalt be queen among the Sygambri.
 Why should I number the peoples
 and the Atlantic's distant shores? The
 whole world alike shall be thy
 dowry."

She spake and fitted to Maria's neck
 and shining limbs the rich gear
 which the happy Nereids had just
 given her. She parted her hair with
 the spear's point, girded up her
 dress, and with her own hands set the
 veil over the maiden's hair.^[136] The
 procession is halted singing at the
 door; brightly gleams the holy
 chariot in which the new bride is to
 fare. The prince burns to run and
 meet her and longs for the sun's
 tardy setting. Even so the noble steed

Aurorae vincis digitos
 umerosque Dianae; 270
 ipsam iam superas matrem. si
 Bacchus amator
 dotali potuit caelum signare
 corona,
 cur nullis virgo redimitur
 pulchrior astris?
 iam tibi molitur stellantia serta
 Bootes
 inque decus Mariae iam sidera
 parturit aether. 275
 i, digno nectenda viro tantique
 per orbem
 consors imperii! iam te
 venerabitur Hister;
 nomen adorabunt populi; iam
 Rhenus et Albis
 serviet; in medios ibis regina
 Sygambros.
 quid numerem gentes
 Atlanteosque recessus
 280
 Oceani? toto pariter donabere
 mundo.”
 Dixit et ornatus, dederant
 quos nuper ovantes
 Nereides, collo membrisque
 micantibus aptat.
 ipsa caput distinguit acu,
 substringit amictus;
 flammea virgineis accommodat
 ipsa capillis. 285
 ante fores iam pompa sonat,
 pilentaque sacra
 praeradiant ductura nurum.
 calet obvius ire
 iam princeps tardumque cupit

when first the smell that stirs his
 passions smites upon him proudly
 shakes his thick, disordered mane
 and courses over Pharsalia's plains.
 His nostrils are aflame and with a
 neighing he greets the streams that
 saw his birth. His masters smile at
 the hope of their stud's increase, and
 the mares take pleasure in their
 handsome mate.

Meanwhile the army has laid aside
 its swords: the soldiers are dressed in
 white and throng around Stilicho, the
 bride's father. No standard-bearer
 nor

[\[136\]](#) Venus acts as *pronuba*. The
 parting of the hair with the spear was a
 relic of marriage by capture (*cf.*
 Catullus lxi.).

iam princeps tandemque caput

discedere^[264] solem:

nobilis haud aliter sonipes,

quem primus amoris

sollicitavit odor, tumidus

quatiensque decoras 290

curvata cervice iubas Pharsalia

rura

pervolat et notos hinnitu flagitat

amnes

naribus accensis; mulcet

fecunda magistros

spes gregis et pulchro gaudent

armenta marito.

Candidus interea positus

exercitus armis 295

exultat socerum circa; nec

signifer ullus

[265]

common soldier fails to scatter
flowers like rain and to drench their
leader in a mist of purple blossoms.
Crowned with laurel and myrtle they
sing: "Blessed father, whether the
vault of heaven is thy home, or thou
walkest in Elysium, the mansion of
the blest, behold Stilicho hath now
fulfilled the promises he made thee.
A happy interchange has now been
made: he compensates thee for his
upbringing, and renders marriage in
return for marriage, giving back to a
son what thou, that son's father, gave
to him. Never needst thou repent of
thy choice; a dying father's love
misled thee not. Worthy is he to be
thine heir, worthy to be entrusted
with the child of so powerful a
prince and to hold the reins of
government. Now could I tell of the
battles fought beneath the slopes of
Mount Haemus, the contests
wherefrom Strymon reeked red with
blood; I could sing the fame of his
arms and how, like a thunderbolt, he
falls upon his foes, but the marriage-
god says me nay. Our song must be
such as now befits the singing. Who
can surpass Stilicho in counsel? who
in knowledge of law and equity? In
thee are two opposed qualities
reconciled, wisdom and strength,
prudence and fortitude. Was e'er so
noble a brow? Whom would Rome's
highest place more befit? What heart

nec miles pluviae flores
 dispergere ritu
cessat purpureoque ducem
 perfundere nimbo.
haec quoque velati lauro
 myrtoque canebant:
 “Dive parens, seu te
 complectitur axis
 Olympi,
seu premis Elysias animarum
 praemia valles, 301
en promissa tibi Stilicho iam
 vota peregit;
iam gratae rediere vices;
 cunabula pensat;
acceptum reddit thalamum
 natoque reponit,
quod dederat genitor. numquam
 te, sancte, pigebit
iudicii nec te pietas suprema
 fefellit. 306
dignus cui leges, dignus cui
 pignora tanti
principis et rerum
 commendarentur
 habenae.
dicere possemus, quae proelia
 gesta sub Haemo
quaeque cruentarint fumantem
 Strymona pugnae,
quam notus clipeo, quanta vi
 fulminet hostem, 311
ni prohiberet Hymen, quae
 tempestiva relatu,
nunc canimus. quis consilio,
 quis iuris et aequi
nosse modum melior? quod
 semper discilit in te

but thine is strong enough to bear so many troubles? Shouldst thou stand amid the crowd whoe'er shall see thee would exclaim, 'That is Stilicho.' It is thus that the aspect of supreme majesty brings its own witness—not with arrogant voice, or pompous walk, or haughty gesture. The graces which others affect and strive to seem to possess are thine by nature's gift. Modesty shines forth together with a noble sternness,

semper visum, in te
 convenit, ingenio^[266] robur,
 formosus, prudentia fortitudoque
 fronte quae aequale^[267] quos
 canities Fortuna deceret, cum sorte
 culmina resu^[268] facerent tantis quae
 contingere solent curis
 stes liceat in populo vel aene
 utraque quicquid providit:
 ‘hic est, hic Stilicho’ sic se
 ornatur Fortuna et offert
 celsa potentis species, non
 tela nec voce ferocibus
 non alto simulata gradu, non
 non odium proba gestus
 adfectant, alii quidquid
 gratia; laborant pariter
 hoc dona naturae tibi muner
 ipse meus canis amat,
 iustissime legum
 arbiter, egregiae pacis fidissime
 custos,
 optime ductorum,
 fortunatissime patrum.
 plus iam, plus domino cuncti
 debere fatemur, 335
 quod gener est, invicte, tuus.
 vincere corona;
 insere te nostris contempto iure
 choreis.
 sic puer Eucherus superet
 virtute parentem;
 aurea sic videat similes
 Thermantia taedas;
 sic uterus crescat Mariae; sic
 natus in ostro 340
 parvus Honoriades genibus
 considat avitis.”

[267]

and white hairs come hastening to
 increase the reverence of thy face.
 Though dignity be the crown of age
 and strength, by a far different lot, of
 youth, yet either season decks thee
 with its own peculiar honours. Thou
 art the ornament of fortune. Never
 tookst thou up the sword for hurt nor
 ever didst steep its blade in citizens’
 blood. No cruelties on thy part
 aroused men’s hatred; favouritism
 never slacks the reins of justice. We
 love thee, yet we fear thee. Our very
 fear testifies to our love, O thou most
 righteous interpreter of Law,
 guardian most sure of peace with
 honour, greatest of our generals,
 most blessed among the fathers of
 our country. We all confess that now
 we owe our emperor an even firmer
 allegiance for that thou, hero
 invincible, art the father of his bride.
 Crown thy head with a garland, lay
 aside thy rank for a moment and join
 our dances. An thou dost this, so
 may thy son Eucherus^[137] surpass
 the virtues of his sire; so may the fair
 Thermantia, thy daughter, live to see
 a marriage such as this; so may
 Maria’s womb grow big and a little
 Honorius, born in the purple, rest on
 his grandsire’s lap.”

[137] Eucherus (born about 388) was
 the son, and Thermantia the younger
 daughter, of Stilicho and Serena. After

[268]

**PANEGYRICUS DE TERTIO
CONSULATU HONORII
AUGUSTI**

PRAEFATIO

(VI.)

[269]

**PANEGYRIC ON THE
THIRD CONSULSHIP OF
THE EMPEROR HONORIUS
(A.D. 396)**

PREFACE

(VI.)

Eagles may not rear their young without the sun's permission and the goodwill of heaven. So soon as the chicks have shattered their shells and issued forth, after that the warmth of their mother's body has cracked the opening egg, the father bird makes haste to carry the unfledged nestlings aloft and bids them gaze at the sun's fires with unblinking eye. He takes counsel of those bright beams and under light's schooling makes trial of the strength and temper of his sons. The angry father strikes with pitiless talons the degenerate who turns away his glance, but he whose eye can bear the searching flame, who with bolder sight can outstare the noonday sun, is brought up a king of birds, heir to the thunderbolt, destined to carry Jove's three-forked weapon. So mighty Rome fears not to send me, oft tested e'er now in the Muses' caverns, to face the emperor, her god. Now have I won an

Parvos non aquilis fas est
educere fetus
ante fidem solis iudiciumque
poli.
nam pater, excusso saluit cum
tegmine proles
ovaque maternus rupit hiulca
tepor,
protinus implumes convertit ad
aethera nidos 5
et recto flammas imperat ore
pati.
consulit ardentes radios et luce
magistra
natorum vires ingeniumque
probat.
degenerem refugo torsit qui
lumine visum,
unguibus hunc saevis ira
paterna ferit. 10
exploratores oculis qui pertulit
ignes
sustinuitque acie nobiliore
diem,
nutritur volucrumque potens et
fulminis heres,
gesturus summo tela trisulca
Iovi.
me quoque Pieriis temptatum
saepius antris 15
audet magna suo mittere
Roma deo.
iam dominas aures, iam regia
tectata meremur
et chelys Augusto iudice
nostra sonat.

emperor's ear, the entrance to an
emperor's palace and the emperor
himself as judge of my lyre's song.

PANEGYRICUS

(VII.)

PANEGYRIC

(VII.)

Let the consular fasces of Romulus open a third year, and for the third time let the warlike procession accompany thy curule litter. More festal in array be the coming year, and let purple, folded in Gabine^[138] guise, be proudly enriched with gems of Hydaspes; let the cloak of peace succeed the arms of war; let the lictor guard the consul's tent and the Latin axes return to the standards.^[139] And do thou, Honorius, who with thy brother, lord of the East, governest with equal care a world that was once thy sire's, go thy way with favourable omens and order the sun's new course, thyself heaven's hope and desire, palace-nurtured even from life's threshold, to whom the camp, gleaming with drawn swords, gave schooling among the laurels of victory. Thy towering fortune has never known the condition of a private citizen; when thou wast born thou wast born a king. Power which was thine by birth received thee, a precious pledge, amid the purple; soldiers bearing victorious standards inaugurated thy birth and set thy cradle in the midst of arms. When

Tertia Romulei sumant
exordia fasces
terque tuas ducat bellatrix
pompa curules;
festior annus eat cinctusque
imitata Gabinos
dives Hydaspeis augescat
purpura gemmis;
succedant armis trabeae,
tentoria lictor 5
ambiat et Latiae redeant ad
signa secures.
tuque o qui patrium curis
aequalibus orbem
Eoo cum fratre regis, procede
secundis
alitibus Phoebique novos ordire
meatus,
spes votumque poli, quem
primo a limine vitae 10
nutrix aula foveat, strictis quem
fulgida telis
inter laurigeros aluerunt castra
triumphos.
ardua privatos nescit Fortuna
penates
et regnum cum luce dedit.
cognata potestas
excepit Tyrio venerabile pignus
in ostro 15
lustravitque tuos aquilis
victricibus ortus
miles et in mediis cunabula
praebuit hastis.
te nascente ferox toto Germania
Rhenos

thou wast born fierce Germany
trembled along

[138] The *cinctus Gabinus* was one of the insignia of the consulship. It consisted in girding the toga tight round the body by means of one of its *lacinae* (= loose ends). Servius (on Virg. *Aen.* vii. 612) has a story that Gabii was invaded during the performance of a sacrifice and that the participants repulsed the enemy in their *cinctus*.

[139] Claudian suggests the uniting of civil and military power in the hands of Honorius.

the Rhine's full course, Caucasus shook his forests in fear, and the people of Meroë, confessing thy divinity, laid aside their quivers and drew the useless arrows from their hair. As a child thou didst crawl among shields, fresh-won spoils of monarchs were thy playthings, and thou wert ever the first to embrace thy stern father on his return from rude battles, when that, reeking with the blood of northern savages, he came home victorious from his conquest over the tribes of the Danube. Then wouldst thou demand thy share of the spoils, a Scythian bow or a belt won from the Geloni, a Dacian spear or Suabian bridle. Often would he smile on thee and uplift thee, eager for the honour, on his shining shield, and clasp thee to his still panting bosom. Thou fearedst not his coat of mail nor the dread gleam of his helmet but stretchedst out thy hands to grasp its lofty plumes. Then in his joy thy father cried: "King of starry Olympus, may this my son return in like manner from the lands of conquered foes, rich with the spoils of Hyrcania or proud with the slaughter of the Assyrians; his sword thus red with blood, his countenance thus roughened by the constant blasts and stained with the welcome dust of heroic combat, may he bring

intremuit movitque suas
formidine silvas
Caucasus et positis numen
confessa pharetris 20
ignavas Meroë traxit de crine
sagittas.
reptasti per scuta puer,
regumque recentes
exuviae tibi ludus erant,
primusque solebas
aspera complecti torvum post
proelia patrem,
signa triumphato quotiens
flexisset ab Histro 25
Arctoa de strage calens, et
poscere partem
de spoliis, Scythicos arcus aut
rapta Gelonis
cingula vel iaculum Daci vel
frena Suebi.
ille coruscanti clipeo te saepe
volentem
sustulit adridens et pectore
pressit anhelo 30
intrepidum ferri galeae nec
triste timentem
fulgur et ad summas tendentem
brachia cristas.
tum sic laetus ait: “rex o
stellantis Olympi,
talis perdomito redeat mihi
filius hoste,
Hyrcanas populatus opes aut
caede superbus 35
Assyria, sic ense rubens, sic
flamine crebro
turbidus et grato respersus
pulvere belli

back to his happy father the arms of
his conquered foes.”

Soon when thou couldst stand
upright and walk with firm step thy
sire forbade thee enervating sloth,
luxurious ease, time-wasting
slumbers. He strengthened thy young
limbs with hard toils and rude was
the training wherewith he exercised
thy tender powers. Thou wert taught
to bear winter’s cruel cold, to shrink
not before storm and tempest, to face
the heat of summer, to swim across
loud-roaring torrents, to

pulvere dem,
armaque gavisus^[274] referat captiva
parenti.”

Mox ubi firmasti recto
vestigia gressu,
non tibi desidias molles nec
marcida luxu 40
otia nec somnos genitor
permisit inertes,
sed nova per duros instruxit
membra labores
et cruda teneras exercuit indole
vires:
frigora saeva pati, gravibus non
cedere nimbis,
aestivum tolerare iubar,
transnare sonoras 45
torrentum furias, ascensu
vincere montes,

[275]

climb mountains, to run o’er the
plain, to leap ravines and hollows, to
spend sleepless nights of watching
under arms, to drink melted snow
from thy casque, to shoot the arrow
from the bow or hurl the acorn-
missiles with a Balearic sling. And
the more to inflame thy heart with
love of battle he would recount to
thee the deeds of thy grandsire,
object of dread to Libya’s sun-
scorched shores and Thule whither
no ship can sail. He conquered the
fleet Moors and the well-named^[140]
Picts; his roaming sword pursued the
flying Scot; his adventurous oars
broke the surface of the northern
seas. Crowned with the spoils of
triumphs won beneath the northern
and the southern sky he trod the
wave-swept strand of either Ocean.
Thus did he spur thy courage, thus
sow the seeds of fame; these were
the examples he gave. Not more
avidly did Achilles himself drink in
the Centaur’s precepts when he
learnt of him how to wield the spear
or play the lyre or discern healing
plants.

Meanwhile the world forgot its
loyalty: the thunder of civil war
sounded afresh and discord shook
the tottering earth. O ye guilty gods!
O shame everlasting!—a
barbarian^[141] exile had possessed

planitiem cursu, valles et
 concava saltu,
 nec non in clipeo vigiles
 producere noctes,
 in galea potare nives, nunc
 spicula cornu
 tendere, nunc glandes Baleari
 spargere funda. 50
 quoque magis nimium pugnae
 inflammaret amorem,
 facta tui numerabat avi, quem
 litus adustae
 horrescit Libyae ratibusque
 impervia Thule:
 ille leves Mauros nec falso
 nomine Pictos
 edomuit Scottumque vago
 mucrone secutus 55
 fregit Hyperboreas remis
 audacibus undas
 et geminis fulgens utroque sub
 axe tropaeis
 Tethyos alternae refluas calcavit
 harenas.
 hos tibi virtutum stimulos, haec
 semina laudum,
 haec exempla dabat. non ocius
 hausit Achilles 60
 semiferi praecepta senis, seu
 cupidis artes
 sive lyrae cantus medicas seu
 disceret herbas.
 Interea turbata fides. civilia
 rursus
 bella tonant dubiumque quatit
 discordia mundum.
 pro crimen superum, longi pro
 dedecus avi: 65

himself of the cities of Italy and had entrusted the government of Rome to some low-born dependent. But Theodosius was already afoot, rallying to his standard the distant nations of the East, the dwellers on the banks of flooding Euphrates, clear Halys, and rich Orontes. The Arabs left their spicy groves, the Medes the waters of the Caspian Sea, the Armenians the river Phasis, the Parthians the Niphates.

What lust of battle then filled thy heart, what longing to accompany thy father! What would not

[\[140\]](#) Pict, to a Roman, means “painted.” They were. “well-named Picts” because they painted themselves with woad or other stain.

[\[141\]](#) Arbogast is the “barbarian,” Eugenius (by trade a rhetorician) the “dependent.” See Introduction, p. ix.

delectus aevi. 65
[276]
barbarus Hesperias exul
 possederat urbes
sceptraque deiecto dederat
 Romana clienti.
iam princeps molitur iter
 gentesque remotas
colligit Aurorae, tumidus
 quascumque pererrat 69
Euphrates, quas lustrat Halys,
 quas ditat Orontes;
turiferos Arabes saltus, vada
 Caspia Medi,
Armenii Phasin, Parthi liquere
 Niphaten.
 Quae tibi tuna Martis rabies
 quantusque sequendi
ardor erat? quanto flagrabant
 pectora voto

[277]

thine eager spirit have given to hear
the beloved clarion's note and to
revel in the bloody storm of battle,
trampling upon the slaughtered
bodies of thy foes! Like a young lion
in a cave, accustomed to look for
nourishment to the teats of its tawny
mother, who, so soon as he finds
talons beginning to grow from out
his paws and a mane sprout from his
neck and teeth arm his jaws, will
have none of this inglorious food but
burns to leave his cavern home and
accompany his Gaetulian sire, to
bring death upon the herds and steep
him in the gore of some tall steer.
But Theodosius said thee nay, and
put the reins of government into thy
hands, crowning thy head with the
sacred diadem it wore so meetly.
And so did thy virtue show in
earliest years, so did thy soul out-
range thy youth that all complained
that to thee empire was granted late.

Swiftly beneath thy auspices was
victory achieved. Both fought for us
—thou with thy happy influence, thy
father with his strong right arm.
Thanks to thee the Alps lay open to
our armies, nor did it avail the
careful foe to cling to fortified posts.
Their ramparts, and the trust they put
therein, fell; the rocks were torn
away and their hiding-places
exposed. Thanks to thine influence

optatas audire tubas campique
 cruenta 75
tempestate frui truncisque
 inmergere plantas?
ut leo, quem fulvae matris
 spelunca tegebat
uberibus solitum pasci, cum
 crescere sensit
ungue pedes et terga iubis et
 dentibus ora,
iam negat imbelles epulas et rupe
 relicta 80
Gaetulo comes ire patri stabulisque
 minari
aestuat et celsi tabo sordere
 iuventi.
ille vetat rerumque tibi commendat
 habenas
et sacro meritos ornat diademate
 crines.
tantaque se rudibus pietas ostendit
 in annis, 85
sic aetas animo cessit, quererentur
 ut omnes
imperium tibi sero datum.

Victoria

 velox
auspiciis effecta tuis. Pugnastis
 uterque:
tu fatis genitorque manu. te propter
 et Alpes
invadi faciles cauto nec profuit
 hosti 90
munitis haesisse locis: spes inrita
 valli
concidit et scopulis patuerunt
 claustra revulsis.
te propter gelidis Aquilo de monte

the wind of the frozen North
overwhelmed the enemy's line with
his mountain storms, hurled back
their weapons upon the throwers and
with the violence of his tempest
drove back their spears. Verily God
is with thee, when at thy behest
Aeolus frees the armed tempests
from his cave, when the very
elements fight for thee and the allied
winds come at the call of thy
trumpets. The Alpine snows grew
red with slaughter, the cold Frigidus,
its waters turned to blood, ran hot
and steaming, and would

te propter genas Aquilo de monte
procellis^[278]

obruit adversas acies revolutaque
tela

vertit in auctores et turbine reppulit
hastas 95

o nimium dilecte deo, cui fundit ab
antris

Aeolus armatas hiemes, cui militat
aether

et coniurati veniunt ad classica
venti.

Alpinae rubuere nives, et Frigidus
amnis

[279]

have been choked with the heaps of
corpses had not their own fast-
flowing gore helped on its course.

Meanwhile Arbogast, the cause of
this wicked war, had pierced his side
deep not with a single blade: two
swords^[142] reeked with his blood,
and his own hand, learning justice at
last, had turned its savage fury
against himself. Thus was liberty
restored; but though Nature
demanded the return to heaven of
divine Theodosius whose work was
now accomplished, though the sky
threw open the golden palaces of its
starry vault and Atlas staggered
knowing the burden he was to bear,
yet did the emperor forbear to entrust
him to expectant Olympus until he
could in thy presence hand over to
thee a world at peace. Straightway
didst thou, Honorius, leave the
coasts of Thrace, and, braving the
dangers of the journey, pass without
a tremor through the hordes of
barbarians. Thou leavest the rocks of
Rhodope to which Orpheus' lyre
gave life; thou quittest the heights of
Oeta, scene of Hercules' ill-omened
funeral pyre; next thou climbest
Pelion, famed for the marriage of
Peleus and Thetis. Fair Enipeus and
lofty Dodona look upon thee in
amaze, and the oaks of Chaonia,
finding tongues once more, utter

mutatis fumavit aquis turbaque
 cadentum 100
 staret, ni rapidus iuvisset
 flumina sanguis.
 At ferus inventor scelerum
 traiecerat altum
 non uno mucrone latus,
 duplexque tepebat
 ensis, et ultrices in se
 converterat iras
 tandem iusta manus. iam
 libertate reducta, 105
 quamvis emeritum peteret
 natura reverti
 numen et auratas astrorum
 panderet arces
 nutaretque oneris venturi
 consciis Atlas,
 distulit Augustus cupido se
 credere caelo,
 dum tibi pacatum praesenti
 traderet orbem. 110
 nec mora: Bistoniis alacer
 consurgis ab oris,
 inter barbaricas ausus transire
 cohortes
 impavido vultu; linquis
 Rhodopeia saxa
 Orpheis animata modis; iuga
 deseris Oetes
 Herculeo damnata rogo; post
 Pelion intras 115
 Nereis inlustre toris; te pulcher
 Enipeus
 celsaque Dodone stupuit
 rursusque locutae
 in te Chaoniae moverunt
 carmina quercus

oracles in thine honour. Thou skirtest
 the extreme coasts of Illyria and,
 passing over Dalmatia's fields, dost
 cross in turn the nine sources of
 Trojan Timavus. ^[143] The high-
 walled cities of Italy rejoice in the
 blessings of thy presence. Eridanus
 bows his head and worships, bidding
 his waves flow gently to the sea; and
 Phaëthon's leafy sisters, that ever
 weep their brother's death, check the
 flow of their dewy amber.

How many youths, how many
 matrons set modesty aside in
 eagerness to behold thee! Austere
 greybeards

^[142] This is obscure. Zosimus (iv. 58.
 6) and Socrates (v. 25) merely mention
 suicide, but from Claudian's account it
 looks as though, like Nero, Arbogast's
 courage had failed him and an
 attendant had had to help him to his
 death.

^[143] The Fons Timavi (near Aquileia
 and the river Frigidus) is called Trojan
 from the story of the colonization of
 Venetia by the Trojan Antenor (Livy i.
 1. 3).

cammina quercus.
Illyrici legitur ^[280]plaga litoris; arva
teruntur
Dalmatiae; Phrygii numerantur
stagna Timavi. 120
gaudent Italiae sublimibus
oppida muris
adventu sacrata tuo, summissus
adorat
Eridanus blandosque iubet
mitescere fluctus
et Phaëthontes solitae deflere
ruinas
roscida frondosae revocant
electra sorores. 125
Quanti tum iuvenes, quanta
sprevere pudorem
spectandi studio matres,
puerisque severi

[281]

struggle with boys for places whence to see thee in the tender embraces of thy sire, borne through the midst of Rome on a triumphal chariot decked but with the shade of a simple laurel branch. Who did not then think that he beheld the morning-star together with the rosy sun, or the Thunderer shine in concert with Bacchus? On every side stretches the host of plumed warriors, each hymning thy praises in his own tongue; the brightness of bronze dazzles the eye and the martial glint of a forest of unsheathed swords redoubles the light of day. Some are decked with bows, others bristle with far-flung javelins or pikes for fighting at close quarters. These raise standards adorned with flying eagles, or with embroidered dragons or writhing serpents, that in their thousands seem to be roused to angry life by the breath of the wind which, as it blows them this way and that, causes them to rustle with a sound like the hiss of a living snake.

When they reached the palace the emperor bade all depart and thus unbidden addressed his son-in-law: “Victorious Stilicho, of whose courage in war, of whose loyalty in peace I have made proof—what warlike feat have I performed without thine aid? What triumph

certavere senes, cum tu
 genitoris amico
exceptus gremio mediam
 veherere per urbem
velaretque pios communis
 laurea currus! 130
quis non Luciferum roseo cum
 Sole videri
credidit aut iunctum Bromio
 radiare Tonantem?
floret cristatis exercitus undique
 turmis,
quisque sua te voce canens.
 praestringit aena
lux oculos, nudique seges
 Mavortia ferri 135
ingeminat splendore diem. pars
 nobilis arcu,
pars longe iaculis, pars
 comminus horrida
 contis;
hi volucres tollunt aquilas, hi
 picta draconum
colla levant, multusque tumet
 per nubila serpens
iratus stimulante Noto vivitque
 receptis 140
flatibus et vario mentitur sibila
 tractu.
 Ut ventum ad sedes, cunctos
 discedere tectis
dux iubet et generum compellat
 talibus ultro:
“bellipotens Stilicho, cuius mihi
 robur in armis,
pace probata fides: quid enim
 per proelia gessi 145
te sine? quem merui te non

have I won that thou helpedst me not
in the winning? Together we caused
Thracian Hebrus to run red with
Getic blood, together overthrew the
squadrons of the Sarmatae, together
rested our weary limbs on the snows
of Mount Rhipaeus and scarred the
frozen Danube with our chariot's
wheel—come, therefore, since
heaven's halls claim me, do thou
take up my task; be thou sole
guardian of my children, let thy hand
protect my two sons. I adjure thee by

te sine: quem metui te non
 [282]
 sudante triumphum?
 Odrysium pariter Getico
 foedavimus Hebrum
 sanguine, Sarmaticas pariter
 prostravimus alas
 Riphæaeque simul fessos
 porreximus artus
 in glacie stantemque rota
 sulcavimus Histrum: 150
 ergo age, me quoniam caelestis
 regia poscit,
 tu curis succede meis, tu
 pignora solus
 nostra fove: geminos dextra tu
 protege fratres.

[283]

that marriage that makes thee kin
 with me, by the night that saw its
 consummation, by the torch which at
 thy wedding-feast the queen carried
 in her own hand when she led thy
 bride-elect from out the imperial
 palace, take on thee a father's spirit,
 guard the years of their childhood.
 Was not their sire thy master and thy
 wife's father? Now, now I shall
 mount untroubled to the stars for
 thou wilt watch over them. Even
 should Typhoeus rend away the
 rocks and leap forth, should Tityus
 free his captive limbs, should
 Enceladus, hurling Etna from him,
 roar in rage—each and all will fall
 before Stilicho's attack."

He spake no more but still in human
 form clove a furrow of light through
 the clouds; he passes to Luna's
 globe, leaves Mercury's threshold
 and hastens to the gentle airs of
 Venus. Hence he traverses Phoebus'
 path, Mars' baleful fires and Jupiter's
 quiet quarters, and stands upon the
 very crown of the sky, cold Saturn's
 frozen zone. Heaven's fabric opens,
 unbidden the shining doors swing
 back. Boötes prepares a place in the
 vault of the northern sky, sword-girt
 Orion unbars the portals of the south;
 they offer welcome to the new star,
 uncertain each in turn to what region
 he will betake himself, what

per consanguineos thalamos
 noctemque beatam,
per taedas, quas ipsa tuo regina
 levavit 155
coniugio sociaque nurum
 produxit ab aula,
indue mente patrem, crescentes
 dilige fetus
ut ducis, ut soceri. Iamiam
 securus ad astra
te custode ferar; rupta si mole
 Typhoeus
prosiliat, vinclis Tityos si
 membra resolvat, 160
si furor Enceladi proiecta
 mugiat Aetna,
opposito Stilichone cadent.”

Nec

 plura locutus,
sicut erat, liquido signavit
 tramite nubes
ingrediturque globum Lunae
 limenque relinquit
Arcados et Veneris clementes
 advolat auras. 165
hinc Phoebi permensus iter
 flammamque nocentem
Gradivi placidumque Iovem;
 stetit arce suprema,
argenti qua zona riget Saturnia
 tractu.
machina laxatur caeli rutilaeque
 patescunt
sponte fores. Arctoa parat
 convexa Bootes, 170
australes reserat portas
 succinctus Orion
invitantque novum sidus

constellation he will grace with his
presence, or in what quarter he will
elect to shine alone. O glory of
heaven as once thou wert of earth,
the ocean that laves the shores of the
land of thy birth receives thee
wearied with thy nightly course,
Spain bathes thee in thy natal waves.
Happy father, when first thou risest
above the horizon thou lookest upon
Arcadius, when thou dippest to thy
setting the sight of Honorius delays
thy westering fires. Through
whichever hemisphere thou takest
thy wandering

natorum per regna venis, qui
 mente serena
maturoque regunt iunctas
 moderamine gentes,
saecula qui rursus formant
 meliore metallo.
luget Avarities Stygiis innexa
 catenis 185
cumque suo demens expellitur
 Ambitus auro.
non dominantur opes nec
 corrumpentia sensus
dona valent: emitur sola virtute
 potestas.
 Unanimi fratres, quorum
 mare terraque fati
debetur, quodcumque manus
 evasit avitas, 190
quod superest patri: vobis iam
 Mulciber arma
praeparat et Sicala Cyclops
 incude laborat,
Brontes innumeris exasperat
 aegida signis,
altum fulminea crispate in
 casside conum
festinat Steropes, nectit thoraca
 Pyragmon 195
ignifluisque gemit Lipare
 fumosa cavernis.
vobis Ionia virides Neptunus in
 alga
nutrit equos, qui summa freti
 per caerula possint
ferre viam segetemque levi
 percurrere motu,
nesciat ut spumas nec proterat
 ungula culmos 200

flight that is not feigned, Bactria
subjected to the Law, the fearful
pallor of the Ganges' servile banks,
the humbled Persian throwing off his
gem-encrusted robes. Mount to
Tanais' source, explore the frozen
North, traverse sun-scorched Libya,
o'ercome the fires of Titan and
surprise Nile's hidden spring; pass
the Pillars of Hercules, the bourne,
too, whence Bacchus returned;
whatever heaven enfolds shall own
your dominion. To you the Red Sea
shall give precious shells, India her
ivory, Panchaia perfumes, and China
silk.

ungula cunnos. 200
 iam video Babylon^[286]a rapi
 Parthumque coactum
 PANEGYRICUS DE
 non ficta trepidare fuga, iam
 QUARTO CONSULATU
 legum^[287] Honori^[288] Augusti
 pallescere ripis
 gemmatosque humilem
 (VIII.)
 dispergere Persida
 cultus.
 ite per extremum Tanaim
 pigrosque Triones, 205
 ite per ardentem Libyam,
 superate vapores
 solis et arcanos Nili deprendite
 fontes,
 Herculeum finem, Bacchi
 transcurrite metas:
 vestri iuris erit, quidquid
 complectitur axis,
 vobis Rubra dabunt pretiosas
 aequora conchas, 210
 Indus ebur, ramos Panchaia,
 vellera Seres.

[287]

PANEGYRIC ON THE FOURTH CONSULSHIP OF THE EMPEROR HONORIUS (A.D. 398)

(VIII.)

Once more the year opens under
 royal auspices and enjoys in fuller
 pride its famous prince; not brooking
 to linger around private thresholds
 the returning fasces rejoice in
 Caesar's consulship. Seest thou how
 the armed chiefs and mighty judges
 don the raiment of senators? and the
 soldiers step forth in garb of peaceful
 hue worn Gabine^[145] wise, and
 laying aside for a season the
 standards of war follow the banner
 of Quirinus. The eagles give way to
 the lictors, the smiling soldier wears
 the toga of peace and the senate-
 house casts its brilliance in the midst
 of the camp. Bellona herself,
 surrounded by a noble band of
 senators, puts on the consul's gown
 and lays by her shield and helmet in
 order to harness the sacred curule
 chair to her shoulders. Think it no
 shame, Gradivus, to bear the laurel-
 crowned axes in a hand of peace and
 to exchange thy shining breastplate
 for the Latin toga while thine iron
 chariot remains unused and thy

Auspiciis iterum sese
 regalibus annus
 induit et nota fruitur iactantior
 aula,
 limina nec passi circum privata
 morari
 exultant reduces Augusto
 consule fasces,
 cernis ut armorum proceres
 legumque potentes 5
 patricos sumant^[144] habitus? et
 more Gabino
 discolor incedit legio positisque
 parumper
 bellorum signis sequitur vexilla
 Quirini.
 lictori cedunt aquilae ridetque
 togatus
 miles et in mediis effulget curia
 castris. 10
 ipsa Palatino circumvallata
 senatu
 iam trabeam Bellona gerit
 parmamque removit
 et galeam sacras umeris vectura
 curules.
 nec te laurigeras pudeat,
 Gradive, secures
 pacata gestare manu Latiaque
 micantem 15
 loricam mutare toga, dum
 ferreus haeret
 currus et Eridani ludunt per
 prata iugales.
 Haud indigna coli nec nuper
 cognita Marti
 Ulpia progenies et quae
 diademata munda

steeds disport them in the pastures of Eridanus.

Not unworthy of reverence nor but newly acquainted with war is the family of Trajan and that Spanish house which has showered diadems upon the world. No common stream was held worthy

^[145] As marking a festival; see note on vii. 3.

[144] ~~quacubam munito~~
~~sumant B, Birt reads sumunt,~~
~~sparsit libera domus. nec~~
tantam vilior unda 20

to water the homeland of so illustrious a race; Ocean laved their cradle, for it befitted the future lords of earth and sea to have their origin in the great father^[146] of all things. Hence came Theodosius, grandfather of Honorius, for whom, exultant after his northern victories, Africa twined fresh laurels won from the Massylae. 'Twas he who pitched his camp amid the snows of Caledonia, ^[147] who never doffed his helmet for all the heat of a Libyan summer, who struck terror into the Moors, brought into subjection the coasts of Britain and with equal success laid waste the north and the south. What avail against him the eternal snows, the frozen air, the uncharted sea? The Orcades ran red with Saxon slaughter; Thule was warm with the blood of Picts; ice-bound Hibernia wept for the heaps of slain Scots. Could heat stay the advance of a courageous general? No; he overran the deserts of Ethiopia, invested Atlas with troops strange to him, drank of lake Triton where was born the virgin goddess Minerva, beheld the Gorgon's empoisoned lair, and laughed to see the common verdure of those gardens of the Hesperides which story had clothed with gold. Juba's fortress was burned down, the frenzied valour of the Moor yielded

promeruit gentis seriem:
 cunabula fovit
 Oceanus; terrae dominos
 pelagique futuros
 inmenso decuit rerum de
 principe nasci.
 hinc processit avus, cui post
 Arctoa frementi
 classica Massylas adnexuit
 Africa laurus, 25
 ille, Caledoniis posuit qui castra
 pruinis,
 qui medios Libyae sub casside
 pertulit aestus,
 terribilis Mauro debellatorque
 Britanni
 litoris ac pariter Boreae vastator
 et Austri.
 quid rigor aeternus, caeli quid
 frigora prosunt 30
 ignotumque fretum? maduerunt
 Saxone fuso
 Orcades; incaluit Pictorum
 sanguine Thyle;
 Scottorum cumulos flevit
 glacialis Hiverne.
 quid calor obsistit forti? per
 vasta cucurrit
 Aethiopum cinxitque novis
 Atlanta manipulis, 35
 virgineum Tritona bibit
 sparsosque venenis
 Gorgoneos vidit thalamos et
 vile virentes
 Hesperidum risit, quos ditat
 fabula, ramos.
 arx incensa Iubae, rabies
 Maurusia ferro

to the sword and the palace of ancient Bocchus was razed to the ground.

But thy father's fame far surpassed that of thy grandsire: he subdued Ocean to his governance and set the sky for border to his kingdom, ruling from Gades to the Tigris, and all that lies 'twixt Tanais and Nile; yet all these lands won by countless triumphs of his own, he gained them not by gift

[146] Claudian is thinking of such passages in Homer as *e.g. Il.* xiv. 245-246:

ῥέεθρα
 Ὠκεανοῦ, ὅς περ γένεσις πάντεσσι
 τέτυκται,

or perhaps Vergil's *Oceanumque patrem rerum* (Virg. *Georg.* iv. 382).

[147] Cf. note on xv. 216.

cessit et antiqui^[290] penetralia
 diruta Bocchi. 40
 Sed laudes genitor longe
 transgressus avitas
 subdidit Oceanum sceptris et
 margine caeli
 clausit opes, quantum distant a
 Tigride Gades,
 inter se Tanais quantum
 Nilusque relinquunt:
 haec tamen innumeris per se
 quaesita tropaeis, 45

of birth or from lust of power. It was his own merit secured his election. Unsought the purple begged his acceptance of itself; he alone when asked to rule was worthy to do so. For when unrest at home drove barbarian hordes over unhappy Rhodope and the now deserted north had poured its tribes in wild confusion across our borders, when all the banks of Danube poured forth battles and broad Mysia rang beneath the chariots of the Getae, when flaxen-haired hordes covered the plains of Thrace and amid this universal ruin all was either prostrate or tottering to its fall, one man alone withstood the tide of disaster, quenched the flames, restored to the husbandmen their fields and snatched the cities from the very jaws of destruction. No shadow of Rome's name had survived had not thy sire borne up the tottering mass, succoured the storm-tossed bark and with sure hand averted universal shipwreck. As when the maddened coursers broke from their path and carried Phaëthon far astray, when day's heat grew fierce and the sun's rays, brought near to earth, dried up both land and sea, Phoebus checked his fierce horses with his wonted voice; for they knew once more their master's tones, and with a happier guide heaven's harmonious order

non generis dono, non
ambitione potitus.
digna legi virtus. ultro se
purpura supplex
obtulit et solus meruit regnare
rogatus.
nam cum barbaries penitus
commota gementem
inrueret Rhodopen et mixto
turbine gentes 50
jam deserta suas in nos
transfunderet Arctos,
Danuvii totae vomerent cum
proelia ripae,
cum Geticis ingens premeretur
Mysia plaustis
flavaque Bistonios operirent
agmina campos,
omnibus adflictis et vel
labentibus ictu 55
vel prope casuris: unus tot
funera contra
restitit extinxitque faces
agrisque colonos
reddidit et leti rapuit de
faucibus urbes.
nulla relictæ foret Romani
nominis umbra,
ni pater ille tuus iamiam ruitura
subisset 60
pondera turbatamque ratem
certaque levasset
naufragium commune manu:
velut ordine rupto
cum procul insanae traherent
Phaëthonta quadrigae
saeviretque dies terramque et
stagna propinqui

was restored; for now the chariot
again accepted government and its
fires control.

Thus was the East entrusted to him
and thus was its salvation assured;
but the other half of the world was
not so entrusted: twice was the West
gained by valour, twice won by
dangers. In those lands of the sunset
by manifold crime there arose to
power tyrants twain: wild Britain
produced one (Maximus), the other
(Eugenius) was chosen

stagna propinqui
 haurirent radii,^[292] solito cum
 murmure torvis 65
 sol occurrit equis; qui postquam
 rursus eriles
 agnovere sonos, rediit meliore
 magistro
 machina concentusque poli,
 currusque recepit
 imperium flammaeque modum.
 Sic
 traditus ille
 servatusque Oriens. at non pars
 altera rerum 70
 tradita: bis possessa manu, bis
 parta periclis.
 per varium gemini scelus
 erupere tyranni
 tractibus occiduis: hunc saeva
 Britannia fudit;

[293]

as a tool by a Frankish outlaw
 (Arbogast). Both dared monstrous
 guilt; both stained their hands with
 an innocent emperor's^[148] blood.
 Sudden elevation inspired Maximus
 with audacity, his failure taught his
 successor caution. Maximus was
 quick to arm rebellion, Eugenius
 careful to attempt only what was
 safe. The one o'erran the country,
 spreading his forces in all directions,
 the other kept his troops together and
 himself secure behind a rampart.
 Different were they, but in their
 deaths alike. To neither was it
 granted to escape an ignominious
 end and to fall in the thick of the
 fight. Gone was their glory, their
 weapons were reft from them and
 they reduced to their former state;
 their arms were bound behind their
 backs and they stretched forth their
 necks to the sword's imminent
 stroke, begging for pardon and for
 life. What a fall did pride there
 suffer! They who but lately had
 moved such countless cohorts with
 but a nod, into whose palm a
 wavering world had hung ready to
 drop, fall not as warriors at a victor's
 hand but as malefactors before a
 judge; he sentences with his voice as
 criminals those whom he assailed in
 war as tyrants. With both perished
 their lieutenants: Andragathius

hunc sibi Germanus famulum
 delegerat exul:
 ausus uterque nefas, domini
 respersus uterque 75
 insontis iugulo. novitas audere
 priori
 suadebat cautumque dabant
 exempla sequentem.
 hic nova moliri praeceps, hic
 quaerere tuta
 providus; hic fusis, collectis
 viribus ille;
 hic vagus excurrens, hic intra
 claustra reductus. 80
 dissimiles, sed morte pares,
 evadere neutri
 dedecus aut mixtis licuit
 procumbere telis.
 amissa specie, raptis insignibus
 ambo
 in vultus rediere suos
 manibusque revinctis
 oblati gladiis summittunt colla
 paratis 85
 et vitam veniamque rogant. pro
 damna pudoris!
 qui modo tam densas nutu
 movere cohortes,
 in quos iam dubius sese
 libraverat orbis,
 non hostes victore cadunt, sed
 iudice sontes;
 damnat voce reos, petiit quos
 Marte tyrannos. 90
 amborum periire duces: hic
 sponte carina
 decidit in fluctus, illum suus
 abstulit ensis.

hurled himself from his ship into the waves, Arbogast took his life with his own sword; the Alps mark the tomb of the one, the sea of the other. This solace at least the avenger afforded to those murdered brothers that both the authors of their deaths themselves were slain; two victims went to appease those royal ghosts. Such was Theodosius' oblation at their tomb and with the blood of the guilty he appeased the shades of the two young emperors.

Those triumphs stablished Justice on her throne

[\[148\]](#) Maximus was responsible for the murder of the Emperor Gratian, Eugenius for that of Valentinian II. See Introduction, p. viii.

adstant caesis,
hunc Alpes, hunc^[294] pontus habet.
solacia caesis
fratribus haec ultor tribuit: necis
auctor uterque
labitur; Augustas par victima
mitigat umbras. 95
has dedit inferias tumulis,
iuvenumque duorum
purpureos merito placavit
sanguine manes.
Illi iustitiam confirmavere
triumphi,

[295]

and taught that heaven gives help. From them let the ages learn that righteousness need fear no foe and guilt expect no safety. Himself his own messenger, outstripping the rumour of his approach, Theodosius traversed those long journeys undetected by his enemies. Suddenly he fell on both, passing over entrenched mountains as if they were a plain. Build up monstrous rocks, raise towers, surround yourselves with rivers, set limitless forests to protect you, put Garganus and the snowy Apennines upon the summits of the Alps that all form one vast mountain barrier, plant Haemus on the crags of Caucasus, roll Pelion on Ossa, yet will ye not gain security for guilt. The avenger will come; for the better cause all things shall sink to make a path.

Yet never did Theodosius forget that he and the vanquished were fellow-citizens, nor was his anger implacable against those who yielded. Not his the choice to exult over the fallen. His ears were open to prayers, his clemency unbounded, his vengeance restrained. His anger did not survive the war to darken the days of peace; the day that set an end to the combat set an end to his wrath. Capture by such a victor was a gain; and many a conquered foe did their

praesentes docuere deos. hinc
 saecula discant
 indomitum nihil esse pio
 tutumve nocenti: 100
 nuntius ipse sui longas
 incognitus egit
 praevento rumore vias, inopinus
 utrumque
 perculit et clausos montes, ut
 plana, reliquit.
 extruite inmanes scopulos,
 attollite tures,
 cingite vos fluviis, vastas
 opponite silvas, 105
 Garganum Alpinis
 Appenninumque
 nivalem
 permixtis sociate iugis et
 rupibus Haemum
 addite Caucasiis, involvite
 Pelion Ossae:
 non dabitur murum sceleri. qui
 vindicta, ibit:
 omnia subsident meliori pervia
 causae. 110
 Nec tamen oblitus civem
 cedentibus atrox
 partibus infremuit; non insultare
 iacenti
 malebat: mitis precibus, pietatis
 abundans,
 poenae parcus erat; paci non
 intulit iram;
 post acies odiis idem qui
 terminus armis. 115
 profuit hoc vincente capi,
 multosque subactos
 prospera [149] leturae

chains commend to future fortune.
 [150] As liberal of money as of
 honours he was ever bent to redress
 the injuries of fate. Hence the love,
 the fortitude, the devotion of his
 troops; hence their abiding loyalty to
 his sons.

Child of so noble a sire, thy kingly
 state was coëval with thy birth nor
 ever knewest thou the soilure of a
 private lot. To thee all things came
 unsought; thee only [151] did a palace
 rear; thy happy growth was in
 ancestral purple, and thy limbs,
 never

[150] i.e. by winning first the pity and
 then the favour of Theodosius.

[151] "Only," because Arcadius was
 born *before* Theodosius became
 emperor.

prospere laudat
^[149] Birt, with the mss., aspera; I
return to commendare of catende.

^{princeps}
magnarum largitor opum,
largitor honorum
pronus et in melius gaudens
convertere fata.
hinc amor, hinc validum devoto
milite robur. 120
hinc natis mansura fides.

Hoc

nobilis ortu
nascaris aequaeva cum
maiestate creatus
nullaque privatae passus
contagia sortis.
omnibus acceptis ultro te regia
solum
protulit et patrio felix adolescens
in ostro, 125

outraged by garb profane, were laid upon a hallowed lap. Spain with its rivers of gold gave birth to thy sire; Bosporus boasts thee among its children. The West is the cradle of thy race but the East was thine own nurse; rivals are they for so dear a pledge, either hemisphere claims thee as its citizen. The fame of Hercules and Bacchus has immortalized Thebes; when Latona gave birth to Apollo in Delos that island stayed its errant course; it is Crete's boast that over its fields the infant Thunderer crawled. But the land that brought divine Honorius to birth is a greater than Delos, a more famous than Crete. Such narrow shores would not suffice our god. Nor did the bleak rocks of Cynthus hurt thy body with their rough bed; on couch of gold, clothed in jewelled raiment, thy mother gave birth to thee amid Tyrian purples; a palace rang with joy at that royal deliverance. What presages were there not then of future prosperity? what songs of birds, what flights of good omen in the heavens? What was the hurrying to and fro of seers? Hornèd Ammon and Delphi so long dumb at length broke their silence; Persian magi prophesied thy triumphs; Tuscan augurs felt thine influence; seers of Babylon beheld the stars and trembled; amazement

membraque vestitu numquam
violata profano
in sacros cecidere sinus.
Hispania patrem
auriferis eduxit aquis, te gaudet
alumno
Bosphorus. Hesperio de limine
surgit origo,
sed nutrix Aurora tibi; pro
pignore tanto 130
certatur, geminus civem te
vindicat axis.
Herculis et Bromii sustentat
gloria Thebas,
haesit Apollineo Delos Latonia
partu
Cretaque se iactat tenero reptata
Tonanti;
sed melior Delo, Dictaeis
clarior oris 135
quae dedit hoc numen regio;
non litora nostro
sufficerent angusta deo. nec
inhospita Cynthi
saxa tuos artus duro laesere
cubili:
adclinis genetrix auro,
circumflua gemmis
in Tyrios enixa toros; ululata
verendis 140
aula puerperiis. quae tunc
documenta futuri?
quae voces avium? quanti per
inane volatus?
qui vatum discursus erat? tibi
corniger Hammon
et dudum taciti rupere silentia
Delphi

seized the Chaldaean priests; the
rock of Cumae, shrine of raging
Sibyl, thundered once again.
Cybele's corybants surrounded not
thy cradle with the clatter of their
brazen shields; a shining host stood
by thee on every side. Standards of
war hedged in the royal babe who
marked the bowed helmets of the
worshipping soldiery while the
trumpet's blare answered his warlike
cries.

The day that gave thee birth gave
thee a kingdom;

te Persae cecinerē magi, te
sensit Etruscus 145
augur et inspectis Babylonius
horruit astris,
Chaldaei stupuere senes
Cumanaque rursus
intonuit rupes, rabidae delubra
Sibyllae.
nec te progenitum Cybeleius
aere sonoro
lustravit Corybas: exercitus
undique fulgens 150
adstitit; ambitur signis augustior
infans,
sentit adorantes galeas,
redditque ferocem
vagitum lituus.
Vitam tibi contulit
idem

[299]

in thy cradle thou wast raised to the consulship.^[152] With the name so recently bestowed upon thee thou dowerest the fasti and the year wherein thou wert born is consecrated to thee. Thy mother herself wrapped thy small form in the consular robe and directed thy first steps to the curule chair. Nourished at a goddess' breasts, honoured with the embraces of immortal arms thou grewest to maturity. Oft to grace thy boyish form Diana hung upon thy shoulders her Maenalian bow and huntress' quiver; oft thou didst sport with Minerva's shield and, crawling unharmed over her glittering aegis, didst caress its friendly serpents with fearless hand. Often even in those early days thy mother beneath thy sire's happy gaze crowned thy tender locks and, anticipating the answer to her prayers, gave thee the diadem that was to be thine hereafter; then raising thee in her gentle arms she held thee up to receive thy mighty father's kiss. Nor was that honour long in coming; thou, then Caesar, didst become emperor and wert straightway made equal with thy brother.^[153]

Never was the encouragement of the gods more sure, never did heaven attend with more favouring omens.

imperiumque dies; inter
 cunabula consul
 proveheris, signas posito modo
 nomine fastos 155
 donaturque tibi, qui te
 produxerat, annus.
 ipsa Quirinali parvum te cinxit
 amictu
 mater et ad primas docuit
 reptare curules.
 uberibus sanctis immortalique
 dearum
 crescis adoratus gremio: tibi
 saepe Diana 160
 Maenaios arcus venatricesque
 pharetras
 suspendit, puerile decus; tu
 saepe Minervae
 lusisti clipeo fulvamque impune
 pererrans
 aegida tractasti blandos
 interritus angues;
 saepe tuas etiam iam tum
 gaudente marito 165
 velavit regina comas festinaque
 voti
 praesumptum diadema dedit,
 tum lenibus ulnis
 sustulit et magno porrexit ad
 oscula patri.
 nec dilatus honos: mutatur
 principe Caesar;
 protinus aequaris fratri. 170

Non

 certius umquam
 hortati superi, nullis praesentior
 aether
 adfuit omnibus tenebris

Black tempest had shrouded the light
 in darkness and the south wind
 gathered thick rain-clouds, when of a
 sudden, so soon as the soldiers had
 borne thee aloft with customary
 shout, Phoebus scattered the clouds
 and at the same moment was given
 to thee the sceptre, to the world light.
 Bosphorus, freed from clouds, permits
 a sight of Chalcedon on the farther
 shore; nor is it only the vicinity of
 Byzantium that is bathed in
 brightness; the clouds are driven
 back and all Thrace is cleared;
 Pangaeus shows afar and lake
 Maeotis makes quiver the rays he

[152] Honorius, who was born Sept. 9, 384, was made consul for 386.

[153] Arcadius was made Augustus Jan. 16 (? 19), 383: Honorius not till Nov. 20, 393. Both succeeded to the throne Jan. 17, 395.

aditum omnibus. tenebris

involverat atra

lumen hiems densosque Notus
collegerat imbres.

sed mox, cum solita miles te
voce levasset,

nubila dissolvit Phoebus
pariterque dabantur 175

sceptra tibi mundoque dies:
caligine liber

Bosphorus adversam patitur
Calchedona cerni.

nec tantum vicina nitent, sed
tota repulsis

nubibus exuitur Thrace,
Pangaea renident

insuetosque palus radios
Maeotia vibrat. 180

[301]

rarely sees. 'Tis not Boreas nor yet Phoebus' warmer breath that has put the mists to flight. That light was an emperor's star. A prophetic radiance was over all things, and with thy brightness Nature laughed. Even at mid-day did a wondering people gaze upon a bold star ('twas clear to behold)—no dulled nor stunted beams but bright as Boötes' nightly lamp. At a strange hour its brilliance lit up the sky and its fires could be clearly seen though the moon lay hid. May be it was the Queen mother's star or the return of thy grandsire's now become a god, or may be the generous sun agreed to share the heavens with all the stars that hasted to behold thee. The meaning of those signs is now unmistakable. Clear was the prophecy of Ascanius' coming power when an aureole crowned his locks, yet harmed them not, and when the fires of fate encircled his head and played about his temples. [\[154\]](#) Thy future the very fires of heaven foretell. So the young Jove, issuing from the caves of Ida, stood upon the summit of the conquered sky and received the homage of the gods whom Nature handed to his charge. The bloom of youth had not yet clothed his cheeks nor flowed there o'er his neck the curls whose

nec Boreas nimbos aut sol
ardentior egit:
imperii lux illa fuit; praesagus
obibat
cuncta nitor risitque tuo natura
sereno.
visa etiam medio populis
mirantibus audax
stella die, dubitanda nihil nec
crine retuso 185
languida, sed quantus
numeratur nocte Bootes,
emicuitque plagis alieni
temporis hospes
ignis et agnosci potuit, cum
luna lateret:
sive parens Augusta fuit, seu
forte reluxit
divi sidus avi, seu te
properantibus astris 190
cernere sol patiens caelum
commune remisit.
adparet quid signa ferant.
ventura potestas
claruit Ascanio, subita cum luce
comarum
innocuus flagraret apex
Phrygioque volutus
vertice fatalis redimiret tempora
candor. 195
at tua caelestes inlustrant omina
flammae.
talis ab Idaeis primaevus
Iuppiter antris
possessi stetit arce poli
famulosque recepit
natura tradente deos; lanugine
nondum

stirrings were to shake the world. He was yet learning how to cleave the clouds and hurl the thunderbolt with unpractised hand.

Gladdened by that augury and proud of his now equal sons the sire returned, upstayed on the two princes and lovingly embracing his children in glittering car. Even so the Spartan twins, the sons of Leda, sit with highest Jove; in each his brother is mirrored, in each their sister; round each alike flows a golden dress, and star-crowned are the

[154] Virgil mentions the portent (*Aen.* ii. 682).

nonnulli
 vernabant vultus nec adhuc per
 colla fluebant 200
 moturae convexa comae; tum
 scindere nubes
 discebat fulmenque rudi
 torquere lacerto.
 Laetior augurio genitor
 natisque superbus
 iam paribus duplici fultus
 consorte redibat
 splendebatque pio complexus
 pignora curru. 205
 haud aliter summo gemini cum
 patre Lacones,
 progenies Ledaea, sedent: in
 utroque relucet
 frater, utroque soror; simili
 chlamys effluit auro;

[303]

locks of both. The Thunderer rejoices in his very uncertainty, and to their hesitating mother her ignorance brings delight; Eurotas cannot make distinction between his own nurslings.

When all had returned to the palace, Theodosius, anxious for the world's just governance, is said to have addressed thee in these terms:

"Had fortune, my dear son, given thee the throne of Parthia, hadst thou been a descendant of the Arsacid house and did the tiara, adored by Eastern lands afar, tower upon thy forehead, thy long lineage would be enough, and thy birth alone would protect thee, though wantoning in idle luxury. Very different is the state of Rome's emperor. 'Tis merit, not blood, must be his support. Virtue hidden hath no value, united with power 'tis both more effective and more useful. Nay, o'erwhelmed in darkness it will no more advantage its obscure possessor than a vessel with no oars, a silent lyre, an unstrung bow.

"Yet virtue none shall find that has not first learned to know himself and stilled the uncertain waves of passion within him. Long and winding is the path that leads thereto. What each man learns in his

stellati pariter crines. iuvat ipse
 Tonantem
 error et ambiguae placet
 ignorantia matri; 210
 Eurotas proprios discernere
 nescit alumnos.
 Ut domus exceptit reduces, ibi
 talìa tecum
 pro rerum stabili fertur ditione
 locutus:
 “Si tibi Parthorum solium
 Fortuna dedisset,
 care puer, terrisque procul
 venerandus Eois 215
 barbarus Arsacio consurgeret
 ore tìaras:
 sufficeret sublime genus
 luxuque fluentem
 deside nobilitas posset te sola
 tueri.
 altera Romanae longe
 rektoribus aulae
 condicio. virtute decet, non
 sanguine niti. 220
 maior et utilior fato coniuncta
 potenti,
 vile latens virtus. quid enim?
 submersa tenebris
 proderit obscuro veluti sine
 remige puppis
 vel lyra quae reticet vel qui non
 tenditur arcus.
 “Hanc tamen haud quisquam,
 qui non agnoverit ante
 225
 semet et incertos animi
 placaverit aestus,
 inveniet longis illuc ambagibus

own interests learn thou in the
 interests of the world. When
 Prometheus mixed earthly and
 heavenly elements and so formed
 human kind, he stole man's spirit
 pure from his own heavenly home,
 held it imprisoned and bound despite
 its outcries, and since humanity
 could be formed in no other way he
 added two more souls. ^[155] These fail
 and perish with the body; the first
 alone remains, survives the pyre and
 flies away. This soul he stationed in
 the lofty fastness of the brain to
 control and oversee the work and
 labours of the body. The other

^[155] Claudian here follows the
 Platonic psychology which divides the
 soul into τὸ ἐπιθυμητικόν, τὸ
 θυμοειδές, the two (“geminas”) baser
 elements, and τὸ λογιστικόν (the
 “haec” of l. 234).

inveniet, longis huc ambagibus
itur. [304]

disce orbi, quod quisque sibi.
cum conderet artus
nostros, aetheriis miscens
terrena, Prometheus,
sinceram patri mentem furatus
Olympo 230
continuit claustris
indignantemque revinxit
et, cum non aliter possent
mortalia fingi,
adiunxit geminas. illae cum
corpore lapsae
intereunt, haec sola manet
bustoque superstes
evolat. hanc alta capitis
fundavit in arce 235
mandatricem operum
prospecturamque labori;

[305]

two he set below the neck in a place befitting their functions, where it is their part to obey the commands of the directing soul. Doubtless our creator, fearing to mix the heavenly with the mortal, placed the different souls in different parts and kept their dwelling-places distinct. Near to the heart whence springs our blood there is within the breast a place where fiery anger lurks, eager to hurt and uncontrolled. This cavity swells when heated by rage and contracts when cooled by fear. Then, since anger swept everything away with it and in its fury gave the limbs no rest, Prometheus invented the lungs to aid the body and applied their humidity to the raging of anger to soothe our wrath-swollen flesh. Lust, that asks for everything and gives nought, was driven down into the liver and of necessity occupied the lowest room. Like a beast, opening its capacious jaws, lust can never be full fed nor satisfied; it is a prey now to the cruel lash of sleepless avarice, now to the fiery goads of love; is swayed now by joy, now by misery, and is no sooner fed than fain to be fed again, returning with more insistence than the oft-beheaded hydra.

“Can any assuage this tumult he will assure an inviolable sanctuary for a spotless soul. Thou mayest hold

illas inferius collo praeceptaque
summae
passuras dominae digna statione
locavit.
quippe opifex veritus
confundere sacra
profanis
distribuit partes animae
sedesque removit. 240
iram sanguinei regio sub
pectore cordis
protegit imbutam flammis
avidamque nocendi
praecipitemque sui. rabie
succensa tumescit,
contrahitur tepefacta metu.
cumque omnia secum
duceret et requiem membris
vesana negaret, 245
invenit pulmonis opem
madidumque furenti
praebuit, ut tumidae ruerent in
mollia fibrae.
at sibi cuncta petens, nil
conlatura cupido
in iecur et tractus imos
compulsa recessit,
quae, velut inmanis reserat dum
belua rictus, 250
expleri pascique nequit: nunc
verbere curas
torquet avaritiae, stimulis nunc
flagrat amorum,
nunc gaudet, nunc maesta dolet
satiataque rursus
exoritur caesaque redit
pollentius hydra.
“Hos igitur potuit si quis

sway o'er farthest India, be obeyed
by Mede, unwarlike Arab or
Chinese, yet, if thou fearest, hast evil
desires, art swayed by anger, thou
wilt bear the yoke of slavery; within
thyself thou wilt be a slave to
tyrannical rule. When thou canst be
king over thyself then shalt thou hold
rightful rule over the world. The
easier way often trod leads to worse;
liberty begets licence and, when
uncontrolled, leads to vice. Then is a
chaste

hos igitur poterit si quis
 sedare ^[306] tumultus, 255
 inconcussa dabit purae sacraria
 menti.
 tu licet extremos late dominere
 per Indos,
 te Medus, te mollis Arabs, te
 Seres adorent:
 si metuis, si prava cupis, si
 duceris ira,
 servitii patiere iugum; tolerabis
 iniquas 260
 interius leges. tunc omnia iure
 tenebis,
 cum poteris rex esse tui.
 proclivior usus
 in peiora datur suadetque
 licentia luxum
 inlecebrisque effrena favet. tum
 vivere caste

[307]

life harder when love is at call; then
 is it a sterner task to govern anger
 when vengeance is to hand. Yet
 master thine emotions and ponder
 not what thou mightest do but what
 thou oughtest to do, and let regard
 for duty control thy mind.

“Of this too I cannot warn thee too
 often: remember that thou livest in
 the sight of the whole world, to all
 peoples are thy deeds known; the
 vices of monarchs cannot anywhere
 remain hid. The splendour of their
 lofty station allows nought to be
 concealed; fame penetrates every
 hiding-place and discovers the
 inmost secrets of the heart.

“Above all fail not in loving-
 kindness; for though we be
 surpassed in every virtue yet mercy
 alone makes us equal with the gods.
 Let thine actions be open and give
 no grounds for suspicion, be loyal to
 thy friends nor lend an ear to
 rumours. He who attends to such
 will quake at every idle whisper and
 know no moment’s peace. Neither
 watch nor guard nor yet a hedge of
 spears can secure thee safety; only
 thy people’s love can do that. Love
 thou canst not extort; it is the gift of
 mutual faith and honest goodwill.
 Seest thou not how the fair frame of
 the very universe binds itself
 together by love, and how the

asperius, cum prompta Venus;
tum durius irae 265
consulitur, cum poena patet. sed
comprime motus
nec tibi quid liceat, sed quid
fecisse decebit
occurrat, mentemque domet
respectus honesti.
“Hoc te praeterea crebro
sermone monebo,
ut te totius medio telluris in ore
270
vivere cognoscas, cunctis tua
gentibus esse
facta palam nec posse dari
regalibus usquam
secretum vitiis; nam lux
altissima fati
occultum nihil esse sinit,
latebrasque per omnes
intrat et abstrusos explorat fama
recessus. 275
“Sis pius in primis; nam cum
vincamur in omni
munere, sola deos aequat
clementia nobis.
neu dubie suspectus agas neu
falsus amicis
rumorumve avidus: qui talia
curat, inanes
horrebit strepitus nulla non
anxius hora. 280
non sic excubiae, non
circumstantia pila
quam tutatur amor. non
extorquebis amari;
hoc alterna fides, hoc simplex
gratia donat

elements, not united by violence, are
for ever at harmony among
themselves? Dost thou not mark how
that Phoebus is content not to outstep
the limits of his path, nor the sea
those of his kingdom, and how the
air, which in its eternal embrace
encircles and upholds the world,
presses not upon us with too heavy a
weight nor yet yields to the burden
which itself sustains? Whoso causes
terror is himself more fearful; such
doom befits tyrants. Let them be
jealous of another's fame, murder the

gratia donat.
nonne vides, ^[308]operum quod se
pulcherrimus ipse
mundus amore liget, nec vi
conexa per aevum 285
conspirent elementa sibi? quod
limite Phoebus
contentus medio, contentus
litore pontus
et, qui perpetuo terras ambitque
vehitque,
nec premat incumbens oneri nec
cesserit aër?
qui terret, plus ipse timet; sors
ista tyrannis 290
convenit; invideant claris
fortesque trucidant,

[309]
brave, live hedged about with swords
and fenced with poisons, dwelling in
a citadel that is ever exposed to
danger, and threaten to conceal their
fears. Do thou, my son, be at once a
citizen and a father, consider not
thyself but all men, nor let thine own
desires stir thee but thy people's.

“If thou make any law or establish
any custom for the general good, be
the first to submit thyself thereto;
then does a people show more regard
for justice nor refuse submission
when it has seen their author
obedient to his own laws. The world
shapes itself after its ruler's pattern,
nor can edicts sway men's minds so
much as their monarch's life; the
unstable crowd ever changes along
with the prince.

“Nor is this all: show no scorn of
thine inferiors nor seek to overstep
the limits established for mankind.
Pride joined thereto defaces the
fairest character. They are not
submissive Sabaeans whom I have
handed over to thy rule, nor have I
made thee lord of Armenia; I give
thee not Assyria, accustomed to a
woman's rule. Thou must govern
Romans who have long governed the
world, Romans who brooked not
Tarquin's pride nor Caesar's tyranny.
History still tells of our ancestors' ill
deeds; the stain will never be wiped

muniti gladiis vivant saeptique
 venenis,
ancipites habeant arces
 trepidique minentur:
tu civem patremque geras, tu
 consule cunctis,
non tibi, nec tua te moveant, sed
 publica vota. 295

“In commune iubes si quid
 censesque tenendum,
primus iussa subi: tunc
 observantior aequi
fit populus nec ferre negat, cum
 viderit ipsum
auctorem parere sibi.
 componitur orbis
regis ad exemplum, nec sic
 inflectere sensus 300
humanos edicta valent quam
 vita regentis:
mobile mutatur semper cum
 principe vulgus.

“His tamen effectis neu
 fastidire minores
neu pete praescriptos homini
 transcendere fines.
inquinat egregios adiuncta
 superbia mores. 305
non tibi tradidimus dociles
 servire Sabaeos,
Armeniae dominum non te
 praefecimus orae,
nec damus Assyriam, tenuit
 quam femina, gentem.
Romani, qui cuncta diu rexere,
 regendi,
qui nec Tarquinii fastus nec iura
 tulere 310

away. So long as the world lasts the monstrous excesses of the Julian house will stand condemned. Will any not have heard of Nero's murders or how Capri's foul cliffs were owned by an agèd lecher^[156]? The fame of Trajan will never die, not so much because, thanks to his victories on the Tigris, conquered Parthia became a Roman province, not because he brake the might of Dacia and led their chiefs in triumph up the slope of the Capitol, but because

^[156] i.e. Tiberius.

tuere sio
 Caesaris. annales veterum
 delicta loquuntur:
 haerebunt maculae. quis non
 per saecula damnat
 Caesareae portenta domus?
 quem dira Neronis
 funera, quem rupes Caprearum
 taetra latebit
 incesto possessa seni? victura
 feretur 315
 gloria Traiani, non tam quod
 Tigride victo
 nostra triumphati fuerint
 provincia Parthi,
 alta quod invectus fractis
 Capitolia Dacis,

[311]

he was kindly to his country. Fail not to make such as he thine example, my son.

“Should war threaten, see first that thy soldiers are exercised in the practices of war and prepare them for the rigours of service. The ease of winter months spent in winter quarters must not weaken nor unnerve their hands. Establish thy camps in healthy places and see that watchful sentries guard the ramparts. Learn how to know when to mass your troops and when it is better to extend them or face them round; study the formations suitable for mountain warfare and those for fighting on the plain. Learn to recognize what valleys may conceal an ambush and what routes will prove difficult. If thine enemy trusts in his walls to defend him then let thy catapults hurl stones at his battlements; fling rocks thereat and let the swinging ram and shield-protected testudo^[157] shake his gates. Your troops should undermine the walls and issuing from this tunnel should rush into the town. Should a long siege delay thee, then take care thou unbend not thy purpose in security or count thine enemy thy prisoner. Many ere this have found premature triumph their undoing, scattered or asleep they

quam patriae quod mitis erat. ne
desine tales,
nate, sequi.

“Si bella canant,
prius agmina duris
exerce studiis et saevo praestruere
Marti. 321

non brumae requies, non
hibernacula segnes
enervent torpore manus.

ponenda salubri
castra loco; praebenda vigil
custodia vallo.

disce, ubi denseri cuneos, ubi
cornua tendi 325

aequius aut iterum flecti; quae
montibus aptae,

quae campis acies, quae fraudi
commoda vallis,

quae via difficilis. fidit si
moenibus hostis,

tum tibi murali libretur machina
pulsu;

saxa rota; praeceps aries
protectaque portas 330

testudo feriat; ruat emersura
iuventus

effossi per operta soli. si longa
moretur

obsidio, tum vota cave secura
remittas

inclusumve putes; multis
damnosa fuere

gaudia; dispersi pereunt
somnia soluti; 335

saepius incautae nocuit victoria
turbae.

non tibi regificis tentoria larga

have been cut to pieces; indeed
victory itself has not seldom been the
ruin of careless troops. Not for thee
let spacious tents o’erflow with
princely delights nor luxury don
arms and drag to the standards her
unwarlike train. Though the storm
winds blow and the rain descends
yield not to them and use not cloth of
gold to guard thee from the sun’s
fierce rays. Eat such food as thou
canst find. It will be a solace to thy
soldiers that thy toil is as heavy as
theirs; be the first to mount the
arduous hill and, should

[157] A well-known Roman method of
attack by which the troops advanced to
the point of attack in close formation,
each man holding his shield above his
head. The protection thus afforded to
the assaulting band was likened to the
shell of the tortoise (*testudo*).

neu ubi regnicis temora larga
redundent^[312]

deliciis, neve imbelles ad signa
ministros
luxuries armata trahat. neu
flantibus Austris
neu pluviis cedas, neu
defensura calorem 340
aurea summoveant rapidos
umbracula soles.
inventis utere cibis. solabere
partes
aequali sudore tuas: si collis
iniquus,

[313]

necessity demand the felling of a forest, be not ashamed to grasp the axe and hew down the oak. If a stagnant marsh must be crossed let thy horse be the first to test the depth of it. Boldly tread the frozen river; swim the flood. Mounted thyself, ride amid thy squadrons of horse or again stand foot to foot with the infantry. They will advance the bolder for thy presence, and with thee to witness glorious and glad shall be the fulfilment of their task.”

More would he have spoken but Honorius broke in and said: “All this will I do, so God favour my attempts. The peoples and kingdoms committed to my care shall find me not unworthy of thee nor of my brother. But why should I not experience in action what thou has taught in words? Thou goest to the wintry Alps: take me with thee. Let mine arrows pierce the tyrant’s body, and the barbarians pale at my bow. Shall I allow Italy to become the prey of a ruthless bandit? Rome to serve one who is himself but a servant? Am I still such a child that neither power profaned nor just revenge for an uncle’s blood shall move me? Fain would I ride through blood. Quick, give me arms. Why castest thou my youth in my teeth? Why thinkest me unequal to the

primus ini; silvam si caedere
 provocat usus,
 sumpta ne pudeat quercum stravisse
 bipenni. 345
 calcatur si pigra palus, tuus ante
 profundum
 pertemptet sonipes. fluvios tu
 protere cursu
 haerentes glacie, liquidos tu scinde
 natatu.
 nunc eques in medias equitum te
 consere turmas;
 nunc pedes adsistas pediti. tum
 promptius ibunt
 te socio, tum conspicuus gratusque
 geretur 351
 sub te teste labor."

Dicturum

 plura parentem
 voce subis: "equidem, faveant modo
 numina coeptis,
 haec effecta dabo, nec me fratrique
 tibique
 dissimilem populi commissaque
 regna videbunt. 355
 sed cur non potius, verbis quae
 disseris, usu
 experior? gelidas certe nunc tendis
 in Alpes.
 duc tecum comitem; figant sine
 nostra tyrannum
 spicula; pallescat nostro sine
 barbarus arcu.
 Italiamne feram furiis praedonis
 acerbi 360
 subiectam? patiar Romam servire
 clienti?
 usque adeone puer? nec me polluta

combat? I am as old as was Pyrrhus
 when alone he o'erthrew Troy and
 proved himself no degenerate from
 his father Achilles. If I may not
 remain in thy camp as a prince I will
 come even as a soldier."

Theodosius kissed his son's sweet
 lips and answered him wondering:
 "Nought have I but praise for thy
 petition, but this love of glory has
 bloomed too early. Thy strength will
 increase with years; till then be
 patient. Though thou hast not yet
 completed ten summers thou wouldst
 hance dangers that a man

usque ad eone puer: nec me potestas
potestas^[314]

nec pia cognati tanget vindicta
cruoris?
per strages equitare libet. da protinus
arma.
cur annos obicis? pugnae cur arguor
impar?
aequalis mihi Pyrrhus erat, cum
Pergama solus 365
verteret et patri non degeneraret
Achilli.
denique si princeps castris haerere
nequibo,
vel miles veniam.”

Delibat dulcia
nati
oscula miratusque refert: “laudanda
petisti; 370
sed festinus amor, veniet robustior
aetas;
ne propera. necdum decimas
emensus aristas
adgrederis metuenda viris: vestigia
magnae

[315]

might fear: I mark the tokens of a
noble nature. It is said that
Alexander, conqueror of eastern
Porus, wept at the constant news of
Philip’s fortune, telling his
companions who rejoiced thereat
that his sire’s valour left him nought
to conquer. In thee I see like spirit.
May a father be allowed this
prophecy—“thou shalt be as great”!
It is not to my goodwill thou owest
the kingdom, for nature has already
made it thine. So even from his birth
bees reverence the king^[158] who is to
lead their buzzing swarms through
the soft meadows, ask his public
laws for the gathering of the honey
and entrust to him their combs. So
the spirited young bull-calf claims
sovereignty over the grazing-
grounds and, though as yet his horns
are not grown strong, lords it over
the herd. Nay: postpone thy
campaigns till thou art a man and
while I do battle patiently help thy
brother to fulfil my office. Be you
two the terror of untamed Araxes and
of swift Euphrates; may Nile
throughout all his length belong to
you and all the lands upon which the
morning sun lets fall his beam.
Should I force a passage over the
Alps, should success crown the
juster cause, thou shalt come and
govern the recovered provinces,

indolis agnosco, fertur Pellaeus,
 Eoum
 qui domuit Porum, cum
 prospera saepe Philippi
 375
 audiret, laetos inter flevisse
 sodales
 nil sibi vincendum patris virtute
 relinqui.
 hos video motus. fas sit
 promittere patri:
 tantus eris. nostro nec debes
 regna favori,
 quae tibi iam natura dedit. sic
 mollibus olim 380
 stridula ducturum pratis
 examina regem
 nascentem venerantur apes et
 publica mellis
 iura petunt traduntque favos; sic
 pascua parvus
 vindicat et necdum firmatis
 cornibus audax
 iam regit armentum vitulus. sed
 proelia differ 385
 in iuvenem patiensque meum
 cum fratre tuere
 me bellante locum, vos
 impacatus Araxes,
 vos celer Euphrates timeat, sit
 Nilus ubique
 vester et emissio quidquid sol
 imbuit ortu.
 si pateant Alpes, habeat si causa
 secundos 390
 iustior eventus, aderis partesque
 receptas
 cuspides animosa tuas ut

whereby fierce Gaul shall obey thy
 laws and my native Spain be guided
 by thy just rule. Then, careless of
 doom and rejoicing in my labours, I
 shall quit this mortal life, while you,
 my sons, rule either hemisphere.

“Meanwhile cultivate the Muses
 whilst thou art yet young; read of
 deeds thou soon mayest rival; never
 may Greece’s story, never may
 Rome’s, cease to speak with thee.
 Study the lives of the heroes of old
 to accustom thee for wars that are to
 be.

[\[158\]](#) As is well known, the ancients
 mistook the sex of the queen bee.

suscipies, animosa tuas ut

Gallia ^[316]leges

audiat et nostros aequus
modereris Hiberos.

tunc ego securus fati laetusque
laborum

discedam, vobis utrumque
regentibus axem. 395

“Interea Muis animus, dum
mollior, instet

et quae mox imitere legat; nec
desinat umquam

tecum Graia loqui, tecum
Romana vetustas.

antiquos evolve duces, adsuesce
futurae

[317]

Go back to the Latin age. Admirest thou a fight for liberty? Thou wilt admire Brutus. Does treachery rouse thine indignation? The punishment of Mettius ^[159] will fill thee with satisfaction. Dost thou hate undue severity? Abominate Torquatus' savagery. Is it a virtue to die for one's country? Honour the self-devotion of the Decii. Horatius Cocles, facing the foe on the broken bridge, Mucius holding his arm in the flames, ^[160] these shall show thee what, single-handed, brave men can do. Fabius will show thee what overthrow delay can cause; Camillus and his slaughter of the Gauls what in face of odds a leader can effect. From history thou mayest learn that no ill fortune can master worth; Punic savagery extends thy fame, Regulus, to eternity; the failure of Cato outdoes success. From history thou mayest learn the power of frugal poverty; Curius was a poor man when he conquered kings in battle; Fabricius was poor when he spurned the gold of Pyrrhus; Serranus, for all he was dictator, drove the muddy plough. In those days the lictors kept watch at a cottage door, the fasces were hung upon a gateway of wood; consuls helped to gather in the harvest, and for long years the fields were

militiae, Latium retro te confer
 in aevum. 400
 libertas quaesita placet?
 mirabere Brutum.
 perfidiam damnas? Metti
 satiabere poenis.
 triste rigor nimius? Torquati
 despice mores.
 mors impensa bonum? Decios
 venerare ruentes.
 vel solus quid fortis agat, te
 ponte soluto 405
 oppositus Cocles, Muci te
 flamma docebit;
 quid mora perfringat, Fabius;
 quid rebus in artis
 dux gerat, ostendet Gallorum
 strage Camillus.
 discitur hinc nullos meritis
 obsistere casus:
 prorogat aeternam feritas tibi
 Punica famam, 410
 Regule; successus superant
 adversa Catonis.
 discitur hinc quantum paupertas
 sobria possit:
 pauper erat Curius, reges cum
 vinceret armis,
 pauper Fabricius, Pyrrhi cum
 sperneret aurum;
 sordida dictator flexit Serranus
 aratra: 415
 lustratae lictore casae fascisque
 salignis
 postibus adfixi; collectae
 consule messes
 et sulcata diu trabeato rura
 colono.”

ploughed by husbandmen who wore the consular robe.”

Such were the precepts of the sire. Even so an aged helmsman oft proved by winter’s various storms, aweary now of the sea and his weight of years, commends to his son the rudder of his bark, tells him of dangers and devices—by what art the helmsman’s hand is guided; what steerage may elude the wave; what is a sign of storms; what the treachery of a cloudless sky, the promise of the

[159] The story of the punishment of Mettius Fufetius, the Alban dictator, by the Roman king Tullus Hostilius for his treachery in the war against Fidenae is told by Livy (i. 28. 10) and referred to by Claudian (xv. 254).

[160] For Mucius (Scaevola) holding his arm in the flame to show Lars Porsenna how little he, a Roman, minded bodily pain see Livy ii. 12.

COLONO.

Haec genitor^[318] praecepta dabat:
velut ille carinae
longaevus rector, variis quem
saepe procellis 420
exploravit hiems, ponto iam
fessus et annis
aequoreas alni nato commendat
habenas
et casus artesque docet: quo
dextra regatur
sidere; quo fluctus possit
moderamine falli;
quae nota nimborum; quae fraus
infida sereni; 425

[319]

setting sun; what storm-wind frets
the Moon so that discoloured she
uplifts an angry face. Behold now,
great father, in whatsoever part of
heaven thou shinest, be it the
southern arch or the cold
constellation of the Plough that has
won the honour of thy presence; see,
thy prayer has been answered; thy
son now equals thee in merit, nay, a
consummation still more to be
desired, he surpasseth thee, thanks to
the support of thy dear Stilicho
whom thou thyself at thy death didst
leave to guard and defend the
brothers twain. For us there is
nought that Stilicho is not ready to
suffer, no danger to himself he is not
willing to face, neither hardships of
the land nor hazards of the sea. His
courage will carry him on foot across
the deserts of Libya, at the setting of
the rainy Pleiads his ship will
penetrate the Gaetolian Syrtes.

To him, however, thy first command
is to calm fierce nations and bring
peace to the Rhine. On wind-swift
steed, no escort clinging to his side,
he crosses the cloud-capped summits
of the Raetian Alps, and, so great is
his trust in himself, approaches the
river unattended. Then mightest thou
have seen from source to mouth
come hastening up Rhine's princes,
bending their heads in fearful

quid sol occiduus prodat; quo
 saucia vento
decolor iratos attollat Cynthia
 vultus.
adspice nunc, quacumque
 micas, seu circulus
 Austri,
magne parens, gelidi seu te
 meruere Triones,
adspice: completur votum. iam
 natus adaequat 430
te meritis et, quod magis est
 optabile, vincit
subnixus Stilichone tuo, quem
 fratribus ipse
discedens clipeum
 defensoremque dedisti.
pro nobis nihil ille pati
 nullumque recusat
discrimen temptare sui, non
 dura viarum, 435
non incerta maris, Libyae
 squalentis harenas
audebit superare pedes
 madidaque cadente
Pleiade Gaetulas intrabit navita
 Syrtes.
Hunc tamen in primis
 populos lenire feroces
et Rhenum pacare iubes. volat
 ille citatis 440
vectus equis nullaue latus
 stipante caterva,
aspera nubiferas qua Raetia
 porrigit Alpes,
pergit et hostiles (tanta est
 fiducia) ripas
incomitatus adit totum

submission. Before our general the
Sygambri abased their flaxen locks
and the Franks cast themselves upon
the ground and sued with trembling
voice for pardon. Germany swears
allegiance to the absent Honorius
and addresses her suppliant prayers
to him. Fierce Bastarnae were there
and the Bructeri who dwell in the
Hercynian forest. The Cimbrians left
their broad marsh-lands, the tall
Cherusci came from the river Elbe.
Stilicho listens

incomitatus aut. totum

properare^[320] per amnem
attonitos reges humili cervice
videres. 445
ante ducem nostrum flavam
sparsere Sygambri
caesariem pavidoque orantes
murmure Franci
procubuere solo: iuratur
Honorius absens
imploratque tuum supplex
Alamannia nomen.
Bastarnae venere truces, venit
accola silvae 450
Bructerus Hercyniae latisque
paludibus exit
Cimber et ingentes Albim
liquere Cherusci.

[321]

to their various prayers, gives tardy assent to their entreaties and of his great bounty bestows upon them peace. A covenant with Germany gave glory to the Drusi of old, but purchased by what uncertain warfare, by how many disasters! Who can recall the Rhine conquered by terror alone? That which others were enabled to win by long wars—this, Honorius, Stilicho's mere march gives thee.

Thou biddest Stilicho after restoring peace in Gaul save Greece from ruin. Vessels cover the Ionian sea; scarce can the wind fill out so many sails. Neptune with favouring currents attends the fleet that is to save Corinth, and young Palaemon, so long an exile from the shores of his isthmus, returns in safety with his mother to the harbour. The blood of barbarians washes their wagons; the ranks of skin-clad warriors are mowed down, some by disease, some by the sword. The glades of Lycaeus, the dark and boundless forests of Erymanthus, are not enough to furnish such countless funeral pyres; Maenalus rejoices that the axe has stripped her of her woods to provide fuel for such a holocaust. Let Ephyre^[161] rise from her ashes while Spartan and Arcadian, now safe, tread under foot the heaps of

accipit ille preces varias
tardeque rogatus
adnuat et magno pacem pro
munere donat.
nobilitant veteres Germanica
foedera Drusus, 455
Marte sed ancipiti, sed multis
cladibus empta—quis
victum meminit sola formidine
Rhenum?
quod longis alii bellis potuere
mereri,
hoc tibi dat Stilichonis iter.

Post

otia Galli
limitis hortaris Graias fulcire
ruinas. 460
Ionium tegitur velis ventique
laborant
tot curvare sinus servaturasque
Corinthum
prosequitur facili Neptunus
gurgite classes,
et puer, Isthmiaci iam pridem
litoris exul,
secura repetit portus cum matre
Palaemon. 465
plaustra cruore natant: metitur
pellita iuventus:
pars morbo, pars ense perit. non
lustra Lycaeï,
non Erymantheae iam copia
sufficit umbrae
innumeris exusta rogis,
nudataque ferro
sic flagrasse suas laetantur
Maenala silvas. 470
excutiat cineres Euboea

slain; let Greece's sufferings be
made good and her weary land be
allowed to breathe once more. That
nation, wider spread than any that
dwells in northern Scythia, that
found Athos too small and Thrace
too narrow when it crossed them,
that nation, I say, was conquered by
thee and thy captains, and now, in
the persons of the few that survive,
laments its own overthrow. One hill
now shelters a people whose hordes
scarce the whole world could once
contain. Athirst and hemmed within
their rampart they

[161] = Corinth.

excedat cunctis Ephyræ,
Spartan^[322]us et Arcas
tutior exanguis pedibus
proculcet acervos
fessaque pensatis respiret
Graecia poenis!
gens, qua non Scythicos
diffusior ulla Triones
incoluit, cui parvus Athos
angusta⁴⁷⁵que Thrace,
cum transiret, erat, per te
viresque tuorum
fracta ducum lugetque sibi iam
rara superstes,
et, quorum turbae spatium vix
praebuit orbis,
uno colle latent. sitiens
inclusaque vallo

[323]

sought in vain for the stolen waters,
that, once within our foemen's reach,
Stilicho had turned aside in another
course, and commanded the stream,
that marvelled at its strange channel
amid unknown ways, to shift its
altered track.

What wonder that the nations barring
thy path should fall before thee,
since the barbarian of his own choice
now seeks to serve thee? The
Sarmatae, ever a prey to internal
strife, beg to swear allegiance to
thee; the Geloni cast off their cloaks
of hide and fight for thee; you, O
Alans, have adopted the customs of
Latium. As thou choosest for war
men that are brave and eager for the
fray, so thou choosest for the offices
of peace men that are just, and once
chosen keepest them long in their
charge, not ousting them by ever
new successors. We know the
magistrates who govern us, and we
enjoy the blessings of peace while
we reap the advantages of war, as
though we lived at one and the same
time in the reign of warlike Romulus
and peace-loving Numa. A sword is
no longer hung over our heads; there
are no massacres of the great; gone
is the mob of false accusers; no
melancholy exiles are driven from
their fatherland. Unholy increase of
perpetual taxes is at an end; there are

ereptas quaesivit aquas, quas
 hostibus ante 480
 contiguas alio Stilicho
 deflexerat actu
 mirantemque novas ignota per
 avia valles
 iusserat averso fluvium migrare
 meatu.
 Obvia quid mirum vinci, cum
 barbarus ultro
 iam cupiat servire tibi? tua
 Sarmata discors 485
 sacramenta petit; proiecta pelle
 Gelonus
 militat; in Latios ritus transistis
 Alani.
 ut fortes in Marte viros
 animisque paratos,
 sic iustos in pace legis
 longumque tueris
 electos crebris nec
 succedentibus urges. 490
 iudicibus notis regimur,
 fruimurque quietis
 militiaeque bonis, ceu bellatore
 Quirino,
 ceu placido moderante Numa.
 non inminet ensis,
 nullae nobilium caedes; non
 crimina vulgo
 texuntur; patria maestus non
 truditur exul; 495
 impia continui cessant augmenta
 tributi;
 non infelices tabulae; non hasta
 refixas
 vendit opes; avida sector non
 voce citatur

no accursed lists, [\[162\]](#) no auctions of
 plundered wealth; the voice of greed
 summons not the salesman, nor is
 thy treasury increased by private
 losses. Thou art liberal with thy
 money, yet not wasteful of it. The
 loyalty of thy soldiers is a lasting
 loyalty, for it is not bought, nor is it
 gifts that win their love; the army is
 anxious for the success of its own
 child and loves thee who wast its
 nursling.

And how deep is thy devotion to
 Rome herself!

[\[162\]](#) i.e. lists of the proscribed and of
 their properties put up for sale.

voce citatur,
nec tua privatis^[324] crescunt aeraria
damnis.
munificus largi, sed non et
prodigus, auri. 500
perdurat non empta fides nec
pectora merces
adligat; ipsa suo pro pignore
castra laborant;
te miles nutritor amat.

denique Romae

Quae

[325]

How fixed abides thy reverence for the Senate! Old customs are preserved, law has recovered its ancient sanctity in the amendment of former statutes and by the addition of new ones. Such an one as thee Pandion's city^[163] found in Solon; even so did warrior Lacedaemon disdain walls, for unyielding Lycurgus gave it defence. What case so petty, what judicial error so slight that it escapes thy notice? Who with truer justice put an end to dishonest suits and brought forth lurking truth from her hiding-place? What mercy, yet what firmness; thine is the quiet strength of a great soul, too firm to be stirred by fear, too stable to be swayed by the attraction of novelty. How stored with learning thy ready wit, how controlled thy speech; ambassadors are awe-stricken at thine answers, and thy grave manners make them forget thy years.

How thy father's nobility shines in thy face! How awful is thy winning brow, how charming the majesty of a blushing emperor! Boy though thou art, thou canst wear thy sire's helmet and brandish thy grandsire's spear. These exercises of thy youth foreshadow vast strength in manhood and convince Rome that the ruler of her prayers is come. How fair art thou in shield and golden

cura tibi! quam fixa manet
 reverentia patrum!
firmatur senium iuris
 priscamque resumunt 505
canitiem leges emendanturque
 vetustae
acceduntque novae. talem
 sensere Solonem
res Pandioniae; sic armipotens
 Lacedaemon
despexit muros rigido munita
 Lycurgo.
quae sub te vel causa brevis vel
 iudicis error 510
neglegitur? dubiis quis litibus
 addere finem
iustior et mersum latebris
 educere verum?
quae pietas quantusque rigor
 tranquillaque magni
vis animi nulloque levis terrore
 moveri
nec nova mirari facilis! quam
 docta facultas 515
ingenii linguaeque modus!
 responsa verentur
legati, gravibusque latet sub
 moribus aetas.
 Quantus in ore pater radiat!
 quam torva voluptas
frontis et augusti maiestas grata
 pudoris!
iam patrias imples galeas; iam
 cornus avita 520
temptatur vibranda tibi;
 promittitur ingens
dextra rudimentis Romanaque
 vota moratur

armour girt, with waving plumes and
taller by the altitude of a helmet! So
looked the youthful Mars when after
the toil and sweat of his first battle
he bathed him in Thracian
Rhodope's mountain stream. With
what vigour thou hurlest the javelin,
and, when thou stretchest the Cretan
bow, what success attends thy shaft!
Sure is the wound it seeks; it knows
not how to fail the appointed stroke.
Thou knowest in what fashion the
Cretan,

[163] *i.e.* Athens.

vota moratur.

quis decor, incedis quotiens
clipeatus et auro
squameus et rutilus cristis et
casside maior!
sic, cum Threïcia primum
sudaret in hasta, 525
flumina laverunt puerum
Rhodopeia Martem.
quae vires iaculis vel, cum
Gortynia tendis
spicula, quam felix arcus
certique petitor
vulneris et iussum mentiri
nescius ictum!
scis, quo more Cydon, qua
dirigat arte sagittas 530

[327]

with what skill the Armenian, directs
his arrows; in what the retreating
Parthian puts his trust. Thus was
Alcides, graced with the sweat of the
wrestling-ground at Thebes, wont to
try his bow and Boeotian arrows on
the beasts of the forest ere he turned
them against the Giants and so
secured peace for heaven. Stains of
blood were ever upon him and proud
was his mother Alcmena of the
spoils he brought back home. Such
was Apollo when he slew the livid
serpent that enfolded and brake
down forests in his dying coils.

When mounted on thy horse thou
playest the mimicry of war, who is
quicker smoothly to wheel in flight,
who to hurl the spear, or more skilled
to sweep round in swift return?
There the Massagetae are not thy
peers nor the tribes of Thessaly, well
versed though they be in riding, no,
nor the very Centaurs themselves.
Scarce can the squadrons and flying
bands that accompany thee keep
pace, while the wind behind thee
bellies the fierce dragons on the
flags. So soon as the touch of thy
spur has fired thy steed, flames start
from his swelling nostrils; his hoof
scarce touches the ground and his
mane is outspread over his
shoulders. His harness rattles and the
golden bit grows warm in his foam-

Armenius, refugo quae sit
 fiducia Partho:
sic Amphioniae pulcher sudore
 palaestrae
Alcides pharetras Dircaeaque
 tela solebat
praetemptare feris olim
 domitura Gigantes
et pacem latura polo,
 semperque cruentus 535
ibat et Alcmenae praedam
 referebat ovanti;
caeruleus tali prostratus
 Apolline Python
implicuit fractis moritura
 volumina silvis.
Cum vectaris equo
 simulacraque Martia
 ludis,
quis mollis sinuare fugas, quis
 tendere contum 540
acrior aut subitos melior
 flexisse recursus?
non te Massagetae, non gens
 exercita campo
Thessala, non ipsi poterunt
 aequare bimembres;
vix comites alae, vix te
 suspensa sequuntur
agmina ferventesque tument
 post terga dracones. 545
utque tuis primum sonipes
 calcaribus arsit,
ignescunt patulae nares, non
 sentit harenas
ungula discussaeque iubae
 sparguntur in armos;
turbantur phalerae, summosque

flecked mouth. The jewels that stud
his quivering bridle are red with
blood. The signs of toil, the dust
stains, the disorder of thy hair all do
but increase thy beauty. Thy brilliant
scarlet cloak drinks in the sunlight as
the wind blows its gay surface into
folds. Could horses choose their
riders then surely would Arion, full
fed in the stables of the Nereids,
have prayed for the very whip of
such a master, Cyllarus would have
had none of Castor, but would have
looked

Cyllarus et flavum Xanthus
 sprevisset Achillem.
ipse tibi famulas praeberet
 Pegasus alas
portaretque libens melioraque
 pondera passus
Bellerophontearum indignaretur
 habenas. 560
quin etiam velox Aurorae
 nuntius Aethon,
qui fugat hinnitu stellas
 roseoque domatur
Lucifero, quotiens equitem te
 cernit ab astris,
invidet inque tuis mavult
 spumare lupatis.
 Nunc quoque quos habitus,
 quantae miracula
 pompae 565
vidimus, Ausonio cum iam
 succinctus amictu
per Ligurum populos solito
 conspicior ires
atque inter niveas alte veherere
 cohortes,
obnixisque simul pubes electa
 lacertis
sidereum gestaret onus. sic
 numina Memphis 570
in vulgus proferre solet;
 penetralibus exit
effigies, brevis illa quidem: sed
 plurimus infra
liniger imposito suspirat vecte
 sacerdos
testatus sudore deum; Nilotica
 sistris
rīna sonat Dhaeriosque modos

rear, throng thy festival; gathered in
one are all the great ones of the earth
that owe their rank either to thee or
to thy sire. Many a consular
surrounds thee, the consul whose
good pleasure it is to associate the
senate in thy triumph. The nobles of
Spain, the wise men of Gaul, and the
senators of Rome all throng round
thee. On young men's necks is borne
thy golden throne, and new adorning
adds weight to deity. Jewels of India
stud thy vestment, rows of green
emeralds enrich

ripa sonat et huiusque modis

Aegyptia ducit ^[330] 575

tibia; summissis admugit

cornibus Apis.

omnis nobilitas, omnis tua sacra

frequentat

Thybridis et Latii suboles;

convenit in unum

quidquid in orbe fuit procerum,

quibus auctor honoris

vel tu vel genitor. numeroso

consule consul 580

cingeris et socios gaudes

admittere patres.

inlustri te prole Tagus, te Gallia

doctis

civibus et toto stipavit Roma

senatu.

portatur iuvenum cervicibus

aurea sedes

ornatuque novo gravior deus.

asperat Indus 585

velamenta lapis pretiosaue fila

smaragdis

[331]

the seams; there gleams the amethyst and the glint of Spanish gold makes the dark-blue sapphire show duller with its hidden fires. Nor in the weaving of such a robe was unadorned beauty enough; the work of the needle increases its value, thread of gold and silver glows therefrom; many an agate adorns the embroidered robes, and pearls of Ocean breathe in varied pattern. What bold hand, what distaff had skill enough to make thus supple elements so hard? What loom so cunning as to weave jewels into close-textured cloth? Who, searching out the uncharted pools of hot Eastern seas, despoiled the bosom of Tethys? Who dared seek o'er burning sands rich growth of coral? Who could broider precious stones on scarlet and so mingle the shining glories of the Red Sea and of Phoenicia's waters? Tyre lent her dyes, China her silks, Hydaspes his jewels. Shouldst thou traverse Maeonian cities in such a garb, to thee would Lydia hand over her vine-wreathed thyrsus, to thee Nysa her dances; the revels of Bacchus would have doubted whence came their madness; tigers would pass fawning beneath thy yoke. Even such, his fawn-skin enwoven with orient gems, doth the Wine-god drive his car, guiding the necks of

ducta virent; amethystus inest et
 fulgor Hiberus
 temperat arcanis hyacinthi
 caerula flammis.
 nec rudis in tali suffecit gratia
 textu;
 auget acus meritum
 picturatumque metallis
 590
 vivit opus: multa remorantur
 iaspide cultus^[164]
 et variis spirat Nereia baca
 figuris.
 quae tantum potuit digitis
 mollire rigorem
 ambitiosa colus? vel cuius
 pectinis arte
 traxerunt solidae gemmarum
 stamina telae? 595
 invia quis calidi scrutatus
 stagna profundum
 Tethyos invasit gremium? quis
 divitis algae
 germina flagrant inter
 quaesivit harenas?
 quis iunxit lapides ostro? quis
 miscuit ignes
 Sidonii Rubrique maris?
 tribuere colorem 600
 Phoenices, Seres subtegmina,
 pondus Hydaspes.
 hoc si Maeonias cinctu
 graderere per urbes,
 in te pampineos transferret
 Lydia thyrsos,
 in te Nysa choros; dubitassent
 orgia Bacchi,
 qui furemque iuxta blandos sub

Hyrcanian tigers with ivory yoke;
 around him satyrs and wild-haired
 Maenads fetter Indians with
 triumphant ivy, while drunken
 Ganges twines his hair with the vine
 tendril.

Already shouts of joy and of good
 omen resound about the consul's
 throne to welcome this thy fourth
 opening of Rome's year. Liberty
 enacts her wonted ceremonies; Law
 observes the custom dating back to
 Vindex^[165] whereby a slave freed
 from his master's service is
 introduced into thy presence and
 thence

^[165] Vindex (or Vindicius) was the
 name of the slave who was granted his
 liberty by Brutus for giving
 information of the royalist plot in
 which Brutus' own sons were
 implicated. For the story (probably an
 aetiological myth to explain *vindicta*,
 another word for *festuca*) see Livy ii. 5.

~~cul. turbant, item Dianae sub~~
^[164] *Birt vultus, cod. Ambrosianus*
cultus. vincula tigres. 605

talīs Erythraeis intextus nebrida
gemmis

Liber agit currus et Caspia
flectit eburnis

colla iugis: Satyri circum
crinemque solutae

Maenades adstringunt hederis
victricibus Indos;

ebrius hostili velatur palmite
Ganges. 610

Auspice mox laetum sonuit
clamore tribunal

te fastos ineunte quater.
sollemnia ludit

omina libertas; deductum
Vindice morem

lex celebrat, famulusque iugo
laxatus erili

dismissed—a freeman thanks to that envied stroke.^[166] A blow upon the brow and his base condition is gone; reddened cheeks have made him a citizen, and with the granting of his prayer a happy insult has given his back freedom from the lash.

Prosperity awaits our empire; thy name is earnest for the fulfilment of our hopes. The past guarantees the future; each time that thy sire made thee chief magistrate of the year the laurels of victory crowned his arms. Once the Gruthungi, hewing down a forest to make them boats, dared to pass beyond the Danube. Three thousand vessels, each crowded with a barbarous crew, made a dash across the river. Odothaeus was their leader. Thy youth, nay, the first year of thy life, crushed the attempt of that formidable fleet. Its boats filled and sank; never did the fish of that northern river feed more lavishly on the bodies of men. The island of Peuce was heaped high with corpses. Scarce even through five mouths could the river rid itself of barbarian blood, and thy sire, owning thine influence, gave thanks to thee for the spoils won in person from King Odothaeus. Consul a second time thou didst end civil war by thine auspices. Let the world thank thee for the overthrow of the Gruthungi

ducitur et grato remeat securior
 ictu. 615
 tristis condicio pulsata fronte
 recedit;
 in civem rubuere genae,
 tergoque removit
 verbera permissi felix iniuria
 voti.
 Prospera Romuleis sperantur
 tempora rebus
 in nomen ventura tuum.
 praemissa futuris 620
 dant exempla fidem: quotiens te
 cursibus aevi
 praefecit, totiens accessit laurea
 patri.
 ausi Danuvium quondam
 transnare Gruthungi
 in lintres fregere nemus; ter
 mille ruebant
 per fluvium plenae cuneis
 inmanibus alni. 625
 dux Odothaeus erat. tantae
 conamina classis
 incipiens aetas et primus
 contudit annus:
 summersae sedere rates;
 fluitantia numquam
 largius Arctoos pavere cadavera
 pisces;
 corporibus premitur Peuce; per
 quinque recurrens
 ostia barbaricos vix egerit unda
 cruores, 631
 confessusque parens Odothaei
 regis opima
 rettulit exuviasque tibi. civile
 secundis

and the defeat of their king; thou
 wast consul when the Danube ran
 red with their blood, thou wast
 consul, too, when thy sire crossed
 the Alps to victory.^[167]

But thou, once author of thy father's
 successes, shalt now be author of
 thine own. Triumph has ever
 attended thy consulship and victory
 thy fasces.

^[166] A reference to the Roman method
 of manumitting a slave *alapa et*
festuca, i.e. by giving him a slight blow
 (*alapa*) with a rod (*festuca*). See Gaius
 on *vindicatio* (iv. 16) and on the whole
 question R. G. Nisbet in *Journal of*
Roman Studies, viii. Pt. 1.

^[167] The campaign of Theodosius
 against Odothaeus, King of the
 Gruthungi (Zosimus iv. 35 calls him
 Ὀδόθεος) is thus dated as 386, the year
 of Honorius' first consulship (see note
 on viii. 153). Honorius' second
 consulship (394) saw the defeat of
 Eugenius.

conficis auspiciis^[334] bellum. tibi
 sis, precor, adsiduus consul
 fata Grunni^{Manigora} relinquo
 et senis Augusti nupterum. quae
 praedia⁶⁴⁰ munda,
 Hister sanguine conegit te
 consule fluctus;
 Alpibus gentibus^{Alpibus} nuptas consule
 prout⁶⁴⁵ taedas!
 quae^{Sed} patris olim fueras
 successu fulgens actor,
 tunc in eisplexus tuae regna
 venere⁶⁵⁰ triumphi
 quem trabes sequitur⁶⁵⁵ tuos,
 victorias⁶⁴⁰ fasces.
 et toto donanda mari?
 quantusque feretur
 idem per Zephyri metas
 Hymenaeus et Euri!
 o mihi si liceat thalamis
 intendere carmen ⁶⁵⁰
 conubiale tuis, si te iam dicere
 patrem!
 tempus erit, cum tu trans Rheni
 cornua victor,
 Arcadius captae spoliis
 Babylonis onustus
 communem maiore toga
 signabitis annum;
 crinitusque tuo sudabit fasce
 Suebus, ⁶⁵⁵
 ultima fraternas horrebunt
 Bactra secures.

Heaven grant thou mayest be our
 perpetual consul and outnumber
 Marius^[168] and old Augustus. Happy
 universe that shall see the first down
 creep over thy cheeks, and the
 wedding-night that shall lead forth
 for thee the festal torches. Who shall
 be consecrated to such a couch; who,
 glorious in purple, shall pass, a
 queen, to the embraces of such a
 husband? What bride shall come to
 be the daughter of so many gods,
 dowered with every land and the
 whole sea? How gloriously shall the
 nuptial song be borne at once to
 farthest East and West! O may it be
 mine to sing thy marriage-hymn,
 mine presently to hail thee father!
 The time will come when, thou
 victorious beyond the mouths of the
 Rhine, and thy brother Arcadius
 laden with the spoil of captured
 Babylon, ye shall endow the year
 with yet more glorious majesty;
 when the long-haired Suebian shall
 bear the arms of Rome and the
 distant Bactrian tremble beneath the
 rule of thyself and thy brother.

^[168] Marius was consul seven,
 Augustus thirteen, times.

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**PANEGYRICUS DICTUS
MANLIO THEODORO
CONSULI**

PRAEFATIO

(XVI.)

[337]

**PANEGYRIC ON THE
CONSULSHIP OF FL.
MANLIUS THEODORUS**[\[169\]](#)
(A.D. 399)

PREFACE

(XVI.)

Wilt dare to sing, my Muse, when so great, so august an assembly shall be thy critic? Does not thine own renown forbid thee? 'Tis greater now than thou deservest; how hard then to enhance, how disgraceful to diminish it! Or has thine assurance grown through ever dwelling in the camp, and does the soldier now wholly possess the poet's breast? Behold the flower of the Roman senate, the majesty, the pride, the heroes of Gaul. The whole earth is my audience, my song shall sound in the ears of all the world. Alack! Love for our consul constrains too strongly. Jove, 'tis said, when he would fain learn its extent (for he knew not the bounds of his own empire) sent forth two eagles of equal flight from the East and from the West. On Parnassus, as they tell, their twin flights met; the Delphic heaven brought together the one bird and the other. Our Emperor needs no

Audebisne, precor, tantae
 subiecta catervae,
 inter tot proceres, nostra
 Thalia, loqui?
 nec te fama vetat, vero quam
 celsius auctam
 vel servasse labor vel
 minuisse pudor?
 an tibi continuis crevit fiducia
 castris 5
 totaque iam vatis pectora
 miles habet?
 culmina Romani maiestatemque
 senatus
 et, quibus exultat Gallia,
 cerne viros.
 omnibus audimur terris
 mundique per aures
 ibimus. ah nimius consulis
 urget amor! 10
 Iuppiter, ut perhibent, spatium
 cum discere vellet
 naturae regni nescius ipse
 sui,
 armigeros utrimque duos
 aequalibus alis
 misit ab Eois Occiduisque
 plagis.
 Parnasus geminos fertur
 iunxisse volatus; 15
 contulit alternas Pythius axis
 aves.
 Princeps non aquilis terras
 cognoscere curat;
 certius in vobis aestimat
 imperium.
 hoc ego concilio collectum
 maior orbem.

eagles to teach him the magnitude of his domains; yourselves are preceptors more convincing. 'Tis this assembly that gives to me the measure of the universe; here I see gathered all the brilliance of the world.

[\[169\]](#) See Introduction, p. xv. Judging from this poem Manlius started by being an *advocatus* in the praetorian prefect's court, was then *praeses* of some district in Africa, then governor (*consularis*) of Macedonia, next recalled to Rome as Gratian's *magister epistularum*, then *comes sacrarum largitionum* (= ecclesiastical treasurer) and after that praetorian prefect of Gaul (ll. 50-53).

melior orbem,
hoc video coetu^[338] quidquid
ubique micat. 20
PANEGYRICUS

(XVII.)

[339]

PANEGYRIC

(XVII.)

Virtue is its own reward; alone with its far-flung splendour it mocks at Fortune; no honours raise it higher nor does it seek glory from the mob's applause. External wealth cannot arouse its desires, it asks no praise but makes its boast of self-contained riches, and unmoved by all chances it looks down upon the world from a lofty citadel. Yet in its own despite importunate honours pursue it, and offer themselves unsought; that the lictor coming from the farm hath ofttimes proved and a consul sought for even at the plough. Thou, too, who wert at leisure to study the mysteries of nature and the heavens, thou who hadst served thy time and retired from the law courts where thou hadst toiled so long, art once more enfolded by a like dignity, which, raising thee aloft, sets in thy returning hands the familiar rein. The consulship now is thine, Theodorus, nor is there now aught left to add to thy virtues or to the glory of thy name. Thou art now at the summit of both; from thine earliest years thy character was thus formed, the whole course of thy life

converse the admiration and delight of all that heard it. The wealth of thy triumphant eloquence soon overflowed the forum and brought safety to the accused. Yea, this most august assembly was astonished at thy pleading, as it was twice to applaud thy governance. Next, a part of Libya approved the administration which it now in its entirety enjoys; but thy brief stay won for thee a pledge of perpetual love, and public statues bear witness with enduring eloquence that thou wert a nation's guardian. Macedonia was next committed to thy care and the walls of Pella, enriched once by conquered Hydaspes. The mildness of thy rule brought to the country entrusted to thee such joy as it once knew under warlike Philip or when the empire of Indian Porus fell to Alexander's arms.

But Rome could not spare thy services longer to the provinces; she chose rather to have thee for her own; thou comest to give edicts to the world, to make reply to suppliants. A monarch's utterance has won dignity from thine eloquence, never can the majesty of Rome recall when she spoke more worthily. After this the offerings and wealth of the world, the tribute of the empire, is entrusted to thy care; the

pondus et attonitas sermo qui
 duceret aures. 20
mox undare foro victrix
 opulentia linguae
tutarique reos. ipsa haec
 amplissima sedes
orantem stupuit, bis laudatura
 regentem.
hinc te pars Libyae moderantem
 iura probavit,
quae nunc tota probat; longi sed
 pignus amoris 25
exiguae peperere morae
 populumque clientem
publica mansuris testantur
 vocibus aera.
inde tibi Macetum tellus et
 credita Pellae
moenia, quae famulus quondam
 ditavit Hydaspes;
tantaque commissae revocasti
 gaudia genti 30
mitibus arbitriis, quantum
 bellante Philippo
floruit aut nigri cecidit cum
 regia Pori.
Sed non ulterius te praebuit
 urbibus aula:
maluit esse suum; terris edicta
 daturus,
supplicibus responsa venis.
 oracula regis 35
eloquio crevere tuo, nec dignius
 umquam
maiestas meminit sese Romana
 locutam.
hinc sacrae mandantur opes
 orbisque tributa

gold washed down by the rivers and
that dug out of deep Thracian mines
by the skill of pale-faced Bessi who
track the hidden seams—all is thine.

As a sailor skilled in wielding the
oar is at first set in charge of but a
side of the vessel, then, when he can
manage the lofty prow and is able,
thanks to his long experience of the
sea, to know beforehand what storms
and tempests the vessel is like to
encounter, he has charge of the helm
and is entrusted with the

^{OLDSPRUE, OLDSPRUE}
[171] expertus Barthius, Birt keeps
possessi, quidquid fluviis

evolvitur auri,
quidquid luce procul venas
rimata sequaces 40
abditā pallentis fodit sollertia
Bessi.

Ac velut expertus [171]
lentandis navita tonsis
praeficitur lateri custos; hinc
ardua prorae
temperat et fluctus
tempestatesque futuras
edocet; adsiduo cum Dorida
vicerit usu, 45
iam clavum totamque subit
torquere carinam:

direction of the entire ship; so when thou hadst long given illustrious proofs of thy character, the empire of Rome summoned thee to govern not a part but the whole of itself, and set thee as ruler over all the rulers of the world. The seas of Spain, the German ocean obeyed thee and Britain, so far removed from our continent. Rivers of all lands observed thy statutes, slow-flowing Saône, swift Rhone, and Ebro rich in gold. How often did the Rhine, in those districts where the barbarians dwell, lament that the blessings of thy rule extended not to both banks! All the lands the setting sun bathes in its rays, all that its last brilliance illumines are entrusted to the charge of one man.

So swiftly did thy career fill office after office; a single period of life was enough for the round of dignities and gave to thy youthful years every step on fortune's ladder.

When repose was earned and now, after reaching the highest place, glory, laying care aside, seeks refuge in a private life, genius again wins reward from other tasks. No part of life is lost: all that is withdrawn from the law courts is devoted to the study, and thy mind in turn either bestows its efforts on the State or its leisure on the Muses. Once more

sic cum clara diu mentis
 documenta dedisses,
 non te parte sui, sed in omni
 corpore sumpsit
 imperium cunctaque dedit
 tellure regendos
 rectores. Hispana tibi
 Germanaque Tethys 50
 paruit et nostro diducta
 Britannia mundo,
 diversoque tuas coluerunt
 gurgite voces
 lentus Arar Rhodanusque ferox
 et dives Hiberus.
 o quotiens doluit Rhenus, qua
 barbarus ibat,
 quod te non geminis frueretur
 iudice ripis! 55
 unius fit cura viri, quodcumque
 rubescit
 occasu, quodcumque dies
 devexior ambit.
 Tam celer adsiduos explevit
 cursus honores;
 una potestatum spatiis interfuit
 aetas
 totque gradus fati iuvenilibus
 intulit annis. 60
 Postquam parta quies et
 summum nacta cacumen
 iam segura petit privatum gloria
 portum,
 ingenii redeunt fructus aliique
 labores,
 et vitae pars nulla perit:
 quodcumque recedit
 litibus, incumbit studiis,
 animusque vicissim 65

thou readest the secrets of ancient
 Athens, examining the discoveries
 with which each sage has enriched
 posterity and noting what hosts of
 disciples the varying schools
 produce.

For some hold that air^[172] is the first
 beginning of all things, others that
 water is, others again derive the sum
 of things from fire. Another, destined
 to

^[172] Claudian refers to the early
 Ionian philosophers. Anaximenes
 believed that air was the first principle
 of all things, Thales said water,
 Heraclitus fire. l. 72 refers to
 Empedocles who postulated the four
 elements and two principles, love and
 hate, which respectively made and
 unmade the universe out of the
 elements. The “*hic*” of l. 75 may be
 Democritus or it may refer to the
 Sceptic, Pyrrho. The “*hic*” of l. 76 is
 Anaxagoras, the friend of Pericles.
 “*Ille*” (79) may be taken to refer to
 Leucippus, the first of the atomic
 philosophers; he postulated infinite
 space. “*Hi*” (82) = Democritus,
 Epicurus, and other atomists. “*Alii*”
 (83) are the Platonists.

animusque vicissim
aut curam imponit^[344] populis aut
otia Musis.
omnia Cecropiae reegis secreta
senectae
discutiens, quid quisque novum
mandaverit aevo
quantaque diversae producant
agmina sectae.
Namque aliis princeps rerum
disponitur aër; 70
hic confidit aquis; hic procreat
omnia flammis.

[345]

fall self-immolated into Etna's fiery crater, reduces God to principles of dispersion and re-collection and binds again in resumed friendship all that discord separates. This philosopher allows no authority to the senses and denies that the truth can be perceived. Another seeks to explain the suspension of the world in space by the rapid revolution of the sky (whence else the world would fall) and kindles day's fires by the whirl of a rushing rock. That fearless spirit, not content with the covering of but one sky, flies through the limitless void and, scorning a limit, conceives in one small brain a thousand worlds. Others make wandering atoms clash with blind blows, while others again set up deities and banish chance.

Thou dost adorn the obscure learning of Greece with Roman flowers,^[173] skilled to shape speech in happy interchange and weave truth's garland with alternate knots. All the lore of Socrates' school, the learning that echoed in Cleanthes' lecture-room, the thoughts of the stoic Chrysippus in his retreat, all the laughter of Democritus, all that Pythagoras spoke by silence—all the wisdom of the ancients is stored in that one brain whence it issues forth the stronger for its concentration.

alter in Aetnaeas casurus sponte
 favillas
 dispergit revocatque deum
 rursusque receptis
 nectit amicitiiis quidquid
 discordia solvit.
 corporis hic damnat sensus
 verumque videri 75
 pernegat. hic semper lapsurae
 pondera terrae
 conatur rapido caeli fulcire
 rotatu
 accenditque diem praerupti
 turbine saxi.
 ille ferox unoque tegi non
 passus Olympo
 inmensum per inane volat
 finemque perosus 80
 parturit innumeros angusto
 pectore mundos.
 hi vaga collidunt caecis
 primordia plagis.
 numina constituunt alii
 casusque relegant.
 Graiorum obscuras Romanis
 floribus artes
 inradius, vicibus gratis formare
 loquentes 85
 suetus et alterno verum
 contexere nodo.
 quidquid Socratico manavit ab
 ordine, quidquid
 docta Cleanthae sonuerunt
 atria turbae,
 inventum quodcumque tuo,
 Chrysippe, recessu,
 quidquid Democritus risit
 dixitque tacendo 90

The ancients gain fresh lustre and,
 scorning Athens, the Academy
 migrates to Latium under a nobler
 master, the more exactly at last to
 learn by what end happiness guides
 its path, what is the rule of the good,
 the goal of the right; what division of
 virtue should be set to combat and
 overthrow each separate vice, and
 what part of virtue it is that curbs
 injustice, that causes reason to
 triumph over fear, that holds lust in
 check. How often hast thou taught us
 the nature

[\[173\]](#) Claudian's way of saying that
 Manlius translates Greek philosophy
 into clear and elegant Latin, throwing
 his translation into the form of a
 dialogue.

Pythagoras, uno^[346] se pectore
cuncta vetustas
condidit et maior collectis
viribus exit.
ornantur veteres et nobiliore
magistro
in Latium spretis Academia
migrat Athenis,
ut tandem propius discat, quo
fine beatum 95
dirigitur, quae norma boni, qui
limes honesti;
quaenam membra sui virtus
divisa domandis
obiectet vitiis; quae pars iniusta
recidat,
quae vincat ratione metus, quae
frenet amores;
aut quotiens elementa doces
semperque fluentis 100

[347]

of the elements and the causes of matter's ceaseless change; what influence has given life to the stars, moving them in their courses; what quickens with movement the universal frame. Thou tellest why the seven planets strive backward towards the East, doing battle with the firmament; whether there is one lawgiver to different movements or two minds govern heaven's revolution; whether colour is a property of matter or whether objects deceive our sight and owe their colours to reflected light; how the moon causes the ebb and flow of the tide; which wind brings about the thunder's crash, which collects the rain clouds and by which the hail-stones are formed; what causes the coldness of snow and what is that flame that ploughs its shining furrow through the sky, hurls the swift thunderbolt, or sets in heaven's dome the tail of the baleful comet.

Already had the anchor stayed thy restful bark, already thou wert minded to go ashore; fruitful leisure charmed and books were being born for immortality, when, of a sudden, Justice looked down from the shining heaven and saw thee at thine ease, saw Law, too, deprived of her great interpreter. She stayed not but, wreathing her chaste forehead with a

materiae causas: quae vis
animaverit astra
impuleritque choros; quo vivat
machina motu;
sidera cur septem retro nitantur
in ortus
obluctata polo; variisne
mentibus idem
arbiter an geminae convertant
aethera mentes;
sitne color proprius rerum,
lucisne repulsu 106
eludant aciem; tumidos quae
luna recursus
nutriat Oceani; quo fracta
tonitrua vento,
quis trahat imbriferas nubes,
quo saxa creentur
grandinis; unde rigor nivibus;
quae flamma per auras
110
excutiat rutilos tractus aut
fulmina velox
torqueat aut tristem figat crinita
cometem.
Iam tibi compositam
fundaverat ancora
puppim,
telluris iam certus eras; fecunda
placebant
otia; nascentes ibant in saecula
libri: 115
cum subito liquida cessantem
vidit ab aethra
Iustitia et tanto viduatas iudice
leges.
continuo frontem limbo velata
nudicam

band, left the gates of Autumn where
the Standard-bearer dips towards the
south and the Scorpion makes good
the losses of the night. Where'er she
flies a peace fell upon the birds and
howling beasts laid aside their rage.
Earth rejoices in the return of a deity
lost to her since the waning of the
age of gold. Secretly Justice enters
the walls of Milan, Liguria's city,
and penetrating with light step the
holy palace finds Theodorus marking
in the sand those heavenly
movements which reverent Memphis
discovered by

deserit Autumni^[348] portas, qua
vergit in Austrum
Signifer et noctis reparant
dispendia Chelae. 120
pax avibus, quacumque volat,
rabiemque frementes
deposuere ferae; laetatur terra
reverso
numine, quod prisci post
tempora perdidit auri.
illa per occultum Ligurum se
moenibus infert
et castos levibus plantis
ingressa penates 125
invenit aetherios signantem
pulvere cursus,
quos pia sollicito deprendit
pollice Memphis:

[349]

anxious reckoning. He sought the forces that move the heavens, the fixed (though errant) path of the planets, the calculation which predicts the over-shadowing of the sun and its surely-fixed eclipse, and the line that sentences the moon to be left in darkness by shutting out her brother. Soon as from afar he beheld the shining face of the Maiden^[175] and recognized the goddess, reverencing that dear countenance, he hurries to meet her, effacing from the sand the diagrams he had drawn.

The goddess was the first to speak. "Manlius, in whom are gathered all the virtues unalloyed, in whom I see traces of ancient justice and manners moulded of a purer metal, thou hast devoted time enough now to study; all these years have the Muses reft from me my pupil. Long has Law demanded thy return to her allegiance. Come, devote thyself once more to my service, and be not content with the glory of thy past. To the service of mankind what boundary ever set the limits? Wisdom accepts no ends for herself. Then, too, to many has this office fallen, as well it might, but only the worthy return thereto; reappointment to office is the best commendation of office well held, and virtue brings

quae moveant momenta polum,
 quam certus in astris
error, quis tenebras solis
 causisque meantem
defectum indicat numerus, quae
 linea Phoeben 130
damnet et excluso pallentem
 fratre relinquat.
ut procul adspexit fulgentia
 Virginis ora
cognovitque deam, vultus
 veneratus amicos
occurrit scriptaeque notas
 confundit harenae.
Tum sic diva prior: "Manli,
 sincera bonorum 135
congeries, in quo veteris
 vestigia recti
et ductos video mores meliore
 metallo:
iam satis indultum studiis,
 Musaeque tot annos
eripueri mihi. pridem te iura
 reposcunt:
adgredere et nostro rursum te
 redde labori 140
nec tibi sufficiat transmissae
 gloria vitae.
humanum curare genus quis
 terminus umquam
praescripsit? nullas recipit
 prudencia metas.
adde quod haec multis potuit
 contingere sedes,
sed meriti tantum redeunt
 actusque priores 145
commendat repetitus honos,
 virtusque reducit

back him whom chance elects.
Deemst thou it a better and a
worthier aim to spend thy days in
exploring Nature's secret laws? Dost
thou think it was thy Plato's precepts
raised his country to glory rather
than he^[176] who, in obedience to the
oracle, sank the Persian fleet, put his
city on shipboard and saved from the
Medes Athens destined for the
flames? Lycurgus could dower the
mothers of Sparta with a man's
courage and by his austere laws
correct the weakness of their sex; by
forbidding

^[175] Virgo (= Astraea) was a
recognized synonym for the goddess
Justice; see Virg. *Ec.* iv. 6.

^[176] i.e. Themistocles.

[174] *virtusque legum* MSS. (*he*
quos fortuna) legit [174] *melius*
magnoque petendum
credis in abstrusa rerum ratione
morari?
scilicet illa tui patriam
praecepta Platonis
erexere magis, quam qui
responsa secutus 150
obruit Eoas classes urbemque
carinis
vexit et arsuras Medo subduxit
Athenas?
Spartanis potuit robur praestare
Lycurgus
matribus et sexum leges vicere
severae

his fellow-citizens to put a coward's trust in walls, he set Lacedemon to face wars more securely in her nakedness; but all the teaching of Pythagoras and his years of silence never crushed the infamous licentiousness of Sparta's colony Tarentum.

“Besides, beneath such an emperor, who could refuse office? Was ever merit more richly rewarded? Who is so insensate as not to wish to meet Stilicho in council? Has ever any age produced his equal in prudence or in bravery? Now would Brutus love to live under a king; to such a court Fabricius would yield, the Catos themselves long to give service. Seest thou not how my sister Mercy blunts the cruel sword of war; how Piety rises to embrace the two noble brothers; how Treason laments her broken weapons and the snakes, writhing in death upon the Furies' wounded heads, lick their chains with enfeebled venom? Peace and loyalty are triumphant. All the host of heaven leaves the stars and wanders from peaceful city to peaceful city. Return thou with us, Theodorus.”

Then Theodorus made answer: “From my long accustomed fields, goddess, thou urgest me to return, summoning to thy standard one

civibus et vetitis ignavo credere
muro 155

tutius obiecit nudam

Lacedaemona bellis:
at non Pythagorae monitus
annique silentes
famosum Oebalii luxum
pressere Tarenti.

“Quis vero insignem tanto
sub principe curam
respuat? aut quando meritis
maiora patebunt 160
praemia? quis demens adeo qui
iungere sensus
cum Stilichone neget? similem
quae protulit aetas
consilio vel Marte virum? nunc
Brutus amaret
vivere sub regno, tali
succumberet aulae
Fabricius, cuperent ipsi servire
Catones. 165

nonne vides, ut nostra soror
Clementia tristes
obtundat gladios fratresque
amplexa serenos
adsurgat Pietas, fractis ut lugeat
armis

Perfidia et laceris morientes
crinibus hydri
lambant invalido Furiarum
vincla veneno? 170
exultat cum Pace Fides, iam
sidera cunctae
liquimus et placidas inter
discurrimus urbes.
nobiscum, Theodore, redi.”

Subit

grown rusty in the distant
countryside. What else has been my
care all these years but to break up
the stubborn fallow-land into
furrows, to know the nature of the
soil, the rocky land suitable to the
growth of trees, the country where
the olive will flourish, the fields that
will yield rich harvests of grain or
the hills which my vineyards may
clothe? I have served my time; am I
to hearken once more to the dreadful
trumpet? Is the old helmsman again
to brave the seas whose lore he has
forgotten?

ille loquentem^[352]

talibus: "agrestem dudum me,
 diva, reverti
 cogis et infectum longi rubigine
 ruris 175
 ad tua signa vocas. nam quae
 mihi cura tot annis
 altera quam duras sulcis mollire
 novales,
 nosse soli vires, nemori quae
 commoda rupes,
 quis felix oleae tractus, quae
 glaeba faveret
 frugibus et quales tegetet
 vindemia colles? 180
 terribiles rursum lituos
 veteranus adibo
 et desueta vetus temptabo
 caerula vector?"

[353]

My fame has long been gathered in
 and where it is 'tis in safe custody;
 am I to suffer its being put to the
 hazard? Full well do I realize that
 habit is a stronger force than nature,
 nor am I ignorant of the rapidity with
 which we forget an art that we have
 ceased to exercise. The whip of an
 unpractised charioteer is powerless
 to urge on his horses; the hand that is
 unaccustomed thereto cannot bend
 the bow. And yet it were unjust, I
 admit, to refuse aught to Justice.
 Thou first didst draw man from his
 woodland cave and free the human
 race from its foul manner of life.
 Thanks to thee we practise law and
 have put off the temper of wild
 beasts. Whosoever has drunk of thee
 with pure heart will rush fearless
 through flames, will sail the wintry
 seas, and overcome unarmed the
 densest company of foemen. Justice
 is to the just as rain to temper even
 the heat of Ethiopia, a breath of
 spring to journey with him across the
 deserts of Scythia."

So spake he and took from the
 goddess' hand the four reins that lay
 stretched along the huge pole of
 Justice's car. The first harnesses the
 rivers Po and Tiber and Italy with all
 her glittering towns; the second
 guides Numidia and Carthage; the
 third runs out across the land of

collectamque diu et certis
 utcumque locatam
 sedibus in dubium patiar
 deponere famam?
 nec me, quid valeat natura
 fortior usus, 185
 praeterit aut quantum neglectae
 defluat arti.
 desidis aurigae non audit
 verbera currus,
 nec manus agnoscit quem non
 exercuit arcum.
 esse sed iniustum fateor
 quodcumque negatur
 iustitiae. tu prima hominem
 silvestribus antris 190
 elicis et foedo deterges saecula
 victu.
 te propter colimus leges
 animosque ferarum
 exuimus. nitidis quisquis te
 sensibus hausit,
 inruet intrepidus flammis,
 hiberna secabit
 aequora, confertos hostes
 superabit inermis. 195
 ille vel Aethiopum pluviis
 solabitur aestus;
 illum trans Scythiam vernus
 comitabitur aër.”
 Sic fatus tradente dea
 suscepit habenas
 quattuor ingenti iuris temone
 refusas.
 prima Padum Thybrimque ligat
 crebrisque micantem
 urbibus Italiam; Numidas^[177]
 Despectus secunda per

Illyria; the last holds Sardinia,
 Corsica, three-cornered Sicily and
 the coasts beaten by the Tyrrhenian
 wave or that echo to the Ionian. The
 splendour and magnitude of the
 undertaking troubled thee not one
 whit; but as the lofty summit of
 Olympus, far removed from the
 winds and tempests of the lower air,
 its eternal bright serene untroubled
 by any cloud, is lifted above the rain
 storms and hears the hurricane
 rushing

[\[177\]](#) [Numidas Heinsius, Birt & Lydos.](#) [Poënosque secundum 201](#)
temperat; Illyrico se tertia
porrigit orbi;
ultima Sardiniam, Cynnum
trifidamque retentat
Sicaniam et quidquid Tyrrhena
tunditur unda
vel gemit Ionia. nec te tot
lumina rerum 205
aut tantum turbavit onus; sed ut
altus Olympi
vertex, qui spatio ventos
hiemesque relinquit,
perpetuum nulla temeratus nube
serenum
celsior exurgit pluviis auditque
ruentes

beneath its feet while it treads upon the thunder's roar; so thy patient mind, unfettered by cares so manifold, rises high above them; thou art ever the same, no hatred can compel thee, no affection induce thee, to swerve from the path of justice. For why should any speak of riches scorned and a heart unallured by gain? These might perhaps be virtues in others: absence of vice is no praise to bestow on thee. The calm of a god banishes anger from thy voice; the spirit of moderation shines from thine eyes; passion never inflames that glance or fills with blood the angry veins; never is a tempest heralded on thy changed countenance. Nay, thou punishest the very criminals without show of anger and checkest their evil-doing with unruffled calm. Never dost thou gnash with thy teeth upon them nor shout orders for them to be chastised.

He is a savage who delights in punishment and seems to make the vengeance of the laws his own; when his heart is inflamed with the poison of wrath he is goaded by fury and rushes on knowing nothing of the cause and eager only to do hurt. But he whom reason, not anger, animates is a peer of the gods, he who, weighing the guilt, can with

sub pedibus nimbos et rauca
 tonitrua calcat: 210
sic patiens animus per tanta
 negotia liber
emergit similisque sui, iustique
 tenorem
flectere non odium cogit, non
 gratia suadet.
nam spretas quis opes
 intactaque pectora lucro
commemoret? fuerint aliis haec
 forte decora: 215
nulla potest laus esse tibi, quae
 crimina purget.
servat inoffensam divina
 modestia vocem:
temperiem servant oculi; nec
 lumina fervor
asperat aut rabidas suffundit
 sanguine venas,
nullaque mutati tempestas
 proditur oris. 220
quin etiam sontes expulsa
 corrigis ira
et placidus delicta domas; nec
 dentibus umquam
instrepis horrendum, fremitu
 nec verbera poscis.
 Qui fruitur poena, ferus est,
 legumque videtur
vindictam praestare sibi; cum
 viscera felle 225
canduerint, ardet stimulis
 ferturque nocendi
prodigus, ignarus causae: dis
 proximus ille,
quem ratio, non ira movet, qui
 facta rependens

deliberation balance the punishment.
Let others boast them of their bloody
swords and wish to be feared for
their ferocity, while they fill their
treasuries with the goods of the
condemned. Gently flows the Nile,
yet is it more beneficent than all
rivers for all that no sound reveals its
power. More swiftly the broad
Danube glides between its quiet
banks. Huge Ganges flows down to
its mouths with gently moving
current. Let torrents roar horribly,
threaten weary

iacta rependens
consilio punire^[356] potest. mucrone
cruento
se iactent alii, studeant feritate
timeri 230
addictoque hominum cumulent
aeraria censu.
lene fluit Nilus, sed cunctis
amnibus extat
utilior nullo confessus murmure
vires;
acrior ac rapidus tacitas
praetermeat ingens
Danuvius ripas; eadem
dementia sani 235
gurgitis inmensum deducit in
ostia Gangen.
torrentes inmane fremant
lassisque minentur

[357]

bridges, and sweep down forests in
their foaming whirl; 'tis repose,
befits the greater; quiet authority
accomplishes what violence cannot,
and that mandate compels more
which comes from a commanding
calm.

“Thou art as deaf to the prayers of
injustice as thou art generous and
attentive where the demand is just.
Pride, that ever accompanies office,
has not so much as dared to touch
thy mind. Thy look is a private
citizen's nor allows that it has
deserved what it thinks to have but
grown^[178]; but full of stately
modesty shines forth a gravity that
charms because pride is banished.
What sedition, what madness of the
crowd could see thee and not sink
down appeased? What country so
barbarous, so foreign in its customs,
as not to bow in reverence before thy
mediation? Who that desires the
honied charm of polished eloquence
would not desert the lyre-
accompanied song of tuneful
Orpheus? In every activity we see
thee as we see thee in thy books,
describing the creation of the newly-
fashioned earth or the parts of the
soul; we recognize thy character in
thy pages.

The Emperor has not been slow in
rewarding thy merit. The robe that

pontibus et volvant spumoso
 vertice silvas:
pax maiora decet; peragit
 tranquilla potestas,
quod violenta nequit,
 mandataque fortius
 urget 240
imperiosa quies.

 Idem
 praedurus iniquas
acceperis preces, rursus, quae
 digna petitu,
largior et facilis; nec quae
 comitatur honores,
ausa tuam leviter temptare
 superbia mentem.
frons privata manet nec se
 meruisse fatetur, 245
quae crevisse putat; rigidi sed
 plena pudoris
elucet gravitas fastu iucunda
 remoto.
quae non seditio, quae non
 insania vulgi
te viso lenita cadat? quae
 dissona ritu
barbaries, medii quam non
 reverentia frangat? 250
vel quis non sitiens sermonis
 mella politi
deserat Orpheos blanda
 testudine cantus?
qualem te legimus teneri
 primordia mundi
scribentem aut partes animae,
 per singula talem
cernimus et similes agnoscit
 pagina mores 255

links Senate-house and palace, that
unites nobles with their prince—the
robe that he himself has four times
worn, he hath at the year's end
handed on to thee, and left his own
curule chair that thou mightest
follow him. Grow, ye virtues; be this
an age of prosperity! The path of
glory lies open to the wise; merit is
sure of its reward; industry dowered
with the gifts it deserves. Arts, rise
from the slumber into which
depraved ambition had forced you!
Envy cannot hold up her head while
Stilicho and his godlike

[178] *i.e.* Manlius modestly regards his
honours as a natural growth, not as the
reward of merit.

Nec dilata tuis^[358] Augusto
 iudice merces
 officiis, illumque habitum, quo
 iungitur aulae
 curia, qui socio proceres cum
 principe nectit,
 quem quater ipse gerit, perfecto
 detulit anno
 deposuitque suas te succedente
 curules. 260
 crescant virtutes fecundaque
 floreat aetas.
 ingeniis patuit campus
 certusque merenti
 stat favor: ornatur propriis
 industria donis.
 surgite sopitae, quas obruit
 ambitus, artes.
 nil licet invidiae, Stilicho dum
 prospicit orbi 265

son-in-law direct the state. Here is no pollution of the consul's office, no shameful names disgrace the Latin fasti; here the consulship is an honour reserved for the brave, given only to senators, never a source of scandal to Rome's city.^[180]

Now had Fame, announcing our good fortune, winged her way to Aonia whose groves she stirred with the tidings of the new consul. Helicon raised a hymn of praise, Aganippe flowed with waters more abundant, the streams of song laughed with flowers. Then Urania, her hair wreath-crowned, Urania whose hand had oft directed Manlius' compass in marking out the starry spheres, thus addressed the other Muses: "Sisters, can we bear to be absent this longed-for day? Shall we not visit our consul's door and the house we have always loved? Better known to us is it than Helicon; gladly we draw the curule chair and bear the fasces. Bring marvels for the people's delight and make known his name in the famed theatres.

"Do thou, Erato, go visit the palace of Neptune beneath the sea and beg for four swift coursers such that even Arion could not snatch the prize from them. Let the Circus be graced by every steed to whose proud

sidereusque gener. non hic
 violata curulis,
 turpia non Latios incestant
 nomina fastos;
 fortibus haec concessa viris
 solisque gerenda
 patribus et Romae numquam
 latura pudorem.
 Nuntia votorum celeri iam
 Fama volatu 270
 moverat Aonios audito consule
 lucos.
 concinuit felix Helicon
 fluxitque Aganippe
 largior et docti riserunt floribus
 amnes.
 Uranie redimita comas, qua
 saepe magistra
 Manlius igniferos radio
 descripserat axes, 275
 sic alias hortata deas:
 “patimurne, sorores,
 optato procul esse die nec
 limina nostri
 consulis et semper dilectas
 visimus aedes?
 notior est Helicone^[179] domus.
 gestare curules
 et fasces subiisse libet. miracula
 plebi 280
 colligite et claris nomen
 celebrate theatri.
 “Tu Iovis aequorei
 summersam fluctibus
 aulam
 oratum volucres, Erato, iam
 perge quadrigas,
 a quibus haud unquam palmam

neighing Baetis re-echoes, who
 drinks of Tagus' shining pools and
 sprinkles his mane with its liquid
 gold.

“Calliope, ask thou of Alcides the oil
 of the wrestling-ground. Let all the
 company proved in the games at Elis
 follow thee and the athletes who
 have won fame with Olympian Jove.

“Fly, Clio, to Taygetus' heights and
 leafy Maenalus and beg Diana not to
 spurn thy petition but help the
 amphitheatre's pomp. Let the
 goddess herself

^[180] Claudian is thinking of
 Eutropius, Manlius' eastern colleague.

a quibus naucumque panem
179 ^{codu. have Sanchone, Birt}
obelizes raptus Arion. found in V;
Helicone Gevartius.

inlustret circum sonipes,
quicumque superbo 285
perstrepit hinnitu Bactin, qui
splendida potat
stagna Tagi madidoque iubas
adspergitur auro.

“Calliope, liquidas Alciden
posce palaestras:
cuncta Palaemoniis manus
explorata coronis
adsit et Eleo pubes laudata
Tonanti. 290

“Tu iuga Taygeti frondosaque
Maenala, Clio,
i Triviae supplex; non aspernata
rogantem
amphitheatrali faveat Latonia
pompae.

choose out brave hunters cunningly
to lasso the necks of wild animals
and to drive home the hunting-spear
with unfailing stroke. With her own
hand let her lead forth from their
caverns fierce beasts and captive
monsters, laying aside her
bloodthirsty bow. Let bears be
gathered together, whereat, as they
charge with mighty bulk, Helice may
gaze in wonder from Lycaon's stars.

[181] Let smitten lions roar till the
people turn pale, lions such as
Cybele would be fain to harness to
her Mygdonian chariot or Hercules
strangle in his mighty arms. May
leopards, lightning-swift, hasten to
meet the spear's wound, beasts that
are born of an adulterous union what
time the spotted sire did violence to
the nobler lion's mate: of such beasts
their markings recall the sire, their
courage the dam. Whatsoever is
nourished by the fields of Gaetulia
rich in monsters, whatsoever lurks
beneath Alpine snows or in Gallic
woods, let it fall before the spear. Let
large streams of blood enrich the
arena and the spectacle leave whole
mountains desolate.

“Nor let gentler games lack the
delights we bring: let the clown be
there to move the people's laughter
with his happy wit, the mime whose
language is in his nod and in the

audaces legat ipsa viros, qui
 colla ferarum
 arte ligent certoque premant
 venabula nisu. 295
 ipsa truces fetus captivaque
 ducat ab antris
 prodigia et caedis sitientem
 differat arcum.
 convenient ursi, magna quos
 mole ruentes
 torva Lycaoniis Helice miretur
 ab astris,
 perfossique rudant populo
 pallente leones, 300
 quales Mygdonio curru frenare
 Cybebe
 optet et Herculei mallent
 fregisse lacerti.
 obvia fulminei properent ad
 vulnera pardi
 semine permixto geniti, cum
 forte leaenae
 nobiliorem uterum viridis
 corruptit adulter; 305
 hi maculis patres referant et
 robore matres.
 quidquid monstriferis nutrit
 Gaetulia campis,
 Alpina quidquid tegitur nive,
 Gallica siquid
 silva tenet, iaceat; largo ditiescat
 harena
 sanguine; consumant totos
 spectacula montes. 310
 “Nec molles egeant nostra
 dulcedine ludi:
 qui laetis risum salibus movisse
 facetus

movements of his hands, the musician whose breath rouses the flute and whose finger stirs the lyre, the slippered comedian to whose voice the theatre re-echoes, the tragedian towering on his loftier buskin; him too whose light touch can elicit loud music from those pipes of bronze that sound a thousand diverse notes beneath his wandering fingers and who by means of a lever stirs to song the labouring water.^[182] Let us see acrobats who hurl themselves through the air like birds and build

^[181] Helice = the Great Bear; so does the phrase “Lycaon’s stars,” for Lycaon was the father of Callisto who was transformed by the jealous Juno into a bear and as such translated by Jupiter to the sky. Claudian means that he wants the Great Bear to observe this assemblage of earthly bears.

^[182] The *hydraulus* or water organ was known in Cicero’s day (*Tusc.* iii. 18.43). It is illustrated by a piece of sculpture in the Museum at Arles (see Grove, *Dict. of Music*, under “Organ”).

iactatus,
[362]
qui nutu manibusque loquax,
cui tibia flatu,
cui plectro pulsanda chelys, qui
pulpita socco
personat aut alte graditur
maiore cothurno, 315
et qui magna levi detrudens
murmura tactu
innumeras voces segetis
moderatus aenae
intonet erranti digito penitusque
trabali
vecte laborantes in carmina
concitet undas,
vel qui more avium sese
iaculentur in auras 320

[363]

pyramids that grow with swift
entwining of their bodies, to the
summit of which pyramid rushes a
boy fastened by a thong, a boy who,
attached there by the foot or leg,
executes a step-dance suspended in
the air. Let the counterweights be
removed and the mobile crane
descend, lowering on to the lofty
stage men who, wheeling chorus-
wise, scatter flames; let Vulcan forge
balls of fire to roll innocuously
across the boards, let the flames
appear to play about the sham beams
of the scenery and a tame
conflagration, never allowed to rest,
wander among the untouched
towers. Let ships meet in mimic
warfare on an improvised ocean and
the flooded waters be lashed to foam
by singing oarsmen.

“As consul at once and stateliest
master, upborne by a twofold fame,
let Manlius go forth among the
peoples, read in his own books and
in our calendars. May the sire’s
example be followed by the son [\[183\]](#)
and handed on to a grandson, nor
these first fasces ever lack
succession. May his race pass on
purple-clad, may the generations,
each to each, hand on the axes, and
obedient to the ordinance of fate,
Manlius after Manlius add one more
consul to the tale.”

corporaque aedificent celeri
 crescentia nexu,
quorum compositam puer
 amentatus in arcem
emicet et vinctu plantae vel
 cruribus hacrens
pendula librato figat vestigia
 saltu.
mobile ponderibus descendat
 pegma reductis 325
inque chori speciem spargentes
 ardua flammās
scaena rotet varios et fingat
 Mulciber orbis
per tabulas impune vagus
 pictaeque citato
ludant igne trabes et non
 permissa morari
fida per innocuas errent
 incendia turre. 330
lascivi subito confligant
 aequore lembi
stagnaque remigibus spument
 inmissa canoris.
 “Consul per populos idemque
 gravissimus auctor
eloquii, duplici vita subnixus in
 aevum
procedat pariter libris fastisque
 legendus. 335
accipiat patris exemplum
 tribuatque nepoti
filius et coeptis ne desit
 fascibus heres.
decurrat trabeata domus
 tradatque secures
mutua postcritas servatoque
 ordine fati

[183] We do not hear of Claudian's hopes coming true. This son was, however, proconsul of Africa (Augustine, *Contra Crescon.* iii. 62).

origines
[364]
Manlia continuo numeretur
consule proles.” 340
**DE CONSULATU
STILICHONIS**

LIBER I.

(XXI.)

[365]
**ON STILICHIO'S
CONSULSHIP (A.D. 400)**

BOOK I

(XXI.)

Ceaseless are the blessings the gods shower with full bounty upon Rome, crowning success with new successes. Scarce had the happy songs of marriage ceased to echo in the palace when the defeat of Gildo brought material for a hymn of triumph. Hard upon the garlands of passionate love followed the crown of laurel, so that the emperor won alike the name of husband and the fame of conqueror. After the war in Africa eastern sedition waned; the Orient once more was laid low and, guarded by the consul Stilicho, the axes rose in triumph. In due order are vows fulfilled. Should I hope to roll into one poem all my lofty themes, more easily should I pile Pelion on frozen Ossa. Were I silent anent a part, what I leave unsung will prove the greater. Am I to recall his deeds of old and earliest manhood? His present deeds lure away my mind. Am I to tell of his justice? His military glory outshines it. Shall I mention his prowess in war? He has done more in peace.

Continuant superi pleno
Romana favore
gaudia successusque novis
successibus augent:
conubii necdum festivos regia
cantus
sopierat, cecinit fuso Gildone
triumphos,
et calidis thalami successit
laurea sertis, 5
sumeret ut pariter princeps
nomenque mariti
victorisque decus; Libyae post
proelia crimen
concidit Eoum, rursusque
Oriente subacto
consule defensae surgunt
Stilichone secures.
ordine vota meant. equidem si
carmen in unum 10
tantarum sperem cumulos
advolvere rerum,
promptius imponam glaciali
Pelion Ossae.
si partem tacuisse velim,
quodcumque relinquam
maius erit. veteres actus
primamque iuventam
prosequar? ad sese mentem
praesentia ducunt. 15
narrem iustitiam? resplendet
gloria Martis.
armati referam vires? plus egit
inermis.
quod floret Latium, Latio quod
reddita servit
Africa, vicinum quod nescit
Hiberia Maurum

Shall I relate how Latium flourishes,
how Africa has returned to her
allegiance and service, how Spain
knows no more

the Moor as her neighbour, how Gaul has now nought to fear from a disarmed Germany? Or shall I sing of wintry Thrace and those fierce struggles whereof Hebrus was witness? Limitless is the expanse that opens before me and even on the slopes of Helicon this weight of praise retards my muse's chariot.

For truly since man inhabited this globe never has one mortal been granted all earth's blessings without alloy. This man's face is fair but his character is evil; another has a beauteous soul but an ugly body. One is renowned in war but makes peace hideous with his vices. This man is happy in his public but unhappy in his private life. Each takes a part; each owes his fame to some one gift, to bodily beauty, to martial prowess, to strength, to uprightness of life, to knowledge of law, to his offspring and a virtuous wife. To all men else blessings come scattered, to thee they flow commingled, and gifts that separately make happy are all together thine.

I will not unfold the tale of thy sire's^[184] warlike deeds. Had he done nothing of note, had he in loyalty to Valens never led to battle those yellow-haired companies, yet to be the father of Stilicho would

tuta quod imbellem miratur
Gallia Rhenum, 20
aut gelidam Thracen
decertatosque labores
Hebro teste canam? magnum
mihi panditur aequor,
ipsaque Pierios lassant proclivia
currus
laudibus innumeris.

Etenim
mortalibus ex quo
tellus coepta coli, numquam
sincera bonorum 25
sors ulli concessa viro. quem
vultus honestat,
dedecorant mores; animus
quem pulchrior ornat,
corpus destituit. bellis insignior
ille,
sed pacem foedat vitiis. hic
publica felix,
sed privata minus, partitum;
singula quemque 30
nobilitant: hunc forma decens,
hunc robur in armis,
hunc rigor, hunc pietas, illum
sollertia iuris,
hunc suboles castique tori.
sparguntur in omnes,
in te mixta fluunt; et quae divisa
beatos
efficiunt, collecta tenes. 35

Ne

facta revolvam
militiamque patris, cuius
producere famam,
si nihil egisset clarum nec fida
Valenti

have spread abroad his fame. Ever
from thy cradle did thy soul aspire,
and in the tender years of childhood
shone forth the signs of loftier estate.
Lofty in spirit and eager, nothing
paltry didst thou essay; never didst
thou haunt any rich man's doorstep;
thy speech was such as to befit thy
future dignities. A mark wert thou
even then for all eyes, even then an
object of reverence; the fiery
brightness of thy noble countenance,
the very mould

[184] We know really nothing of
Stilicho's parentage save that the
family was a Vandal one: *Vandalorum
genere editus*, Oros. vii. 38.

dextera duxisset^[368] rutilantes
 crinibus alas,
 sufficeret natus Stilicho: mens
 ardua semper
 a puero, tenerisque etiam
 fulgebat in annis 40
 fortunae maioris honos. erectus
 et acer
 nil breve moliri, nullis haerere
 potentum
 liminibus fatisque loqui iam
 digna futuris.
 iam tum conspicuus, iam tum
 venerabilis ibas
 spondebatque ducem celsi nitor
 igneus oris 45

[369]

of thy limbs, greater even than poets
 feign of demi-gods, marked thee out
 for a leader of men. Whithersoever
 thy proud form went in the city thou
 didst see men rise and give place to
 thee; yet thou wast then but a soldier.
 The silent suffrage of the people had
 already offered thee all the honours
 the court was soon to owe.

Scarce hadst thou reached man's
 estate when thou wast sent to
 negotiate peace with Assyria^[185]; to
 make a treaty with so great a people
 was the charge entrusted to thy
 youth. Crossing the Tigris and the
 deep Euphrates thou cam'st to
 Babylon. The grave lords of Parthia
 looked at thee in amaze and the
 quiver-bearing mob burned with
 desire to behold, while the daughters
 of Persia gazing on their beauteous
 guest sighed out their hidden love.
 The peace is sworn at altars sweet
 with the fragrance of incense and the
 harvests of Saba. Fire is brought
 forth from the innermost sanctuary
 and the Magi sacrifice heifers
 according to the Chaldean ritual. The
 king himself dips the jewelled bowl
 of sacrifice and swears by the
 mysteries of Bel and by Mithras who
 guides the errant stars of heaven.
 Whenever they made thee sharer of
 their hunting, whose sword struck
 down the lion in close combat before

membrorumque modus, qualem
nec carmina fingunt
semideis. quacumque alte
graderis in urbe,
cedentes spatii adsurgentesque
videbas
quamvis miles adhuc. taciti
suffragia vulgi
iam tibi detulerant, quidquid
mox debuit aula. 50
Vix primaevus eras, pacis
cum mitteris auctor
Assyriae; tanta foedus cum
gente ferire
commissum iuveni. Tigrim
transgressus et altum
Euphraten Babylona petis.
stupere severi
Parthorum procures, et plebs
pharetrata videndi 55
flagravit studio, defixaeque
hospite pulchro
Persides arcanum suspiravere
calorem.
turis odoratae cumulis et messe
Sabaea
pacem conciliant arae;
penetralibus ignem
sacratum rapuere adytis rituque
iuvenco 60
Chaldaeo stravere magi. rex
ipse micantem
inclinat dextra pateram
secretaque Beli
et vaga testatur volventem
sidera Mithram.
si quando sociis tecum
venatibus ibant

that of Stilicho, whose arrow pierced
the striped tiger afar before thine?
When thou didst guide the easy rein
the Mede gave way to thee, and the
Parthian marvelled at the bow thou
didst discharge in flight.

Meanwhile a maiden of years full
ripe for marriage troubled a father's
heart, and the emperor doubted
whom to select as her husband and
as future ruler of the world; right
anxiously did he search east and
west for a son-in-law worthy of
being wedded

[185] By Assyria Claudian means
Persia. He refers to the dispatch of
Stilicho in 387 as ambassador to the
court of Sapor III. (383-388) to arrange
about the partition of Armenia.

venantibus idant,
 quis Stilichone prior ferro
 penetrare leones 65
 comminus aut longe virgatas
 figere tigres?
 flectenti faciles cessit tibi
 Medus habenas;
 torquebas refugum Parthis
 mirantibus arcum.
 Nubilis interea maturae
 virginis aetas
 urgebat patrias suspensio
 principe curas, 70
 quem simul imperioque ducem
 nataeque maritum
 prospiceret; dubius toto
 quaerebat ab axe
 dignum coniugio generum
 thalamisque Serenae.

[371]

to Serena. Merit alone had to decide; through camps, through cities, through nations roamed his poised and hesitating thoughts. But thou wast chosen, thus in the opinion and judgement of him who selected thee surpassing all the candidates of the whole world and becoming a son-in-law in the imperial family where thou wast shortly to become a father-in-law. The marriage-bed was ablaze with flashing gold and regal purple. The maiden steps forth accompanied by her parents clad in scarlet. On one side stood her sire, famed for his triumphs, on the other was the queen, fulfilling a mother's loving office and ordering the bridal veil beneath a weight of jewels. Then, so men say, the horses of the sun and the stars of heaven danced for joy, pools of honey and rivers of milk welled forth from the earth. Bosphorus decked his banks with vernal flowers, and Europe, entwined with rosy garlands, uplifted the torches in rivalry with Asia.

Happy our emperor in his choice; he judges and the world agrees; he is the first to value what we all see. Ay, for he has allied to his children and to his palace one who never preferred ease to war nor the pleasures of peace to danger, nor yet his life to his honour. Who but he

iudicium virtutis erat; per
castra, per urbes,
per populos animi cunctantis
libra cucurrit. 75
tu legeris tantosque viros, quos
obtulit orbis,
intra consilium vincis
sensusque legentis,
et gener Augustis olim socer
ipse futurus
accedis. radiis auri Tyriaque
superbit
maiestate torus; comitata
parentibus exit 80
purpureis virgo. stabat pater
inde tropaeis
inclitus; inde pium matris
regina gerebat
obsequium gravibus subnectens
flammea gemmis.
tunc et Solis equos, tunc
exultasse choreis
astra ferunt mellisque lacus et
flumina lactis 85
erupisse solo, cum floribus
aequora vernis
Bosphorus indueret roseisque
evincta coronis
certantes Asiae taedas Europa
levaret.
Felix arbitrii princeps, qui
congrua mundo
iudicat et primus censet, quod
cernimus omnes. 90
talem quippe virum natis
adiunxit et aulae,
cui neque luxuries bello nec
blanda periculis

could have driven back the savage
Visigoths to their wagons or
overwhelmed in one huge slaughter
the Bastarnae puffed up with the
slaying of Promotus^[186]? Aeneas
avenged the slaughter of Pallas with
the death of Turnus, Hector, dragged
behind the chariot-wheels, was to
wrathful Achilles either revenge or
gain; thou dost not carry off in mad
chariot dead bodies for ransom nor
plot idle savagery against a single
corpse; thou slayest at thy friend's
tomb whole

^[186] Promotus, who had rescued
Theodosius from an ambush in his war
against the Visigoths in 390, lost his
life in the same war the year after.
Stilicho succeeded to his command.

otia nec lucis ^{fructus} pretiosior
umquam
laude fuit. quis enim Visos in
plaustra feroces
reppulit aut saeva Promoti
caede tumentes 95
Bastarnas una potuit delere
ruina?
Pallantis iugulum Turno
moriente piavit
Aeneas, tractusque rotis
ultricibus Hector
irato vindicta fuit vel quaestus
Achilli.
tu neque vesano raptas venalia
curru 100
funera nec vanam corpus
meditaris in unum
saevitiam; turmas equitum
peditumque catervas

[373]

squadrons of horse, companies of foot, and hordes of enemies. To his ghost a whole nation is offered up. Neither Vulcan's fabulous shield nor such armour as that of which poets sing the forging assisted thine efforts. Single-handed thou didst succeed in penning within the narrow confines of a single valley the vast army of barbarians that were long since ravaging the land of Thrace. For thee the fearful shriek of the onrushing Alan had no terrors nor the fierceness of the nomad Hun nor the scimitar of the Geloni, nor the Getae's bow or Sarmatian's club. These nations would have been destroyed root and branch had not a traitor by a perfidious trick abused the emperor's ear and caused him to withhold his hand; hence the sheathing of the sword, the raising of the siege, and the granting of a treaty to the prisoners.

He was always with the army, seldom in Rome, and then only when the young emperor's anxious love summoned him thither. Scarce had he greeted the gods of his home, scarce seen his wife when, still stained with the blood of his enemies, he hastened back to the battle. He did not stay to catch at least a kiss from Eucherius through his vizor; the anxieties of a general

hostilesque globos tumulo
 prosternis amici;
inferiis gens tota datur. nec
 Mulciber auctor
mendacis clipei fabricataque
 vatibus arma 105
conatus iuvere tuos: tot barbara
 solus
milia iam pridem miseram
 vastantia Thracen
finibus exiguae vallis conclusa
 tenebas.
nec te terrisonus stridor
 venientis Alani
nec vaga Chunorum feritas, non
 falce Gelonus, 110
non arcu pepulere Getae, non
 Sarmata conto.
extinctique forent penitus, ni
 more maligno
falleret Augustas occultus
 proditor aures
obstrueretque moras
 strictumque reconderet
 ensem,
solveret obsessos, praeberet
 foedera captis. 115
 Adsiduus castris aderat,
 rarissimus urbi,
si quando trepida princeps
 pietate vocaret;
vixque salutatis Laribus, vix
 coniuge visa,
deterso necdum repetebat
 sanguine campum.
nec stetit Eucherii dum carperet
 oscula saltem 120
nec galeam patris stimulos

o'ercame a father's yearning and a
husband's love. How often has he
bivouacked through the Thracian
winter and endured beneath the open
sky the blasts that slow Boötes sends
from mount Rhiphaeus. When others,
huddled over the fire, could scarce
brook the cold, he would ride his
horse across the frozen Danube and
climb Athos deep in snow, his helmet
on his head, thrusting aside the
frozen branches of the ice-laden
trees with his far gleaming targe.
Now he pitched his tent by the
shores of Cimmerian Pontus, now

per galeam. paulis summos

ignisque^[374] mariti

vicit cura ducis. quotiens sub

pellibus egit

Edonas hiemes et tardi flabra

Bootae

sub divo Riphaca tulit! cumque

igne propinquo

frigora vix ferrent alii, tunc iste

rigentem¹²⁵

Danuvium calcabat eques

nivibusque profundum

scandebat cristatus Athon

lateque corusco

curvatas glacie silvas umbone

ruebat.

nunc prope Cimmerii tendebat

litora Ponti,

[375]

misty Rhodope afforded him a winter's bed. I call you to witness, cold valleys of Haemus, that Stilicho has often filled with bloody slaughter; and you, rivers of Thrace, your waters turned to blood; say, ye Bisaltæ, or you whose oxen plough Pangæus' slopes, how many a rotting helm has not your share shattered neath the soil, how oft have not your mattocks rung against the giant bones of slaughtered kings.

Fain would I embrace each separate one; but thine exploits press on in too close array, and I am overwhelmed by the pursuing flood of glorious deeds. When Theodosius had warred against, and slain, the tyrant^[187] he ascended into heaven, leaving the governance of the world to thee. With a strength equal to his thou dost bear up the tottering structure of the empire that threatens each moment to collapse. Thus, when once Hercules upheld the world, the universal frame hung more surely poised, the Standard-bearer did not reel with tottering stars, and old Atlas, relieved for a moment of the eternal load, was confounded as he gazed upon his own burden.

Barbary was quiet, no revolution troubled the empire's peace and though so great a prince was dead

nunc dabat hibernum Rhodope
 nimbosa cubile. 130
 vos Haemi gelidae valles, quas
 saepe cruentis
 stragibus aequavit Stilicho, vos
 Thracia testor
 flumina, quae largo mutastis
 sanguine fluctus;
 dicite, Bisaltae vel qui Pangaea
 iuvençis
 scinditis, offenso quanta sub
 vomere putres 135
 dissiliant glaebis galeae vel
 qualia rastris
 ossa peremptorum resonent
 inmania regum.
 Singula complecti cuperem;
 sed densior instat
 gestorum series laudumque
 sequentibus undis
 obruimur. genitor caesi post
 bella tyranni 140
 iam tibi commissis
 conscenderat aethera
 terris.
 ancipites rerum ruituro culmine
 lapsus
 aequali cervice subis: sic
 Hercule quondam
 sustentante polum melius
 librata pependit
 machina nec dubiis titubavit
 Signifer astris 145
 perpetuaque senex subductus
 mole parumper
 obstupuit proprii spectator
 ponderis Atlas.
 Nulli barbariae motus: nil

the world knew not that the reins had
 passed into another's hands. No
 company in the two armies^[188] dared
 aught as though set loose from
 control. Yet surely never had such
 diversities of language and arms met
 together to form one united people.
 Theodosius had unified the whole
 East beneath his rule. Here were
 mingled Colchian and Iberian,
 mitred Arab, beautifully coifed
 Armenian; here the Sacian had
 pitched his painted tent, the Mede
 his

^[187] i.e. Eugenius.

^[188] i.e. of East and West.

INNUM BARBARAE MOTUS, III
 turbida rupto^[376]
 ordine temptavit novitas,
 tantoque remoto
 principe mutatas orbis non
 sensit habenas. 150
 nil inter geminas acies, ceu
 libera frenis,
 ausa manus. certe nec tantis
 dissona linguis
 turba nec armorum cultu
 diversior umquam
 confluit populus: totam pater
 undique secum
 moverat Auroram; mixtis hic
 Colchus Hiberis, 155
 hic mitra velatus Arabs, hic
 crine decorus
 Armenius; hic picta Saces
 fucataque Medus,

[377]

stained tent, the dusky Indian his
 embroidered tent: here were the tall
 company of warriors from the Rhone
 and the warlike children of Ocean.
 Stilicho and Stilicho alone
 commanded all the nations looked
 on by the rising and the setting sun.
 Amid this company so diverse in
 blood and speech such peace reigned
 beneath thy rule, so did fear of
 justice secure right, that not a single
 vineyard was robbed, nor did a
 single field cheat the husbandman of
 its plundered crop; rage incited to no
 violence, passion to no deeds of
 shame; the peaceful sword was
 obedient to law. Of a truth their
 leaders' pattern passes to the crowd,
 and the soldier follows not only the
 standards but also the example of his
 general.

Whithersoever thou didst lead thy
 victorious eagles there rivers grew
 dry, drunk up by so many thousands
 of men. Didst thou march towards
 Illyria, plain and mountain were
 hidden; didst thou give the signal to
 thy fleet, the Ionian main was lost
 beneath thy ships. Cloud-girt
 Ceraunia, the storms that dash the
 waves in foam on Leucas'
 promontory—these could not
 affright any. Shouldst thou bid them
 explore some frozen sea, thy
 untroubled soldiers would shatter the

hic gemmata niger tentoria
 fixerat Indus;
 hic Rhodani procera cohors, hic
 miles alumnus
 Oceani. ductor Stilicho tot
 gentibus unus, 160
 quot vel progrediens vel
 conspicit occiduus sol.
 in quo tam vario vocum
 generumque tumultu
 tanta quies iurisque metus
 servator honesti
 te moderante fuit, nullis ut
 vinea furtis
 vel seges erepta fraudaret messe
 colonus, 165
 ut nihil aut saevum rabies aut
 turpe libido
 suaderet, placidi servirent
 legibus enses.
 scilicet in vulgus manant
 exempla regentum,
 utque ducum lituos, sic mores
 castra sequuntur.
 Denique felices aquilas
 quocumque moveres, 170
 arebant tantis epoti milibus
 amnes.
 Illyricum peteres: campi
 montesque latebant.
 vexillum navale dares: sub
 puppibus ibat
 Ionium. nullas^[189] succincta
 Ceraunia nimbis
 nec iuga Leucatae feriens
 spumantia fluctu 175
 deterrebat hiems. tu si glaciale
 inhorres

congealed waters with
 countervailing oar; had they to seek
 the deserts of the south, to search out
 the sources of the Nile, their sails
 would penetrate into Ethiopia's
 midmost heat.

Thee mindful Eurotas, thee Lycaeus'
 rustic muse, thee Maenalus
 celebrates in pastoral song, and
 therewith the woods of Parthenius,
 where, thanks to thy victorious arms,
 weary Greece has raised once more
 her head from amid the flames. Then
 did Ladon, river of Arcadia, stay his
 course amid the countless bodies,

[189] ^{HYPERES} ~~Al nullis~~; other MSS. nullis,
vestigat ~~per totum~~, ^{sed} ~~seu~~ ^{non} ~~oblat~~
an object (as A and Π indicate).
^{ducti} Possibly, then, nullas.
stagna reluctantes quaterent

Saturnia remi;
si deserta Noti, fontem si
quaerere Nili,
Aethiopum medios penetrassent
vela vapores. 180
Te memor Eurotas, te rustica
Musa Lycaeï,
te pastorali modulantur
Maenala cantu
Partheniumque nemus, quod te
pugnante resurgens
aegra caput mediis erexit
Graecia flammis.
plurima Parrhasius tunc inter
corpora Ladon 185

and Alphaeus, choked with heaps of slaughtered Getae, won his way more slowly to his Sicilian love.^[190]

Do we wonder that the foe so swiftly yields in battle when they fall before the sole terror of his name? We did not declare war on the Franks; yet they were overthrown. We did not crush in battle the Suebi on whom we now impose our laws. Who could believe it? Fierce Germany was our slave or ever the trumpets rang out. Where are now thy wars, Drusus, or thine, Trajan? All that your hands wrought after doubtful conflict that Stilicho did as he passed along, and o'ercame the Rhine in as many days as you could do in years; you conquered with the sword, he with a word; you with an army, he single-handed. Descending from the river's source to where it splits in twain and to the marshes that connect its mouths he flashed his lightning way. The speed of the general outstripped the river's swift course, and Peace, starting with him from Rhine's source, grew as grew Rhine's waters. Chieftains whose names were once so well known, flaxen-haired warrior-kings whom neither gifts nor prayers could win over to obedience to Rome's emperors, hasten at his command and fear to offend by dull delay. Crossing the river in boats

haesit et Alpheus Geticis
angustus acervis
tardior ad Siculos etiam nunc
pergit amores.
Miramur rapidis hostem
succumbere bellis,
cum solo terrore ruant? non
classica Francis
intulimus: iacuerunt tamen. non
Marte Suebos 190
contudimus, quis iura damus.
quis credere possit?
ante tubam nobis audax
Germania servit.
cedant, Druse, tui, cedant,
Traiane, labores:
vestra manus dubio quidquid
discrimine gessit,
transcurrens egit Stilicho
totidemque diebus 195
edomuit Rhenum, quot vos
potuistis in annis;
quem ferro, adloquii; quem
vos cum milite, solus.
impiger a primo descendens
fluminis ortu
ad bifidos tractus et iuncta
paludibus ora
fulmineum perstrinxit iter;
ducis impetus undas 200
vincebat celeres, et pax a fonte
profecta
cum Rheni crescebat aquis.
ingentia quondam
nomina, crinigeri flaventes
vertice reges,
qui nec principibus donis
precibusque vocati

they meet him wheresoever he will.
The fame of his justice did not play
them false: they found him merciful,
they found him trustworthy. Him
whom at his coming the German
feared, at his departure he loved.
Those dread tribes whose wont it
was ever to set their price on peace
and let us purchase repose by
shameful tribute, offered their
children as hostages and begged for
peace with such suppliant looks that
one would have thought them

[190] i.e. Arethusa.

precibusque vocati
paruerant, iussi^[380] properant
segnique verentur 205
offendisse mora; transvecti
lintribus amnem
occursant ubicumque velit. nec
fama fefellit
iustitiae: videre pium, videre
fidelem.
quem veniens timuit, rediens
Germanus amavit.
illi terribiles, quibus otia
vendere semper 210
mos erat et foeda requiem
mercede pacisci,
natis obsidibus pacem tam
supplice vultu

[381]

captives, their hands bound behind their backs, and they mounting the Tarpeian rock with the chains of slavery upon their necks. All those lands that lie between Ocean and the Danube trembled at the approach of one man. Boreas was brought into servitude without a blow; the Great Bear was disarmed.

In so short a time didst thou win so many battles without loss of blood, and, setting out with the moon yet new, thou didst return or ever it was full; so didst thou compel the threatening Rhine to learn gentleness with shattered horns, that the Salian now tills his fields, the Sygambrian beats his straight sword into a curved sickle, and the traveller, as he looks at the two banks, asks over which Rome rules. The Belgian, too, pastures his flock across the river and the Chauci heed it not; Gallic herds cross the middle Elbe and wander over the hills of the Franks. Safe it is to hunt amid the vast silence of the distant Hercynian forest, and in the woods that old-established superstition has rendered awful our axes fell the trees the barbarian once worshipped and nought is said.

Nay more, devoted to their conqueror this people offers its arms in his defence. How oft has Germany

captivoque rogant, quam si post
terga revincti
Tarpeias pressis subeant
cervicibus arces.
omne, quod Oceanum fontesque
interiacet Histri, 215
unius incursu tremuit; sine
caede subactus
servitio Boreas exarmatique
Triones.

Tempore tam parvo tot
proelia sanguine nullo
perficis et luna nuper nascente
profectus
ante redis, quam tota fuit,
Rhenumque minacem
220

cornibus infractis adeo
mitescere cogis,
ut Salius iam rura colat
flexosque Sygambrus
in falcem curvet gladios,
geminasque viator
cum videat ripas, quae sit
Romana, requirat;
ut iam trans fluvium non
indignante Chauco 225
pascat Belga pecus, mediumque
ingressa per Albim
Gallica Francorum montes
armenta pererrent;
ut procul Hercyniae per vasta
silentia silvae
venari tuto liceat, lucosque
vetusta
religione truces et robur
numinis instar 230
barbarici nostrae feriant impune

begged to add her troops to thine and
to join her forces with those of
Rome! Nor yet was she angered
when her offer was rejected, for
though her aid was refused her
loyalty came off with praise.
Provence will sooner drive out the
governor thou sendest than will the
land of the Franks expel the ruler
thou hast given them. Not to rout
rebels in the field but to punish them
with chains is now the law; under
our judge a Roman prison holds
inquest

barbari nosque tenant impune
bipennes.^[382]

Utro quin etiam devota
mente tuentur
victorique favent. quotiens
sociare catervas
oravit iungique tuis Alamannia
signis!
nec doluit contempta tamen,
spretoque recessit 235
auxilio laudata fides. provincia
missos
expellet citius fasces quam
Francia reges,
quos dederis. acie nec iam
pulsare rebelles,
sed vinclis punire licet; sub
iudice nostro
regia Romanus disquirit crimina
carcer: 240

[383]

on the crimes of kings. Marcomeres and Sunno^[191] give proof: the one underwent exile in Etruria, the other, proclaiming himself the exile's avenger, fell beneath the swords of his own soldiers. Both were eager to arouse rebellion, both hated peace—true brothers in character and in a common love of crime.

After the conquest of the north arose a fresh storm in another quarter. The trumpets of war rang out in the south that there might be no part of the world untouched by thy victories. Gildo stirred up all the Moorish tribes living beneath mount Atlas and those whom the excessive heat of the sun cuts off from us in the interior of Africa, those too whom Cinyps' wandering stream waters, and Triton, neighbour of the garden of the Hesperides; those who dwell beside the waters of Gir, most famous of the rivers of Ethiopia, that overflows his banks as it had been another Nile. There came at his summons the Nubian with his head-dress of short arrows, the fleet Garamantian, the Nasamonian whose impetuous ardour not even the sinister predictions of Ammon could restrain. The plain of Numidia was overrun, their dust covered the Gaetulian Syrtes; the sky of Carthage was darkened with their

Marcomeres Sunnoque docet;
 quorum alter Etruscum
 pertulit exilium; cum se
 promitteret alter
 exulis ultorem, iacuit mucrone
 suorum:
 res avidi concire novas odioque
 furentes
 pacis et ingenio scelerumque
 cupidine fratres. 245
 Post domitas Arctos alio
 prorupit ab axe
 tempestas et, ne qua tuis intacta
 tropaeis
 pars foret, Australis sonuit tuba.
 moverat omnes
 Maurorum Gildo populos,
 quibus inminet Atlas
 et quos interior nimio plaga sole
 relegat: 250
 quos vagus umectat Cinyps et
 proximus hortis
 Hesperidum Triton et Gir
 notissimus amnis
 Aethiopum, simili mentitus
 gurgite Nilum;
 venerat et parvis redimitus
 Nuba sagittis
 et velox Garamas, nec quamvis
 tristibus Hammon 255
 responsis alacrem potuit
 Nasamona morari.
 stipantur Numidae campi, stant
 pulvere Syrtes
 Gaetulae, Poenus iaculis
 obtextitur aër.
 hi virga moderantur equos; his
 fulva leones

arrows. Some, mounted, guide their horses with sticks, others are clad in tawny lion-skins and pelts of the nameless animals that range the vast deserts of Meroë. Severed heads of serpents with gaping jaws serve them for helmets, the bright scaly skin of the viper fashions their quivers. Simois trembled not so violently when swart Memnon led his dusky troops o'er Ida's summit. Not so fearful was Ganges when Porus approached, mounted on his towering elephant and surrounded with his far-shooting Indian soldiery.

[\[191\]](#) Marcomeres and Sunno, brother chiefs of the Ripuarian Franks, had (?in connexion with Maximus' revolt) invaded Roman territory near Cologne in 388 and been defeated by Arbogast. Stilicho's successful campaign against them, of which we read here, is to be dated 395 (?March).

iuua leones
 velamenta dabant^[384] ignotarumque
 ferarum 260
 exuviae, vastis Meroë quas
 nutrit harenis;
 serpentum patulos gestant pro
 casside rictus;
 pendent viperae squamosa
 pelle pharetrae.
 non sic intremuit Simois, cum
 montibus Idae
 nigra coloratus produceret
 agmina Memnon, 265
 non Ganges, cum tela procul
 vibrantibus Indis
 inmanis medium vectaret belua
 Porum.

[385]

Yet Porus was defeated by Alexander, Memnon by Achilles, and Gildo by thee.

It was not, however, only the South that fierce Mars aroused but also the East. Though loyalty cried out against it Gildo had transferred the nominal rule of Libya to the Eastern empire, cloaking his base treason under the name of legitimate government.^[192] Thus with diverse terror a twofold war arose; here were arms, there were wiles. Africa supported the one with her savage tribes, the other the conspiring East nurtured with treachery. From Byzantium came edicts to subvert the loyalty of governors; from Africa that refused her crops black famine pressed and had beleaguered trembling Rome. Libya openly meditated our destruction; over the civic strife shame had laid her veil of silence.

Though such storms raged on either hand, though the twofold tempest buffeted the torn empire on this side and on that, no whit did our consul's courage yield to weariness, but ever watchful against threatening doom and soon to win prosperous issue, shone greater amid dangers: as the ship's pilot, tossed in mid Aegean by the storms of rainy Orion, eludes the waves' buffeting by the least turn of

Porus Alexandro, Memnon
prostratus Achilli,
Gildo nempe tibi.

Nec solum
fervidus Austrum,
sed partes etiam Mavors
agitabat Eoas. 270
quamvis obstreperet pietas, his
ille regendae
transtulerat nomen Libyae
scelerique profano
fallax legitimam regni
praetenderat umbram.
surgebat geminum varia
formidine bellum,
hoc armis, hoc triste dolis. hoc
Africa saevis 275
cinxerat auxiliis, hoc coniuratus
alebant
insidiis Oriens. illinc edicta
meabant
corruptura duces; hinc frugibus
atra negatis
urgebat trepidamque fames
obsederat urbem.
exitiale palam Libycum; civile
pudoris 280
obtentu tacitum.

Tales
utrimque procellae
cum fremerent lacerumque
alternis ictibus anceps
imperium pulsaret hiems, nil
fessa remisit
officii virtus contraque minantia
fata
pervigil eventusque sibi latura
secundos 285

the tiller, skilfully guiding his vessel
now on straight, now on slanting
course, and struggles successfully
against the conjoint fury of sea and
sky.

At what, Stilicho, shall I first
marvel? At the providence that
resisted all intrigues, whereby no
treacherous missive, no bribe-fraught
hand escaped thy notice? Or because
that amid the general terror thou
spakest no word unworthy of
Latium? Or because thou didst ever
give haughty answer to the East and
later made that answer

[192] Africa belonged to the West.
Gildo, in the words of Zosimus (v. 11.
2), ἀφίστησι τὴν χῶραν τῆς Ὀνωρίου
βασιλείας καὶ τῇ Ἀρκαδίου
προστίθουσιν.

maior in adversis micuit: velut
 arbiter alni,
 nubilus Aegaeo quam turbine
 vexat Orion,
 exiguo clavi flexu declinat
 aquarum
 verbera, nunc recta, nunc
 obliquante carina
 callidus, et pelagi caelique
 obnititur irae. 290
 Quid primum, Stilicho,
 mirer? quod cautus ad
 omnes
 restiteris fraudes, ut te nec
 noxia furto
 littera nec pretio manus
 inflammata lateret?
 quod nihil in tanto circum
 terrore locutus
 indignum Latio? responsa quod
 ardua semper 295
 Eois dederis, quae mox effecta
 probasti—

good? They held thy goods, thy lands, thy houses, yet wast thou unmoved. This thou didst account a trifling loss nor ever preferred private to public interest. Thy mighty task thou dost parcel out, yet dost thou face it all alone, debating the problems that must needs be thought out, acting where deeds are called for, ever ready to dictate where aught is to be accomplished by writing. What hundred-handed monster, what Briareus, whose arms ever grew more numerous as they were lopped off, could cope with all these things at once? To avoid the snares of treachery, to strengthen existing regiments and enroll new ones, to equip two fleets, one of corn-ships, one of men-of-war, to quell the tumult of the court and alleviate the hunger of the Roman populace—what eyes, never visited by the veil of sleep, have had the strength to turn their gaze in so many directions and over so many lands or to pierce so far? Fame tells how Argus girt with a hundred eyes could guard but one heifer with his body's watch.

Whence comes this mass of corn? What forest fashioned all those vessels? Whence has sprung this untutored army with all its young recruits? Whence has Gaul, its age once more at the spring, won back

securus, quamvis et opes et rura
 tenerent
 insignesque domos? levis haec
 iactura; nec umquam
 publica privatae cesserunt
 commoda causae.
 dividis ingentes curas teque
 omnibus unum 300
 obicis, inveniens animo quae
 mente gerenda,
 efficiens patranda manu, dictare
 paratus
 quae scriptis peragenda forent.
 quae brachia centum,
 quis Briareus aliis numero
 crescente lacertis
 tot simul obiectis posset
 confligere rebus: 305
 evitare dolos; veteres firmare
 cohortes,
 explorare novas; duplices
 disponere classes,
 quae fruges aut bella ferant;
 aulaeque tumultum
 et Romae lenire famem? quot
 nube soporis
 innumeros oculi per tot discurrere
 partes, 310
 tot loca sufficerent et tam
 longinqua tueri?
 Argum fama canit centeno
 lumine cinctum
 corporis excubiis unam servasse
 iuvencam!
 Unde tot adlatae segetes?
 quae silva carinas
 texuit? unde rudis tanto tirone
 inventus 315

the strength that Alpine blows twice
 shattered^[193]? Methinks 'tis no levy
 but the ploughshare of the
 Phoenician Cadmus that has raised
 up thus suddenly a host sprung from
 the sowing of the dragon's teeth; 'tis
 like the crop that in the fields of
 Thebes drew the sword of kin in
 threatened battle with its own sower
 when, the seed once sown, the earth-
 born giants clave the earth, their
 mother's womb, with their springing
 helms and a harvest of

^[193] In the wars against, respectively,
 Eugenius and the Goths.

emicuit senioque^[388] iterum
 vernante resumpsit
 Gallia bis fractas Alpino
 vulnere vires?
 non ego dilectu, Tyrii sed
 vomere Cadmi
 tam subitas acies concepto
 dente draconis
 exiluisse reor: Dircaeis qualis in
 arvis 320
 messis cum proprio mox
 bellatura colono
 cognatos strinxit gladios, cum
 semine iacto
 terrigenae galea matrem
 nascente ferirent

young soldiery burgeoned along the
 armèd furrows. This too must not be
 passed over without full meed of
 praise, that the avenging expedition
 did not embark until the senate had,
 in accordance with antique usage,
 declared war. Stilicho re-established
 this custom, neglected for so many
 ages, that the Fathers should give
 generals charge to fight, and by
 decree of the toga-clad Senate the
 battle-token pass auspiciously
 among the legions. We acknowledge
 that the laws of Romulus have now
 returned when we see arms obedient
 to our ministers.

Thou couldst have filled the
 Tyrrhene sea with all thy standards,
 the Syrtes with thy fleet and Libya
 with thy battalions, but wrath was
 stayed o'ercome by prudent fear lest
 Gildo, terrified at the thought that
 thou wast in arms against him and
 suspecting that thy forces were of
 overwhelming strength, might retire
 into the hot desert and the torrid
 zone, or travel east in flight or, to
 console him for the certainty of
 death, might destroy his cities with
 fire. Marvellous it is to tell: thou
 wast fearful of being feared and
 forbade him to despair whom thy
 vengeance awaited. How greatly was
 his confidence our gain! Safe are the
 towers of hostile Carthage, and the

armifer et viridi floreret milite
sulcus.
hoc quoque non parva fas est
cum laude relinqui, 325
quod non ante fretis exercitus
adstitit ultor,
ordine quam prisco censeret
bella senatus.
neglectum Stilicho per tot iam
saecula morem
rettulit, ut ducibus mandarent
proelia patres
decretoque togae felix
legionibus iret 330
tessera. Romuleas leges rediisse
fatemur,
cum procerum iussis famulantia
cernimus arma.
Tyrrenum poteras cunctis
transmittere signis
et ratibus Syrtes, Libyam
complere manipulis;
consilio stetit ira minor, ne
territus ille 335
te duce suspecto Martis
graviores paratu
aut in harenosos aestus
zonamque rubentem
tenderet aut solis fugiens
transiret in ortus
missurusve sibi certae solacia
mortis
oppida dirueret flammis. res
mira relatu: 340
ne timeare times et, quem
vindicta manebat,
desperare vetas. quantum
fiducia nobis

Phoenician fields rejoice in their
unharm'd husbandmen, fields he
might have laid waste in his flight.
Deluded by a vain hope he spared
what was ours without escaping
chastisement for himself. Madman,
to measure Rome by the numbers
instead of the valour of her soldiers!
He advanced as though he would
ride them all down by means of his
fleet cavalry and, as he often
boasted, would overwhelm in the
dust the Gauls enervated by the sun's
heat. But he soon learned that neither
wounds

profuit! hostilis^[390] salvae
Carthaginis arces;
inlaesis Tyrii gaudent cultoribus
agri,
quos potuit vastare fuga. spe
captus inani³⁴⁵
nec se subripuit poenae
nostrisque pepercit:
demens, qui numero tantum,
non robore mensus
Romanos rapidis ibat ceu
protinus omnes
calcaturus equis et, quod iactare
solebat,
solibus effetos mersurus pulvere
Gallos. 350

[391]

made more deadly by the poisoned arrow of Ethiopia nor thick hail of javelins nor clouds of horsemen can withstand Latin spears. The cowardly Nasamonian troops are scattered, the Garamantian hurls not his spears but begs for mercy, the swift-footed Autololes fly to the desert, the terror-stricken Mazacian flings away his arms, in vain the Moor urges on his flagging steed. The brigand flees in a small boat and driven back by the winds met with his just fate in the harbour of Tabraca, discovering that no element offered refuge, Stilicho, to thine enemies. There he was destined to undergo the insults of the overjoyed populace and to bow his guilty head before a lowly judgement-seat.

Let not Fortune claim aught for herself. Let her be ever favourable; but we trusted not the issue to a single fight, nor was the hazard set with all our force to be lost at a single throw. Had hard chance at all prevailed, a second fleet pressed on behind, a greater leader was yet to come.

Never was a more famous victory nor one that was the object of more heart-felt prayers. Will anyone compare with this the defeat of Tigranes, of the king of Pontus, the flight of Pyrrhus or Antiochus, the

Sed didicit non Aethiopum
 geminata venenis
vulnera, non fustum crebris
 hastilibus imbrem,
non equitum nimbos Latiis
 obsistere pilis.
sternitur ignavus Nasamon, nec
 spicula supplex
iam torquet Garamas; repetunt
 deserta fugaces 355
Autololes; pavidus proiecit missile
 Mazax.
cornipedem Maurus nequiquam
 hortatur anhelum;
praedonem lembo profugum
 ventisque repulsum
suscepit merito fatalis Tabraca
 portu
expertum quod nulla tuis elementa
 paterent 360
hostibus, et laetae passurum iurgia
 plebis
fracturumque reos humili sub
 iudice vultus.
 Nil tribuat Fortuna sibi. sit
 prospera semper
illa quidem; sed non uni certamina
 pugnae
credidimus totis nec constitit alea
 castris 365
nutatura semel; si quid licuisset
 iniquis
casibus, instabant aliae post terga
 biremes;
venturus dux maior erat.

Victoria

 nulla
clarior aut hominum votis optatior

capture of Jugurtha, the overthrow of Perses or Philip? Their fall meant but the enlargement of the empire's bounds; on Gildo's depended the very existence of Rome. In those cases delay entailed no ill; in this a late-won victory was all but a defeat. On this supreme issue, while leanness racked her people, hung the fate of Rome; and to win back Libya was a greater gain than its first conquest, even as to lose a possession stirs a heavier pain than never to have had it. Who would

clamosi aut hominum vocis optationi
umquam^[392]

contigit, a Scipioque Tigranem,

Regule, Posti, 370

vel Plenum Antiochum fugam

tele vincam purthae

conferat aut Persen debellatumque

Philippum? Maurus?

hic propagandi ruerant pro dimitte

regna lauros;

hic stabas Romana cunctos tibi,

Tempora triumphos. 385

traxerunt dilata moras; hic vincere

tarde 375

vinci paene fuit. discrimine Roma

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supremo

inter supplicium populi deforme

pependit;

et tantum Libyam fructu maiore

recepit

quam peperit, quantum graviolem

amissa dolorem

quam necdum quaesita movent.

quis Punica gesta,

[393]

now be telling of the Punic wars, of
you, ye Scipios, or of thee, Regulus;
who would sing of cautious Fabius,
if, destroying right, the fierce Moor
were trampling on an enslaved
Carthage? This victory, Rome, has
revived the laurels of thy heroes of
old; Stilicho has restored to thee all
thy triumphs.

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